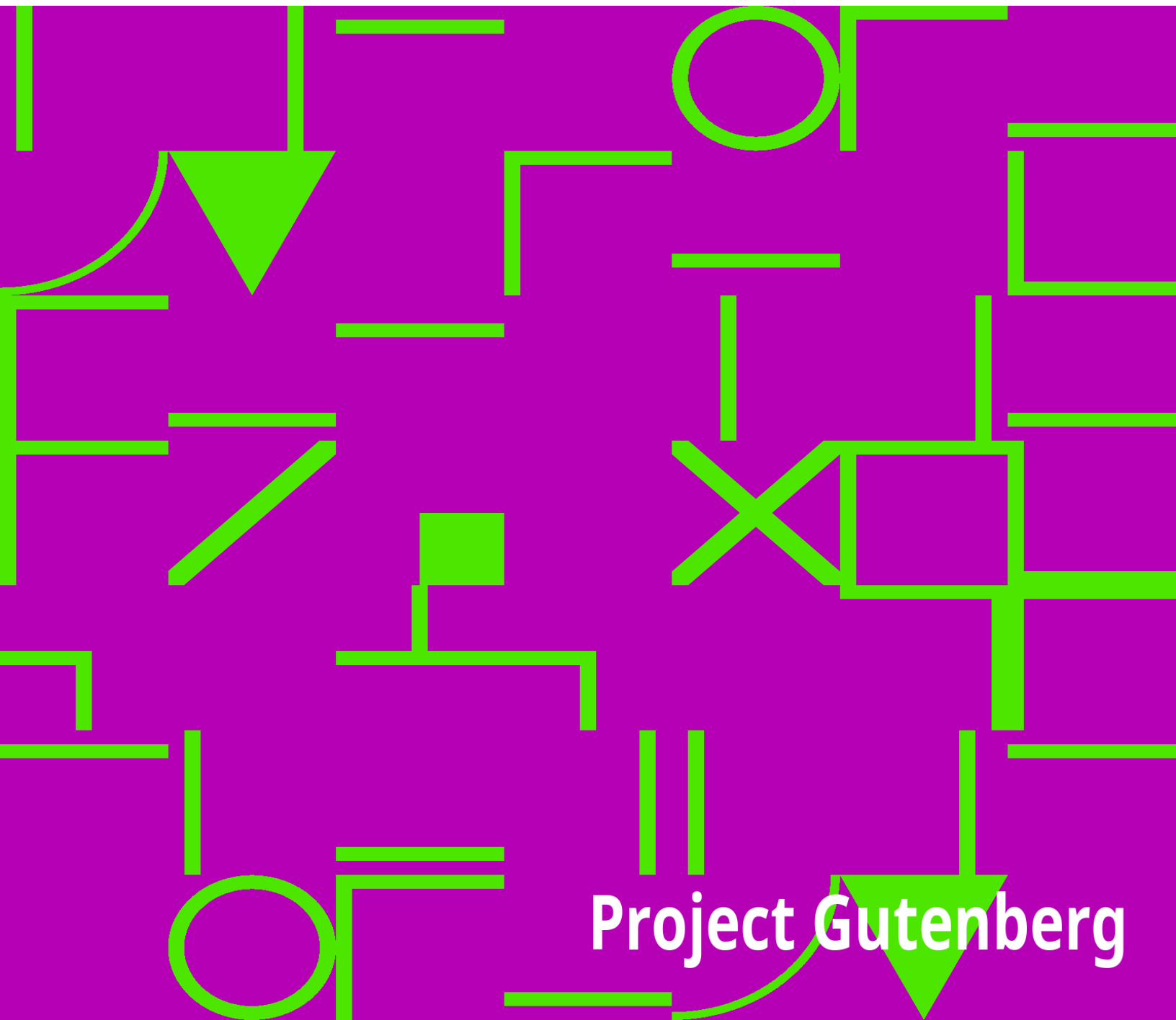


The Works of Lord Byron, Vol. 1. Poetry

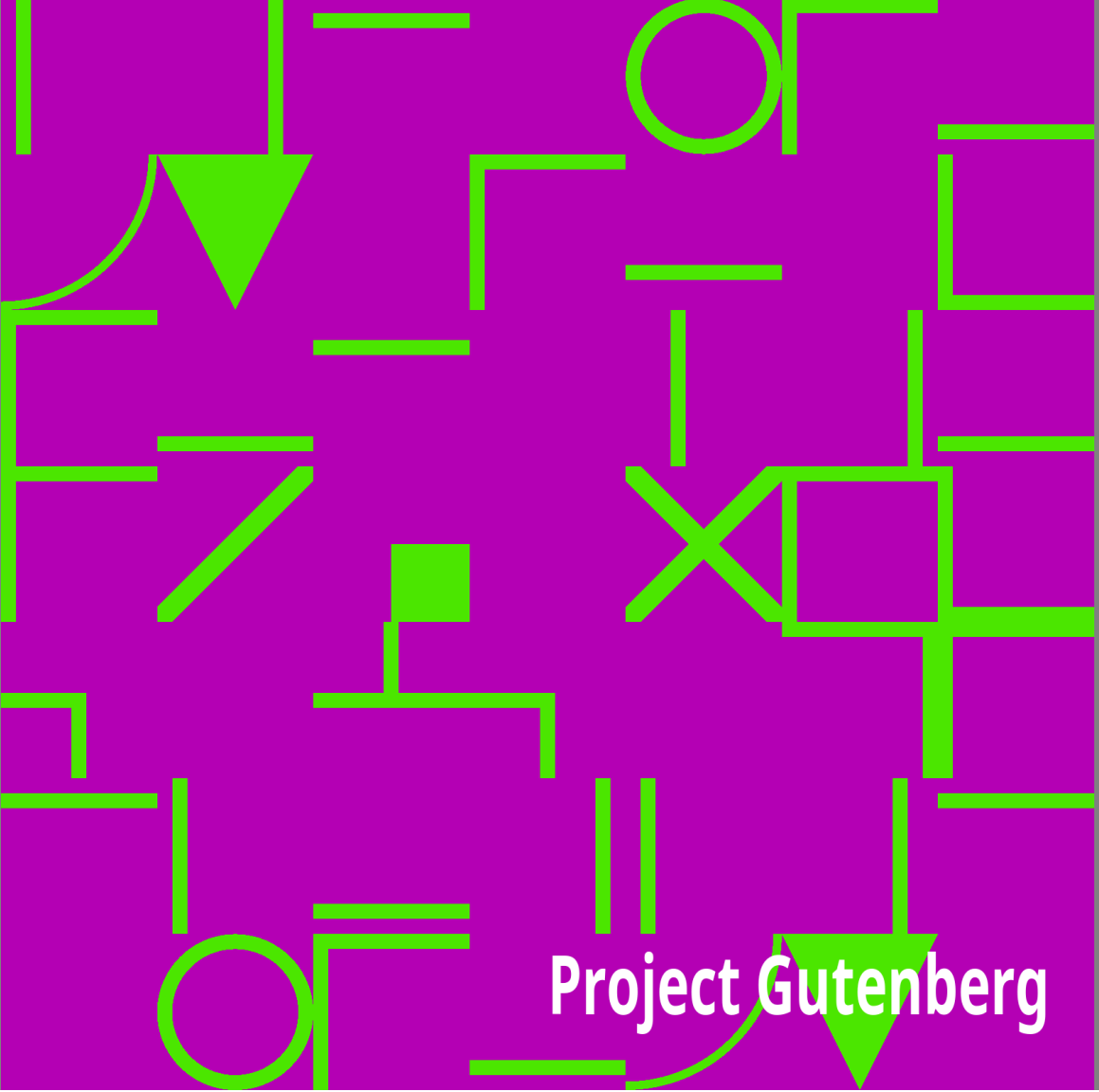
Baron George Gordon Byron Byron and

An abstract geometric pattern consisting of various black lines, circles, squares, and triangles of different sizes and orientations, scattered across a white background.

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The Works of Lord Byron, Vol. 1. Poetry

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Title: The Works of Lord Byron, Vol. 1. Poetry

Author: Baron George Gordon Byron Byron

Editor: Ernest Hartley Coleridge

Release date: September 1, 2005 [eBook #8861]

Most recently updated: April 4, 2020

Language: English

Other information and formats: www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/8861

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LORD BYRON, VOL. 1. POETRY ***

Byron's Poetical Works

a new, revised and enlarged edition, with illustrations

Volume 1.

edited by Ernest Hartley Coleridge.

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Preface

The text of the present issue of Lord Byron's *Poetical Works* is based on that of *The Works of Lord Byron*, in six volumes, 12mo, which was published by John Murray in 1831. That edition followed the text of the successive issues of plays and poems which appeared in the author's lifetime, and were subject to his own revision, or that of Gifford and other accredited readers. A more or less thorough collation of the printed volumes with the MSS. which were at Moore's disposal, yielded a number of *variorum* readings which have appeared in subsequent editions published by John Murray. Fresh collations of the text of individual poems with the original MSS. have been made from time to time, with the result that the text of the latest edition (one-vol. 8vo, 1891) includes some emendations, and has been supplemented by additional variants. Textual errors of more or less importance, which had crept into the numerous editions which succeeded the seventeen-volume edition of 1832, were in some instances corrected, but in others passed over. For the purposes of the present edition the printed text has been collated with all the MSS. which passed through Moore's hands, and, also, for the first time, with MSS. of the following plays and poems, viz. *English Bards, and Scotch Reviewers*; *Childe Harold*, Canto IV.; *Don Juan*, Cantos VI.-XVI.; *Werner*; *The Deformed Transformed*; *Lara*; *Parisina*; *The Prophecy of Dante*; *The Vision of Judgment*; *The Age of Bronze*; *The Island*. The only works of any importance which have been printed directly from the text of the first edition, without reference to the MSS., are the following, which appeared in *The Liberal* (1822-23), viz.: *Heaven and Earth*, *The Blues*, and *Morgante Maggiore*.

A new and, it is believed, an improved punctuation has been adopted. In this respect Byron did not profess to prepare his MSS. for the press, and the punctuation, for which Gifford is mainly responsible, has been reconsidered with reference solely to the meaning and interpretation of the sentences as they occur.

In the *Hours of Idleness and Other Early Poems*, the typography of the first

four editions, as a rule, has been preserved. A uniform typography in accordance with modern use has been adopted for all poems of later date.

- *Variants*, being the readings of one or more MSS. or of successive editions, are [included as alphabetical footnotes to each poem —html Ed.]
- Words and lines through which the author has drawn his pen in the MSS. or Revises are marked *MS. erased*.
- Poems and plays are given, so far as possible, in chronological order. *Childe Harold* and *Don Juan*, which were written and published in parts, are printed continuously; and minor poems, including the first four satires, have been arranged in groups according to the date of composition.
- Epigrams and *jeux d'esprit* have been placed together, in chronological order, towards the end of the sixth volume.
- A Bibliography of the poems will immediately precede the Index at the close of the **sixth volume**.

The edition contains at least thirty hitherto **unpublished poems**, including fifteen stanzas of the unfinished seventeenth canto of *Don Juan*, and a considerable fragment of the third part of *The Deformed Transformed*. The eleven unpublished poems from MSS. preserved at Newstead, which appear in the first volume, are of slight if any literary value, but they reflect with singular clearness and sincerity the temper and aspirations of the tumultuous and moody stripling to whom "the numbers came," but who wisely abstained from printing them himself.

Byron's **notes**, of which many are published for the first time, and editorial notes, [are included as numerical footnotes to each poem—html Ed.] The editorial notes are designed solely to supply the reader with references to passages in other works illustrative of the text, or to interpret expressions and allusions which lapse of time may have rendered obscure.

Much of the knowledge requisite for this purpose is to be found in the articles of the *Dictionary of National Biography*, to which the fullest acknowledgments are due; and much has been arrived at after long research,

involving a minute examination of the literature, the magazines, and often the newspapers of the period.

Inasmuch as the poems and plays have been before the public for more than three quarters of a century, it has not been thought necessary to burden the notes with the eulogies and apologies of the great poets and critics who were Byron's contemporaries, and regarded his writings, both for good and evil, for praise and blame, from a different standpoint from ours. Perhaps, even yet, the time has not come for a definite and positive appreciation of his genius. The tide of feeling and opinion must ebb and flow many times before his rank and station among the poets of all time will be finally adjudged. The splendour of his reputation, which dazzled his own countrymen, and, for the first time, attracted the attention of a contemporary European audience to an English writer, has faded, and belongs to history; but the poet's work remains, inviting a more intimate and a more extended scrutiny than it has hitherto received in this country. The reader who cares to make himself acquainted with the method of Byron's workmanship, to unravel his allusions, and to follow the tenour of his verse, will, it is hoped, find some assistance in these volumes.

I beg to record my especial thanks to the Earl of Lovelace for the use of MSS. of his grandfather's poems, including unpublished fragments; for permission to reproduce portraits in his possession; and for valuable information and direction in the construction of some of the notes.

My grateful acknowledgments are due to Dr. Garnett, C.B., Dr. A. H. Murray, Mr. R. E. Graves, and other officials of the British Museum, for invaluable assistance in preparing the notes, and in compiling a bibliography of the poems.

I have also to thank Mr. Leslie Stephen and others for important hints and suggestions with regard to the interpretation of some obscure passages in *Hints from Horace*.

In correcting the proofs for the press, I have had the advantage of the skill and knowledge of my friend Mr. Frank E. Taylor, of Chertsey, to whom my thanks are due.

On behalf of the Publisher, I beg to acknowledge with gratitude the kindness of the Lady Dorchester, the Earl Stanhope, Lord Glenesk and Sir Theodore Martin, K.C.B., for permission to examine MSS. in their possession; and of Mrs. Chaworth Musters, for permission to reproduce her miniature of Miss Chaworth, and for other favours. He desires also to acknowledge the generous assistance of Mr. and Miss Webb, of Newstead Abbey, in permitting the publication of MS. poems, and in making transcripts for the press.

I need hardly add that, throughout the progress of the work, the advice and direct assistance of Mr. John Murray and Mr. R. E. Prothero have been always within my reach. They have my cordial thanks.

Ernest Hartley Coleridge.

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Poems on Various Occasions

(Facsimile of title-page of second private volume, succeeding the 4to.)

P O E M S

ON

VARIOUS OCCASIONS.

VIRGINIBUS PUERISQUE CANTO.
Hor. Lib. 3. Ode 1.

NEWARK: PRINTED BY S. & J. RIDGE.

MDCCCVII.

THE only Apology necessary
to be adduced, in extenuation of any errors
in the following collection, is, that the Au-
thor has not yet completed his nineteenth
year.

DECEMBER 23, 1806.

Bibliographical Note to 'Hours of Idleness' and Other Early
Poems

There were four distinct issues of Byron's Juvenilia. The first collection, entitled *Fugitive Pieces*, was printed in quarto by S. and J. Ridge of Newark. Two of the poems, *The Tear* and the *Reply to Some Verses of J. M. B. Pigot, Esq.*, were signed "Byron;" but the volume itself, which is without a title-page, was anonymous. It numbers sixty-six pages, and consists of thirty-eight distinct pieces. The last piece, *Imitated from Catullus. To Anna*, is dated November 16, 1806. The whole of this issue, with the exception of two or three copies, was destroyed. An imperfect copy, lacking pp. 17-20 and pp. 58-66, is preserved at Newstead. A perfect copy, which had been retained by the Rev. J. T. Becher, at whose instance the issue was suppressed, was preserved by his family (see *Life*, by Karl Elze, 1872, p. 450), and is now in the possession of Mr. H. Buxton Forman, C.B. A facsimile reprint of this unique volume, limited to one hundred copies, was issued, for private circulation only, from the Chiswick Press in 1886.

Of the thirty-eight *Fugitive Pieces*, two poems, viz. *To Caroline* and *To Mary*, together with the last six stanzas of the lines, *To Miss E. P. [To Eliza]*, have never been republished in any edition of Byron's *Poetical Works*.

A second edition, small octavo, of *Fugitive Pieces*, entitled *Poems on Various Occasions*, was printed by S. and J. Ridge of Newark, and distributed in January, 1807. This volume was issued anonymously. It numbers 144 pages, and consists of a reproduction of thirty-six *Fugitive Pieces*, and of twelve hitherto unprinted poems--forty-eight in all. For references to the distribution of this issue--limited, says Moore, to one hundred copies--see letters to Mr. Pigot and the Earl of Clare, dated January 16, February 6, 1807, and undated letters of the same period to Mr. William Bankes and Mr. Falkner (*Life*, pp. 41, 42). The annotated copy of *Poems on Various Occasions*, referred to in the present edition, is in the British Museum.

Early in the summer (June--July) of 1807, a volume, small octavo, named *Hours of Idleness*--a title henceforth associated with Byron's early poems--was printed and published by S. and J. Ridge of Newark, and was sold by the following London booksellers: Crosby and Co.; Longman, Hurst, Rees, and Orme; F. and C. Rivington; and J. Mawman. The full title is, "*Hours of Idleness; a Series of Poems Original and Translated. By George Gordon, Lord Byron, a Minor*". It numbers 187 pages, and consists of thirty-nine poems. Of these, nineteen belonged to the original *Fugitive Pieces*, eight had first appeared in *Poems on Various Occasions*, and twelve were published for the first time. The "Fragment of a Translation from the 9th Book of Virgil's *Æneid*" (*sic*), numbering sixteen lines, reappears as *The Episode of Nisus and Euryalus, A Paraphrase from the Æneid, Lib. 9*, numbering 406 lines.

The final collection, also in small octavo, bearing the title "*Poems Original and Translated, by George Gordon, Lord Byron*", second edition, was printed and published in 1808 by S. and J. Ridge of Newark, and sold by the same London booksellers as *Hours of Idleness*. It numbers 174 pages, and consists of seventeen of the original *Fugitive Pieces*, four of those first published in *Poems on Various Occasions*, a reprint of the twelve poems first published in *Hours of Idleness*, and five poems which now appeared for the

first time--thirty-eight poems in all. Neither the title nor the contents of this so-called second edition corresponds exactly with the previous issue.

Of the thirty-eight *Fugitive Pieces* which constitute the suppressed quarto, only seventeen appear in all three subsequent issues. Of the twelve additions to *Poems on Various Occasions*, four were excluded from *Hours of Idleness*, and four more from *Poems Original and Translated*.

The collection of minor poems entitled *Hours of Idleness*, which has been included in every edition of Byron's *Poetical Works* issued by John Murray since 1831, consists of seventy pieces, being the aggregate of the poems published in the three issues, *Poems on Various Occasions*, *Hours of Idleness*, and *Poems Original and Translated*, together with five other poems of the same period derived from other sources.

In the present issue a general heading, "*Hours of Idleness*, and other Early Poems," has been applied to the entire collection of *Early Poems*, 1802-1809. The quarto has been reprinted (excepting the lines *To Mary*, which Byron himself deliberately suppressed) in its entirety, and in the original order. The successive additions to the *Poems on Various Occasions*, *Hours of Idleness*, and *Poems Original and Translated*, follow in order of publication. The remainder of the series, viz. poems first published in Moore's *Life and Journals of Lord Byron* (1830); poems hitherto unpublished; poems first published in the *Works of Lord Byron* (1832), and poems contributed to J. C. Hobhouse's *Imitations and Translations* (1809), have been arranged in chronological order. (For an important contribution to the bibliography of the quarto of 1806, and of the other issues of Byron's *Juvenilia*, see papers by Mr. R. Edgcumbe, Mr. H. Buxton Forman, C.B., and others, in the *Athenæum*, 1885, vol. ii. pp. 731-733, 769; and 1886, vol. i. p. 101, etc. For a collation of the contents of the four first issues and of certain large-paper copies of *Hours of Idleness*, etc., see *The Bibliography of the Poetical Works of Lord Byron*, **vol. vi. of the present edition.**)

(Facsimile of title-page of second published impression.)

POEMS

ORIGINAL AND TRANSLATED

BY

GEORGE GORDON, LORD BYRON,

Μητ' ἄρ' με μάλ' αἶψα μῆτε τί νείκεϊ.

HOMER, *Iliad*, 10.

He whistled as he went for want of thought,

DRYDEN.

SECOND EDITION.

Newark:

Printed and sold by S. and J. RIDGE;

SOLD ALSO BY B. CROSBY AND CO. STATIONER'S COURT;
LONGMAN, HURST, REES, AND ORME, PATERNOSTER-
ROW; F. & C. RIVINGTON, ST. PAUL'S CHURCH-
YARD; AND J. MAWMAN, IN THE
POULTRY, LONDON.

1808.

(Facsimile of first published impression.)

Mrs. Byron's Copy

HOURS OF IDLENESS,

A

SERIES OF POEMS,

ORIGINAL

AND

TRANSLATED,

BY GEORGE GORDON, LORD BYRON,

A MINOR.

Μητ' ὅς μ' ἐ μάλ' αἶψα μὲν τὶ νείκερ.

HOMER. *Iliad*, 10.

Virginibus puerisque Canto.

HORACE.

He whistled as he went for want of thought.

DRYDEN.

Newark:

Printed and sold by S. and J. RIDGE;

SOLD ALSO BY B. CROSEY AND CO. STATIONER'S COURT;

LONGMAN, HURST, REES, AND ORME, PATERNOSTER-

ROW; F. AND C. RIVINGTON, ST. PAUL'S CHURCH-

YARD; AND J. MAWMAN, IN THE POULTRY,

LONDON.

1807.

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Bibliographical Note to *English Bards and Scotch Reviewers*

The MS. (MS. M.) of the first draft of Byron's *Satire* (see Letter to Pigot, October 26, 1807) is now in Mr. Murray's possession. It is written on folio sheets paged 6-25, 28-41, and numbers 360 lines. Mutilations on pages 12, 13, 34, 35 account for the absence of ten additional lines.

After the publication of the January number of *The Edinburgh Review* for 1808 (containing the critique on *Hours of Idleness*), which was delayed till the end of February, Byron added a beginning and an ending to the original draft. The MSS. of these additions, which number ninety lines, are written on quarto sheets, and have been bound up with the folios. (Lines 1-16 are missing.) The poem, which with these and other additions had run up to 560 lines, was printed in book form (probably by Ridge of Newark), under the title of *British Bards, A Satire*.

"This Poem," writes Byron [MSS. M.], "was begun in October, 1807, in London, and at different intervals composed from that period till September, 1808, when it was completed at Newstead Abbey.--B., 1808."

A date, 1808, is affixed to the last line. Only one copy is extant, that which was purchased, in 1867, from the executors of R.C. Dallas, by the Trustees of the British Museum. Even this copy has been mutilated. Pages 17, 18, which must have contained the first version of the attack on Jeffrey (see *English Bards*, p. 332, line 439, [note 2](#)), have been torn out, and quarto proof-sheets in smaller type of lines 438-527, "Hail to immortal Jeffrey," etc., together with a quarto proof-sheet, in the same type as *British Bards*, containing lines 540-559, "Illustrious Holland," etc., have been inserted. Hobhouse's lines (first edition, lines 247-262), which are not in the original draft, are included in *British Bards*. The insertion of the proofs increased the printed matter to 584 lines. After the completion of this revised version of *British Bards*, additions continued to be made. Marginal corrections and MS.

fragments, bound up with *British Bards*, together with forty-four lines (lines 723-726, 819-858) which do not occur in MS. M., make up with the printed matter the 696 lines which were published in March, 1809, under the title of *English Bards, and Scotch Reviewers*. The folio and quarto sheets in Mr. Murray's possession (MS. M.) may be regarded as the MS. of *British Bards*; *British Bards* (there are a few alterations, e.g. the substitution of lines 319-326, "Moravians, arise," etc., for the eight lines on Pratt, which are to be found in the folio MS., and are printed in *British Bards*), with its accompanying MS. fragments, as the foundation of the text of the first edition of *English Bards, and Scotch Reviewers*.

Between the first edition, published in March, and the second edition in October, 1809, the difference is even greater than between the first edition and *British Bards*. The Preface was enlarged, and a postscript affixed to the text of the poem. Hobhouse's lines (first edition, 247-262) were omitted, and the following additional passages inserted, viz.:

- i. lines 1-96, "Still must I hear," etc.;
- ii. lines 129-142, "Thus saith the Preacher," etc.;
- iii. lines 363-417, "But if some new-born whim," etc.;
- iv. lines 638-706, "Or hail at once," etc.;
- v. lines 765-798, "When some brisk youth," etc.;
- vi. lines 859-880, "And here let Shee," etc.;
- vii. lines 949-960, "Yet what avails," etc.;
- viii. lines 973-980, "There, Clarke," etc.;
- ix. lines 1011-1070, "Then hapless Britain," etc.

These additions number 370 lines, and, together with the 680 lines of the first edition (reduced from 696 by the omission of Hobhouse's contribution), make up the 1050 lines of the second and third editions, and the doubtful fourth edition of 1810. Of these additions, Nos. i., ii., iii., iv., vi., viii., ix. exist in MS., and are bound up with the folio MS. now in Mr. Murray's possession.

The third edition, which is, generally, dated 1810, is a replica of the second edition.

The first issue of the fourth edition, which appeared in 1810, is identical

with the second and third editions. A second issue of the fourth edition, dated 1811, must have passed under Byron's own supervision. Lines 723, 724 are added, and lines 725, 726 are materially altered. The fourth edition of 1811 numbers 1052 lines.

The suppressed fifth edition, numbering 1070 lines (the copy in the British Museum has the title-page of the fourth edition; a second copy, in Mr. Murray's possession, has no title-page), varies from the fourth edition of 1811 by the addition of lines 97-102 and 528-539, and by some twenty-nine emendations of the text. Eighteen of these emendations were made by Byron in a copy of the fourth edition which belonged to Leigh Hunt. On another copy, in Mr. Murray's possession, Byron made nine emendations, of which six are identical with those in the Hunt copy, and three appear for the first time. It was in the latter volume that he inscribed his after-thoughts, which are dated "B. 1816."

For a complete collation of the five editions of *English Bards, and Scotch Reviewers*, and textual emendations in the two annotated volumes, and for a note on genuine and spurious copies of the first and other editions, see *The Bibliography of the Poetical Works of Lord Byron*, **vol. vi.**

(Facsimile of title-page of first edition.)

G. G. Byron —————

ENGLISH BARDS,

AND

Scotch Reviewers.

A SATIRE.

I had rather be a kitten, and cry, mew!
Than one of these same metre ballad-mongers.

SHAKSPEARE.

Such shameless Bards we have ; and yet 'tis true,
There are as mad, abandon'd Critics too.

POPE.

LONDON:

PRINTED FOR JAMES CAWTHORN, BRITISH LIBRARY,
No. 24, COCKSPUR STREET.

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Hours of Idleness and Other Early Poems



Fugitive Pieces

On Leaving Newstead Abbey^a

Why dost thou build the hall, Son of the winged days? Thou lookest from thy tower to-day: yet a few years, and the blast of the desert comes: it howls in thy empty court.-Ossian¹.

I.

Through thy battlements, Newstead², the hollow winds whistle^b:
Thou, the hall of my Fathers, art gone to decay;
In thy once smiling garden, the hemlock and thistle
Have choak'd up the rose, which late bloom'd in the way.

2.

Of the mail-cover'd Barons, who, proudly, to battle^c,
Led their vassals from Europe to Palestine's plain³,
The escutcheon and shield, which with ev'ry blast rattle,
Are the only sad vestiges now that remain.

3.

No more doth old Robert, with harp-stringing numbers,

Raise a flame, in the breast, for the war-laurell'd wreath;
Near Askalon's towers, John of Horistan⁴ slumbers,
Unnerv'd is the hand of his minstrel, by death.

4.

Paul and Hubert too sleep in the valley of Cressy;
For the safety of Edward and England they fell:
My Fathers! the tears of your country redress ye:
How you fought! how you died! still her annals can tell.

5.

On Marston⁵, with Rupert⁶, 'gainst traitors contending,
Four brothers enrich'd, with their blood, the bleak field;
For the rights of a monarch their country defending^d,
Till death their attachment to royalty seal'd⁷.

6.

Shades of heroes, farewell! your descendant departing
From the seat of his ancestors, bids you adieu^e!
Abroad, or at home, your remembrance imparting
New courage, he'll think upon glory and you.

7.

Though a tear dim his eye at this sad separation^f,
'Tis nature, not fear, that excites his regret^g;
Far distant he goes, with the same emulation,
The fame of his Fathers he ne'er can forget^h.

8.

That fame, and that memory, still will he cherishⁱ;
He vows that he ne'er will disgrace your renown:
Like you will he live, or like you will he perish;
When decay'd, may he mingle his dust with your own!

1803.

Footnote 1: Ý The motto was prefixed in *Hours of Idleness*.
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Footnote 2: Ý The priory of Newstead, or de Novo Loco, in Sherwood, was founded about the year 1170, by Henry II. On the dissolution of the monasteries it was granted (in 1540) by Henry VIII. to "Sir John Byron the Little, with the great beard." His portrait is still preserved at Newstead.
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Footnote 3: Ý No record of any crusading ancestors in the Byron family can be found. Moore conjectures that the legend was suggested by some groups of heads on the old panel-work at Newstead, which appear to represent Christian

Footnote a: Ý *On Leaving N ... ST ... D.--[4to],
On Leaving Newstead.--(P. on V. Occasions.)*
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Footnote b: Ý
*Through the cracks in these
battlements loud the winds
whistle
For the hall of my fathers is
gone to decay;
And in yon once gay garden the
hemlock and thistle
Have choak'd up the rose, which
late bloom'd in the way.*

[4to]
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Footnote c: Ý
*Of the barons of old, who once
proudly to battle.*

[4to]
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soldiers and Saracens, and were, most probably, put up before the Abbey came into the possession of the family.

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Footnote 4: Ý Horistan Castle, in Derbyshire, an ancient seat of the B--R--N family [4to]. (Horiston.--4to.)

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Footnote d: Ý

For Charles the Martyr their country defending.

[4to. *P. on V. Occasions.*]

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Footnote 5: Ý The battle of Marston Moor, where the adherents of Charles I. were defeated.

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Footnote e: Ý *Bids ye adieu!* [4to]

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Footnote 6: Ý Son of the Elector Palatine, and related to Charles I. He afterwards commanded the Fleet, in the reign of Charles II.

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Footnote f: Ý *Though a tear dims.* [4to]

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Footnote 7: Ý Sir Nicholas Byron, the great-grandson of Sir John Byron the Little, distinguished himself in the Civil Wars. He is described by Clarendon (*Hist, of the Rebellion*, 1807, i. 216) as "a person of great affability and dexterity, as well as martial knowledge." He was Governor of Carlisle, and afterwards Governor of Chester. His nephew and heir-at-law, Sir John Byron, of Clayton, K.B. (1599-1652), was raised to the peerage as Baron Byron of Rochdale, after the Battle of Newbury, October 26, 1643. He held successively the posts of Lieutenant

Footnote g: Ý

'Tis nature, not fear, which commands his regret.

[4to]

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of the Tower, Governor of Chester, and, after the expulsion of the Royal Family from England, Governor to the Duke of York. He died childless, and was succeeded by his brother Richard, the second lord, from whom the poet was descended. Five younger brothers, as Richard's monument in the chancel of Hucknall Torkard Church records, "faithfully served King Charles the First in the Civil Wars, suffered much for their loyalty, and lost all their present fortunes." (See *Life of Lord Byron*, by Karl Elze: Appendix, Note (A), p. 436.)

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Footnote h: Ý

*In the grave he alone can his
fathers forget.*

[4to]

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Footnote i: Ý

*Your fame, and your memory,
still will he cherish.*

[4to]

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To E—— 1

Let Folly smile, to view the names
Of thee and me, in Friendship twin'd;
Yet Virtue will have greater claims
To love, than rank with vice combin'd.

And though unequal is *thy* fate,
Since title deck'd my higher birth;
Yet envy not this gaudy state,
Thine is the pride of modest worth.

Our *souls* at least congenial meet,
Nor can *thy* lot *my* rank disgrace;
Our intercourse is not less sweet,
Since worth of rank supplies the place.

Footnote 1: Ý E--- was, according to Moore, a boy of Byron's own age, the son of one of the tenants at Newstead.

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On the Death of a Young Lady¹, Cousin to the Author, and very dear to Him

1.

Hush'd are the winds, and still the evening gloom,
Not e'en a zephyr wanders through the grove,
Whilst I return to view my Margaret's tomb,
And scatter flowers on the dust I love.

2.

Within this narrow cell reclines her clay,
That clay, where once such animation beam'd;
The King of Terrors seiz'd her as his prey;
Not worth, nor beauty, have her life redeem'd.

3.

Oh! could that King of Terrors pity feel,
Or Heaven reverse the dread decree of fate,
Not here the mourner would his grief reveal,
Not here the Muse her virtues would relate.

4.

But wherefore weep? Her matchless spirit soars
Beyond where splendid shines the orb of day;
And weeping angels lead her to those bowers,

Where endless pleasures virtuous deeds repay.

5.

And shall presumptuous mortals Heaven arraign!
And, madly, Godlike Providence accuse!
Ah! no, far fly from me attempts so vain;--
I'll ne'er submission to my God refuse.

6.

Yet is remembrance of those virtues dear,
Yet fresh the memory of that beauteous face;
Still they call forth my warm affection's tear,
Still in my heart retain their wonted place^a.

1802.

Footnote 1: Ý The author claims the indulgence of the reader more for this piece than, perhaps, any other in the collection; but as it was written at an earlier period than the rest (being composed at the age of fourteen), and his first essay, he preferred submitting it to the indulgence of his friends in its present state, to making either addition or alteration.--[4to]

Footnote a: Ý *Such sorrow brings me honour, not disgrace.* [4to]
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"My first dash into poetry was as early as 1800. It was the ebullition of a passion for--my first cousin, Margaret Parker

(daughter and granddaughter of the two Admirals Parker), one of the most beautiful of evanescent beings. I have long forgotten the verse; but it would be difficult for me to forget her--her dark eyes--her long eye-lashes--her completely Greek cast of face and figure! I was then about twelve--she rather older, perhaps a year. She died about a year or two afterwards, in consequence of a fall, which injured her spine, and induced consumption ... I knew nothing of her illness, being at Harrow and in the country till she was gone. Some years after, I made an attempt at an elegy--a very dull one."--

Byron Diary, 1821; *Life*, p. 17.

[Margaret Parker was the sister of Sir Peter Parker, whose death at Baltimore, in 1814, Byron celebrated in the *Elegiac Stanzas*, which were first published in the poems attached to the seventh edition of *Childe Harold*.

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To D——1

1.

In thee, I fondly hop'd to clasp
A friend, whom death alone could sever;
Till envy, with malignant grasp^a,
Detach'd thee from my breast for ever.

2.

True, she has forc'd thee from my *breast*,
Yet, in my *heart*, thou keep'st thy seat^b;
There, there, thine image still must rest,
Until that heart shall cease to beat.

3.

And, when the grave restores her dead,
When life again to dust is given,
On *thy dear* breast I'll lay my head--
Without *thee!* *where* would be my *Heaven?*

February, 1803

Footnote 1: Ý George John, 5th Earl **Footnote a:** Ý
Delawarr (1791-1869).
(See [note](#); see also lines [To George](#),

[Earl Delawarr\)](#)

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*But envy with malignant grasp,
Has torn thee from my breast for
ever.*

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote b: Ý *But in my heart.* [4to]

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To Caroline^a

1.

Think'st thou I saw thy beauteous eyes,
Suffus'd in tears, implore to stay;
And heard *unmov'd* thy plenteous sighs,
Which said far more than words can say^b?

2.

Though keen the grief *thy* tears exprest^c,
When love and hope lay *both* o'erthrown;
Yet still, my girl, *this* bleeding breast
Throbb'd, with deep sorrow, as *thine* own.

3.

But, when our cheeks with anguish glow'd,
When *thy* sweet lips were join'd to mine;
The tears that from *my* eyelids flow'd
Were lost in those which fell from *thine*.

4.

Thou could'st not feel my burning cheek,
Thy gushing tears had quench'd its flame,
And, as thy tongue essay'd to speak,
In *sighs alone* it breath'd my name.

5.

And yet, my girl, we weep in vain,
In vain our fate in sighs deplore;
Remembrance only can remain,
But *that*, will make us weep the more.

6.

Again, thou best belov'd, adieu!
Ah! if thou canst, o'ercome regret,
Nor let thy mind past joys review,
Our only *hope* is, to *forget*!

1805.

Footnote a: Ý *To*——. [4to]

[return to footnote mark](#)

Footnote b: Ý *than words could say*. [4to]

[return](#)

Footnote c: Ý *Though deep the grief*. [4to]

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To Caroline¹

1.

You say you love, and yet your eye
No symptom of that love conveys,
You say you love, yet know not why,
Your cheek no sign of love betrays.

2.

Ah! did that breast with ardour glow,
With me alone it joy could know,
Or feel with me the listless woe,
Which racks my heart when far from thee.

3.

Whene'er we meet my blushes rise,
And mantle through my purpled cheek,
But yet no blush to mine replies,
Nor e'en your eyes your love bespeak.

4.

Your voice alone declares your flame,
And though so sweet it breathes my name,
Our passions still are not the same;
Alas! you cannot love like me.

5.

For e'en your lip seems steep'd in snow,
And though so oft it meets my kiss,
It burns with no responsive glow,
Nor melts like mine in dewy bliss.

6.

Ah! what are words to love like *mine*,
Though uttered by a voice like thine,
I still in murmurs must repine,
And think that love can ne'er be *true*,

7.

Which meets me with no joyous sign,
Without a sigh which bids adieu;
How different is my love from thine,
How keen my grief when leaving you.

8.

Your image fills my anxious breast,
Till day declines adown the West,
And when at night, I sink to rest,
In dreams your fancied form I view.

9.

'Tis then your breast, no longer cold,
With equal ardour seems to burn,
While close your arms around me fold,

Your lips my kiss with warmth return.

10.

Ah! would these joyous moments last;
Vain **Hope!** the gay delusion's past,
That voice!--ah! no, 'tis but the blast,
Which echoes through the neighbouring grove.

11.

But when *awake*, your lips I seek,
And clasp enraptur'd all your charms,
So chill's the pressure of your cheek,
I fold a statue in my arms.

12.

If thus, when to my heart embrac'd,
No pleasure in your eyes is trac'd,
You may be prudent, fair, and *chaste*,
But ah! my girl, you *do not love*.

Footnote 1: Ý These lines, which appear in the Quarto, were never republished.

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To Emma¹

1.

Since now the hour is come at last,
When you must quit your anxious lover;
Since now, our dream of bliss is past,
One pang, my girl, and all is over.

2.

Alas! that pang will be severe,
Which bids us part to meet no more;
Which tears me far from *one* so dear,
Departing for a distant shore.

3.

Well! we have pass'd some happy hours,
And joy will mingle with our tears;
When thinking on these ancient towers,
The shelter of our infant years;

4.

Where from this Gothic casement's height,
We view'd the lake, the park, the dell,
And still, though tears obstruct our sight,
We lingering look a last farewell,

5.

O'er fields through which we us'd to run,
And spend the hours in childish play;
O'er shades where, when our race was done,
Reposing on my breast you lay;

6.

Whilst I, admiring, too remiss,
Forgot to scare the hovering flies,
Yet envied every fly the kiss,
It dar'd to give your slumbering eyes:

7.

See still the little painted *bark*,
In which I row'd you o'er the lake;
See there, high waving o'er the park,
The *elm* I clamber'd for your sake.

8.

These times are past, our joys are gone,
You leave me, leave this happy vale;
These scenes, I must retrace alone;
Without thee, what will they avail?

9.

Who can conceive, who has not prov'd,
The anguish of a last embrace?

When, torn from all you fondly lov'd,
You bid a long adieu to peace.

10.

This is the deepest of our woes,
For *this* these tears our cheeks bedew;
This is of love the final close,
Oh, God! the fondest, *last* adieu!

Footnote 1: Ý To Maria [4to]
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**Fragments of School Exercises: From the *Prometheus Vincetus* of
*Æschylus***

Μηδ'άμ' ὁ πάντα νέμων, κ.τ.λ.¹

Great Jove! to whose Almighty Throne
Both Gods and mortals homage pay,
Ne'er may my soul thy power disown,

Thy dread behests ne'er disobey.
Oft shall the sacred victim fall,
In sea-girt Ocean's mossy hall;
My voice shall raise no impious strain,
'Gainst him who rules the sky and azure main.

...

How different now thy joyless fate,
Since first Hesione thy bride,
When plac'd aloft in godlike state,
The blushing beauty by thy side,
Thou sat'st, while reverend Ocean smil'd,
And mirthful strains the hours beguil'd;
The Nymphs and Tritons danc'd around,
Nor yet thy doom was fix'd, nor Jove relentless frown'd².

Harrow, December 1, 1804.

Footnote 1: Ý The Greek heading does not appear in the Quarto, nor in the three first Editions.

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Footnote 2: Ý

"My first Harrow verses (that is, English, as exercises), a translation of a chorus from the *Prometheus* of Æschylus, were received by Dr. Drury, my grand patron (our headmaster), but coolly. No one had, at that time, the least notion that I should subside into poetry."

(*Life*, p. 20.)

The lines are not a translation but a loose adaptation or paraphrase of part of a chorus of the *Prometheus Vincit*, I, 528, *sq.*

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Lines written in "Letters of an Italian Nun and an English Gentleman, by J.J. Rousseau¹: Founded on Facts"

"Away, away,--your flattering arts
May now betray some simpler hearts;
And *you* will *smile* at their believing,
And *they* shall weep at your deceiving."

Footnote 1: ¹ A second edition of this work, of which the title is, *Letters, etc., translated from the French of Jean Jacques Rousseau*, was published in London, in 1784. It is, probably, a literary forgery.

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Answer to the Foregoing^a, Addressed to Miss——

Dear simple girl, those flattering arts,
(From which thou'dst guard frail female hearts,)^b
Exist but in imagination,
Mere phantoms of thine own creation^c;
For he who views that witching grace,
That perfect form, that lovely face,
With eyes admiring, oh! believe me,
He never wishes to deceive thee:
Once in thy polish'd mirror glance^d
Thou'lt there descry that elegance
Which from our sex demands such praises,
But envy in the other raises.--
Then he who tells thee of thy beauty^e,
Believe me, only does his duty:
Ah! fly not from the candid youth;
It is not flattery, — 'tis truth^f.

July, 1804.

Footnote a: Ý

Answer to the above.

[4to]

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Footnote b: Ý

From which you'd.

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote c: Ý

*Mere phantoms of your own creation;
For he who sees.*

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote d: Ý

*Once let you at your mirror glance
You'll there descry that elegance,*

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote e: Ý

Then he who tells you of your beauty.

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote f: Ý

It is not flattery, but truth.

[4to]
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On a Change of Masters at a Great Public School¹_—

Where are those honours, **Ida!** once your own,
When Probus fill'd your magisterial throne?
As ancient Rome, fast falling to disgrace,
Hail'd a Barbarian in her Cæsar's place,
So you, degenerate, share as hard a fate,
And seat *Pomposus* where your *Probus* sate.
Of narrow brain, yet of a narrower soul^a,
Pomposus holds you in his harsh controul;
Pomposus, by no social virtue sway'd,
With florid jargon, and with vain parade;
With noisy nonsense, and new-fangled rules,
(Such as were ne'er before enforc'd in schools.)^b
Mistaking *pedantry* for *learning's* laws,
He governs, sanction'd but by self-applause;
With him the same dire fate, attending Rome,
Ill-fated *Ida!* soon must stamp your doom:
Like her o'erthrown, for ever lost to fame,
No trace of science left you, but the name,

Harrow, July, 1805.

Footnote 1: Ý In March, 1805, Dr. Drury, the Probus of the piece, retired from the Head-mastership of Harrow School, and was succeeded by Dr. Butler, the Pomposus.

"Dr. Drury," said Byron, in one of his note-books, "was the best, the kindest (and yet strict, too) friend I ever had; and I look upon him still as a father."

Out of affection to his late preceptor, Byron advocated the election of Mark Drury to the vacant post, and hence his dislike of the successful candidate. He was reconciled to Dr. Butler before departing for Greece, in 1809, and in his diary he says,

"I treated him rebelliously, and have been sorry ever since."

(See allusions in and notes to *Childish Recollections*, pp. 84-106, and especially note I, p. 88, notes I and 2, p. 89, and note I, p. 91.)

[return to footnote mark](#)

Footnote a: Ý

——*but of a narrower soul.*

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote b: Ý

*Such as were ne'er before beheld
in schools.*

[4to]

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Epitaph on a Beloved Friend¹

Ἄσκηρ πρὶν μὲν ἔλαμπες ἐνὶ ζῳοῖσιν ἑῶος.

[Plato's Epitaph (*Epig. Græc.*, Jacobs, 1826, p. 309), quoted by Diog. Laertins.]

Oh, Friend! for ever lov'd, for ever dear^a!
What fruitless tears have bathed thy honour'd bier!
What sighs re-echo'd to thy parting breath,
Whilst thou wast struggling in the pangs of death!
Could tears retard the tyrant in his course;
Could sighs avert his dart's relentless force;
Could youth and virtue claim a short delay,
Or beauty charm the spectre from his prey;
Thou still hadst liv'd to bless my aching sight,
Thy comrade's honour and thy friend's delight.
If yet thy gentle spirit hover nigh
The spot where now thy mouldering ashes lie,
Here wilt thou read, recorded on my heart,
A grief too deep to trust the sculptor's art.
No marble marks thy couch of lowly sleep,
But living statues there are seen to weep;
Affliction's semblance bends not o'er thy tomb,
Affliction's self deplores thy youthful doom.
What though thy sire lament his failing line,
A father's sorrows cannot equal mine!
Though none, like thee, his dying hour will cheer,
Yet other offspring soothe his anguish here:

But, who with me shall hold thy former place?
Thine image, what new friendship can efface?
Ah, none!--a father's tears will cease to flow,
Time will assuage an infant brother's woe;
To all, save one, is consolation known,
While solitary Friendship sighs alone.

Harrow, 1803

Footnote 1: Ý The heading which appears in the Quarto and *P. on V. Occasions* was subsequently changed to *Epitaph on a Friend*. The motto was prefixed in *Hours of Idleness*. The epigram which Bergk leaves under Plato's name was translated by Shelley (*Poems*, 1895, iii. 361)

"Thou wert the morning star
Among the living,
Ere thy fair light had fled;
Now having died, thou art as
Hesperus, giving
New splendour to the dead."

There is an echo of the Greek distich in Byron's exquisite line, "The Morning-Star of Memory."

The words, "Southwell, March 17," are added, in a lady's hand, on p. 9 of the annotated copy of *P. on V. Occasions* in the British Museum. The conjecture that the "*beloved friend*," who is of humble origin, is identical with "E----" of the verses on

Footnote a: Ý

*Oh Boy! for ever lov'd, for ever
dear!
What fruitless tears have wash'd
thy honour'd bier^b;
What sighs re-echoed to thy
parting breath,
Whilst thou wert struggling in
the pangs of death.
Could tears have turn'd the
tyrant in his course,
Could sighs have checked his
dart's relentless force^c;
Could youth and virtue claim a
short delay,
Or beauty charm the spectre
from his prey,
Thou still had'st liv'd to bless my
aching sight,
Thy comrade's honour, and thy
friend's delight:
Though low thy lot since in a
cottage born,
No titles did thy humble name
adorn,*

p. 4, remains uncertain.
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*To me, far dearer, was thy
artless love,
Than all the joys, wealth, fame,
and friends could prove.
For thee alone I liv'd, or wish'd
to live,
(Oh God! if impious, this rash
word forgive,)
Heart-broken now, I wait an
equal doom,
Content to join thee in thy turf-
clad tomb;
Where this frail form compos'd
in endless rest,
I'll make my last, cold, pillow on
thy breast;
That breast where oft in life, I've
laid my head,
Will yet receive me mouldering
with the dead;
This life resign'd, without one
parting sigh,
Together in one bed of earth
we'll lie!
Together share the fate to
mortals given,
Together mix our dust, and hope
for Heaven.*

Harrow, 1803. [4to. P. on V.
Occasions.]

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Footnote b: Ý

have bath'd thy honoured bier.

[P. on V. Occasions.]

[return](#)

Footnote c: Ý *Could tears retard,*
Ý[*P. on V. Occasions.*] *Could sighs*
avert. Ý[P. on V. Occasions.]
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Adrian's Address to his Soul when Dying

Animula! vagula, Blandula,
Hospes, comesque corporis,
Quæ nunc abibis in Loca--
Pallidula, rigida, nudula,
Nec, ut soles, dabis Jocos?

Translation:

Ah! gentle, fleeting, wav'ring Sprite,
Friend and associate of this clay!
To what unknown region borne,
Wilt thou, now, wing thy distant flight?
No more with wonted humour gay,
But pallid, cheerless, and forlorn.

1806.

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A Fragment¹

When, to their airy hall, my Fathers' voice
Shall call my spirit, joyful in their choice;
When, pois'd upon the gale, my form shall ride,
Or, dark in mist, descend the mountain's side;
Oh! may my shade behold no sculptur'd urns,
To mark the spot where earth to earth returns!
No lengthen'd scroll, no praise-encumber'd stone^a;
My epitaph shall be my name alone²:
If *that* with honour fail to crown my clay^b,
Oh! may no other fame my deeds repay!
That, only *that*, shall single out the spot;
By that remember'd, or with that forgot^c.

1803

Footnote 1: ¹ There is no heading in **Footnote a:** ^a
the Quarto.

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*No lengthen'd scroll of virtue
and renown.*

[4to. P. on V. Occ.]

[return](#)

Footnote 2: ² In his will, drawn up in **Footnote b:** ^b
1811, Byron gave directions that "no
inscription, save his name and age,
should be written on his tomb." June,
1819, he wrote to Murray:

If that with honour fails,

[4to]

[return](#)

"Some of the epitaphs at the Certosa cemetery, at Ferrara, pleased me more than the more splendid monuments at Bologna; for instance, 'Martini Luigi Implora pace.' Can anything be more full of pathos? I hope whoever may survive me will see those two words, and no more, put over me."

Life, pp. 131, 398.

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Footnote c: Ý

*But that remember'd, or fore'er
forgot.*

[4to. *P. on V. Occasions.*]

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To Caroline^{[1](#)}

1.

Oh! when shall the grave hide for ever my sorrow?
Oh! when shall my soul wing her flight from this clay?

The present is hell! and the coming to-morrow
But brings, with new torture, the curse of to-day.

2.

From my eye flows no tear, from my lips flow no curses^a,
I blast not the fiends who have hurl'd me from bliss;
For poor is the soul which, bewailing, rehearses
Its querulous grief, when in anguish like this--

3.

Was my eye, 'stead of tears, with red fury flakes bright'ning,
Would my lips breathe a flame which no stream could assuage,
On our foes should my glance launch in vengeance its lightning,
With transport my tongue give a loose to its rage.

4.

But now tears and curses, alike unavailing,
Would add to the souls of our tyrants delight;
Could they view us our sad separation bewailing,
Their merciless hearts would rejoice at the sight.

5.

Yet, still, though we bend with a feign'd resignation,
Life beams not for us with one ray that can cheer;
Love and Hope upon earth bring no more consolation,
In the grave is our hope, for in life is our fear.

6.

Oh! when, my ador'd, in the tomb will they place me,
Since, in life, love and friendship for ever are fled?
If again in the mansion of death I embrace thee,
Perhaps they will leave unmolested--the dead.

1805.

Footnote 1: ÝTo—— [4to].
[return to footnote mark](#)

Footnote a: Ý *fall no curses*. [4to. *P.*
on V. Occasions.]
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To Caroline¹

1.

When I hear you express an affection so warm,
Ne'er think, my belov'd, that I do not believe;
For your lip would the soul of suspicion disarm,
And your eye beams a ray which can never deceive.

2.

Yet still, this fond bosom regrets, while adoring,
That love, like the leaf, must fall into the sear,

That Age will come on, when Remembrance, deploring,
Contemplates the scenes of her youth, with a tear;

3.

That the time must arrive, when, no longer retaining
Their auburn, those locks must wave thin to the breeze,
When a few silver hairs of those tresses remaining,
Prove nature a prey to decay and disease.

4.

Tis this, my belov'd, which spreads gloom o'er my features,
Though I ne'er shall presume to arraign the decree
Which God has proclaim'd as the fate of his creatures,
In the death which one day will deprive you of me^a.

5.

Mistake not, sweet sceptic, the cause of emotion^b,
No doubt can the mind of your lover invade;
He worships each look with such faithful devotion,
A smile can enchant, or a tear can dissuade.

6.

But as death, my belov'd, soon or late shall o'ertake us,
And our breasts, which alive with such sympathy glow,
Will sleep in the grave, till the blast shall awake us,
When calling the dead, in Earth's bosom laid low.

7.

Oh! then let us drain, while we may, draughts of pleasure,
Which from passion, like ours, must unceasingly flow^c;
Let us pass round the cup of Love's bliss in full measure,
And quaff the contents as our nectar below.

1805.

Footnote 1: ¶ There is no heading in the Quarto.

[return to footnote mark](#)

Footnote a: ¶ *will deprive me of thee.*
¶[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote b: ¶

*No jargon of priests o'er our
union was mutter'd,
To rivet the fetters of husband
and wife;
By our lips, by our hearts, were
our vows alone utter'd,
To perform them, in full, would
ask more than a life.*

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote c: ¶ *will unceasingly flow.*
¶[4to]

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On a Distant View of the Village and School of Harrow on the Hill, 1806

Oh! mihi præteritos referat si Jupiter annos¹.

Virgil.

1.

Ye scenes of my childhood, whose lov'd recollection
Embitters the present, compar'd with the past;
Where science first dawn'd on the powers of reflection,
And friendships were form'd, too romantic to last²;

2.

Where fancy, yet, joys to retrace the resemblance
Of comrades, in friendship and mischief allied³;
How welcome to me your ne'er fading remembrance^a,
Which rests in the bosom, though hope is deny'd!

3.

Again I revisit the hills where we sported,
The streams where we swam, and the fields where we fought⁴;
The school where, loud warn'd by the bell, we resorted,
To pore o'er the precepts by Pedagogues taught.

4.

Again I behold where for hours I have ponder'd,
As reclining, at eve, on yon tombstone⁵ I lay;
Or round the steep brow of the churchyard I wander'd,
To catch the last gleam of the sun's setting ray.

5.

I once more view the room, with spectators surrounded,
Where, as Zanga⁶, I trod on Alonzo o'erthrown;
While, to swell my young pride, such applauses resounded,
I fancied that Mossop⁷ himself was outshone.

6.

Or, as Lear, I pour'd forth the deep imprecation,
By my daughters, of kingdom and reason depriv'd;
Till, fir'd by loud plaudits and self-adulation,
I regarded myself as a *Garrick* reviv'd^b.

7.

Ye dreams of my boyhood, how much I regret you!
Unfaded your memory dwells in my breast^c;
Though sad and deserted, I ne'er can forget you:
Your pleasures may still be in fancy possess.

8.

To Ida full oft may remembrance restore me^d,
While Fate shall the shades of the future unroll!
Since Darkness o'ershadows the prospect before me,
More dear is the beam of the past to my soul!

9.

But if, through the course of the years which await me,
Some new scene of pleasure should open to view,
I will say, while with rapture the thought shall elate me,
"Oh! such were the days which my infancy knew."⁸

1806.

Footnote 1: Ý The motto was prefixed in *Hours of Idleness*.

[return to footnote mark](#)

Footnote a: Ý

How welcome once more.

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote 2: Ý

"My school-friendships were with me *passions* (for I was always violent), but I do not know that there is one which has endured (to be sure, some have been cut short by death) till now."

Diary, 1821; *Life*, p. 21.

[return](#)

Footnote 3: Ý Byron was at first placed in the house of Mr. Henry Drury, but in 1803 was removed to that of Mr. Evans.

"The reason why Lord Byron wishes for the change, arises from the repeated complaints of Mr. Henry Drury respecting his inattention to business, and his propensity to make others laugh and disregard their employment as much as himself."

(Dr. Joseph Drury to Mr. John Hanson.)

[return](#)

Footnote 4: Ý

Footnote b: Ý

I consider'd myself.

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote c: Ý

*As your memory beams through
this agonized breast;
Thus sad and deserted, I n'er can
forget you,
Though this heart throbs to
bursting by anguish possess.*

[4to]

*Your memory beams through this
agonized breast.*

[*P. on V. Occasions.*]

[return](#)

Footnote d: Ý

"At Harrow I fought my way very fairly. I think I lost but one battle out of seven."

Diary, 1821; *Life*, p. 21.

[return](#)

*I thought this poor brain, fever'd
even to madness,
Of tears as of reason for ever was
drain'd;
But the drops which now flow
down **this** bosom of sadness,
Convince me the springs have
some moisture retain'd.*

*Sweet scenes of my childhood!
your blest recollection,
Has wrung from these eyelids, to
weeping long dead,
In torrents, the tears of my
warmest affection,
The last and the fondest, I ever
shall shed.*

[4to. *P. on V. Occasions.*]

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Footnote 5: Ý A tomb in the churchyard at Harrow was so well known to be his favourite resting-place, that the boys called it "Byron's Tomb:" and here, they say, he used to sit for hours, wrapt up in thought.--*Life*, p. 26.

[return](#)

Footnote 6: Ý For the display of his declamatory powers, on the speech-days, he selected always the most vehement passages; such as the speech of Zanga over the body of Alonzo, and Lear's address to the storm.--*Life*, p. 20, *note*; and *post*, p. 103, *var.* i.

[return](#)

Footnote 7: Ý Henry Mossop (1729-1773), a contemporary of Garrick,

famous for his performance of
"Zanga" in Young's tragedy of *The
Revenge*.

[return](#)

Footnote 8: Ý Stanzas 8 and 9 first
appeared in *Hours of Idleness*.

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Thoughts Suggested by a College Examination

High in the midst, surrounded by his
peers,
Magnus¹ his ample front sublime
uprears^a:
Plac'd on his chair of state, he seems a
God,
While Sophs² and Freshmen tremble
at his nod;
As all around sit wrapt in speechless
gloom^b,
His voice, in thunder, shakes the 10
sounding dome;
Denouncing dire reproach to luckless
fools,
Unskill'd to plod in mathematic rules.
Happy the youth! in Euclid's axioms
tried,
Though little vers'd in any art beside;
Who, scarcely skill'd an English line
to pen^c,
Scans Attic metres with a critic's ken.

What! though he knows not how his fathers bled,
When civil discord pil'd the fields with dead,
When Edward bade his conquering bands advance,
Or Henry trampled on the crest of France:
Though marvelling at the name of *Magna Charta*,
Yet well he recollects the *laws of Sparta*;
Can tell, what edicts sage *Lycurgus* made,
While *Blackstone's* on the *shelf*, *neglected* laid;
Of *Grecian dramas* vaunts the deathless fame,
Of *Avon's bard*, rememb'ring scarce the name.
Such is the youth whose scientific pate
Class-honours, medals, fellowships, await;
Or even, perhaps, the *declamation* prize,
If to such glorious height, he lifts his eyes.
But lo! no *common* orator can hope
The envied silver cup within his scope:
Not that our *heads* much eloquence require,
Th' **Athenian's**³ glowing style, or **Tully's** fire.
A *manner* clear or warm is useless, since^d
We do not try by *speaking* to

convince;
Be other *orators* of pleasing *proud*,--
We speak to *please* ourselves, not
move the crowd:
Our gravity prefers the *muttering* 60
tone,
A proper mixture of the *squeak* and
groan:
No borrow'd *grace* of *action* must be
seen,
The slightest motion would displease
the *Dean*;
Whilst every staring Graduate would
prate,
Against what--*he* could never imitate. 70
The man, who hopes t' obtain the
promis'd cup,
Must in one *posture* stand, and *ne'er*
look up;
Nor *stop*, but rattle over *every* word--
No matter *what*, so it can *not* be
heard:
Thus let him hurry on, nor think to
rest:
Who speaks the *fastest's* sure to speak
the *best*;
Who utters most within the shortest
space,
May, safely, hope to win the *wordy*
race.
The Sons of *Science* these, who, thus
repaid,
Linger in ease in Granta's sluggish
shade;
Where on Cam's sedgy banks, supine,
they lie,
Unknown, unhonour'd live--unwept
for die:
Dull as the pictures, which adorn their

halls,
They think all learning fix'd within
their walls:
In manners rude, in foolish forms
precise,
All modern arts affecting to despise;
Yet prizing *Bentley's*, *Brunck's*, or
*Porson's*⁴ note^e,
More than the *verse on which the*
critic wrote:
Vain as their honours, heavy as their
Ale⁵,
Sad as their wit, and tedious as their
tale;
To friendship dead, though not
untaught to feel,
When Self and Church demand a
Bigot zeal.
With eager haste they court the lord
of power^f,
(Whether 'tis **Pitt** or **Petty**⁶ rules the
hour;)
To *him*, with suppliant smiles, they
bend the head,
While distant mitres to their eyes are
spread^g;
But should a storm o'erwhelm him
with disgrace,
They'd fly to seek the next, who fill'd
his place.
Such are the men who learning's
treasures guard!
Such is their *practice*, such is their
reward!
This *much*, at least, we may presume
to say--
The premium can't exceed the *price*
they pay^h.

1806.

Footnote 1: Ý

No reflection is here intended against the person mentioned under the name of Magnus. He is merely represented as performing an unavoidable function of his office. Indeed, such an attempt could only recoil upon myself; as that gentleman is now as much distinguished by his eloquence, and the dignified propriety with which he fills his situation, as he was in his younger days for wit and conviviality.

[Dr. William Lort Mansel (1753-1820) was, in 1798, appointed Master of Trinity College, by Pitt. He obtained the bishopric of Bristol, through the influence of his pupil, Spencer Perceval, in 1808. He died in 1820.

[return to footnote mark](#)

Footnote 2: Ý Undergraduates of the second and third year.

[return](#)

Footnote 3: Ý Demosthenes.

[return](#)

Footnote a: Ý

M--us--l--

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote b: Ý

Whilst all around.

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote c: Ý

Who with scarce sense to pen an English letter,

*Yet with precision scans an Attis
metre.*

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote 4: Ý The present Greek professor at Trinity College, Cambridge; a man whose powers of mind and writings may, perhaps, justify their preference. [Richard Porson (1759-1808). For Byron's description of him, see letter to Murray, of February 20, 1818. Byron says (*Diary*, December 17, 18, 1813) that he wrote the *Devil's Drive* in imitation of Porson's *Devil's Walk*. This was a common misapprehension at the time. The *Devil's Thoughts* was the joint composition of Coleridge and Southey, but it was generally attributed to Porson, who took no trouble to disclaim it. It was originally published in the *Morning Post*, Sept. 6, 1799, and Stuart, the editor, said that it raised the circulation of the paper for several days after. (See Coleridge's *Poems* (1893), pp. 147, 621.)]

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Footnote 5: Ý Lines 59-62 are not in the Quarto. They first appeared in *Poems Original and Translated*.

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Footnote 6: Ý Since this was written, Lord Henry Petty has lost his place, and subsequently (I had almost said consequently) the honour of representing the University. A fact so

Footnote d: Ý

*The manner of the speech is
nothing, since,*

[4to. *P*, on *V. Occasions*.]

[return](#)

Footnote e: Ý

Celebrated critics

[4to. *Three first Editions*.]

[return](#)

Footnote f: Ý

They court the tool of power

glaring requires no comment.
(Lord Henry Petty, M.P. for the
University of Cambridge, was
Chancellor of the Exchequer in 1805;
but in 1807 he lost his seat. In 1809 he
succeeded his brother as Marquis of
Lansdowne. He died in 1863.)

[return](#)

[4to. *P. on V. Occasions.*]

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Footnote g: *Ÿ While mitres, prebends.--*

[4to. *P. on V. Occasions.*]

[return](#)

Footnote h: *Ÿ*

The *reward's* scarce equal to the
price they pay.

[4to]

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To Mary, on Receiving Her Picture¹

1.

This faint resemblance of thy charms,
(Though strong as mortal art could give,)
My constant heart of fear disarms,
Revives my hopes, and bids me live.

2.

Here, I can trace the locks of gold
Which round thy snowy forehead wave;
The cheeks which sprung from Beauty's mould,
The lips, which made me *Beauty's* slave.

3.

Here I can trace--ah, no! that eye,
Whose azure floats in liquid fire,
Must all the painter's art defy,
And bid him from the task retire.

4.

Here, I behold its beauteous hue;
But where's the beam so sweetly straying^a,
Which gave a lustre to its blue,
Like Luna o'er the ocean playing?

5.

Sweet copy! far more dear to me,
Lifeless, unfeeling as thou art,
Than all the living forms could be,
Save her who plac'd thee next my heart.

6.

She plac'd it, sad, with needless fear,
Lest time might shake my wavering soul,
Unconscious that her image there
Held every sense in fast controul.

7.

Thro' hours, thro' years, thro' time, 'twill cheer--
My hope, in gloomy moments, raise;
In life's last conflict 'twill appear,
And meet my fond, expiring gaze.

Footnote 1: Ý This "Mary" is not to be **Footnote a:** Ý

confounded with the heiress of
Annesley, or "Mary" of Aberdeen. She
was of humble station in life. Byron
used to show a lock of her light golden
hair, as well as her picture, among his
friends. (See *Life*, p. 41, note.)

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*But Where's the beam of soft
desire?
Which gave a lustre to its blue,
Love, only love, could e'er
inspire.--*

[4to. *P. on V, Occasions.*]

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On the Death of Mr. Fox¹

the following illiberal impromptu appeared in the *Morning Post*:

"Our Nation's foes lament on *Fox's* death,
But bless the hour, when **Pitt** resign'd his breath:
These feelings wide, let Sense and Truth unclue,
We give the palm, where Justice points its due."

to which the author of these pieces sent the following reply^a for insertion in the *Morning Chronicle*.

Oh, factious viper! whose envenom'd tooth
Would mangle, still, the dead, perverting truth^b;
What, though our "nation's foes" lament the fate,
With generous feeling, of the good and great;
Shall dastard tongues essay to blast the name^c
Of him, whose meed exists in endless fame?
When **Pitt** expir'd in plenitude of power,
Though ill success obscur'd his dying hour,
Pity her dewy wings before him spread,
For noble spirits "war not with the dead:"
His friends in tears, a last sad requiem gave,
As all his errors slumber'd in the grave^d;
He sunk, an Atlas bending 'neath the weight"^e
Of cares o'erwhelming our conflicting state.
When, lo! a Hercules, in Fox, appear'd,
Who for a time the ruin'd fabric rear'd:
He, too, is fall'n, who Britain's loss supplied^f,
With him, our fast reviving hopes have died;
Not one great people, only, raise his urn,
All Europe's far-extended regions mourn.
"These feelings wide, let Sense and Truth undue,
To give the palm where Justice points its due;"^g
Yet, let not canker'd Calumny assail^h,
Or round her statesman wind her gloomy veil.
Fox! o'er whose corse a mourning world must weep,
Whose dear remains in honour'd marble sleep;
For whom, at last, e'en hostile nations groan,
While friends and foes, alike, his talents ownⁱ.--
Fox! shall, in Britain's future annals, shine,
Nor e'en to **Pitt**, the patriot's *palm* resign;
Which Envy, wearing Candour's sacred mask,
For **Pitt**, and **Pitt** alone, has dar'd to ask^j.

(Southwell, Oct., 1806².)

Footnote 1: Ý The stanza on the death of Fox appeared in the *Morning Post*, September 26, 1806.

[return to footnote mark](#)

Footnote a: Ý

The subjoined Reply.

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote 2: Ý This MS. is preserved at Newstead.

[return](#)

Footnote b: Ý

*Would mangle, still, the dead, in
spite of truth.*

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote c: Ý

*Shall, therefore, dastard tongues
assail the name
Of him, whose virtues claim
eternal fame?*

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote d: Ý

and all his errors.

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote e: Ý

*He died, an Atlas bending 'neath
the weight
Of cares oppressing our unhappy
state.
But lo! another Hercules
appeared.*

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote f: Ý

*He too is dead who still our
England propp'd
With him our fast reviving hopes
have dropp'd.*

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote g: Ý

And give the palm.

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote h: Ý

*But let not canker'd Calumny
assail
And round.*

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote i: Ý

And friends and foes.

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote j: Ý

--would dare to ask.

[4to]

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To a Lady who Presented to the Author a Lock of Hair Braided with his own, and appointed a Night in December to meet him in the Garden¹

These locks, which fondly thus entwine,
In firmer chains our hearts confine,
Than all th' unmeaning protestations
Which swell with nonsense, love orations.
Our love is fix'd, I think we've prov'd it;
Nor time, nor place, nor art have mov'd it;
Then wherefore should we sigh and whine,
With groundless jealousy repine;
With silly whims, and fancies frantic,
Merely to make our love romantic?
Why should you weep, like *Lydia Languish*,
And fret with self-created anguish?
Or doom the lover you have chosen,
On winter nights to sigh half frozen;
In leafless shades, to sue for pardon,
Only because the scene's a garden?
For gardens seem, by one consent,
(Since Shakespeare set the precedent;
Since Juliet first declar'd her passion)
To form the place of assignation.
Oh! would some modern muse inspire,
And seat her by a *sea-coal* fire;
Or had the bard at Christmas written,
And laid the scene of love in Britain;
He surely, in commiseration,
Had chang'd the place of declaration.
In Italy, I've no objection,

Warm nights are proper for reflection;
 But here our climate is so rigid,
 That love itself, is rather frigid:
 Think on our chilly situation,
 And curb this rage for imitation.
 Then let us meet, as oft we've done,
 Beneath the influence of the sun;
Or, if at midnight I must meet you,
 Within your mansion let me greet you^a:
 There, we can love for hours together,
 Much better, in such snowy weather,
 Than plac'd in all th' Arcadian groves,
That ever witness'd rural loves;
 Then, if my passion fail to please^b,
 Next night I'll be content to freeze;
No more I'll give a loose to laughter,
 But curse my fate, for ever after².

Footnote 1: Ý These lines are addressed to the same Mary referred to in the lines beginning, "This faint resemblance of thy charms." (*Vide ante*, p. 32.)

[return to footnote mark](#)

Footnote a: Ý

Oh! let me in your chamber greet you.

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote 2: Ý In the above little piece the author has been accused by some *candid readers* of introducing the name of a lady [Julia Leacroft] from whom he was some hundred miles distant at the time this was written; and poor Juliet, who has slept so long in "the tomb of all the Capulets," has been converted, with a trifling alteration of her name, into an English damsel, walking in a garden of their

Footnote b: Ý

There if my passion

[4to. *P. on V. Occasions.*]

[return](#)

own creation, during the month of *December*, in a village where the author never passed a winter. Such has been the candour of some ingenious critics. We would advise these *liberal* commentators on taste and arbiters of decorum to read *Shakespeare*.

Having heard that a very severe and indelicate censure has been passed on the above poem, I beg leave to reply in a quotation from an admired work, *Carr's Stranger in France*.--

"As we were contemplating a painting on a large scale, in which, among other figures, is the uncovered whole length of a warrior, a prudish-looking lady, who seemed to have touched the age of desperation, after having attentively surveyed it through her glass, observed to her party that there was a great deal of indecorum in that picture. Madame S. shrewdly whispered in my ear 'that the indecorum was in the remark.'"

[*Ed.* 1803, cap. xvi. p. 171.
Compare the *note* on verses addressed
To a Knot of Ungenerous Critics, p.
213.]

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[Contents p.2](#)

To a Beautiful Quaker¹

Sweet girl! though only once we met,
That meeting I shall ne'er forget;
And though we ne'er may meet again,
Remembrance will thy form retain;
I would not say, "I love," but still,
My senses struggle with my will:
In vain to drive thee from my breast,
My thoughts are more and more repress;
In vain I check the rising sighs,
Another to the last replies:
Perhaps, this is not love, but yet,
Our meeting I can ne'er forget.

What, though we never silence broke,
Our eyes a sweeter language spoke;
The tongue in flattering falsehood deals,
And tells a tale it never feels:
Deceit, the guilty lips impart,
And hush the mandates of the heart;
But soul's interpreters, the eyes,
Spurn such restraint, and scorn disguise.
As thus our glances oft convers'd,
And all our bosoms felt rehears'd,
No *spirit*, from within, reprov'd us,
Say rather, "'twas the *spirit* mov'd us."
Though, what they utter'd, I repress,
Yet I conceive thou'lt partly guess;
For as on thee, my memory ponders,
Perchance to me, thine also wanders.
This, for myself, at least, I'll say,
Thy form appears through night, through day;

Awake, with it my fancy teems,
In sleep, it smiles in fleeting dreams;
The vision charms the hours away,
And bids me curse Aurora's ray
For breaking slumbers of delight,
Which make me wish for endless night.
Since, oh! whate'er my future fate,
Shall joy or woe my steps await;
Tempted by love, by storms beset,
Thine image, I can ne'er forget.

Alas! again no more we meet,
No more our former looks repeat;
Then, let me breathe this parting prayer,
The dictate of my bosom's care:
"May Heaven so guard my lovely quaker,
That anguish never can o'ertake her;
That peace and virtue ne'er forsake her,
But bliss be aye her heart's partaker!
Oh! may the happy mortal, fated^a
To be, by dearest ties, related,
For *her*, each hour, *new joys* discover^b,
And lose the husband in the lover!
May that fair bosom never know
What 'tis to feel the restless woe,
Which stings the soul, with vain regret,
Of him, who never can forget!"

1806.

Footnote 1: Ý

*Whom the author saw at
Harrowgate.*

Annotated copy of *P. on V. Occasions*,
p. 64 (*British Museum*).

Footnote a: Ý The Quarto inserts the
following lines:--

*"No jealous passion shall invade,
No envy that pure heart pervade;"
For he that revels in such charms,
Can never seek another's arms.*

[return to footnote mark](#)

[return](#)

Footnote b: Ý

new joy *discover*.

[4to]

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[Contents p.2](#)

To Lesbia¹ [a](#)

1.

Lesbia! since far from you I've rang'd^b,
Our souls with fond affection glow not;
You say, 'tis I, not you, have chang'd,
I'd tell you why,--but yet I know not.

2.

Your polish'd brow no cares have crost;
And Lesbia! we are not much older^c,
Since, trembling, first my heart I lost,
Or told my love, with hope grown bolder.

3.

Sixteen was then our utmost age,
Two years have lingering pass'd away, love!
And now new thoughts our minds engage,
At least, I feel disposed to stray, love!

4.

"Tis *I* that am alone to blame,
I, that am guilty of love's treason;
Since your sweet breast is still the same,
Caprice must be my only reason.

5.

I do not, love! suspect your truth,
With jealous doubt my bosom heaves not;
Warm was the passion of my youth,
One trace of dark deceit it leaves not.

6.

No, no, my flame was not pretended;
For, oh! I lov'd you most sincerely;
And though our dream at last is ended
My bosom still esteems you dearly.

7.

No more we meet in yonder bowers;
Absence has made me prone to roving^d;
But older, firmer *hearts* than ours
Have found monotony in loving.

8.

Your cheek's soft bloom is unimpair'd,
New beauties, still, are daily bright'ning,
Your eye, for conquest beams prepar'd^e,
The forge of love's resistless lightning.

9.

Arm'd thus, to make their bosoms bleed,
Many will throng, to sigh like me, love!
More constant they may prove, indeed;
Fonder, alas! they ne'er can be, love!

1806.

Footnote 1: Ý "The lady's name was
Julia Leacroft"

(*Note by Miss E. Pigot*).

The word "Julia" (?) is added, in a
lady's hand, in the annotated copy of *P.*
on V. Occasions, p. 52 (British
Museum)

[return to footnote mark](#)

Footnote a: Ý *To Julia*. Ý[4to]
[return](#)

Footnote b: Ý *Julia since*. Ý[4to]
[return](#)

Footnote c: Ý *And Julia*. Ý[4to]
[return](#)

Footnote d: Ý

*Perhaps my soul's too pure for
roving.*

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote e: Ý

*Your eye for conquest comes
prepar'd.*

[4to]

[return](#)

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To Woman

Woman! experience might have told me^a
That all must love thee, who behold thee:
Surely experience might have taught
Thy firmest promises are nought^b;
But, plac'd in all thy charms before me,
All I forget, but to *adore* thee.
Oh memory! thou choicest blessing,
When join'd with hope, when still possessing^c;
But how much curst by every lover
When hope is fled, and passion's over.
Woman, that fair and fond deceiver,
How prompt are striplings to believe her!
How throbs the pulse, when first we view
The eye that rolls in glossy blue,
Or sparkles black, or mildly throws
A beam from under hazel brows!

How quick we credit every oath,
And hear her plight the willing troth!
Fondly we hope 'twill last for ay,
When, lo! she changes in a day.
This record will for ever stand,'
"Woman, thy vows are trac'd in sand."¹ [d](#)

Footnote 1: Ý The last line is almost a **Footnote a:** Ý
literal translation from a Spanish
proverb.

Surely, experience.

(The last line is not "almost a literal
translation from a Spanish proverb,"
but an adaptation of part of a stanza
from the *Diana* of Jorge de
Montemajor:

[4to]
[return](#)

"Mirà, el Amor, lo que ordena;
Que os viene a hazer creer
Cosas dichas por muger,
Y escriptas en el arena."

Southey, in his *Letters from Spain*,
1797, pp. 87-91, gives a specimen of
the *Diana*, and renders the lines in
question thus:

"And Love beheld us from his
secret stand,
And mark'd his triumph,
laughing, to behold me,
To see me trust a writing traced in
sand,
To see me credit what a woman
told me."

Byron, who at this time had little or no knowledge of Spanish literature, seems to have been struck with Southey's paraphrase, and compressed the quatrain into an epigram.

[return to footnote mark](#)

Footnote b: Ý

A woman's promises are naught.

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote c: Ý Here follows, in the Quarto, an additional couplet:--

*Thou whisperest, as our hearts
are beating,
"What oft we've done, we're still
repeating,"*

[return](#)

Footnote d: Ý

A woman's promises are naught.

[4to]

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An Occasional Prologue, Delivered by the Author Previous to the Performance of *The Wheel of Fortune* at a Private Theatre¹

Since the refinement of this polish'd age
Has swept immoral raillery from the stage;
Since taste has now expung'd licentious wit,
Which stamp'd disgrace on all an author writ;
Since, now, to please with purer scenes we seek,
Nor dare to call the blush from Beauty's cheek;
Oh! let the modest Muse some pity claim,
And meet indulgence--though she find not fame.
Still, not for *her* alone, we wish respect^a,
Others appear more conscious of defect:
To-night no *vet'ran Roscii* you behold,
In all the arts of scenic action old;
No **Cooke**, no **Kemble**, can salute you here,
No **Siddons** draw the sympathetic tear;
To-night you throng to witness the *début*
Of embryo Actors, to the Drama new:
Here, then, our almost unfledg'd wings we try;
Clip not our *pinions*, ere the *birds can fly*:
Failing in this our first attempt to soar,
Drooping, alas! we fall to rise no more.
Not one poor trembler, only, fear betrays,
Who hopes, yet almost dreads to meet your praise;
But all our Dramatis Personæ wait,
In fond suspense this crisis of their fate.
No venal views our progress can retard,
Your generous plaudits are our sole reward;
For these, each *Hero* all his power displays^b,
Each timid *Heroine* shrinks before your gaze:
Surely the last will some protection find^c?
None, to the softer sex, can prove unkind:
While Youth and Beauty form the female shield^d,
The sternest Censor to the fair must yield^e.
Yet, should our feeble efforts nought avail,
Should, *after all*, our best endeavours fail;
Still, let some mercy in your bosoms live,
And, if you can't applaud, at least *forgive*.

Footnote 1: Ý

"I enacted Penruddock, in *The Wheel of Fortune*, and Tristram Fickle, in the farce of *The Weathercock*, for three nights, in some private theatricals at Southwell, in 1806, with great applause. The occasional prologue for our volunteer play was also of my composition."

--*Diary; Life*, p. 38. The prologue was written by him, between stages, on his way from Harrogate. On getting into the carriage at Chesterfield, he said to his companion,

"Now, Pigot, I'll spin a prologue for our play;"

and before they reached Mansfield he had completed his task,--interrupting only once his rhyming reverie, to ask the proper pronunciation of the French word *début*; and, on being told it, exclaiming,

"Aye, that will do for rhyme to 'new.'"

--*Life*, p. 39.

"The Prologue was spoken by G. Wylde, Esq."

Note by Miss E. Pigot.

[return to footnote mark](#)

Footnote a: Ý

But not for her alone.

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote b: Ý

For them each Hero.

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote c: Ý

Surely these last.

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote d: Ý

Whilst Youth

[4to *P. on V. Occasions.*]

[return](#)

Footnote e: Ý

The sternest critic

[4to]

[return](#)

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To Eliza^a

1.

Eliza¹! what fools are the Mussulman sect,

Who, to woman, deny the soul's future existence;
Could they see thee, Eliza! they'd own their defect,
And this doctrine would meet with a general resistance^b.

2.

Had their Prophet possess'd half an atom of sense^c,
He ne'er would have *woman* from Paradise driven;
Instead of his *Houris*, a flimsy pretence^d,
With *woman alone* he had peopled his Heaven.

3.

Yet, still, to increase your calamities more^e,
Not content with depriving your bodies of spirit,
He allots one poor husband to share amongst four^f!--
With *souls* you'd dispense; but, this last, who could bear it?

4.

His religion to please neither party is made;
On *husbands* 'tis *hard*, to the wives most uncivil;
Still I can't contradict^g, what so oft has been said,
"Though women are angels, yet wedlock's the devil."

5.

This terrible truth, even Scripture has told²,
Ye Benedicks! hear me, and listen with rapture;
If a glimpse of redemption you wish to behold,
Of **St. Matt.**--read the second and twentieth chapter.

6.

'Tis surely enough upon earth to be vex'd,
With wives who eternal confusion are spreading;
"But in Heaven" (so runs the Evangelists' Text)
"We neither have giving in marriage, or wedding."

7.

From this we suppose, (as indeed well we may,)
That should Saints after death, with their spouses put up more,
And wives, as in life, aim at absolute sway,
All Heaven would ring with the conjugal uproar.

8.

Distraction and Discord would follow in course,
Nor **Matthew**, nor **Mark**, nor **St. Paul**, can deny it,
The only expedient is general divorce,
To prevent universal disturbance and riot.

9.

But though husband and wife, shall at length be disjoin'd,
Yet woman and man ne'er were meant to dissever,
Our chains once dissolv'd, and our hearts unconfin'd,
We'll love without bonds, but we'll love you for ever.

10.

Though souls are denied you by fools and by rakes,
Should you own it yourselves, I would even then doubt you,
Your nature so much of *celestial* partakes,
The Garden of Eden would wither without you.

Southwell, October 9, 1806.

Footnote 1: Ý The letters "E. B. P." are added, in a lady's hand, in the annotated copy of *P. on V. Occasions*, p. 26 (British Museum). The initials stand for Miss Elizabeth Pigot.
[return to footnote mark](#)

Footnote 2: Ý Stanzas 5-10, which appear in the Quarto, were never reprinted.
[return](#)

Footnote a: Ý
To Miss E. P.

[4to]

To Miss——

P. on V. Occasions.
[return](#)

Footnote b: Ý

*Did they know but yourself they
would bend with respect,
And this doctrine must meet*

[MS. Newstead]
[return](#)

Footnote c: Ý

But an atom of sense.

[4to]
[return](#)

Footnote d: Ý

But instead of his Houris.

[4to]
[return](#)

Footnote e: Ý

But still to increase.

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote f: Ý

He allots but one husband.

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote g: Ý

But I can't--

[4to]

[return](#)

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The Tear

*O lachrymarum fons, tenero sacros
Ducentium ortus ex animo; quater
Felix! in imo qui scatentem
Pectore te, pia Nympha, sensit^{[1](#)}.*

Gray, 'Alcaic Fragment'.

When Friendship or Love
Our sympathies move;
When Truth, in a glance, should appear,
The lips may beguile,
With a dimple or smile,
But the test of affection's a *Tear*.

2.

Too oft is a smile
But the hypocrite's wile,
To mask detestation, or fear;
Give me the soft sigh,
Whilst the soul-telling eye
Is dimm'd, for a time, with a *Tear*.

3.

Mild Charity's glow,
To us mortals below,
Shows the soul from barbarity clear;
Compassion will melt,
Where this virtue is felt,
And its dew is diffused in a *Tear*.

4.

The man, doom'd to sail
With the blast of the gale,
Through billows Atlantic to steer,
As he bends o'er the wave
Which may soon be his grave,
The green sparkles bright with a *Tear*.

5.

The Soldier braves death
For a fanciful wreath
In Glory's romantic career;
But he raises the foe
When in battle laid low,
And bathes every wound with a *Tear*.

6.

If, with high-bounding pride^a,
He return to his bride!
Renouncing the gore-crimson'd spear;
All his toils are repaid
When, embracing the maid,
From her eyelid he kisses the *Tear*.

7.

Sweet scene of my youth²!
Seat of Friendship and Truth,
Where Love chas'd each fast-fleeting year;
Loth to leave thee, I mourn'd,
For a last look I turn'd,
But thy spire was scarce seen through a *Tear*.

8.

Though my vows I can pour,
To my Mary no more³,
My Mary, to Love once so dear,
In the shade of her bow'r,
I remember the hour,
She rewarded those vows with a *Tear*.

9.

By another possest,
May she live ever blest!
Her name still my heart must revere:
With a sigh I resign,
What I once thought was mine,
And forgive her deceit with a *Tear*.

10.

Ye friends of my heart,
Ere from you I depart,
This hope to my breast is most near:
If again we shall meet,
In this rural retreat,
May we *meet*, as we *part*, with a *Tear*.

11.

When my soul wings her flight
To the regions of night,
And my corse shall recline on its bier^b;
As ye pass by the tomb,
Where my ashes consume,
Oh! moisten their dust with a *Tear*.

12.

May no marble bestow
The splendour of woe,
Which the children of Vanity rear;
No fiction of fame
Shall blazon my name,

All I ask, all I wish, is a *Tear*.

October 26, 1806^c.

Footnote 1: Ý The motto was prefixed in *Hours of Idleness*.

[return to footnote mark](#)

Footnote 2: Ý Harrow.

[return](#)

Footnote 3: Ý Miss Chaworth was married in 1805.

[return](#)

Footnote a: Ý

*When with high-bounding pride,
He returns...*

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote b: Ý

*And my body shall sleep on its
bier.*

[4to *P. on V. Occasions*]

[return](#)

Footnote c: Ý

BYRON, October 26, 1806.

[4to]

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Reply to some Verses of J.M.B. Pigot, Esq., on the Cruelty of his Mistress¹

1.

Why, Pigot, complain
Of this damsel's disdain,
Why thus in despair do you fret?
For months you may try,
Yet, believe me, a *sigh*^a
Will never obtain a *coquette*.

2.

Would you teach her to love?
For a time seem to rove;
At first she may *frown* in a *pet*;
But leave her awhile,
She shortly will smile,
And then you may *kiss* your *coquette*.

3.

For such are the airs
Of these fanciful fairs,
They think all our *homage* a *debt*:
Yet a partial neglect^b
Soon takes an effect,
And humbles the proudest *coquette*.

4.

Dissemble your pain,
And lengthen your chain,
And seem her *hauteur* to *regret*^c;
If again you shall sigh,

She no more will deny,
That *yours* is the rosy *coquette*.

5.

If still, from false pride^d,
Your pangs she deride,
This whimsical virgin forget;
Some *other* admire,
Who will *melt* with your *fire*,
And laugh at the *little coquette*.

6.

For *me*, I adore
Some *twenty* or more,
And love them most dearly; but yet,
Though my heart they enthrall,
I'd abandon them all,
Did they act like your blooming *coquette*.

7.

No longer repine,
Adopt this design^e,
And break through her slight-woven net!
Away with despair,
No longer forbear
To fly from the captious *coquette*.

8.

Then quit her, my friend!
Your bosom defend,

Ere quite with her snares you're beset:
Lest your deep-wounded heart,
When incens'd by the smart,
Should lead you to *curse* the *coquette*.

October 27, 1806^f.

Footnote 1: Ý The letters "C. B. F. J. B. M." are added, in a lady's hand, in the annotated copy of *P. on V. Occasions*, p. 14 (British Museum).
[return to footnote mark](#)

Footnote a: Ý

But believe me

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote b: Ý

But a partial...

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote c: Ý

Nor seem...

[4to *P. on V. Occasions*]

[return](#)

Footnote d: Ý

But if from false pride...

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote e: Ý

But form this design...

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote f: Ý

BYRON, October 27, 1806..

[4to]

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Granta. A Medley.

Ἀργυρέαις λόγχαισι μάχου καὶ πάντα κρατήσεις

(Reply of the Pythian Oracle to Philip of Macedon.)

1.

Oh! could **Le Sage's**² demon's gift
Be realis'd at my desire,
This night my trembling form he'd lift
To place it on St. Mary's spire^a.

2.

Then would, unroof'd, old Granta's halls,

Pedantic inmates full display;
Fellows who dream on *lawn* or *stalls*,
The price of venal votes to pay^b.

3.

Then would I view each rival wight,
Petty and **Palmerston** survey;
Who canvass there, with all their might^c,
Against the next elective day³.

4.

Lo! candidates and voters lie^d
All lull'd in sleep, a goodly number!
A race renown'd for piety,
Whose conscience won't disturb their slumber.

5.

Lord H——⁴ indeed, may not demur;
Fellows are sage, reflecting men:
They know preferment can occur,
But very seldom,--*now* and *then*.

6.

They know the Chancellor has got
Some pretty livings in disposal:
Each hopes that *one* may be his *lot*,
And, therefore, smiles on his proposal^e.

7.

Now from the soporific scene^f
I'll turn mine eye, as night grows later,
To view, unheeded and unseen^g,
The studious sons of Alma Mater.

8.

There, in apartments small and damp,
The candidate for college prizes,
Sits poring by the midnight lamp;
Goes late to bed, yet early rises^h.

9.

He surely well deserves to gain them,
With all the honours of his collegeⁱ,
Who, striving hardly to obtain them,
Thus seeks unprofitable knowledge:

10.

Who sacrifices hours of rest,
To scan precisely metres Attic;
Or agitates his anxious breast^j,
In solving problems mathematic:

11.

Who reads false quantities in Seale⁵,
Or puzzles o'er the deep triangle;
Depriv'd of many a wholesome meal^k;
In barbarous Latin⁶ doom'd to wrangle:

12.

Renouncing every pleasing page,
From authors of historic use;
Preferring to the letter'd sage,
The square of the hypothenuse⁷.

13.

Still, harmless are these occupations^m,
That hurt none but the hapless student,
Compar'd with other recreations,
Which bring together the imprudent;

14.

Whose daring revels shock the sight,
When vice and infamy combine,
When Drunkenness and dice inviteⁿ,
As every sense is steep'd in wine.

15.

Not so the methodistic crew,
Who plans of reformation lay:
In humble attitude they sue,
And for the sins of others pray:

16.

Forgetting that their pride of spirit,
Their exultation in their trial⁰,
Detracts most largely from the merit

Of all their boasted self-denial.

17.

'Tis morn:--from these I turn my sight:
What scene is this which meets the eye?
A numerous crowd array'd in white⁸,
Across the green in numbers fly.

18.

Loud rings in air the chapel bell;
'Tis hush'd:--what sounds are these I hear?
The organ's soft celestial swell
Rolls deeply on the listening ear.

19.

To this is join'd the sacred song,
The royal minstrel's hallow'd strain;
Though *he* who hears the *music* long^p,
Will *never* wish to *hear again*.

20.

Our choir would scarcely be excus'd,
E'en as a band of raw beginners;
All mercy, now, must be refus'd^q
To such a set of croaking sinners.

21.

If David, when his toils were ended,
Had heard these blockheads sing before him,

To us his psalms had ne'er descended,--
In furious mood he would have tore 'em.

22.

The luckless Israelites, when taken
By some inhuman tyrant's order,
Were ask'd to sing, by joy forsaken,
On Babylonian river's border.

23.

Oh! had they sung in notes like these^r
Inspir'd by stratagem or fear,
They might have set their hearts at ease,
The devil a soul had stay'd to hear.

24.

But if I scribble longer now^s,
The deuce a soul will *stay to read*;
My pen is blunt, my ink is low;
'Tis almost time to *stop, indeed*.

25.

Therefore, farewell, old *Granta's* spires!
No more, like *Cleofas*, I fly;
No more thy theme my Muse inspires:
The reader's tir'd, and so am I.

October 28, 1806.

Footnote 1: Ý The motto was prefixed in *Hours of Idleness*:

"Fight with silver spears" (*i. e.* with bribes), "and them shall prevail in all things."

And place it...

[4to *P. on V. Occasions*]
[return](#)

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Footnote 2: Ý The *Diable Boiteux* of Le Sage, where Asmodeus, the demon, places Don Cleofas on an elevated situation, and unroofs the houses for inspection. [Don Cleofas, clinging to the cloak of Asmodeus, is carried through the air to the summit of S. Salvador.]

[return](#)

Footnote 3: Ý On the death of Pitt, in January, 1806, Lord Henry Petty beat Lord Palmerston in the contest for the representation of the University of Cambridge in Parliament.

[return](#)

Footnote 4: Ý Probably Lord Henry Petty. See variant d.

[return](#)

Footnote b: Ý

The price of hireling...

[4to *P. on V. Occasions*]
[return](#)

Footnote c: Ý

Who canvass now...

[4to]
[return](#)

Footnote d: Ý

*One on his power and place
depends,
The other on--the Lord knows
what!
Each to some eloquence pretends,
But neither will convince by that.*

*The first, indeed, may not demur;
Fellows are sage reflecting men,
And know...*

[4to *P. on V. Occasions*]

[return](#)

Footnote 5: ÝScale's publication on Greek Metres displays considerable talent and ingenuity, but, as might be expected in so difficult a work, is not remarkable for accuracy. (*An Analysis of the Greek Metres; for the use of students at the University of Cambridge*. By John Barlow Seale (1764), 8vo. A fifth edition was issued in 1807.)

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Footnote 6: ÝThe Latin of the schools is of the *canine species*, and not very intelligible.

[return](#)

Footnote 7: Ý The discovery of Pythagoras, that the square of the hypothenuse is equal to the squares of the other two sides of a right-angled triangle.

[return](#)

Footnote 8: Ý On a saint's day the students wear surplices in chapel.

[return](#)

Footnote e: Ý

And therefore smiles at his...

[4to *P. on V. Occasions*]

[return](#)

Footnote f: Ý

Now from Corruption's shameless scene...

[4to *P. on V. Occasions*]

[return](#)

Footnote g: Ý

And view unseen...

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote h: Ý

and early rises...

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote i: Ý

And all the...

[4to *P. on V. Occasions*]

[return](#)

Footnote j: Ý

And agitates...

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote k: Ý

*And robs himself of many a
meal...*

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote m: Ý

*But harmless are these
occupations...
Which...*

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote n: Ý

*When Drunkenness and dice
unite.
And every sense...*

[4to P. on V. Occasions]

[return](#)

Footnote o: Ý

And exultation...

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote p: Ý

But he...

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote q: Ý

But mercy...

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote r: Ý

But had they sung...

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote s: Ý

But if I write much longer now...

[4to]

[return](#)

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To the Sighing Strephon¹

1.

Your pardon, my friend,
If my rhymes did offend,
Your pardon, a thousand times o'er;

From friendship I strove,
Your pangs to remove,
But, I swear, I will do so no more.

2.

Since your *beautiful* maid,
Your flame has repaid,
No more I your folly regret;
She's now most divine,
And I bow at the shrine,
Of this quickly reformèd coquette.

3.

Yet still, I must own^a,
I should never have known,
From *your verses*, what else she deserv'd;
Your pain seem'd so great,
I pitied your fate,
As your fair was so dev'lish reserv'd.

4.

Since the balm-breathing kiss^b
Of this magical Miss,
Can such wonderful transports produce^c;
Since the "*world you forget*,
When your lips once have met,"
My counsel will get but abuse.

5.

You say, "When I rove,"

"I know nothing of love;"
Tis true, I am given to range;
If I rightly remember,
I've lov'd a good number^d;
Yet there's pleasure, at least, in a change.

6.

I will not advance^e,
By the rules of romance,
To humour a whimsical fair;
Though a smile may delight,
Yet a *frown* will *affright*^f,
Or drive me to dreadful despair.

7.

While my blood is thus warm,
I ne'er shall reform,
To mix in the Platonists' school;
Of this I am sure,
Was my Passion so pure,
Thy *Mistress* would think me a fool^g.

8^h

And if I should shun,
Every *woman* for *one*,
Whose *image* must fill my whole breast;
Whom I must *prefer*,
And *sigh* but for *her*,
What an *insult* 'twould be to the *rest*!

9.

Now Strephon, good-bye;
I cannot deny,
Your *passion* appears most *absurd*;
Such *love* as you plead,
Is *pure* love, indeed,
For it *only* consists in the *word*.

Footnote 1: Ý The letters "J. M. B. P." are added, in a lady's hand, in the annotated copy of *P. on V. Occasions*, p. 17 (British Museum).
[return to footnote mark](#)

Footnote a: Ý
But still...

[4to]
[return](#)

Footnote b: Ý

But since the chaste kiss...

[4to]
[return](#)

Footnote c: Ý

Such wonderful...

[4to]
[return](#)

Footnote d: Ý

I've kiss'd a good number. But--...

[4to]
[return](#)

Footnote e: Ý

I ne'er will advance...

[4to]

[return](#)

Footnote f: Ý

Yet a frown won't affright...

[4to *P. on V. Occasions.*]

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Footnote g: Ý

My mistress must think me...

[4to *P. on V. Occasions.*]

[return](#)

Footnote h: Ý

*Though the kisses are sweet,
Which voluptuously meet,
Of kissing I ne'er was so fond,
As to make me forget,
Though our lips oft have met,
That still there was something
beyond....*

[4to]

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The Cornelian^{[1](#)}

1.

No specious splendour of this stone
Endears it to my memory ever;
With lustre *only once* it shone,
And blushes modest as the giver^a.

2.

Some, who can sneer at friendship's ties,
Have, for my weakness, oft reprov'd me;
Yet still the simple gift I prize,
For I am sure, the giver lov'd me.

3.

He offer'd it with downcast look,
As *fearful* that I might refuse it;
I told him, when the gift I took,
My *only fear* should be, to lose it.

4.

This pledge attentively I view'd,
And *sparkling* as I held it near,
Methought one drop the stone bedew'd,
And, ever since, *I've lov'd a tear*.

5.

Still, to adorn his humble youth,
Nor wealth nor birth their treasures yield;
But he, who seeks the flowers of truth,
Must quit the garden, for the field.

6.

'Tis not the plant uprear'd in sloth,
Which beauty shews, and sheds perfume;
The flowers, which yield the most of both,
In Nature's wild luxuriance bloom.

7.

Had Fortune aided Nature's care,
For once forgetting to be blind,
His would have been an ample share,
If well proportioned to his mind.

8.

But had the Goddess clearly seen,
His form had fix'd her fickle breast;
Her countless hoards would *his* have been,
And none remain'd to give the rest.

Footnote 1: Ý The cornelian was a present from his friend Edleston, a Cambridge chorister, afterwards a clerk in a mercantile house in London. Edleston died of consumption, May 11, 1811. (See letter from Byron to Miss Pigot, October 28, 1811.) Their acquaintance began by Byron saving him from drowning. (MS. note by the Rev. W. Harness.)
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Footnote a: Ý

But blushes modest...

[4to]
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To M——a

1.

Oh! did those eyes, instead of fire,
With bright, but mild affection shine:
Though they might kindle less desire,
Love, more than mortal, would be thine.

2.

For thou art form'd so heavenly fair,
Howe'er those orbs *may* wildly beam,
We must *admire*, but still despair;
That fatal glance forbids esteem.

3.

When Nature stamp'd thy beauteous birth,
So much perfection in thee shone,
She fear'd that, too divine for earth,
The skies might claim thee for their own.

4.

Therefore, to guard her dearest work,
Lest angels might dispute the prize,

She bade a secret lightning lurk,
Within those once celestial eyes.

5.

These might the boldest Sylph appall,
When gleaming with meridian blaze;
Thy beauty must enrapture all;
But who can dare thine ardent gaze?

6.

'Tis said that Berenice's hair,
In stars adorns the vault of heaven;
But they would ne'er permit *thee* there,
Thou wouldst so far outshine the seven.

7.

For did those eyes as planets roll,
Thy sister-lights would scarce appear:
E'en suns, which systems now controul,
Would twinkle dimly through their sphere^{[1](#)}.

Friday, November 7, 1806

Footnote 1: Ý

"Two of the fairest stars in all the
heaven,
Having some business, do intreat
her eyes
To twinkle in their spheres till

Footnote a: Ý

To A...

[4to]
[return](#)

they return."
Shakespeare.

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Lines Addressed to a Young Lady¹.

(As the Author was discharging his Pistols in a Garden, Two Ladies passing near the spot were alarmed by the sound of a Bullet hissing near them, to one of whom the following stanzas were addressed the next morning)².

1.

Doubtless, sweet girl! the hissing lead,
Wafting destruction o'er thy charms^a
And hurtling o'er³ thy lovely head,
Has fill'd that breast with fond alarms.

2.

Surely some envious Demon's force,
Vex'd to behold such beauty here,
Impell'd the bullet's viewless course,
Diverted from its first career.

3.

Yes! in that nearly fatal hour,
The ball obey'd some hell-born guide;
But Heaven, with interposing power,
In pity turn'd the death aside.

4.

Yet, as perchance one trembling tear
Upon that thrilling bosom fell;
Which *I*, th' unconscious cause of fear,
Extracted from its glistening cell;--

5.

Say, what dire penance can atone
For such an outrage, done to thee?
Arraign'd before thy beauty's throne,
What punishment wilt thou decree?

6.

Might I perform the Judge's part,
The sentence I should scarce deplore;
It only would restore a heart,
Which but belong'd to *thee* before.

7.

The least atonement I can make
Is to become no longer free;
Henceforth, I breathe but for thy sake,
Thou shalt be *all in all* to me.

8.

But thou, perhaps, may'st now reject
Such expiation of my guilt;
Come then--some other mode elect?
Let it be death--or what thou wilt.

9.

Choose, then, relentless! and I swear
Nought shall thy dread decree prevent;
Yet hold--one little word forbear!
Let it be aught but banishment.

Footnote 1: Ý This title first appeared in "Contents" to *P. on V. Occasions*
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Footnote a: Ý
near thy charms...

[4to]
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Footnote 2: Ý The occurrence took place at Southwell, and the beautiful lady to whom the lines were addressed was Miss Houson, who is also commemorated in the verses *To a Vain Lady* and *To Anne*. She was the daughter of the Rev. Henry Houson of Southwell, and married the Rev. Luke Jackson. She died on Christmas Day, 1821, and her monument may be seen in Hucknall Torkard Church.
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Footnote 3: Ý This word is used by Gray in his poem to the *Fatal Sisters*:-

-

"Iron-sleet of arrowy shower
Hurtles in the darken'd air."

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Translation from Catullus. *Ad Lesbiam*

Equal to Jove that youth must be--
Greater than Jove he seems to me--
Who, free from Jealousy's alarms,
Securely views thy matchless charms;
That cheek, which ever dimpling glows,
That mouth, from whence such music flows,
To him, alike, are always known,
Reserv'd for him, and him alone.
Ah! Lesbia! though 'tis death to me,
I cannot choose but look on thee;
But, at the sight, my senses fly,
I needs must gaze, but, gazing, die;
Whilst trembling with a thousand fears,
Parch'd to the throat my tongue adheres,
My pulse beats quick, my breath heaves short,
My limbs deny their slight support;
Cold dews my pallid face o'erspread,
With deadly languor droops my head,
My ears with tingling echoes ring,
And Life itself is on the wing;
My eyes refuse the cheering light,

Their orbs are veil'd in starless night:
Such pangs my nature sinks beneath,
And feels a temporary death.

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Translation of the Epitaph on Virgil and Tibullus, by Domitius Marsus

He who, sublime, in epic numbers roll'd,
And he who struck the softer lyre of Love,
By Death's *unequal*¹ hand alike controul'd,
Fit comrades in Elysian regions move!

Footnote 1: Ý The hand of Death is said to be unjust or unequal, as Virgil was considerably older than Tibullus at his decease.

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Imitation of Tibullus. Sulpicia ad Cerinthus

Lib. Quart.

Cruel Cerinthus! does the fell disease^a
Which racks my breast your fickle bosom please?
Alas! I wish'd but to o'ercome the pain,
That I might live for Love and you again;
But, now, I scarcely shall bewail my fate:
By Death alone I can avoid your hate.

Footnote a: Ý

does this fell disease...

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Translation from Catullus. Lugete Veneres Cupidinesque

Carm. III^a

Ye Cupids, droop each little head,
Nor let your wings with joy be spread,
My Lesbia's favourite bird is dead,
Whom dearer than her eyes she lov'd^b:
For he was gentle, and so true,
Obedient to her call he flew,
No fear, no wild alarm he knew,
But lightly o'er her bosom mov'd:

And softly fluttering here and there,
He never sought to cleave the air,
He chirrup'd oft, and, free from care^c,
Tun'd to her ear his grateful strain.
Now having pass'd the gloomy bourn^d,
From whence he never can return,
His death, and Lesbia's grief I mourn,
Who sighs, alas! but sighs in vain.

Oh! curst be thou, devouring grave!
Whose jaws eternal victims crave,
From whom no earthly power can save,
For thou hast ta'en the bird away:
From thee my Lesbia's eyes o'erflow,
Her swollen cheeks with weeping glow;
Thou art the cause of all her woe,
Receptacle of life's decay.

Footnote a: Ý *Luctus De Morte Passeris*. Ý[4to. P. on V. Occasions.]

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Footnote b: Ý *Which dearer.* Ý [4to]
[return](#)

Footnote c: Ý *But chirrup'd.* Ý[4to]
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Footnote d: Ý *But now he's pass'd.* Ý [4to]
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Imitated from Catullus^{[1](#)}. To Ellen^{[a](#)}

Oh! might I kiss those eyes of fire,
A million scarce would quench desire;
Still would I steep my lips in bliss,
And dwell an age on every kiss;
Nor then my soul should sated be,
Still would I kiss and cling to thee:
Nought should my kiss from thine dis sever,
Still would we kiss and kiss for ever;
E'en though the numbers did exceed^{[b](#)}
The yellow harvest's countless seed;
To part would be a vain endeavour:
Could I desist?--ah! never--never.

November 16, 1806.

Footnote 1: Ý From a note in Byron's copy of Catullus (now in the possession of Mr. Murray), it is evident that these lines are based on Carm. xlviii., *Mellitos oculos tuos, Juventi.*

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Footnote a: Ý *To Anna.* Ý[4to]
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Footnote b: Ý

E'en though the number...

[4to. *Three first Editions.*]
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Poems on Various Occasions

To M. S. G.

1.

Whene'er I view those lips of thine,
Their hue invites my fervent kiss;
Yet, I forego that bliss divine,
Alas! it were--unhallow'd bliss.

2.

Whene'er I dream of that pure breast,
How could I dwell upon its snows!
Yet, is the daring wish repress,
For that,--would banish its repose.

3.

A glance from thy soul-searching eye
Can raise with hope, depress with fear;
Yet, I conceal my love,--and why?
I would not force a painful tear.

4.

I ne'er have told my love, yet thou
Hast seen my ardent flame too well;
And shall I plead my passion now,
To make thy bosom's heaven a hell?

5.

No! for thou never canst be mine,
United by the priest's decree:
By any ties but those divine,
Mine, my belov'd, thou ne'er shalt be.

6.

Then let the secret fire consume,
Let it consume, thou shalt not know:
With joy I court a certain doom,
Rather than spread its guilty glow.

7.

I will not ease my tortur'd heart,
By driving dove-ey'd peace from thine;
Rather than such a sting impart,
Each thought presumptuous I resign.

8.

Yes! yield those lips, for which I'd brave
More than I here shall dare to tell;
Thy innocence and mine to save,--
I bid thee now a last farewell.

9.

Yes! yield that breast, to seek despair
And hope no more thy soft embrace;
Which to obtain, my soul would dare,
All, all reproach, but thy disgrace.

10.

At least from guilt shall thou be free,
No matron shall thy shame reprove;
Though cureless pangs may prey on me,
No martyr shall thou be to love.

Stanzas to a Lady, with the Poems of Camoëns¹

1.

This votive pledge of fond esteem,
Perhaps, dear girl! for me thou'lt prize;
It sings of Love's enchanting dream,
A theme we never can despise.

2.

Who blames it but the envious fool,
The old and disappointed maid?
Or pupil of the prudish school,
In single sorrow doom'd to fade?

3.

Then read, dear Girl! with feeling read,
For thou wilt ne'er be one of those;
To thee, in vain, I shall not plead
In pity for the Poet's woes.

4.

He was, in sooth, a genuine Bard;
His was no faint, fictitious flame:
Like his, may Love be thy reward,
But not thy hapless fate the same.

Footnote 1: Ý Lord Strangford's *Poems from the Portuguese* by Luis de Camoëns and "Little's" Poems are mentioned by Moore as having been Byron's favourite study at this time (*Life*, P--39).

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To M. S. G.^{[1](#)}

1.

When I dream that you love me, you'll surely forgive;
Extend not your anger to sleep;
For in visions alone your affection can live,--
I rise, and it leaves me to weep.

2.

Then, Morpheus! envelop my faculties fast,
Shed o'er me your languor benign;
Should the dream of to-night but resemble the last,
What rapture celestial is mine!

3.

They tell us that slumber, the sister of death,
Mortality's emblem is given;
To fate how I long to resign my frail breath,
If this be a foretaste of Heaven!

4.

Ah! frown not, sweet Lady, unbend your soft brow,
Nor deem me too happy in this;
If I sin in my dream, I atone for it now,
Thus doom'd, but to gaze upon bliss.

5.

Though in visions, sweet Lady, perhaps you may smile,
Oh! think not my penance deficient!
When dreams of your presence my slumbers beguile,
To awake, will be torture sufficient.

Footnote 1: Ý "C. G. B. to E. P."--MS. Newstead.
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Translation from Horace. *Justum et tenacem, etc.*

"Justum et tenacem propositi virum". Hor. 'Odes', iii. 3. I.

1.

The man of firm and noble soul
No factious clamours can controul;
No threat'ning tyrant's darkling brow
Can swerve him from his just intent:
Gales the warring waves which plough,
By Auster on the billows spent,
To curb the Adriatic main,
Would awe his fix'd determined mind in vain.

2.

Aye, and the red right arm of Jove,
Hurling his lightnings from above,
With all his terrors there unfurl'd,
He would, unmov'd, unaw'd, behold;
The flames of an expiring world,
Again in crashing chaos roll'd,

In vast promiscuous ruin hurl'd,
Might light his glorious funeral pile:
Still dauntless 'midst the wreck of earth he'd smile.

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The First Kiss of Love

‘Α βάρβιτος δὲ χορδαῖς
Ἔρωτα μούνον ἤχει.¹

Anacreon, Ode 1.

1.

Away with your fictions of flimsy romance,
Those tissues of falsehood which Folly has wove^a;
Give me the mild beam of the soul-breathing glance,
Or the rapture which dwells on the first kiss of love.

2.

Ye rhymers, whose bosoms with fantasy glow^b,
Whose pastoral passions are made for the grove;
From what blest inspiration your sonnets would flow^c,

Could you ever have tasted the first kiss of love.

3.

If Apollo should e'er his assistance refuse,
Or the Nine be dispos'd from your service to rove,
Invoke them no more, bid adieu to the Muse,
And try the effect, of the first kiss of love.

4.

I hate you, ye cold compositions of art,
Though prudes may condemn me, and bigots reprove;
I court the effusions that spring from the heart,
Which throbs, with delight, to the first kiss of love^d.

5.

Your shepherds, your flocks, those fantastical themes^e,
Perhaps may amuse, yet they never can move:
Arcadia displays but a region of dreams^f;
What are visions like these, to the first kiss of love?

6.

Oh! cease to affirm that man, since his birth^g,
From Adam, till now, has with wretchedness strove;
Some portion of Paradise still is on earth,
And Eden revives, in the first kiss of love.

7.

When age chills the blood, when our pleasures are past--
For years fleet away with the wings of the dove--
The dearest remembrance will still be the last,
Our sweetest memorial, the first kiss of love.

December 23, 1806.

Footnote 1: Ý The motto was
prefixed in *Hours of Idleness*.
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Footnote a: Ý

*Moriah^A those air dreams and
types has o'er wove...*

*Those tissues of fancy Moriah
has wove...*

[MS. Newstead]

Sub-Footnote A:Ý Moriah is the
"Goddess of Folly".
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Footnote b: Ý

*Ye rhymers, who sing as if
seated on snow...*

[4to P. on V. Occasions]

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Footnote c: Ý

With what blest inspiration...

[4to MS. P. on V. Occasions]

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Footnote d: Ý

Which glows with delight at...

[MS]

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Footnote e: Ý

our shepherds, your pipes...

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Footnote f: Ý

*Arcadia yields but a legion of
dreams...*

[MS]

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Footnote g: Ý

that man from his birth...

[MS. P. on V. Occasions]

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Childish Recollections¹

*"I cannot but remember such things were,
And were most dear to me."*

'Macbeth' [2](#)

"That" were most precious to me."

'Macbeth', act iv. sc. 3.)

When slow Disease, with all her
host of Pains^a,
Chills the warm tide, which flows
along the veins;
When Health, affrighted, spreads
her rosy wing,
And flies with every changing
gale of spring;
Not to the aching frame alone
confin'd, 10
Unyielding pangs assail the
drooping mind:
What grisly forms, the spectre-
train of woe,
Bid shuddering Nature shrink
beneath the blow,
With Resignation wage relentless
strife,
While Hope retires appall'd, and
clings to life. 20
Yet less the pang when, through
the tedious hour,
Remembrance sheds around her
genial power,
Calls back the vanish'd days to

rapture given,
When Love was bliss, and Beauty
form'd our heaven;
Or, dear to youth, pourtrays each
childish scene, 30
Those fairy bowers, where all in
turn have been.
As when, through clouds that
pour the summer storm,
The orb of day unveils his distant
form,
Gilds with faint beams the crystal
dews of rain
And dimly twinkles o'er the
watery plain; 40
Thus, while the future dark and
cheerless gleams,
The Sun of Memory, glowing
through my dreams,
Though sunk the radiance of his
former blaze,
To scenes far distant points his
paler rays,
Still rules my senses with
unbounded sway,
The past confounding with the 50
present day.
Oft does my heart indulge the
rising thought,
Which still recurs, unlook'd for
and unsought;
My soul to Fancy's fond
suggestion yields,
And roams romantic o'er her airy
fields.
Scenes of my youth, develop'd, 60
crowd to view,

To which I long have bade a last
adieu!
Seats of delight, inspiring
youthful themes;
Friends lost to me, for aye, except
in dreams;
Some, who in marble prematurely
sleep,
Whose forms I now remember, 70
but to weep;
Some, who yet urge the same
scholastic course
Of early science, future fame the
source;
Who, still contending in the
studious race,
In quick rotation, fill the senior
place!
These, with a thousand visions,
now unite, 80
To dazzle, though they please, my
aching sight³.
Ida! blest spot, where Science
holds her reign,
How joyous, once, I join'd thy
youthful train!
Bright, in idea, gleams thy lofty
spire,
Again, I mingle with thy playful
quire; 90
Our tricks of mischief⁴, every
childish game,
Unchang'd by time or distance,
seem the same;
Through winding paths, along the
glade I trace
The social smile of every

welcome face;
My wonted haunts, my scenes of
joy or woe,
Each early boyish friend, or 100
youthful foe,
Our feuds dissolv'd, but not my
friendship past,--
I bless the former, and forgive the
last.
Hours of my youth! when,
nurtur'd in my breast,
To Love a stranger, Friendship
made me blest,--
Friendship, the dear peculiar 110
bond of youth,
When every artless bosom throbs
with truth;
Untaught by worldly wisdom
how to feign,
And check each impulse with
prudential rein;
When, all we feel, our honest
souls disclose,
In love to friends, in open hate to 120
foes;
No varnish'd tales the lips of
youth repeat,
No dear-bought knowledge
purchased by deceit;
Hypocrisy, the gift of lengthen'd
years,
Matured by age, the garb of
Prudence wears^b:
When, now, the Boy is ripen'd
into Man, 130
His careful Sire chalks forth some
wary plan;

Instructs his Son from Candour's
path to shrink,
Smoothly to speak, and
cautiously to think;
Still to assent, and never to deny-

-

A patron's praise can well reward
the lie: 140

And who, when Fortune's
warning voice is heard,
Would lose his opening prospects
for a word?

Although, against that word, his
heart rebel,

And Truth, indignant, all his
bosom swell.

Away with themes like this! not
mine the task, 150

From flattering friends to tear the
hateful mask;

Let keener bards delight in
Satire's sting,

My Fancy soars not on
Detraction's wing:

Once, and but once, she aim'd a
deadly blow,

To hurl Defiance on a secret Foe;
But when that foe, from feeling 160
or from shame,

The cause unknown, yet still to
me the same,

Warn'd by some friendly hint,
perchance, retir'd,

With this submission all her rage
expired.

From dreaded pangs that feeble
Foe to save,

She hush'd her young resentment, 170
and forgave.

Or, if my Muse a Pedant's portrait
drew,

Pomposus⁵ virtues are but
known to few:

I never fear'd the young usurper's
nod,

And he who wields must,
sometimes, feel the rod.

If since on Granta's failings, 180
known to all

Who share the converse of a
college hall,

She sometimes trifled in a lighter
strain,

'Tis past, and thus she will not sin
again:

Soon must her early song for ever
cease,

And, all may rail, when I shall
rest in peace. 190

Here, first remember'd be the
joyous band,

Who hail'd me chief⁶, obedient to
command;

Who join'd with me, in every
boyish sport,

Their first adviser, and their last
resort;

Nor shrunk beneath the upstart
pedant's frown^c, 200

Or all the sable glories of his
gown^d;

Who, thus, transplanted from his
father's school,

Unfit to govern, ignorant of rule--

Succeeded him, whom all unite to
praise,
The dear preceptor of my early
days,
Probus⁷, the pride of science, and
the boast-- 210

To Ida now, alas! for ever lost!
With him, for years, we search'd
the classic page^e,
And fear'd the Master, though we
lov'd the Sage:
Retir'd at last, his small yet
peaceful seat
From learning's labour is the blest
retreat.

Pomposus fills his magisterial 220
chair;

Pomposus governs,--but, my
Muse, forbear:
Contempt, in silence, be the
pedant's lot^f,
His name and precepts be alike
forgot;
No more his mention shall my
verse degrade,--

To him my tribute is already 230
paid⁸.

High, through those elms with
hoary branches crown'd⁹

Fair Ida's bower adorns the
landscape round;
There Science, from her favour'd
seat, surveys
The vale where rural Nature
claims her praise;
To her awhile resigns her 240

youthful train,
Who move in joy, and dance
along the plain;
In scatter'd groups, each favour'd
haunt pursue,
Repeat old pastimes, and discover
new;
Flush'd with his rays, beneath the
noontide Sun,
In rival bands, between the 250
wickets run,
Drive o'er the sward the ball with
active force,
Or chase with nimble feet its
rapid course.
But these with slower steps direct
their way,
Where Brent's cool waves in
limpid currents stray,
While yonder few search out 260
some green retreat,
And arbours shade them from the
summer heat:
Others, again, a pert and lively
crew,
Some rough and thoughtless
stranger plac'd in view,
With frolic quaint their antic jests
expose,
And tease the grumbling rustic as 270
he goes;
Nor rest with this, but many a
passing fray
Tradition treasures for a future
day:
"'Twas here the gather'd swains
for vengeance fought,

And here we earn'd the conquest
dearly bought:
Here have we fled before superior 280
might,
And here renew'd the wild
tumultuous fight."
While thus our souls with early
passions swell,
In lingering tones resounds the
distant bell;
Th' allotted hour of daily sport is
o'er,
And Learning beckons from her
temple's door. 290
No splendid tablets grace her
simple hall,
But ruder records fill the dusky
wall:
There, deeply carv'd, behold!
each Tyro's name
Secures its owner's academic
fame;
Here mingling view the names of
Sire and Son, 300
The one long grav'd, the other
just begun:
These shall survive alike when
Son and Sire,
Beneath one common stroke of
fate expire¹⁰;
Perhaps, their last memorial these
alone,
Denied, in death, a monumental
stone,
Whilst to the gale in mournful 310
cadence wave
The sighing weeds, that hide their

nameless grave.
And, here, my name, and many
an early friend's,
Along the wall in lengthen'd line
extends.
Though, still, our deeds amuse
the youthful race,
Who tread our steps, and fill our 320
former place,
Who young obeyed their lords in
silent awe,
Whose nod commanded, and
whose voice was law;
And now, in turn, possess the
reins of power,
To rule, the little Tyrants of an
hour;
Though sometimes, with the
Tales of ancient day, 330
They pass the dreary Winter's eve
away;
"And, thus, our former rulers
stemm'd the tide,
And, thus, they dealt the combat,
side by side;
Just in this place, the mouldering
walls they scaled,
Nor bolts, nor bars, against their
strength avail'd;" 340
Here **Probus** came, the rising
fray to quell,
And, here, he falter'd forth his
last farewell;
And, here, one night abroad they
dared to roam,
While bold **Pomposus** bravely
staid at home;"

While thus they speak, the hour
must soon arrive,
When names of these, like ours, 350
alone survive:
Yet a few years, one general
wreck will overwhelm
The faint remembrance of our
fairy realm.
Dear honest race! though now we
meet no more,
One last long look on what we
were before--
Our first kind greetings, and our 360
last adieu--
Drew tears from eyes unus'd to
weep with you.
Through splendid circles,
Fashion's gaudy world,
Where Folly's glaring standard
waves unfurl'd,
I plung'd to drown in noise my
fond regret,
And all I sought or hop'd was to
forget: 370
Vain wish! if, chance, some well-
remember'd face,
Some old companion of my early
race,
Advanc'd to claim his friend with
honest joy,
My eyes, my heart, proclaim'd me
still a boy;
The glittering scene, the fluttering
groups around,
Were quite forgotten when my 380
friend was found;
The smiles of Beauty, (for, alas!

I've known
What 'tis to bend before Love's
mighty throne;)
The smiles of Beauty, though
those smiles were dear,
Could hardly charm me, when
that friend was near:
My thoughts bewilder'd in the 390
fond surprise,
The woods of **Ida** danc'd before
my eyes;
I saw the sprightly wand'ers pour
along,
I saw, and join'd again the joyous
throng;
Panting, again I trac'd her lofty
grove,
And Friendship's feelings 400
triumph'd over Love.
Yet, why should I alone with such
delight
Retrace the circuit of my former
flight?
Is there no cause beyond the
common claim,
Endear'd to all in childhood's very
name?
Ah! sure some stronger impulse 410
vibrates here,
Which whispers friendship will
be doubly dear
To one, who thus for kindred
hearts must roam,
And seek abroad, the love denied
at home.
Those hearts, dear **Ida**, have I
found in thee,

A home, a world, a paradise to
me.
Stern Death forbade my orphan
youth to share
The tender guidance of a Father's
care;
Can Rank, or e'en a Guardian's
name supply
The love, which glistens in a
Father's eye?
For this, can Wealth, or Title's
sound atone,
Made, by a Parent's early loss,
my own?
What Brother springs a Brother's
love to seek?
What Sister's gentle kiss has prest
my cheek?
For me, how dull the vacant
moments rise,
To no fond bosom link'd by
kindred ties!
Oft, in the progress of some
fleeting dream,
Fraternal smiles, collected round
me seem;
While still the visions to my heart
are prest,
The voice of Love will murmur in
my rest:
I hear--I wake--and in the sound
rejoice!
I hear again,--but, ah! no
Brother's voice.
A Hermit, 'midst of crowds, I fain
must stray
Alone, though thousand pilgrims

fill the way;
While these a thousand kindred
wreaths entwine,
I cannot call one single blossom
mine:
What then remains? in solitude to
groan,
To mix in friendship, or to sigh
alone?
Thus, must I cling to some
endearing hand,
And none more dear, than **Ida's**
social band.
Alonzo¹¹! best and dearest of my
friends^g,
Thy name ennobles him, who
thus commends:
From this fond tribute thou canst
gain no praise;
The praise is his, who now that
tribute pays.
Oh! in the promise of thy early
youth,
If Hope anticipate the words of
Truth!
Some loftier bard shall sing thy
glorious name,
To build his own, upon thy
deathless fame^h:
Friend of my heart, and foremost
of the list
Of those with whom I lived
supremely blest;
Oft have we drain'd the font of
ancient lore,
Though drinking deeply, thirsting
still the more;

Yet, when Confinement's
lingering hour was done,
Our sports, our studies, and our
souls were one:
Together we impell'd the flying
ball,
Together waited in our tutor's
hall;
Together join'd in cricket's manly
toil,
Or shar'd the produce of the
river's spoil;
Or plunging from the green
declining shore,
Our pliant limbs the buoyant
billows bore^j:
In every element, unchang'd, the
same,
All, all that brothers should be,
but the name.
Nor, yet, are you forgot, my
jocund Boy!
Davus¹², the harbinger of
childish joy;
For ever foremost in the ranks of
fun,
The laughing herald of the
harmless pun;
Yet, with a breast of such
materials made,
Anxious to please, of pleasing
half afraid;
Candid and liberal, with a heart
of steel
In Danger's path, though not
untaught to feel.
Still, I remember, in the factious

strife,
The rustic's musket aim'd against
my life¹³:
High pois'd in air the massy
weapon hung,
A cry of horror burst from every
tongue:
Whilst I, in combat with another
foe,
Fought on, unconscious of th'
impending blow;
Your arm, brave Boy, arrested his
career--
Forward you sprung, insensible to
fear;
Disarm'd, and baffled by your
conquering hand,
The grovelling Savage roll'd upon
the sand:
An act like this, can simple
thanks repay^k?
Or all the labours of a grateful
lay?
Oh no! whene'er my breast
forgets the deed,
That instant, **Davus**, it deserves
to bleed.
Lycus¹⁴! on me thy claims are
justly great:
Thy milder virtues could my
Muse relate,
To thee, alone, unrivall'd, would
belong
The feeble efforts of my
lengthen'd song^m.
Well canst thou boast, to lead in
senates fit,

A Spartan firmness, with
Athenian wit:
Though yet, in embryo, these
perfections shine,
Lycus! thy father's fame¹⁵ will
soon be thine.
Where Learning nurtures the
superior mind,
What may we hope, from genius
thus refin'd;
When Time, at length, matures
thy growing years,
How wilt thou tower, above thy
fellow peers!
Prudence and sense, a spirit bold
and free,
With Honour's soul, united beam
in thee.
Shall fair **Euryalus**¹⁶, pass by
unsung?
From ancient lineage, not
unworthy, sprung:
What, though one sad dissension
bade us part,
That name is yet embalm'd within
my heart,
Yet, at the mention, does that
heart rebound,
And palpitate, responsive to the
sound;
Envy dissolved our ties, and not
our will:
We once were friends,--I'll think,
we are so still.
A form unmatch'd in Nature's
partial mould,
A heart untainted, we, in thee,

behold:

Yet, not the Senate's thunder thou
shall wield,

Nor seek for glory, in the tented
field:

To minds of ruder texture, these
be given--

Thy soul shall nearer soar its
native heaven.

Haply, in polish'd courts might be
thy seat,

But, that thy tongue could never
forge deceit:

The courtier's supple bow, and
sneering smile,

The flow of compliment, the
slippery wile,

Would make that breast, with
indignation, burn,

And, all the glittering snares, to
tempt thee, spurn.

Domestic happiness will stamp
thy fate;

Sacred to love, unclouded e'er by
hate;

The world admire thee, and thy
friends adore;--

Ambition's slave, alone, would
toil for moreⁿ.

Now last, but nearest, of the
social band,

See honest, open, generous

Cleon¹⁷ stand;

With scarce one speck, to cloud
the pleasing scene,

No vice degrades that purest soul
serene.

On the same day, our studious
race begun,
On the same day, our studious
race was run;
Thus, side by side, we pass'd our
first career,
Thus, side by side, we strove for
many a year:
At last, concluded our scholastic
life,
We neither conquer'd in the
classic strife:
As Speakers¹⁸, each supports an
equal name^o,
And crowds allow to both a
partial fame:
To soothe a youthful Rival's early
pride,
Though Cleon's candour would
the palm divide,
Yet Candour's self compels me
now to own,
Justice awards it to my Friend
alone.
Oh! Friends regretted, Scenes for
ever dear,
Remembrance hails you with her
warmest tear!
Drooping, she bends o'er pensive
Fancy's urn,
To trace the hours, which never
can return;
Yet, with the retrospection loves
to dwell^p,
And soothe the sorrows of her
last farewell!
Yet greets the triumph of my

boyish mind,
As infant laurels round my head
were twin'd;
When **Probus**' praise repaid my
lyric song,
Or plac'd me higher in the
studious throng;
Or when my first harangue
receiv'd applause¹⁹,
His sage instruction the primeval
cause,
What gratitude, to him, my soul
possest,
While hope of dawning honours
fill'd my breast^q!
For all my humble fame, to him
alone,
The praise is due, who made that
fame my own.
Oh! could I soar above these
feeble lays,
These young effusions of my
early days,
To him my Muse her noblest
strain would give,
The song might perish, but the
theme might live^r.
Yet, why for him the needless
verse essay?
His honour'd name requires no
vain display:
By every son of grateful **Ida**
blest,
It finds an echo in each youthful
breast;
A fame beyond the glories of the
proud,

Or all the plaudits of the venal
crowd.

Ida! not yet exhausted is the
theme,

Nor clos'd the progress of my
youthful dream.

How many a friend deserves the
grateful strain!

What scenes of childhood still
unsung remain!

Yet let me hush this echo of the
past,

This parting song, the dearest and
the last;

And brood in secret o'er those
hours of joy,

To me a silent and a sweet
employ,

While, future hope and fear alike
unknown,

I think with pleasure on the past
alone;

Yes, to the past alone, my heart
confine,

And chase the phantom of what
once was mine.

Ida! still o'er thy hills in joy
preside,

And proudly steer through Time's
eventful tide:

Still may thy blooming Sons thy
name revere,

Smile in thy bower, but quit thee
with a tear;--

That tear, perhaps, the fondest
which will flow,

O'er their last scene of happiness

below:

Tell me, ye hoary few, who glide
along,

The feeble Veterans of some
former throng,

Whose friends, like Autumn
leaves by tempests whirl'd,
Are swept for ever from this busy
world;

Revolve the fleeting moments of
your youth,

While Care has yet withheld her
venom'd tooth^s;

Say if Remembrance days like
these endears,

Beyond the rapture of succeeding
years?

Say, can Ambition's fever'd dream
bestow

So sweet a balm to soothe your
hours of woe?

Can Treasures hoarded for some
thankless Son,

Can Royal Smiles, or Wreaths by
slaughter won,

Can Stars or Ermine, Man's
maturer Toys,

(For glittering baubles are not left
to Boys,)

Recall one scene so much belov'd
to view,

As those where Youth her garland
twin'd for you?

Ah, no! amid the gloomy calm of
age

You turn with faltering hand life's
varied page,

Peruse the record of your days on
earth,
Unsullied only where it marks
your birth;
Still, lingering, pause above each
chequer'd leaf,
And blot with Tears the sable
lines of Grief;
Where Passion o'er the theme her
mantle threw,
Or weeping Virtue sigh'd a faint
adieu;
But bless the scroll which fairer
words adorn,
Trac'd by the rosy finger of the
Morn;
When Friendship bow'd before
the shrine of truth,
And Love, without his pinion²⁰,
smil'd on Youth.

Footnote 1: Ý The words, "that schoolboy thing," etc. (see letter to H. Drury, Jan. 8, 1808), evidently apply, not as Moore intimates, to this period, but to the lines *On a Change of Masters*, etc., July, 1805 (see letter to W. Banks, March 6, 1807).

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Footnote a: Ý

*Hence! thou unvarying song,
of varied loves,
Which youth commends,
maturer age reproves;
Which every rhyming bard
repeats by rote,
By thousands echo'd to the
self-same note!
Tir'd of the dull, unceasing,
copious strain,
My soul is panting to be free
again.*

*Farewell! ye nymphs,
propitious to my verse,
Some other Damon, will your
charms rehearse;
Some other paint his pangs,
in hope of bliss,
Or dwell in rapture on your
nectar'd kiss.
Those beauties, grateful to
my ardent sight,
No more entrance my senses
in delight;
Those bosoms, form'd of
animated snow,
Alike are tasteless and
unfeeling now.
These to some happier lover,
I resign;
The memory of those joys
alone is mine.
Censure no more shall brand
my humble name,
The child of passion and the
fool of fame.
Weary of love, of life,
devoured with spleen,
I rest a perfect Timon, not
nineteen;
World! I renounce thee! all
my hope's o'ercast!
One sigh I give thee, but that
sigh's the last.
Friends, foes, and females,
now alike, adieu!
Would I could add
remembrance of you, too!
Yet though the future, dark*

*and cheerless gleams,
The curse of memory,
hovering in my dreams,
Depicts with glowing pencil
all those years,
Ere yet, my cup, empoison'd,
flow'd with tears,
Still rules my senses with
tyrannic sway,
The past confounding with
the present day.*

*Alas! in vain I check the
maddening thought;
It still recurs, unlook'd for
and unsought:
My soul to Fancy's,*

etc., etc., as at line 29.

[return](#)

Footnote 2: Ý The motto was
prefixed in *Hours of Idleness*.

[return](#)

Footnote b: Ý

Cunning with age...

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote 3: Ý Lines 43-98 were
added in *Hours of Idleness*

[return](#)

Footnote c: Ý

Nor shrunk before...

[*Hours of Idleness*]

[return](#)

Footnote 4: Ý Newton Hanson
relates that on one occasion he
accompanied his father to Harrow
on Speech Day to see his brother
Hargreaves Hanson and Byron.

Footnote d: Ý

*Careless to soothe the
pedant's furious frown,
Scarcely respecting his*

"On our arrival at Harrow, we set out in search of Hargreaves and Byron, but the latter was not at his tutor's. Three or four lads, hearing my father's inquiries, set off at full speed to find him. They soon discovered him, and, laughing most heartily, called out, 'Hallo, Byron! here's a gentleman wants you.' And what do you think? He had got on Drury's hat. I can still remember the arch cock of Byron's eye at the hat and then at my father, and the fun and merriment it caused him and all of us whilst, during the day, he was perambulating the highways and byeways of Ida with the hat on. 'Harrow Speech Day and the Governor's Hat' was one of the standing rallying-points for Lord Byron ever after."

*majestic gown;
By which, in vain, he gain'd a
borrow'd grace,
Adding new terror to his
sneering face,...*

[P. on V. Occasions]
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Footnote 5: Ý Dr. Butler, then Head-master of Harrow. Had Byron published another edition of these poems, it was his intention to replace these four lines by the four which follow:--

*"If once my muse a harsher
portrait drew,*

Footnote e: Ý

*With him for years I search'd
the classic page,
Culling the treasures of the
letter'd sage,...*

[P. on V. Occasions]
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*Warm with her wrongs, and
deentd the likeness true,
By cooler judgment taught,
her fault she owns,--
With noble minds a fault
confess'd, atones."*

[MS. M.]

See also allusion in letter to Mr.
Henry Drury, June 25, 1809.
(Moore's Note).

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Footnote 6: *Y* On the retirement of **Footnote f:** *Y*

Dr. Drury, three candidates for the
vacant chair presented themselves--
Messrs. Drury, Evans, and Butler.
On the first movement to which
this contest gave rise in the school,
young Wildman was at the head of
the party for Mark Drury, while
Byron held himself aloof from
any. Anxious, however, to have
him as an ally, one of the Drury
faction said to Wildman,

*Contempt, in silence, be the
pedant's lot,
Soon shall his shallow
precepts be forgot;
No more his mention shall my
pen degrade--
My tribute to his name's
already paid...*

[P. on V. Occasions]

"Byron, I know, will not join,
because he does not choose
to act second to any one, but,
by giving up the leadership to
him, you may at once secure
him."

Another variant for a new edition
ran--

*Another fills his magisterial
chair;
Reluctant Ida owns a
stranger's care;
Oh! may like honours crown
his future name:
If such his virtues, such shall
be his fame.*

This Wildman did, and Byron took
the command. (*Life*, p. 29.)

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MS. M.

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Footnote 7: Dr. Drury. This most **Footnote g:**

able and excellent man retired from his situation in March, 1805, after having resided thirty-five years at Harrow; the last twenty as head-master; an office he held with equal honour to himself and advantage to the very extensive school over which he presided. Panegyric would here be superfluous: it would be useless to enumerate qualifications which were never doubted. A considerable contest took place between three rival candidates for his vacant chair: of this I can only say--

Joannes! best and dearest of my friends....

[P. on V. Occasions.]

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*Si mea cum vestris valuissent
vota, Pelasgi!
Non foret ambiguus tanti
certaminis hares.*

[Byron's letters from Harrow contain the same high praise of Dr. Drury. In one, of November 2, 1804, he says,

"There is so much of the gentleman, so much mildness, and nothing of pedantry in his character, that

I cannot help liking him, and
will remember his
instructions with gratitude as
long as I live."

A week after, he adds,

"I revere Dr. Drury. I dread
offending him; not, however,
through fear, but the respect I
bear him makes me unhappy
when I am under his
displeasure."

Dr. Drury has related the secret of
the influence he obtained: the
glance which told him that the lad
was "a wild mountain colt," told
him also that he could be "led with
a silken string."]

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Footnote 8: Ý This alludes to a
character printed in a former
private edition [*P. on V.*
Occasions] for the perusal of some
friends, which, with many other
pieces, is withheld from the
present volume. To draw the
attention of the public to
insignificance would be
deservedly reprobated; and
another reason, though not of
equal consequence, may be given
in the following couplet:--

"Satire or sense, alas! can
Sporus feel?

Footnote h: Ý

*Could aught inspire me with
poetic fire,
For thee, alone, I'd strike the
hallow'd lyre;
But, to some abler hand, the
task I wave,
Whose strains immortal may
outlive the grave<...*

[*P. on V. Occasions.*]
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Who breaks a Butterfly upon
a wheel?"

(*Prologue to the Satires*: Pope.)

[*Hours of Idleness*, p. 154, *note*]
(See the lines "On a Change of
Masters at a Great Public School,"
ante, p. 16.)

The following lines, attached to
the Newstead MS. draft of
Childish Recollections, are aimed
at Pomposus:--

"Just half a Pedagogue, and
half a Fop,
Not formed to grace the
pulpit, but the Shop;
The *Counter*, not the *Desk*,
should be his place,
Who deals out precepts, as if
dealing Lace;
Servile in mind, from
Elevation proud,
In argument, less sensible
than loud,
Through half the continent,
the Coxcomb's been,
And stuns you with the
Wonders he has seen:
'How in Pompeii's vault he
found the page,
Of some long lost, and long
lamented Sage,
And doubtless he the Letters
would have trac'd,

Had they not been by age and
dust effac'd:
This single specimen will
serve to shew,
The weighty lessons of this
reverend Beau,
Bombast in vain would want
of Genius cloke,
For feeble fires evaporate in
smoke;
A Boy, o'er Boys he holds a
trembling reign,
More fit than they to seek
some School again."

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Footnote 9: Ý Lines 121-243 were added in *Hours of Idleness*.

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Our lusty limbs.

[P. on V. Occasions.]

--the buoyant waters bore.

[Hours of Idleness.]...

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Footnote 10: Ý During a rebellion at Harrow, the poet prevented the school-room from being burnt down, by pointing out to the boys the names of their fathers and grandfathers on the walls. (Medwin's *Conversations* (1824), p. 85.)

Footnote k: Ý

*Thus did you save that life I
scarcely prize--
A life unworthy such a
sacrifice.
Oh! when my breast forgets
the generous deed....*

Byron elsewhere thus describes

his usual course of life while at Harrow: "always cricketing, rebelling, *rowing*, and in all manner of mischiefs." One day he tore down the gratings from the window of the hall; and when asked by Dr. Butler his reason for the outrage, coolly answered, "because they darkened the room."--*Life*, p. 29.

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Footnote 11: Ý "Lord Clare." (Annotated copy of *P. on V. Occasions* in the British Museum.) (Lines 243-264, as the note in Byron's handwriting explains, were originally intended to apply to Lord Clare. In *Hours of Idleness* "Joannes" became "Alonzo," and the same lines were employed to celebrate the memory of his friend the Hon. John Wingfield, of the Coldstream Guards, brother to Richard, fourth Viscount Powerscourt. He died at Coimbra in 1811, in his twentieth year. Byron at one time gave him the preference over all other friends.)

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[*P. on V. Occasions*]

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Footnote m: Ý

*For ever to possess a friend
in thee,
Was bliss unhop'd, though not
unsought by me;
Thy softer soul was form'd
for love alone,
To ruder passions and to hate
unknown;
Thy mind, in union with thy
beauteous form,
Was gentle, but unfit to stem
the storm;
That face, an index of
celestial worth,
Proclaim'd a heart abstracted
from the earth.
Oft, when depress'd with sad,
foreboding gloom,
I sat reclin'd upon our
favourite tomb,
I've seen those sympathetic
eyes o'erflow
With kind compassion for thy
comrade's woe;*

*Or, when less mournful
subjects form'd our themes,
We tried a thousand fond
romantic schemes,
Oft hast thou sworn, in
friendship's soothing tone.
Whatever wish was mine,
must be thine own.
The next can boast to lead in
senates fit,
A Spartan firmness,--with
Athenian wit;
Tho' yet, in embryo, these
perfections shine,
Clarus! thy father's fame will
soon be thine....*

[*P. on V. Occasions*]

A remonstrance which Lord Clare addressed to him at school; was found among his papers (as were most of the notes of his early favourites), and on the back of it was an endorsement which is a fresh testimony of his affection:--

"This and another letter were written at Harrow, by my *then* and, I hope, *ever* beloved friend, Lord Clare, when we were both schoolboys; and sent to my study in consequence of some *childish* misunderstanding,--the only one which ever arose between us. It was of short

duration, and I retain this
note solely for the purpose of
submitting it to his perusal,
that we may smile over the
recollection of the
insignificance of our first and
last quarrel."

See, also, Byron's account of his
accidental meeting with Lord
Clare in Italy in 1821, as recorded
in *Detached Thoughts*, Nov. 5,
1821; in letters to Moore, March 1
and June 8, 1822; and Mme.
Guiccioli's description of his
emotion on seeing Clare (*My
Recollections of Lord Byron*, ed.
1869, p. 156).]

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Footnote 12: Ý The Rev. John
Cecil Tattersall, B.A., of Christ
Church, Oxford, who died
December 8, 1812, at Hall's Place,
Kent, aged twenty-three.

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Footnote 13: Ý Footnote 13: The
"factious strife" was brought on by
the breaking up of school, and the
dismissal of some volunteers from
drill, both happening at the same
hour. The butt-end of a musket
was aimed at Byron's head, and
would have felled him to the
ground, but for the interposition of
Tattersall.--*Life*, p. 25.

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Footnote n: Ý

*Where is the restless fool,
would wish for more?...*

[*P. on V. Occasions.*]

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Footnote o: Ý

*As speakers, each supports a
rival name,
Though neither seeks to damn
the other's fame,
Pomposus sits, unequal to
decide,
With youthful candour, we the
palm divide...*

[P. on V. Occasions]

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Footnote 14: Ý John Fitzgibbon, second Earl of Clare (1792-1851), afterwards Governor of Bombay, of whom Byron said, in 1822,

"I have always loved him better than any *male* thing in the world." "I never," was his language in 1821, "hear the word '*Clare*' without a beating of the heart even now; and I write it with the feelings of 1803-4-5, ad infinitum."

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Footnote 15: Ý John Fitzgibbon, first Earl of Clare (1749-1802), became Attorney-General and Lord Chancellor of Ireland. In the latter years of the independent Irish Parliament, he took an active part in politics in opposition to Grattan and the national party, and was distinguished as a powerful, if bitter, speaker. He was made Earl of Clare in 1795.

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Footnote p: Ý

*Yet in the retrospection finds relief,
And revels in the luxury of grief...*

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Footnote q: Ý

*When, yet a novice in the mimic art,
I feign'd the transports of a vengeful heart;
When, as the Royal Slave, I trod the stage,
To vent in Zanga, more than mortal rage;
The praise of Probus, made me feel more proud,
Than all the plaudits of the list'ning crowd.*

*Ah! vain endeavour in this childish strain
To soothe the woes of which I thus complain!*

*What can avail this fruitless
loss of time,
To measure sorrow, in a
jingling rhyme!
No social solace from a
friend, is near,
And heartless strangers drop
no feeling tear.
I seek not joy in Woman's
sparkling eye,
The smiles of Beauty cannot
check the sigh.
Adieu, thou world! thy
pleasure's still a dream,
Thy virtue, but a visionary
theme;
Thy years of vice, on years of
folly roll,
Till grinning death assigns
the destin'd goal,
Where all are hastening to
the dread abode,
To meet the judgment of a
righteous God;
Mix'd in the concourse of a
thoughtless throng,
A mourner, midst of mirth, I
glide along;
A wretched, isolated, gloomy
thing,
Curst by reflection's deep
corroding sting;
But not that mental sting,
which stabs within,
The dark avenger of
unpunish'd sin;
The silent shaft, which goads*

*the guilty wretch
Extended on a rack's untiring
stretch:
Conscience that sting, that
shaft to him supplies--
His mind the rack, from
which he ne'er can rise,
For me, whatever my folly, or
my fear,
One cheerful comfort still is
cherish'd here.
No dread internal, haunts my
hours of rest,
No dreams of injured
innocence infest;
Of hope, of peace, of almost
all bereft,
Conscience, my last but
welcome guest, is left.
Slander's empoison'd breath,
may blast my name,
Envy delights to blight the
buds of fame:
Deceit may chill the current
of my blood,
And freeze affection's warm
impassion'd flood;
Presaging horror, darken
every sense,
Even here will conscience be
my best defence;
My bosom feeds no "worm
which ne'er can die:"
Not crimes I mourn, but
happiness gone by.
Thus crawling on with many
a reptile vile,*

*My heart is bitter, though my
cheek may smile;
No more with former bliss,
my heart is glad;
Hope yields to anguish and
my soul is sad;
From fond regret, no future
joy can save;
Remembrance slumbers only
in the grave....*

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Footnote 16: Ý George John, fifth Earl of Delawarr.-- **Footnote r:** Ý

"I am happy enough, and comfortable here," says Byron, in a letter from Harrow of Oct. 25, 1804.

"My friends are not numerous, but select. Among the principal, I rank Lord Delawarr, who is very amiable, and my particular friend."--

"Nov. 2, 1804. Lord Delawarr is considerably younger than me, but the most good-tempered, amiable, clever fellow in the universe. To all which he adds the quality (a good one in the eyes of women) of being remarkably handsome. Delawarr and myself are, in a manner, connected; for one of my

*The song might perish, but
the theme must live...*

[Hours of Idleness]

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forefathers, in Charles I.'s
time, married into their
family."

The allusion in the text to their
subsequent quarrel, receives
further light from a letter which
the poet addressed to Lord Clare
under date, February 6, 1807.
(See, too, lines "To George, Earl
Delawarr," p. 126.) The first Lord
Byron was twice married. His first
wife was Cecilie, widow of Sir
Francis Bindlose, and daughter of
Thomas, third Lord Delawarr. He
died childless, and was succeeded
by his brother Richard, the poet's
ancestor. His younger brother, Sir
Robert Byron, married Lucy,
another daughter of the third Lord
Delawarr.

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[cross reference: return to footnote
of "To D——"](#)

[cross reference: return to footnote
of "To George, Earl Delawarr"](#)

Footnote 17: Ý Edward Noel
Long, who was drowned by the
foundering of a transport on the
voyage to Lisbon with his
regiment, in 1809. (See lines *To
Edward Noel Long, Esq., post*, p.
184.)

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Footnote 18: Ý This alludes to the
public speeches delivered at the
school where the author was

Footnote s: Ý

--his venom'd tooth....

[*Hours of Idleness*]

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educated.

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Footnote 19: Ý

"My qualities were much more oratorical than poetical, and Dr. Drury, my grand patron, had a great notion that I should turn out an orator from my fluency, my turbulence, my voice, my copiousness of declamation, and my action. I remember that my first declamation astonished Dr. Drury into some unwonted (for he was economical of such) and sudden compliments, before the declaimers at our first rehearsal."

Byron Diary.

"I certainly was much pleased with Lord Byron's attitude, gesture, and delivery, as well as with his composition. To my surprise, he suddenly diverged from the written composition, with a boldness and rapidity sufficient to alarm me, lest he should fail in memory as to the conclusion. I questioned him, why he had altered his declamation? He declared he had made no alteration, and

did not know, in speaking,
that he had deviated from it
one letter. I believed him, and
from a knowledge of his
temperament, am convinced
that he was hurried on to
expressions and colourings
more striking than what his
pen had expressed."

Dr. Drury, *Life*, p. 20.

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Footnote 20: Ý "L'Amitié est
l'Amour sans ailes," is a French
proverb. (See the lines so entitled,
p. 220.)

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**Answer to a Beautiful Poem, Written by Montgomery,
Author of *The Wanderer in Switzerland*, etc., entitled *The
Common Lot*** [1](#)

1.

Montgomery! true, the common lot

Of mortals lies in Lethe's wave;
Yet some shall never be forgot,
Some shall exist beyond the grave.

2.

"Unknown the region of his birth,"
The hero² rolls the tide of war;
Yet not unknown his martial worth,
Which glares a meteor from afar.

3.

His joy or grief, his weal or woe,
Perchance may 'scape the page of fame;
Yet nations, now unborn, will know
The record of his deathless name.

4.

The Patriot's and the Poet's frame
Must share the common tomb of all:
Their glory will not sleep the same;
That will arise, though Empires fall.

5.

The lustre of a Beauty's eye
Assumes the ghastly stare of death;
The fair, the brave, the good must die,
And sink the yawning grave beneath.

6.

Once more, the speaking eye revives,
Still beaming through the lover's strain;
For Petrarch's Laura still survives:
She died, but ne'er will die again.

7.

The rolling seasons pass away,
And Time, untiring, waves his wing;
Whilst honour's laurels ne'er decay,
But bloom in fresh, unfading spring.

8.

All, all must sleep in grim repose,
Collected in the silent tomb;
The old, the young, with friends and foes,
Fest'ring alike in shrouds, consume.

9.

The mouldering marble lasts its day,
Yet falls at length an useless fane;
To Ruin's ruthless fangs a prey,
The wrecks of pillar'd Pride remain.

10.

What, though the sculpture be destroy'd,
From dark Oblivion meant to guard;
A bright renown shall be enjoy'd,

By those, whose virtues claim reward.

11.

Then do not say the common lot
Of all lies deep in Lethe's wave;
Some few who ne'er will be forgot
Shall burst the bondage of the grave.

1806.

Footnote 1: Y Montgomery (James), 1771-1854, poet and hymn-writer, published

- *Prison Amusements* (1797),
- *The Ocean; a Poem* (1805),
- *The Wanderer of Switzerland, and other Poems* (1806),
- *The West Indies, and other Poems* (1810),
- *Songs of Sion* (1822),
- *The Christian Psalmist* (1825),
- *The Pelican Island, and other Poems* (1827),

etc. (vide post, [English Bards, etc., line 418](#) (click c2 to return here), and [note](#)).

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Footnote 2: Ὡς No particular hero is here alluded to. The exploits of Bayard, Nemours, Edward the Black Prince, and, in more modern times, the fame of Marlborough, Frederick the Great, Count Saxe, Charles of Sweden, etc., are familiar to every historical reader, but the exact places of their birth are known to a very small proportion of their admirers.

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Love's Last Adieu

Ἄελ δ' ἄελ με φεύγει.

[Pseud.] Anacreon,

Εἰς χρυσόν·

1.

The roses of Love glad the garden of life,
Though nurtur'd 'mid weeds dropping pestilent dew,
Till Time crops the leaves with unmerciful knife,
Or prunes them for ever, in Love's last adieu!

2.

In vain, with endearments, we soothe the sad heart,

In vain do we vow for an age to be true;
The chance of an hour may command us to part,
Or Death disunite us, in Love's last adieu!

3.

Still Hope, breathing peace, through the grief-swollen breast^a,
Will whisper, "Our meeting we yet may renew:"
With this dream of deceit, half our sorrow's repress,
Nor taste we the poison, of Love's last adieu!

4.

Oh! mark you yon pair, in the sunshine of youth,
Love twin'd round their childhood his flow'rs as they grew;
They flourish awhile, in the season of truth,
Till chill'd by the winter of Love's last adieu!

5.

Sweet lady! why thus doth a tear steal its way,
Down a cheek which outrivals thy bosom in hue?
Yet why do I ask?--to distraction a prey,
Thy reason has perish'd, with Love's last adieu!

6.

Oh! who is yon Misanthrope, shunning mankind?
From cities to caves of the forest he flew:
There, raving, he howls his complaint to the wind;
The mountains reverberate Love's last adieu!

7.

Now Hate rules a heart which in Love's easy chains,
Once Passion's tumultuous blandishments knew;
Despair now inflames the dark tide of his veins,
He ponders, in frenzy, on Love's last adieu!

8.

How he envies the wretch, with a soul wrapt in steel!
His pleasures are scarce, yet his troubles are few,
Who laughs at the pang that he never can feel,
And dreads not the anguish of Love's last adieu!

9.

Youth flies, life decays, even hope is o'ercast;
No more, with Love's former devotion, we sue:
He spreads his young wing, he retires with the blast;
The shroud of affection is Love's last adieu!

10.

In this life of probation, for rapture divine,
Astrea¹ declares that some penance is due;
From him, who has worshipp'd at Love's gentle shrine,
The atonement is ample, in Love's last adieu!

11.

Who kneels to the God, on his altar of light
Must myrtle and cypress alternately strew:

His myrtle, an emblem of purest delight,
His cypress, the garland of Love's last adieu!

Footnote 1: Ý The Goddess of
Justice.

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Footnote a: Ý

Still, hope-beaming peace...

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Lines^a Addressed to the Rev. J.T. Becher¹, on his advising the Author to mix more with Society

1.

Dear **Becher**, you tell me to mix with mankind;
I cannot deny such a precept is wise;
But retirement accords with the tone of my mind:
I will not descend to a world I despise.

2.

Did the Senate or Camp my exertions require,
Ambition might prompt me, at once, to go forth;

When Infancy's years of probation expire,
Perchance, I may strive to distinguish my birth.

3.

The fire, in the cavern of Etna, conceal'd,
Still mantles unseen in its secret recess;
At length, in a volume terrific, reveal'd,
No torrent can quench it, no bounds can repress.

4.

Oh! thus, the desire, in my bosom, for fame^b
Bids me live, but to hope for Posterity's praise.
Could I soar with the Phoenix on pinions of flame,
With him I would wish to expire in the blaze.

5.

For the life of a Fox, of a Chatham the death,
What censure, what danger, what woe would I brave!
Their lives did not end, when they yielded their breath,
Their glory illumines the gloom of their grave^c.

6.

Yet why should I mingle in Fashion's full herd?
Why crouch to her leaders, or cringe to her rules?
Why bend to the proud, or applaud the absurd?
Why search for delight, in the friendship of fools?

7.

I have tasted the sweets, and the bitters, of love,
In friendship I early was taught to believe;
My passion the matrons of prudence reprove,
I have found that a friend may profess, yet deceive.

8.

To me what is wealth?--it may pass in an hour,
If Tyrants prevail, or if Fortune should frown:
To me what is title?--the phantom of power;
To me what is fashion?--I seek but renown.

9.

Deceit is a stranger, as yet, to my soul;
I, still, am unpractised to varnish the truth:
Then, why should I live in a hateful controul?
Why waste, upon folly, the days of my youth?

1806.

Footnote 1: Ý The Rev. John Thomas Becher (1770-1848) was Vicar of Rumpton and Midsomer Norton, Notts., and made the acquaintance of Byron when he was living at Southwell. To him was submitted an early copy of the *Quarto*, and on his remonstrance at the tone of some of the verses, the whole edition (save one or two

Footnote a: Ý
To the Rev. J. T. Becher...
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copies) was burnt. Becher assisted in the revision of *P. on V.*

Occasions, published in 1807. He was in 1818 appointed Prebendary of Southwell, and, all his life, took an active interest and prominent part in the administration of the poor laws and the welfare of the poor. (See Byron's letters to him of February 26 and March 28, 1808.)

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Footnote b: Ý

Oh! such the desire...

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Footnote c: Ý

--the gloom of the grave....

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Answer to some Elegant Verses sent by a Friend to the Author, complaining that one of his descriptions was rather too warmly drawn

*"But if any old Lady, Knight, Priest, or Physician,
Should condemn me for printing a second edition;
If good Madam Squintum my work should abuse,
May I venture to give her a smack of my muse?"*

Anstey's 'New Bath Guide', p. 169.

Candour compels me, **Becher!** to commend
The verse, which blends the censor with the friend;
Your strong yet just reproof extorts applause
From me, the heedless and imprudent cause^a;
For this wild error, which pervades my strain^b,
I sue for pardon,--must I sue in vain?
The wise sometimes from Wisdom's ways depart;
Can youth then hush the dictates of the heart?
Precepts of prudence curb, but can't controul,
The fierce emotions of the flowing soul.
When Love's delirium haunts the glowing mind,
Limping Decorum lingers far behind;
Vainly the dotard mends her prudish pace,
Outstript and vanquish'd in the mental chase.
The young, the old, have worn the chains of love;
Let those, they ne'er confined, my lay reprove;
Let those, whose souls condemn the pleasing power,
Their censures on the hapless victim shower.
Oh! how I hate the nerveless, frigid song,
The ceaseless echo of the rhyming throng,
Whose labour'd lines, in chilling numbers flow,
To paint a pang the author ne'er can know!
The artless Helicon, I boast, is youth;--
My Lyre, the Heart--my Muse, the simple Truth.

Far be't from me the "virgin's mind" to "taint:"
Seduction's dread is here no slight restraint:
The maid whose virgin breast is void of guile,
Whose wishes dimple in a modest smile,
Whose downcast eye disdains the wanton leer,
Firm in her virtue's strength, yet not severe;
She, whom a conscious grace shall thus refine,
Will ne'er be "tainted" by a strain of mine.
But, for the nymph whose premature desires
Torment her bosom with unholy fires,
No net to snare her willing heart is spread;
She would have fallen, though she ne'er had read.
For me, I fain would please the chosen few,
Whose souls, to feeling and to nature true,
Will spare the childish verse, and not destroy
The light effusions of a heedless boy^c.
I seek not glory from the senseless crowd;
Of fancied laurels, I shall ne'er be proud;
Their warmest plaudits I would scarcely prize,
Their sneers or censures, I alike despise.

November 26, 1806.

Footnote a: Ý

the heedless and unworthy cause...

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Footnote b: Ý

For this sole error...

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Footnote c: Ý

The light effusions of an amorous boy...

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Elegy on Newstead Abbey¹

*"It is the voice of years, that are gone! they roll before me, with
all their deeds."*

Ossian^a.

Newstead! fast-falling, once-resplendent dome!
Religion's shrine! repentant **Henry's**² pride!
Of Warriors, Monks, and Dames the cloister'd tomb,
Whose pensive shades around thy ruins glide,

2.

Hail to thy pile! more honour'd in thy fall,
Than modern mansions, in their pillar'd state;
Proudly majestic frowns thy vaulted hall,
Scowling defiance on the blasts of fate.

3.

No mail-clad Serfs³, obedient to their Lord,
In grim array, the crimson cross⁴ demand;
Or gay assemble round the festive board,
Their chief's retainers, an immortal band.

4.

Else might inspiring Fancy's magic eye
Retrace their progress, through the lapse of time;
Marking each ardent youth, ordain'd to die,
A votive pilgrim, in Judea's clime.

5.

But not from thee, dark pile! departs the Chief;
His feudal realm in other regions lay:
In thee the wounded conscience courts relief,
Retiring from the garish blaze of day.

6.

Yes! in thy gloomy cells and shades profound,
The monk abjur'd a world, he ne'er could view;
Or blood-stain'd Guilt repenting, solace found,
Or Innocence, from stern Oppression, flew.

7.

A Monarch bade thee from that wild arise,
Where Sherwood's outlaws, once, were wont to prowl;
And Superstition's crimes, of various dyes,
Sought shelter in the Priest's protecting cowl.

8.

Where, now, the grass exhales a murky dew,
The humid pall of life-extinguish'd clay,
In sainted fame, the sacred Fathers grew,
Nor raised their pious voices, but to pray.

9.

Where, now, the bats their wavering wings extend,
Soon as the gloaming⁵ spreads her waning shade^b;
The choir did, oft, their mingling vespers blend,
Or matin orisons to Mary⁶ paid.

10.

Years roll on years; to ages, ages yield;

Abbots to Abbots, in a line, succeed:
Religion's charter, their protecting shield,
Till royal sacrilege their doom decreed.

11.

One holy **Henry** rear'd the Gothic walls,
And bade the pious inmates rest in peace;
Another **Henry**⁷ the kind gift recalls,
And bids devotion's hallow'd echoes cease.

12.

Vain is each threat, or supplicating prayer;
He drives them exiles from their blest abode,
To roam a dreary world, in deep despair--
No friend, no home, no refuge, but their God⁸.

13.

Hark! how the hall, resounding to the strain,
Shakes with the martial music's novel din!
The heralds of a warrior's haughty reign,
High crested banners wave thy walls within.

14.

Of changing sentinels the distant hum,
The mirth of feasts, the clang of burnish'd arms,
The braying trumpet, and the hoarser drum,
Unite in concert with increas'd alarms.

15.

An abbey once, a regal fortress⁹ now,
Encircled by insulting rebel powers;
War's dread machines o'erhang thy threat'ning brow,
And dart destruction, in sulphureous showers.

16.

Ah! vain defence! the hostile traitor's siege,
Though oft repuls'd, by guile o'ercomes the brave;
His thronging foes oppress the faithful Liege,
Rebellion's reeking standards o'er him wave.

17.

Not unaveng'd the raging Baron yields;
The blood of traitors smears the purple plain;
Unconquer'd still, his falchion there he wields,
And days of glory, yet, for him remain.

18.

Still, in that hour, the warrior wish'd to strew
Self-gather'd laurels on a self-sought grave;
But Charles' protecting genius hither flew,
The monarch's friend, the monarch's hope, to save.

19.

Trembling, she snatch'd him¹⁰ from th' unequal strife,
In other fields the torrent to repel;
For nobler combats, here, reserv'd his life,

To lead the band, where godlike **Falkland**¹¹ fell.

20.

From thee, poor pile! to lawless plunder given,
While dying groans their painful requiem sound,
Far different incense, now, ascends to Heaven,
Such victims wallow on the gory ground.

21.

There many a pale and ruthless Robber's corse,
Noisome and ghast, defiles thy sacred sod;
O'er mingling man, and horse commix'd with horse,
Corruption's heap, the savage spoilers trod.

22.

Graves, long with rank and sighing weeds o'erspread,
Ransack'd resign, perforce, their mortal mould:
From ruffian fangs, escape not e'en the dead,
Racked from repose, in search for buried gold.

23.

Hush'd is the harp, unstrung the warlike lyre,
The minstrel's palsied hand reclines in death;
No more he strikes the quivering chords with fire,
Or sings the glories of the martial wreath^c.

24.

At length the sated murderers, gorged with prey,
Retire: the clamour of the fight is o'er;
Silence again resumes her awful sway,
And sable Horror guards the massy door.

25.

Here, Desolation holds her dreary court:
What satellites declare her dismal reign!
Shrieking their dirge, ill-omen'd birds resort,
To flit their vigils, in the hoary fane.

26.

Soon a new Morn's restoring beams dispel
The clouds of Anarchy from Britain's skies;
The fierce Usurper seeks his native hell,
And Nature triumphs, as the Tyrant dies.

27.

With storms she welcomes his expiring groans;
Whirlwinds, responsive, greet his labouring breath;
Earth shudders, as her caves receive his bones,
Loathing¹² the offering of so dark a death.

28.

The legal Ruler¹³ now resumes the helm,
He guides through gentle seas, the prow of state;
Hope cheers, with wonted smiles, the peaceful realm,
And heals the bleeding wounds of wearied Hate.

29.

The gloomy tenants, Newstead! of thy cells,
Howling, resign their violated nest^d;
Again, the Master on his tenure dwells,
Enjoy'd, from absence, with enraptured zest.

30.

Vassals, within thy hospitable pale,
Loudly carousing, bless their Lord's return;
Culture, again, adorns the gladdening vale,
And matrons, once lamenting, cease to mourn.

31.

A thousand songs, on tuneful echo, float,
Unwonted foliage mantles o'er the trees;
And, hark! the horns proclaim a mellow note,
The hunters' cry hangs lengthening on the breeze.

32.

Beneath their coursers' hoofs the valleys shake;
What fears! what anxious hopes! attend the chase!
The dying stag seeks refuge in the lake;
Exulting shouts announce the finish'd race.

33.

Ah happy days! too happy to endure!
Such simple sports our plain forefathers knew:

No splendid vices glitter'd to allure;
Their joys were many, as their cares were few.

34.

From these descending, Sons to Sires succeed;
Time steals along, and Death uprears his dart;
Another Chief impels the foaming steed,
Another Crowd pursue the panting hart.

35.

Newstead! what saddening change of scene is thine!
Thy yawning arch betokens slow decay;
The last and youngest of a noble line,
Now holds thy mouldering turrets in his sway.

36.

Deserted now, he scans thy gray worn towers;
Thy vaults, where dead of feudal ages sleep;
Thy cloisters, pervious to the wintry showers;
These, these he views, and views them but to weep.

37.

Yet are his tears no emblem of regret:
Cherish'd Affection only bids them flow;
Pride, Hope, and Love, forbid him to forget,
But warm his bosom, with impassion'd glow.

38.

Yet he prefers thee, to the gilded domes¹⁴,
Or gewgaw grottos, of the vainly great;
Yet lingers 'mid thy damp and mossy tombs,
Nor breathes a murmur 'gainst the will of Fate.

39.

Haply thy sun, emerging, yet, may shine,
Thee to irradiate with meridian ray;
Hours, splendid as the past, may still be thine,
And bless thy future, as thy former day^e.

Footnote 1: Ý As one poem on this subject is already printed, the author had, originally, no intention of inserting the following. It is now added at the particular request of some friends.

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Footnote 2: Ý Henry II. founded Newstead soon after the murder of Thomas à Becket.

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Footnote b: Ý

*Soon as the twilight winds a
waning shade....*

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Footnote 3: Ý This word is used by Walter Scott, in his poem, *The Wild Huntsman*, as synonymous with "vassal."

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Footnote c: Ý

--of the laurel'd wreath...

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Footnote 4: Ý The red cross was the badge of the Crusaders.

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Footnote d: Ý

Howling, forsake--...

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Footnote 5: Ý As "gloaming," the Scottish word for twilight, is far more poetical, and has been recommended by many eminent literary men, particularly by Dr. Moore in his Letters to Burns, I have ventured to use it on account of its harmony.

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Footnote e: Ý

*Fortune may smile upon a
future line,
And heaven restore an ever-
cloudless day,*

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Footnote 6: Ý The priory was dedicated to the Virgin.--[*Hours of Idleness*].

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Footnote 7: Ý At the dissolution of the monasteries, Henry VIII. bestowed Newstead Abbey on Sir John Byron.

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Footnote 8: Ý During the lifetime of Lord Byron's predecessor in the title there was found in the lake a large brass eagle, in the body of which were concealed a number of ancient deeds and documents. This eagle is supposed to have been thrown into the lake by the retreating monks.--*Life*, p. 2, note. It is now a lectern in Southwell Minster.

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Footnote 9: Ý Newstead sustained a considerable siege in the war between Charles I. and his parliament.

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Footnote 10: Ý Lord Byron and his brother Sir William held high commands in the royal army. The former was general-in-chief in Ireland, lieutenant of the Tower, and governor to James, Duke of York, afterwards the unhappy James II.; the latter had a principal share in many actions. [*Vide ante*, p. 3, *note* 1.]

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Footnote 11: Ý Lucius Cary, Lord Viscount Falkland, the most accomplished man of his age, was killed at the Battle of Newbury, charging in the ranks of Lord Byron's regiment of cavalry.

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Footnote 12: Ý This is an historical fact. A violent tempest occurred immediately subsequent to the death or interment of Cromwell, which occasioned many disputes between his partisans and the cavaliers: both interpreted the circumstance into divine interposition; but whether as approbation or condemnation, we leave to the casuists of that age to decide. I have made such use of the occurrence as suited the

subject of my poem.

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Footnote 13: Ý Charles II.

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Footnote 14: Ý An indication of
Byron's feelings towards
Newstead in his younger days will
be found in his letter to his mother
of March 6, 1809.

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Hours of Idleness

To George, Earl Delawarr^a

1.

Oh! yes, I will own we were dear to each other;
The friendships of childhood, though fleeting, are true;
The love which you felt was the love of a brother,
Nor less the affection I cherish'd for you.

2.

But Friendship can vary her gentle dominion;
The attachment of years, in a moment expires:
Like Love, too, she moves on a swift-waving pinion,
But glows not, like Love, with unquenchable fires.

3.

Full oft have we wander'd through Ida together,
And blest were the scenes of our youth, I allow:
In the spring of our life, how serene is the weather!
But Winter's rude tempests are gathering now.

4.

No more with Affection shall Memory blending,
The wonted delights of our childhood retrace:
When Pride steels the bosom, the heart is unbending,
And what would be Justice appears a disgrace.

5.

However, dear George, for I still must esteem you^b--
The few, whom I love, I can never upbraid;
The chance, which has lost, may in future redeem you,
Repentance will cancel the vow you have made.

6.

I will not complain, and though chill'd is affection,
With me no corroding resentment shall live:
My bosom is calm'd by the simple reflection,
That both may be wrong, and that both should forgive.

7.

You knew, that my soul, that my heart, my existence,
If danger demanded, were wholly your own;
You knew me unalter'd, by years or by distance,
Devoted to love and to friendship alone.

8.

You knew,--but away with the vain retrospection!
The bond of affection no longer endures;

Too late you may droop o'er the fond recollection,
And sigh for the friend, who was formerly yours.

9.

For the present, we part,--I will hope not for ever¹;
For time and regret will restore you at last:
To forget our dissension we both should endeavour,
I ask no atonement, but days like the past.

Footnote 1: Ý See Byron's Letter to Lord Clare of February 6, 1807, referred to in [note](#) 2, p. 100.

To——...

[return to footnote mark in this poem](#)

[*P. on V. Occasions, Poems O. and Translated*]

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Footnote b: Ý

However, dear S——...

[*P. on V. Occasions, Poems O. and Translated*]

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([Cross-reference: return to footnote of "To D——"](#))

Damætas¹

In law an infant², and in years a boy,
In mind a slave to every vicious joy;
From every sense of shame and virtue wean'd,
In lies an adept, in deceit a fiend;
Vers'd in hypocrisy, while yet a child;
Fickle as wind, of inclinations wild;
Woman his dupe, his heedless friend a tool;
Old in the world, though scarcely broke from school;
Damætas ran through all the maze of sin,
And found the goal, when others just begin:
Ev'n still conflicting passions shake his soul,
And bid him drain the dregs of Pleasure's bowl;
But, pall'd with vice, he breaks his former chain,
And what was once his bliss appears his bane.

Footnote 1: Ý Moore appears to have regarded these lines as applying to Byron himself. It is, however, very unlikely that, with all his passion for painting himself in the darkest colours, he would have written himself down "a hypocrite." Damætas is, probably, a satirical sketch of a friend or acquaintance. (Compare the solemn denunciation of Lord Falkland in *English Bards, and Scotch Reviewers*, lines 668-686.)

[return to footnote mark](#)

Footnote 2: Ý In law, every person is an infant who has not attained the age of twenty-one.

[return](#)

To Marion¹₋

Marion! why that pensive brow^a?
What disgust to life hast thou?
Change that discontented air;
Frowns become not one so fair.
'Tis not Love disturbs thy rest,
Love's a stranger to thy breast:
He, in dimpling smiles, appears,
Or mourns in sweetly timid tears;
Or bends the languid eyelid down,
But *shuns* the cold forbidding *frown*.
Then resume thy former fire,
Some will *love*, and all admire!
While that icy aspect chills us,
Nought but cool Indiff'rence thrills us.
Would'st thou wand'ring hearts beguile,
Smile, at least, or *seem* to *smile*;
Eyes like *thine* were never meant
To hide their orbs in dark restraint;
Spite of all thou fain wouldst say,
Still in *truant* beams they play.
Thy lips--but here my *modest* Muse
Her impulse *chaste* must needs refuse:
She *blushes*, *curtsies*, *frowns*,--in short She
Dreads lest the *Subject* should transport me;
And flying off, in search of *Reason*,
Brings Prudence back in proper season.

All I shall, therefore, say (whate'er^b
I think, is neither here nor there,)
Is, that such *lips*, of looks endearing,
Were form'd for *better things* than *sneering*.
Of soothing compliments divested,
Advice at least's disinterested;
Such is my artless song to thee,
From all the flow of Flatt'ry free;
Counsel like *mine* is as a brother's,
My heart is given to some others;
That is to say, unskill'd to cozen,
It shares itself among a dozen.
Marion, adieu! oh, pr'ythee slight not
This warning, though it may delight not;
And, lest my precepts be displeasing^c,
To those who think remonstrance teasing,
At once I'll tell thee our opinion,
Concerning Woman's soft Dominion:
Howe'er we gaze, with admiration,
On eyes of blue or lips carnation;
Howe'er the flowing locks attract us,
Howe'er those beauties may distract us;
Still fickle, we are prone to rove,
These cannot fix our souls to love;
It is not too *severe* a stricture,
To say they form a *pretty picture*;
But would'st thou see the secret chain,
Which binds us in your humble train,
To hail you Queens of all Creation,
Know, in a word, 'tis *Animation*.

Byron, *January* 10, 1807.

Footnote 1: Ý The MS. of this
Poem is preserved at Newstead.

Footnote a: Ý

"This was to Harriet Maltby,
afterwards Mrs. Nichols, written
upon her meeting Byron, and,

"being *cold, silent*, and
reserved to him, by the
advice of a Lady with whom
she was staying; quite foreign
to her *usual* manner, which
was gay, lively, and full of
flirtation."

--Note by Miss E. Pigot. ([See](#) p.
130, var. ii.)
[return to this poem](#)
[cross-reference: return to lines "to
Harriet"](#)

Harriet...

[MS. Newstead]
[return](#)

Footnote b: Ý

*All I shall therefore say of
these,
(Thy pardon if my words
displease)....*

[MS. Newstead]
[return](#)

Footnote c: Ý

*And lest my precepts be found
fault, by
Those who approved the
frown of M--lt-by....*

[MS. Newstead]
[return to this poem](#)
[cross reference: return to footnote
of previous lines "To Marion"](#)

Oscar of Alva¹

1.

How sweetly shines, through azure skies,
The lamp of Heaven on Lora's shore;
Where Alva's hoary turrets rise,
And hear the din of arms no more!

2.

But often has yon rolling moon,
On Alva's casques of silver play'd;
And view'd, at midnight's silent noon,
Her chiefs in gleaming mail array'd:

3.

And, on the crimson'd rocks beneath,
Which scowl o'er ocean's sullen flow,
Pale in the scatter'd ranks of death,
She saw the gasping warrior low^a;

4.

While many an eye, which ne'er again^b
Could mark the rising orb of day,
Turn'd feebly from the gory plain,
Beheld in death her fading ray.

5.

Once, to those eyes the lamp of Love,
They blest her dear propitious light;
But, now, she glimmer'd from above,
A sad, funereal torch of night.

6.

Faded is Alva's noble race,
And grey her towers are seen afar;
No more her heroes urge the chase,
Or roll the crimson tide of war.

7.

But, who was last of Alva's clan?
Why grows the moss on Alva's stone?
Her towers resound no steps of man,
They echo to the gale alone.

8.

And, when that gale is fierce and high,
A sound is heard in yonder hall;
It rises hoarsely through the sky,

And vibrates o'er the mould'ring wall.

9.

Yes, when the eddyng tempest sighs,
It shakes the shield of Oscar brave;
But, there, no more his banners rise,
No more his plumes of sable wave.

10.

Fair shone the sun on Oscar's birth,
When Angus hail'd his eldest born;
The vassals round their chieftain's hearth
Crowd to applaud the happy morn.

11.

They feast upon the mountain deer,
The Pibroch rais'd its piercing note²,
To gladden more their Highland cheer,
The strains in martial numbers float.

12.

And they who heard the war-notes wild,
Hop'd that, one day, the Pibroch's strain
Should play before the Hero's child,
While he should lead the Tartan train.

13.

Another year is quickly past,
And Angus hails another son;
His natal day is like the last,
Nor soon the jocund feast was done.

14.

Taught by their sire to bend the bow,
On Alva's dusky hills of wind,
The boys in childhood chas'd the roe,
And left their hounds in speed behind.

15.

But ere their years of youth are o'er,
They mingle in the ranks of war;
They lightly wheel the bright claymore,
And send the whistling arrow far.

16.

Dark was the flow of Oscar's hair,
Wildly it stream'd along the gale;
But Allan's locks were bright and fair,
And pensive seem'd his cheek, and pale.

17.

But Oscar own'd a hero's soul,
His dark eye shone through beams of truth;
Allan had early learn'd controul,
And smooth his words had been from youth.

18.

Both, both were brave; the Saxon spear
Was shiver'd oft beneath their steel;
And Oscar's bosom scorn'd to fear,
But Oscar's bosom knew to feel;

19.

While Allan's soul belied his form,
Unworthy with such charms to dwell:
Keen as the lightning of the storm,
On foes his deadly vengeance fell.

20.

From high Southannon's distant tower
Arrived a young and noble dame;
With Kenneth's lands to form her dower,
Glenalvon's blue-eyed daughter came;

21.

And Oscar claim'd the beauteous bride,
And Angus on his Oscar smil'd:
It soothed the father's feudal pride
Thus to obtain Glenalvon's child.

22.

Hark! to the Pibroch's pleasing note,
Hark! to the swelling nuptial song,

In joyous strains the voices float,
And, still, the choral peal prolong.

23.

See how the Heroes' blood-red plumes
Assembled wave in Alva's hall;
Each youth his varied plaid assumes,
Attending on their chieftain's call.

24.

It is not war their aid demands,
The Pibroch plays the song of peace;
To Oscar's nuptials throng the bands
Nor yet the sounds of pleasure cease.

25.

But where is Oscar? sure 'tis late:
Is this a bridegroom's ardent flame?
While thronging guests and ladies wait,
Nor Oscar nor his brother came.

26.

At length young Allan join'd the bride;
"Why comes not Oscar?" Angus said:
"Is he not here?" the Youth replied;
"With me he rov'd not o'er the glade:

27.

"Perchance, forgetful of the day,
'Tis his to chase the bounding roe;
Or Ocean's waves prolong his stay:
Yet, Oscar's bark is seldom slow."

28.

"Oh, no!" the anguish'd Sire rejoin'd,
"Nor chase, nor wave, my Boy delay;
Would he to Mora seem unkind?
Would aught to her impede his way?"

29.

"Oh, search, ye Chiefs! oh, search around!
Allan, with these, through Alva fly;
Till Oscar, till my son is found,
Haste, haste, nor dare attempt reply."

30.

All is confusion--through the vale,
The name of Oscar hoarsely rings,
It rises on the murm'ring gale,
Till night expands her dusky wings.

31.

It breaks the stillness of the night,
But echoes through her shades in vain;
It sounds through morning's misty light,
But Oscar comes not o'er the plain.

32.

Three days, three sleepless nights, the Chief
For Oscar search'd each mountain cave;
Then hope is lost; in boundless grief,
His locks in grey-torn ringlets wave.

33.

"Oscar! my son!--thou God of Heav'n,
Restore the prop of sinking age!
Or, if that hope no more is given,
Yield his assassin to my rage.

34.

"Yes, on some desert rocky shore
My Oscar's whiten'd bones must lie;
Then grant, thou God! I ask no more,
With him his frantic Sire may die!

35.

"Yet, he may live,--away, despair!
Be calm, my soul! he yet may live;
T' arraign my fate, my voice forbear!
O God! my impious prayer forgive.

36.

"What, if he live for me no more,

I sink forgotten in the dust,
The hope of Alva's age is o'er:
Alas! can pangs like these be just?"

37.

Thus did the hapless Parent mourn,
Till Time, who soothes severest woe,
Had bade serenity return,
And made the tear-drop cease to flow.

38.

For, still, some latent hope surviv'd
That Oscar might once more appear;
His hope now droop'd and now revived,
Till Time had told a tedious year.

39.

Days roll'd along, the orb of light
Again had run his destined race;
No Oscar bless'd his father's sight,
And sorrow left a fainter trace.

40.

For youthful Allan still remain'd,
And, now, his father's only joy:
And Mora's heart was quickly gain'd,
For beauty crown'd the fair-hair'd boy.

41.

She thought that Oscar low was laid,
And Allan's face was wondrous fair;
If Oscar liv'd, some other maid
Had claim'd his faithless bosom's care.

42.

And Angus said, if one year more
In fruitless hope was pass'd away,
His fondest scruples should be o'er,
And he would name their nuptial day.

43.

Slow roll'd the moons, but blest at last
Arriv'd the dearly destin'd morn:
The year of anxious trembling past,
What smiles the lovers' cheeks adorn!

44.

Hark to the Pibroch's pleasing note!
Hark to the swelling nuptial song!
In joyous strains the voices float,
And, still, the choral peal prolong.

45.

Again the clan, in festive crowd,
Throng through the gate of Alva's hall;
The sounds of mirth re-echo loud,

And all their former joy recall.

46.

But who is he, whose darken'd brow
Glooms in the midst of general mirth?
Before his eyes' far fiercer glow
The blue flames curdle o'er the hearth.

47.

Dark is the robe which wraps his form,
And tall his plume of gory red;
His voice is like the rising storm,
But light and trackless is his tread.

48.

'Tis noon of night, the pledge goes round,
The bridegroom's health is deeply quaff'd;
With shouts the vaulted roofs resound,
And all combine to hail the draught.

49.

Sudden the stranger-chief arose,
And all the clamorous crowd are hush'd;
And Angus' cheek with wonder glows,
And Mora's tender bosom blush'd.

50.

"Old man!" he cried, "this pledge is done,
Thou saw'st 'twas truly drunk by me;
It hail'd the nuptials of thy son:
Now will I claim a pledge from thee.

51.

"While all around is mirth and joy,
To bless thy Allan's happy lot,
Say, hadst thou ne'er another boy?
Say, why should Oscar be forgot?"

52.

"Alas!" the hapless Sire replied,
The big tear starting as he spoke,
"When Oscar left my hall, or died,
This aged heart was almost broke.

53.

"Thrice has the earth revolv'd her course
Since Oscar's form has bless'd my sight;
And Allan is my last resource,
Since martial Oscar's death, or flight."

54.

"'Tis well," replied the stranger stern,
And fiercely flash'd his rolling eye;
"Thy Oscar's fate, I fain would learn;
Perhaps the Hero did not die.

55.

"Perchance, if those, whom most he lov'd,
Would call, thy Oscar might return;
Perchance, the chief has only rov'd;
For him thy Beltane, yet, may burn³.

56.

"Fill high the bowl the table round,
We will not claim the pledge by stealth;
With wine let every cup be crown'd;
Pledge me departed Oscar's health."

57.

"With all my soul," old Angus said,
And fill'd his goblet to the brim:
"Here's to my boy! alive or dead,
I ne'er shall find a son like him."

58.

"Bravely, old man, this health has sped;
But why does Allan trembling stand?
Come, drink remembrance of the dead,
And raise thy cup with firmer hand."

59.

The crimson glow of Allan's face
Was turn'd at once to ghastly hue;

The drops of death each other chace,
Adown in agonizing dew.

60.

Thrice did he raise the goblet high,
And thrice his lips refused to taste;
For thrice he caught the stranger's eye
On his with deadly fury plac'd.

61.

"And is it thus a brother hails
A brother's fond remembrance here?
If thus affection's strength prevails,
What might we not expect from fear?"

62.

Roused by the sneer, he rais'd the bowl,
"Would Oscar now could share our mirth!"
Internal fear appall'd his soul;
He said, and dash'd the cup to earth.

63.

"'Tis he! I hear my murderer's voice!"
Loud shrieks a darkly gleaming Form.
"A murderer's voice!" the roof replies,
And deeply swells the bursting storm.

64.

The tapers wink, the chieftains shrink,
The stranger's gone,--amidst the crew,
A Form was seen, in tartan green,
And tall the shade terrific grew.

65.

His waist was bound with a broad belt round,
His plume of sable stream'd on high;
But his breast was bare, with the red wounds there,
And fix'd was the glare of his glassy eye.

66.

And thrice he smil'd, with his eye so wild
On Angus bending low the knee;
And thrice he frown'd, on a Chief on the ground,
Whom shivering crowds with horror see.

67.

The bolts loud roll from pole to pole,
And thunders through the welkin ring,
And the gleaming form, through the mist of the storm,
Was borne on high by the whirlwind's wing.

68.

Cold was the feast, the revel ceas'd.
Who lies upon the stony floor?
Oblivion press'd old Angus' breast^d,
At length his life-pulse throbs once more.

69.

"Away, away! let the leech essay
To pour the light on Allan's eyes:"
His sand is done,--his race is run;
Oh! never more shall Allan rise!

70.

But Oscar's breast is cold as clay,
His locks are lifted by the gale;
And Allan's barbèd arrow lay
With him in dark Glentanar's vale.

71.

And whence the dreadful stranger came,
Or who, no mortal wight can tell;
But no one doubts the form of flame,
For Alva's sons knew Oscar well.

72.

Ambition nerv'd young Allan's hand,
Exulting demons wing'd his dart;
While Envy wav'd her burning brand,
And pour'd her venom round his heart.

73.

Swift is the shaft from Allan's bow;

Whose streaming life-blood stains his side?
Dark Oscar's sable crest is low,
The dart has drunk his vital tide.

74.

And Mora's eye could Allan move,
She bade his wounded pride rebel:
Alas! that eyes, which beam'd with love,
Should urge the soul to deeds of Hell.

75.

Lo! see'st thou not a lonely tomb,
Which rises o'er a warrior dead?
It glimmers through the twilight gloom;
Oh! that is Allan's nuptial bed.

76.

Far, distant far, the noble grave
Which held his clan's great ashes stood;
And o'er his corse no banners wave,
For they were stain'd with kindred blood.

77.

What minstrel grey, what hoary bard,
Shall Allan's deeds on harp-strings raise?
The song is glory's chief reward,
But who can strike a murd'rer's praise?

78.

Unstrung, untouch'd, the harp must stand,
No minstrel dare the theme awake;
Guilt would benumb his palsied hand,
His harp in shuddering chords would break.

79.

No lyre of fame, no hallow'd verse,
Shall sound his glories high in air:
A dying father's bitter curse,
A brother's death-groan echoes there.

Footnote 1: Ý The catastrophe of this tale was suggested by the story of "Jeronymo and Lorenzo," in the first volume of Schiller's *Armenian, or the Ghost-Seer*. It also bears some resemblance to a scene in the third act of *Macbeth*. - [Der Geisterseher, Schiller's Werke (1819), x. 97, sq.

[return to footnote mark](#)

Footnote 2: Ý It is evident that Byron here confused the *pibroch*, the air, with the *bagpipe*, the instrument.

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[cross-reference: return to "Lachin y Gair"](#)

Footnote 3: Ý Beltane Tree, a Highland festival on the first of

Footnote a: Ý

She view'd the gasping...

[Hours of Idleness]

[return](#)

Footnote b: Ý

*When many an eye which
ne'er again
Could view...*

[Hours of Idleness]

[return](#)

Footnote c: Ý

May, held near fires lighted for the *Internal fears...*
occasion.

[return](#)

[*Hours of Idleness*]

[return](#)

Footnote d: Ý

*Old Angus prest, the earth
with his breast...*

[*Hours of Idleness*]

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Translation from Anacreon. Ode 1

Θέλω λέγειν Ἀτρείδας, κ.τ.λ.¹

Ode 1

To his Lyre

I wish to tune my quivering lyre^a,
To deeds of fame, and notes of fire;
To echo, from its rising swell,
How heroes fought and nations fell,

When Atreus' sons advanc'd to war,
 Or Tyrian Cadmus rov'd afar;
 But still, to martial strains unknown,
 My lyre recurs to Love alone.
 Fir'd with the hope of future fame^b,
I seek some nobler Hero's name;
 The dying chords are strung anew,
 To war, to war, my harp is due:
 With glowing strings, the Epic strain
 To Jove's great son I raise again;
 Alcides and his glorious deeds,
 Beneath whose arm the Hydra bleeds;
 All, all in vain; my wayward lyre
 Wakes silver notes of soft Desire.
 Adieu, ye Chiefs renown'd in arms!
 Adieu the clang of War's alarms^c!
To other deeds my soul is strung,
 And sweeter notes shall now be sung;
 My harp shall all its powers reveal,
 To tell the tale my heart must feel;
 Love, Love alone, my lyre shall claim,
 In songs of bliss and sighs of flame.

Footnote 1: Ý The motto does not appear in *Hours of Idleness* or *Poems O. and T.*
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Footnote a: Ý
I sought to tune...

[MS. Newstead]
[return](#)

Footnote b: Ý

*The chords resumed a second strain,
 To Jove's great son I strike again.*

*Alcides and his glorious
deeds,
Beneath whose arm the
Hydra bleeds...*

[MS. Newstead]

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Footnote c: Ύ

*The Trumpet's blast with
these accords
To sound the clash of hostile
swords--
Be mine the softer, sweeter
care
To soothe the young and
virgin Fair...*

[MS. Newstead]

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From Anacreon. Ode 3

Μεσονυκτίοις ποθ' ὥραις, κ.τ.λ.¹

'Twas now the hour when Night had driven
Her car half round yon sable heaven;
Boötes, only, seem'd to roll^a
His Arctic charge around the Pole;
While mortals, lost in gentle sleep,
Forgot to smile, or ceas'd to weep:
At this lone hour the Paphian boy,
Descending from the realms of joy,
Quick to my gate directs his course,
And knocks with all his little force;
My visions fled, alarm'd I rose,--
"What stranger breaks my blest repose?"
"Alas!" replies the wily child
In faltering accents sweetly mild;
"A hapless Infant here I roam,
Far from my dear maternal home.
Oh! shield me from the wintry blast!
The nightly storm is pouring fast.
No prowling robber lingers here;
A wandering baby who can fear?"
I heard his seeming artless tale^b,
I heard his sighs upon the gale:
My breast was never pity's foe,
But felt for all the baby's woe.
I drew the bar, and by the light
Young Love, the infant, met my sight;
His bow across his shoulders flung,
And thence his fatal quiver hung
(Ah! little did I think the dart
Would rankle soon within my heart).
With care I tend my weary guest,
His little fingers chill my breast;
His glossy curls, his azure wing,
Which droop with nightly showers, I wring;
His shivering limbs the embers warm;
And now reviving from the storm,

Scarce had he felt his wonted glow,
 Than swift he seized his slender bow:--
 "I fain would know, my gentle host,"
 He cried, "if this its strength has lost;
 I fear, relax'd with midnight dews,
 The strings their former aid refuse."
 With poison tipt, his arrow flies,
 Deep in my tortur'd heart it lies:
 Then loud the joyous Urchin laugh'd:--
 "My bow can still impel the shaft:
 'Tis firmly fix'd, thy sighs reveal it;
 Say, courteous host, canst thou not feel it?"

Footnote 1: Ý The motto does not appear in *Hours of Idleness* or *Poems O. and T.*

[return to footnote mark](#)

Footnote a: ÝThe Newstead MS. inserts--

*No Moon in silver robe was
 seen
 Nor e'en a trembling star
 between...*

[return](#)

Footnote b: Ý

*Touched with the seeming
 artless tale
 Compassion's tears o'er
 doubt prevail;
 Methought I viewed him, cold
 and damp,
 I trimmed anew my dying
 lamp,
 Drew back the bar--and by
 the light
 A pinioned Infant met my*

sight;
His bow across his shoulders
slung,
And hence a gilded quiver
hung;
With care I tend my weary
guest,
His shivering hands by mine
are pressed:
My hearth I load with embers
warm
To dry the dew drops of the
storm:
Drenched by the rain of
yonder sky
The strings are weak--but let
us try.

[MS. Newstead]

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[Contents p.3](#)

The Episode of Nisus and Euryalus¹. A Paraphrase from the *Æneid*, Lib. 9

Nisus, the guardian of the portal,
stood,
Eager to gild his arms with

hostile blood;
Well skill'd, in fight, the
quivering lance to wield,
Or pour his arrows thro' th'
embattled field:
From Ida torn, he left his sylvan
cave^a, 10
And sought a foreign home, a
distant grave.
To watch the movements of the
Daunian host,
With him Euryalus sustains the
post;
No lovelier mien adorn'd the
ranks of Troy,
And beardless bloom yet grac'd
the gallant boy;
Though few the seasons of his
youthful life, 20
As yet a novice in the martial
strife,
'Twas his, with beauty, Valour's
gifts to share--
A soul heroic, as his form was
fair:
These burn with one pure flame
of generous love;
In peace, in war, united still they
move; 30
Friendship and Glory form their
joint reward;
And, now, combin'd they hold
their nightly guard^b.

"What God," exclaim'd the first,
"instils this fire?
Or, in itself a God, what great

desire?

My lab'ring soul, with anxious
thought oppress'd, 40

Abhors this station of inglorious
rest;

The love of fame with this can ill
accord,

Be't mine to seek for glory with
my sword.

See'st thou yon camp, with
torches twinkling dim,

Where drunken slumbers wrap
each lazy limb? 50

Where confidence and ease the
watch disdain,

And drowsy Silence holds her
sable reign?

Then hear my thought:--In deep
and sullen grief

Our troops and leaders mourn
their absent chief:

Now could the gifts and promised
prize be thine,
(The deed, the danger, and the 60
fame be mine,)

Were this decreed, beneath yon
rising mound,

Methinks, an easy path,
perchance, were found;

Which past, I speed my way to
Pallas' walls,

And lead Æneas from Evander's
halls."

70

With equal ardour fir'd, and
warlike joy,

His glowing friend address'd the

Dardan boy:--

"These deeds, my Nisus, shalt
thou dare alone?

Must all the fame, the peril, be
thine own?

Am I by thee despis'd, and left
afar,

As one unfit to share the toils of 80
war?

Not thus his son the great

Opheltes taught:

Not thus my sire in Argive
combats fought;

Not thus, when Ilion fell by
heavenly hate,

I track'd Æneas through the walks
of fate:

Thou know'st my deeds, my
breast devoid of fear, 90

And hostile life-drops dim my
gory spear.

Here is a soul with hope immortal
burns,

And *life*, ignoble *life*, for *Glory*
spurns^c.

Fame, fame is cheaply earn'd by
fleeting breath:

The price of honour, is the sleep
of death."

100

Then Nisus:--"Calm thy bosom's
fond alarms^d:

Thy heart beats fiercely to the din
of arms.

More dear thy worth, and valour
than my own,

I swear by him, who fills

Olympus' throne!
So may I triumph, as I speak the
truth, 110
And clasp again the comrade of
my youth!
But should I fall,--and he, who
dares advance
Through hostile legions, must
abide by chance,--
If some Rutulian arm, with
adverse blow,
Should lay the friend, who ever
lov'd thee, low,
Live thou--such beauties I would 120
fain preserve--
Thy budding years a lengthen'd
term deserve;
When humbled in the dust, let
some one be,
Whose gentle eyes will shed one
tear for me;
Whose manly arm may snatch me
back by force,
Or wealth redeem, from foes, my 130
captive corse;
Or, if my destiny these last deny,
If, in the spoiler's power, my
ashes lie;
Thy pious care may raise a simple
tomb,
To mark thy love, and signalise
my doom.
Why should thy doating wretched
mother weep
Her only boy, reclin'd in endless 140
sleep?
Who, for thy sake, the tempest's

fury dar'd,
Who, for thy sake, war's deadly
peril shar'd;
Who brav'd what woman never
brav'd before,
And left her native, for the Latian
shore."

150

"In vain you damp the ardour of
my soul,"
Replied Euryalus; "it scorns
controul;
Hence, let us haste!"--their
brother guards arose,
Rous'd by their call, nor court
again repose;
The pair, buoy'd up on Hope's
exulting wing,
Their stations leave, and speed to
seek the king.

160

Now, o'er the earth a solemn
stillness ran,
And lull'd alike the cares of brute
and man;
Save where the Dardan leaders,
nightly, hold
Alternate converse, and their
plans unfold.
On one great point the council are
agreed,
An instant message to their prince
decreed;
Each lean'd upon the lance he
well could wield,
And pois'd with easy arm his
ancient shield;

170

When Nisus and his friend their
leave request, 180

To offer something to their high
behest.

With anxious tremors, yet unaw'd
by fear^e,

The faithful pair before the throne
appear;

Iulus greets them; at his kind
command,

The elder, first, address'd the
hoary band.

190

"With patience" (thus Hyrtacides
began)

"Attend, nor judge, from youth,
our humble plan.

Where yonder beacons half-
expiring beam,

Our slumbering foes of future
conquest dream^f,

Nor heed that we a secret path
have trac'd, 200

Between the ocean and the portal
plac'd;

Beneath the covert of the
blackening smoke,

Whose shade, securely, our
design will cloak!

If you, ye Chiefs, and Fortune
will allow,

We'll bend our course to yonder
mountain's brow, 210

Where Pallas' walls, at distance,
meet the sight,

Seen o'er the glade, when not
obscur'd by night:

Then shall Æneas in his pride
return,
While hostile matrons raise their
offspring's urn;
And Latian spoils, and purpled
heaps of dead
Shall mark the havoc of our 220
Hero's tread;
Such is our purpose, not unknown
the way,
Where yonder torrent's devious
waters stray;
Oft have we seen, when hunting
by the stream,
The distant spires above the
valleys gleam."

Mature in years, for sober 230
wisdom fam'd,
Mov'd by the speech, Alethes
here exclaim'd,--
"Ye parent gods! who rule the
fate of Troy,
Still dwells the Dardan spirit in
the boy;
When minds, like these, in
striplings thus ye raise,
Yours is the godlike act, be yours 240
the praise;
In gallant youth, my fainting
hopes revive,
And Ilion's wonted glories still
survive."
Then in his warm embrace the
boys he press'd,
And, quivering, strain'd them to
his agéd breast;

My sire secured them on that fatal
day,
Nor left such bowls an Argive
robber's prey.
Two massy tripods, also, shall be
thine,
Two talents polish'd from the 290
glittering mine;
An ancient cup, which Tyrian
Dido gave,
While yet our vessels press'd the
Punic wave:
But when the hostile chiefs at
length bow down,
When great Æneas wears
Hesperia's crown,
The casque, the buckler, and the
fiery steed 300
Which Turnus guides with more
than mortal speed,
Are thine; no envious lot shall
then be cast,
I pledge my word, irrevocably
past:
Nay more, twelve slaves, and
twice six captive dames,
To soothe thy softer hours with
amorous flames, 310
And all the realms, which now
the Latins sway,
The labours of to-night shall well
repay.
But thou, my generous youth,
whose tender years
Are near my own, whose worth
my heart reveres,
Henceforth, affection, sweetly

brave,
Lest grief should bend my parent
to the grave;
From this alone no fond adieus I
seek,
No fainting mother's lips have
press'd my cheek; 360
By gloomy Night and thy right
hand I vow,
Her parting tears would shake my
purpose now^h:
Do thou, my prince, her failing
age sustain,
In thee her much-lov'd child may
live again;
Her dying hours with pious
conduct bless, 370
Assist her wants, relieve her fond
distress:
So dear a hope must all my soul
enflameⁱ,
To rise in glory, or to fall in
fame."
Struck with a filial care so deeply
felt,
In tears at once the Trojan
warriors melt; 380
Faster than all, Iulus' eyes
o'erflow!
Such love was his, and such had
been his woe.
"All thou hast ask'd, receive," the
Prince replied;
"Nor this alone, but many a gift
beside.
To cheer thy mother's years shall
be my aim,

Creusa's² style but wanting to the 390
dame;

Fortune an adverse wayward
course may run,
But bless'd thy mother in so dear
a son.

Now, by my life!--my Sire's most
sacred oath--

To thee I pledge my full, my
firmest troth,

All the rewards which once to
thee were vow'd^j, 400

If thou should'st fall, on her shall
be bestow'd."

Thus spoke the weeping Prince,
then forth to view

A gleaming falchion from the
sheath he drew;

Lycaon's utmost skill had grac'd
the steel,

For friends to envy and for foes
to feel:

A tawny hide, the Moorish lion's
spoil^k,

Slain 'midst the forest in the
hunter's toil,

Mnestheus to guard the elder
youth bestows^m,

And old Alethes' casque defends
his brows;

Arm'd, thence they go, while all
th' assembl'd train,

To aid their cause, implore the
gods in vainⁿ.

More than a boy, in wisdom and
in grace,

Iulus holds amidst the chiefs his
place:
His prayer he sends; but what can
prayers avail,
Lost in the murmurs of the
sighing gale^o?

The trench is pass'd, and favour'd
by the night,
Through sleeping foes, they
wheel their wary flight.
When shall the sleep of many a
foe be o'er?
Alas! some slumber, who shall
wake no more!
Chariots and bridles, mix'd with
arms, are seen,
And flowing flasks, and scatter'd
troops between:
Bacchus and Mars, to rule the
camp, combine;
A mingled Chaos this of war and
wine.
"Now," cries the first, "for deeds
of blood prepare,
With me the conquest and the
labour share:
Here lies our path; lest any hand
arise,
Watch thou, while many a
dreaming chieftain dies;
I'll carve our passage, through the
heedless foe,
And clear thy road, with many a
deadly blow."
His whispering accents then the
youth repress'd,

And pierced proud Rhamnes
through his panting breast:
Stretch'd at his ease, th'
incautious king repos'd;
Debauch, and not fatigue, his
eyes had clos'd;
To Turnus dear, a prophet and a
prince,
His omens more than augur's skill
evinced;
But he, who thus foretold the fate
of all,
Could not avert his own untimely
fall.
Next Remus' armour-bearer,
hapless, fell,
And three unhappy slaves the
carnage swell;
The charioteer along his courser's
sides
Expires, the steel his sever'd neck
divides;
And, last, his Lord is number'd
with the dead:
Bounding convulsive, flies the
gasping head;
From the swol'n veins the
blackening torrents pour;
Stain'd is the couch and earth
with clotting gore.
Young Lamyrus and Lamus next
expire,
And gay Serranus, fill'd with
youthful fire;
Half the long night in childish
games was pass'd^P;
Lull'd by the potent grape, he

slept at last:

Ah! happier far, had he the morn
survey'd,

And, till Aurora's dawn, his skill
display'd^q.

In slaughter'd folds, the keepers
lost in sleep^r,

His hungry fangs a lion thus may
steep;

'Mid the sad flock, at dead of
night he prowls,

With murder glutted, and in
carnage rolls

Insatiate still, through teeming
herds he roams^s;

In seas of gore, the lordly tyrant
foams.

Nor less the other's deadly
vengeance came,

But falls on feeble crowds
without a name;

His wound unconscious Fatus
scarce can feel,

Yet wakeful Rhæsus sees the
threatening steel;

His coward breast behind a jar he
hides,

And, vainly, in the weak defence
confides;

Full in his heart, the falchion
search'd his veins,

The reeking weapon bears
alternate stains;

Through wine and blood,
commingling as they flow,

One feeble spirit seeks the shades

below.

Now where Messapus dwelt they
bend their way,

Whose fires emit a faint and
trembling ray;

There, unconfin'd, behold each
grazing steed,

Unwatch'd, unheeded, on the
herbage feed^t:

Brave Nisus here arrests his
comrade's arm,

Too flush'd with carnage, and
with conquest warm:

"Hence let us haste, the
dangerous path is pass'd;

Full foes enough, to-night, have
breath'd their last:

Soon will the Day those Eastern
clouds adorn;

Now let us speed, nor tempt the
rising morn."

What silver arms, with various art
emboss'd,

What bowls and mantles, in
confusion toss'd,

They leave regardless! yet one
glittering prize

Attracts the younger Hero's
wandering eyes;

The gilded harness Rhamnes'
coursers felt,

The gems which stud the
monarch's golden belt:

This from the pallid corse was
quickly torn,

Once by a line of former

chieftains worn.
Th' exulting boy the studded
girdle wears,
Messapus' helm his head, in
triumph, bears;
Then from the tents their cautious
steps they bend,
To seek the vale, where safer
paths extend.

Just at this hour, a band of Latian
horse
To Turnus' camp pursue their
destin'd course:
While the slow foot their tardy
march delay,
The knights, impatient, spur
along the way:
Three hundred mail-clad men, by
Volscens led,
To Turnus with their master's
promise sped:
Now they approach the trench,
and view the walls,
When, on the left, a light
reflection falls;
The plunder'd helmet, through the
waning night,
Sheds forth a silver radiance,
glancing bright;
Volscens, with question loud, the
pair alarms:--
"Stand, Stragglers! stand! why
early thus in arms?
From whence? to whom?"--He
meets with no reply;
Trusting the covert of the night,

they fly:

The thicket's depth, with hurried
pace, they tread,
While round the wood the hostile
squadron spread.

With brakes entangled, scarce a
path between,

Dreary and dark appears the
sylvan scene:

Euryalus his heavy spoils impede,
The boughs and winding turns his
steps mislead;

But Nisus scours along the
forest's maze,
To where Latinus' steeds in safety
graze,

Then backward o'er the plain his
eyes extend,

On every side they seek his
absent friend.

"O God! my boy," he cries, "of
me bereft^u,

In what impending perils art thou
left!"

Listening he runs--above the
waving trees,

Tumultuous voices swell the
passing breeze;

The war-cry rises, thundering
hoofs around

Wake the dark echoes of the
trembling ground.

Again he turns--of footsteps hears
the noise--

The sound elates--the sight his
hope destroys:

The hapless boy a ruffian train
surround^v,

While lengthening shades his
weary way confound;
Him, with loud shouts, the
furious knights pursue,
Struggling in vain, a captive to
the crew^w.

What can his friend 'gainst
thronging numbers dare?

Ah! must he rush, his comrade's
fate to share?

What force, what aid, what
stratagem essay,
Back to redeem the Latian
spoiler's prey?

His life a votive ransom nobly
give,

Or die with him, for whom he
wish'd to live?

Poising with strength his lifted
lance on high,

On Luna's orb he cast his frenzied
eye:--

"Goddess serene, transcending
every star^x!

Queen of the sky, whose beams
are seen afar!

By night Heaven owns thy sway,
by day the grove,

When, as chaste Dian, here thou
deign'st to rove;

If e'er myself, or Sire, have
sought to grace

Thine altars, with the produce of
the chase,

Speed, speed my dart to pierce
yon vaunting crowd,
To free my friend, and scatter far
the proud."
Thus having said, the hissing dart
he flung;
Through parted shades the
hurtling weapon sung;
The thirsty point in Sulmo's
entrails lay,
Transfix'd his heart, and stretch'd
him on the clay:
He sobs, he dies,--the troop in
wild amaze,
Unconscious whence the death,
with horror gaze;
While pale they stare, thro' Tagus'
temples riven,
A second shaft, with equal force
is driven:
Fierce Volscens rolls around his
lowering eyes;
Veil'd by the night, secure the
Trojan lies^y.
Burning with wrath, he view'd his
soldiers fall.
"Thou youth accurst, thy life shall
pay for all!"
Quick from the sheath his
flaming glaive he drew,
And, raging, on the boy
defenceless flew.
Nisus, no more the blackening
shade conceals,
Forth, forth he starts, and all his
love reveals;
Aghast, confus'd, his fears to

madness rise,
And pour these accents, shrieking
as he flies;
"Me, me,--your vengeance hurl
on me alone;
Here sheathe the steel, my blood
is all your own;
Ye starry Spheres! thou conscious
Heaven! attest!
He could not--durst not--lo! the
guile confest!
All, all was mine,--his early fate
suspend;
He only lov'd, too well, his
hapless friend:
Spare, spare, ye Chiefs! from him
your rage remove;
His fault was friendship, all his
crime was love."
He pray'd in vain; the dark
assassin's sword
Pierced the fair side, the snowy
bosom gor'd;
Lowly to earth inclines his
plume-clad crest,
And sanguine torrents mantle o'er
his breast:
As some young rose whose
blossom scents the air,
Languid in death, expires beneath
the share;
Or crimson poppy, sinking with
the shower,
Declining gently, falls a fading
flower;
Thus, sweetly drooping, bends his
lovely head,

And lingering Beauty hovers
round the dead.

But fiery Nisus stems the battle's
tide,
Revenge his leader, and Despair
his guide^Z;

Volscens he seeks amidst the
gathering host,
Volscens must soon appease his
comrade's ghost;
Steel, flashing, pours on steel, foe
crowds on foe;
Rage nerves his arm, Fate gleams
in every blow;
In vain beneath unnumber'd
wounds he bleeds,
Nor wounds, nor death, distracted
Nisus heeds;
In viewless circles wheel'd his
falchion flies,
Nor quits the hero's grasp till
Volscens dies;
Deep in his throat its end the
weapon found,
The tyrant's soul fled groaning
through the wound^A.

Thus Nisus all his fond affection
prov'd--

Dying, revenged the fate of him
he lov'd;

Then on his bosom sought his
wonted place^B,

And death was heavenly, in his
friend's embrace!

Celestial pair! if aught my verse

can claim,
Wafted on Time's broad pinion,
yours is fame^C!
Ages on ages shall your fate
admire,
No future day shall see your
names expire,
While stands the Capitol,
immortal dome!
And vanquished millions hail
their Empress, Rome!

Footnote 1: Ý Lines 1-18 were
first published in *P. on V.*
Occasions, under the title of
"Fragment of a Translation from
the 9th Book of Virgil's *Æneid*."
[return to footnote mark](#)

Footnote a: Ý

*Him Ida sent, a hunter, now
no more,
To combat foes, upon a
foreign shore;
Near him, the loveliest of the
Trojan band,
Did fair Euryalus, his
comrade, stand;
Few are the seasons of his
youthful life,
As yet a novice in the martial
strife:
The Gods to him unwonted
gifts impart,
A female's beatify, with a
hero's heart.*

[P. on V. Occasions.]

*From Ida torn he left his
native grove,*

*Through distant climes, and
trackless seas to rove.*

[Hours of Idleness.]

[return](#)

Footnote 2: Ý The mother of Iulus, **Footnote b:** Ý
lost on the night when Troy was
taken.

[return](#)

*And now combin'd, the massy
gate they guard.*

[P. on V. Occasions.]

--they hold the nightly guard.

[Hours of Idleness.]

[return](#)

Footnote c: Ý

*And Love, and Life alike the
glory spurned...*

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote d: Ý

*Then Nisus, "Ah, my friend--
why thus suspect
Thy youthful breast admits of
no defect."*

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote e: Ý

*Trembling with diffidence not
awed by fear...*

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote f:Ý

*The vain Rutulians lost in
slumber dream...*

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote g:Ý

Hither she came...

[Hours of Idleness.]

[return](#)

Footnote h:Ý

Her falling tears...

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote i:Ý

*With this assurance Fate's
attempts are vain;
Fearless I dare the foes of
yonder plain....*

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote j:Ý

*That all the gifts which once
to thee were vowed...*

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote k:Ý

insert...

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote m:Ý

*Mnestheus presented, and the
Warrior's mask
Alethes gave a doubly
temper'd casque...*

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote n:Ý

*o glad their journey, follow
them in vain...*

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote o:Ý

*Dispersed and scattered on
the sighing gale...*

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote p:Ý

*By Bacchus' potent draught
weigh'd down at last
Half the long night in
childish games was past....*

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote q:Ý

--disportive play'd...

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote r:Ý

*By hunger prest, the keeper
lull'd to sleep
In slaughter thus a Lyon's
fangs may steep...*

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote s:Ý

*Through teeming herds
unchecked, unawed, he
roams...*

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote t:Ý

*Heedless of danger on the
herbage feed...*

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote u:Ý

*of thee bereft
In what dire perils is my
brother left...*

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote v:Ý

*Then his lov'd boy the ruffian
band surround
Entangled in the tufted Forest
ground....*

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote w:Ý

*t length a captive to the
hostile crew...*

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote x:Ý

*The Goddess bright
transcending every star...*

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote y:Ý

*No object meets them but the
earth and skies.
He burns for vengeance,
rising in his wrath--
Then you, accursed, thy life
shall pay for both;
Then from the sheath his
flaming brand he drew,
And on the raging boy
defenceless flew.*

Nisus no more the blackening
shade conceals,
Forth forth he rushed and all
his love reveals;
Pale and confused his fear to
madness grows,
And thus in accents mild he
greeted his Foes.
"On me, on me, direct your
impious steel,
Let me and me alone your
vengeance feel--
Let not a stripling's blood by
Chiefs be spilt,
Be mine the Death, as mine
was all the guilt.
By Heaven and Hell, the
powers of Earth and Air.
Yon guiltless stripling neither
could nor dare:
Spare him, oh! spare by all
the Gods above,
A hapless boy whose only
crime was Love."
He prayed in vain; the fierce
assassin's sword
Pierced the fair side, the
snowy bosom gored;
Drooping to earth inclines
his lovely head,
O'er his fair curls, the
purpling stream is spread.
As some sweet lily, by the
ploughshare broke
Languid in Death, sinks down
beneath the stroke;
Or, as some poppy, bending

*with the shower,
Gently declining falls a
waning flower...*

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote z:Ý

Revenge his object...

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote A:Ý

The assassin's soul...

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote B:Ý

*Then on his breast he sought
his wonted place, And Death
was lovely in his Friend's
embrace...*

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote C:Ý

*Yours are the fairest wreaths
of endless Fame...*

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Translation from the *Medea* of Euripides [L. 627-660]

Ἔρωτες ὑπὲρ μὲν ἄγαν, κ.τ.λ.¹

1.

When fierce conflicting passions urge
The breast, where love is wont to glow,
What mind can stem the stormy surge
Which rolls the tide of human woe?
The hope of praise, the dread of shame,
Can rouse the tortur'd breast no more;
The wild desire, the guilty flame,
Absorbs each wish it felt before.

2.

But if affection gently thrills
The soul, by purer dreams possest,
The pleasing balm of mortal ills
In love can soothe the aching breast:
If thus thou comest in disguise^a,
Fair Venus! from thy native heaven,
What heart, unfeeling, would despise
The sweetest boon the Gods have given?

3.

But, never from thy golden bow,
May I beneath the shaft expire!
Whose creeping venom, sure and slow,
Awakes an all-consuming fire:
Ye racking doubts! ye jealous fears!
With others wage internal war;
Repentance! source of future tears,
From me be ever distant far!

4.

May no distracting thoughts destroy
The holy calm of sacred love!
May all the hours be winged with joy,
Which hover faithful hearts above!
Fair Venus! on thy myrtle shrine
May I with some fond lover sigh!
Whose heart may mingle pure with mine,
With me to live, with me to die!

5.

My native soil! belov'd before,
Now dearer, as my peaceful home,
Ne'er may I quit thy rocky shore,
A hapless banish'd wretch to roam!
This very day, this very hour,
May I resign this fleeting breath!
Nor quit my silent humble bower;
A doom, to me, far worse than death.

6.

Have I not heard the exile's sigh,
And seen the exile's silent tear,
Through distant climes condemn'd to fly,
A pensive, weary wanderer here?
Ah! hapless dame²! no sire bewails,
No friend thy wretched fate deplores,
No kindred voice with rapture hails
Thy steps within a stranger's doors.

7.

Perish the fiend! whose iron heart
To fair affection's truth unknown,
Bids her he fondly lov'd depart,
Unpitied, helpless, and alone;
Who ne'er unlocks with silver key³,
The milder treasures of his soul;
May such a friend be far from me,
And Ocean's storms between us roll!

Footnote 1: Ý The Greek heading does not appear in
Hours of Idleness or *Poems O. and T.*
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Footnote
a:Ý

*If thus
thou
com'st
in*

*gentle
guise...*

[*Hours of
Idleness*]

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Footnote 2: Ὡς Medea, who accompanied Jason to Corinth, was deserted by him for the daughter of Creon, king of that city. The chorus, from which this is taken, here addresses Medea; though a considerable liberty is taken with the original, by expanding the idea, as also in some other parts of the translation.

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Footnote 3: Ὡς The original is

καθαρὰν ἀνοίξαντα κληῖδα φρενῶν,

literally "disclosing the bright key of the mind."

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Lachin y Gair^{[1](#)}

1.

Away, ye gay landscapes, ye gardens of roses!
In you let the minions of luxury rove:
Restore me the rocks, where the snow-flake reposes,
Though still they are sacred to freedom and love:
Yet, Caledonia, belov'd are thy mountains,
Round their white summits though elements war:

Though cataracts foam 'stead of smooth-flowing fountains,
I sigh for the valley of dark Loch na Garr.

2.

Ah! there my young footsteps in infancy, wander'd:
My cap was the bonnet, my cloak was the plaid²;
On chieftains, long perish'd, my memory ponder'd,
As daily I strode through the pine-cover'd glade;
I sought not my home, till the day's dying glory
Gave place to the rays of the bright polar star;
For fancy was cheer'd, by traditional story,
Disclos'd by the natives of dark Loch na Garr.

3.

"Shades of the dead! have I not heard your voices
Rise on the night-rolling breath of the gale?"
Surely, the soul of the hero rejoices,
And rides on the wind, o'er his own Highland vale!
Round Loch na Garr, while the stormy mist gathers,
Winter presides in his cold icy car:
Clouds, there, encircle the forms of my Fathers;
They dwell in the tempests of dark Loch na Garr.

4.

"Ill starr'd³, though brave, did no visions foreboding
Tell you that fate had forsaken your cause?"
Ah! were you destined to die at Culloden⁴,
Victory crown'd not your fall with applause:
Still were you happy, in death's earthy slumber,
You rest with your clan, in the caves of Braemar⁵;

The Pibroch⁶ resounds, to the piper's loud number,
Your deeds, on the echoes of dark Loch na Garr.

5.

Years have roll'd on, Loch na Garr, since I left you,
Years must elapse, ere I tread you again:
Nature of verdure and flowers has bereft you,
Yet still are you dearer than Albion's plain:
England! thy beauties are tame and domestic,
To one who has rov'd on the mountains afar:
Oh! for the crags that are wild and majestic,
The steep, frowning glories of dark Loch na Garr⁷.

Footnote 1: Ý *Lachin y Gair*, or, as it is pronounced in the Erse, *Loch na Garr*, towers proudly pre-eminent in the Northern Highlands, near Invercauld. One of our modern tourists mentions it as the highest mountain, perhaps, in Great Britain. Be this as it may, it is certainly one of the most sublime and picturesque amongst our "Caledonian Alps." Its appearance is of a dusky hue, but the summit is the seat of eternal snows. Near Lachin y Gair I spent some of the early part of my life, the recollection of which has given birth to the following stanzas. [Prefixed to the poem in *Hours of Idleness* and *Poems O. and T.*]

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Footnote 2: Ý This word is erroneously pronounced *plad*; the proper pronunciation (according to the Scotch) is shown by the orthography.

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Footnote 3: Ý I allude here to my maternal ancestors, "the Gordons," many of whom fought for the unfortunate Prince Charles, better known by the name of the Pretender. This branch was nearly allied by blood, as well as attachment, to the Stuarts. George, the second Earl of Huntley, married the Princess Annabella Stuart, daughter of James I. of Scotland. By her he left four sons: the third, Sir William Gordon, I have the honour to claim as one of my progenitors.

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Footnote 4: ÝWhether any perished in the Battle of Culloden, I am not certain; but, as many fell in the insurrection, I have used the name of the principal action, "*pars pro toto*."

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Footnote 5: Ý A tract of the Highlands so called. There is also a Castle of Braemar.

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Footnote 6: Ý The Bagpipe.--*Hours of Idleness*. ([See](#) note, p. 133.)

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Footnote 7: ÝThe love of mountains to the last made Byron

"Hail in each crag a friend's familiar face,
And Loch na Garr with Ida looked o'er Troy."

The Island (1823), Canto II. stanza xii.

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To Romance

1.

Parent of golden dreams, Romance!
Auspicious Queen of childish joys,
Who lead'st along, in airy dance,
Thy votive train of girls and boys;
At length, in spells no longer bound,
I break the fetters of my youth;
No more I tread thy mystic round,
But leave thy realms for those of Truth.

2.

And yet 'tis hard to quit the dreams
Which haunt the unsuspecting soul,
Where every nymph a goddess seems^a,
Whose eyes through rays immortal roll;
While Fancy holds her boundless reign,
And all assume a varied hue;
When Virgins seem no longer vain,
And even Woman's smiles are true.

3.

And must we own thee, but a name,
And from thy hall of clouds descend?
Nor find a Sylph in every dame,

A Pylades¹ in every friend?
But leave, at once, thy realms of air^b
To mingling bands of fairy elves;
Confess that woman's false as fair,
And friends have feeling for--themselves?

4.

With shame, I own, I've felt thy sway;
Repentant, now thy reign is o'er;
No more thy precepts I obey,
No more on fancied pinions soar;
Fond fool! to love a sparkling eye,
And think that eye to truth was dear;
To trust a passing wanton's sigh,
And melt beneath a wanton's tear!

5.

Romance! disgusted with deceit,
Far from thy motley court I fly,
Where Affectation holds her seat,
And sickly Sensibility;
Whose silly tears can never flow
For any pangs excepting thine;
Who turns aside from real woe,
To steep in dew thy gaudy shrine.

6.

Now join with sable Sympathy,
With cypress crown'd, array'd in weeds,
Who heaves with thee her simple sigh,
Whose breast for every bosom bleeds;

And call thy sylvan female choir,
To mourn a Swain for ever gone,
Who once could glow with equal fire,
But bends not now before thy throne.

7.

Ye genial Nymphs, whose ready tears^c
On all occasions swiftly flow;
Whose bosoms heave with fancied fears,
With fancied flames and phrenzy glow
Say, will you mourn my absent name,
Apostate from your gentle train?
An infant Bard, at least, may claim
From you a sympathetic strain.

8.

Adieu, fond race! a long adieu!
The hour of fate is hovering nigh;
E'en now the gulf appears in view,
Where unlamented you must lie^d:
Oblivion's blackening lake is seen,
Convuls'd by gales you cannot weather,
Where you, and eke your gentle queen,
Alas! must perish altogether.

Footnote 1: Ý It is hardly
necessary to add, that Pylades was
the companion of Orestes, and a
partner in one of those friendships
which, with those of Achilles and
Patroclus, Nisus and Euryalus,

Footnote a: Ý
here every girl--...
[MS. Newstead]
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Damon and Pythias, have been handed down to posterity as remarkable instances of attachments, which in all probability never existed beyond the imagination of the poet, or the page of an historian, or modern novelist.

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Footnote b:Ý

*But quit at once thy realms of
air
Thy mingling ...*

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote c:Ý

Auspicious bards...

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote d:Ý

*Where you are doomed in
death to lie....*

[MS. Newstead]

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The Death of Calmar and Orla¹

An Imitation of Macpherson's *Ossian*².

Dear are the days of youth! Age dwells on their remembrance through the mist of time. In the twilight he recalls the sunny hours of morn. He lifts his spear with trembling hand. "Not thus feebly did I raise the steel before my fathers!" Past is the race of heroes! But their fame rises on the harp; their souls ride on the wings of the wind; they hear the sound through the sighs of the storm, and rejoice in their hall of clouds. Such is Calmar. The grey stone marks his narrow house. He looks down from eddying tempests: he rolls his form in the whirlwind, and hovers on the blast of the mountain.

In Morven dwelt the Chief; a beam of war to Fingal. His steps in the field were marked in blood. Lochlin's sons had fled before his angry spear^a; but mild was the eye of Calmar; soft was the flow of his yellow locks: they streamed like the meteor of the night. No maid was the sigh of his soul: his thoughts were given to friendship,--to dark-haired Orla, destroyer of heroes! Equal were their swords in battle; but fierce was the pride of Orla:--gentle alone to Calmar. Together they dwelt in the cave of Oithona.

From Lochlin, Swaran bounded o'er the blue waves. Erin's sons fell beneath his might. Fingal roused his chiefs to combat^b. Their ships cover the ocean! Their hosts throng on the green hills. They come to the aid of Erin.

Night rose in clouds. Darkness veils the armies. But the blazing oaks gleam through the valley^c. The sons of Lochlin slept: their dreams were of blood. They lift the spear in thought, and Fingal flies. Not so the Host of Morven. To watch was the post of Orla. Calmar stood by

his side. Their spears were in their hands. Fingal called his chiefs: they stood around. The king was in the midst. Grey were his locks, but strong was the arm of the king. Age withered not his powers. "Sons of Morven," said the hero, "to-morrow we meet the foe. But where is Cuthullin, the shield of Erin? He rests in the halls of Tura; he knows not of our coming. Who will speed through Lochlin, to the hero, and call the chief to arms? The path is by the swords of foes; but many are my heroes. They are thunderbolts of war. Speak, ye chiefs! Who will arise?"

"Son of Trenmor! mine be the deed," said dark-haired Orla, "and mine alone. What is death to me? I love the sleep of the mighty, but little is the danger. The sons of Lochlin dream. I will seek car-borne Cuthullin. If I fall, raise the song of bards; and lay me by the stream of Lubar."

"And shalt thou fall alone?" said fair-haired Calmar. "Wilt thou leave thy friend afar? Chief of Oithona! not feeble is my arm in fight. Could I see thee die, and not lift the spear? No, Orla! ours has been the chase of the roebuck, and the feast of shells; ours be the path of danger: ours has been the cave of Oithona; ours be the narrow dwelling on the banks of Lubar."

"Calmar," said the chief of Oithona, "why should thy yellow locks be darkened in the dust of Erin? Let me fall alone. My father dwells in his hall of air: he will rejoice in his boy; but the blue-eyed Mora spreads the feast for her Son in Morven. She listens to the steps of the hunter on the heath, and thinks it is the tread of Calmar. Let her not say, 'Calmar has fallen by the steel of Lochlin: he died with gloomy Orla, the chief of the dark brow.' Why should tears dim the azure eye of Mora? Why should her voice curse Orla, the destroyer of Calmar? Live Calmar! Live to raise my stone of moss; live to revenge me in the blood of Lochlin. Join the song of bards above my grave. Sweet will be the song of Death to Orla, from the voice of Calmar. My ghost shall smile on the notes of Praise."

"Orla," said the son of Mora, "could I raise the song of Death to my friend? Could I give his fame to the winds? No, my heart would speak

in sighs: faint and broken are the sounds of sorrow. Orla! our souls shall hear the song together. One cloud shall be ours on high: the bards will mingle the names of Orla and Calmar."

They quit the circle of the Chiefs. Their steps are to the Host of Lochlin. The dying blaze of oak dim-twinkles through the night. The northern star points the path to Tura. Swaran, the King, rests on his lonely hill. Here the troops are mixed: they frown in sleep; their shields beneath their heads. Their swords gleam, at distance in heaps. The fires are faint; their embers fail in smoke. All is hushed; but the gale sighs on the rocks above. Lightly wheel the Heroes through the slumbering band. Half the journey is past, when Mathon, resting on his shield, meets the eye of Orla. It rolls in flame, and glistens through the shade. His spear is raised on high.

"Why dost thou bend thy brow, chief of Oithona?" said fair-haired Calmar: "we are in the midst of foes. Is this a time for delay?"

"It is a time for vengeance," said Orla of the gloomy brow. "Mathon of Lochlin sleeps: seest thou his spear? Its point is dim with the gore of my father. The blood of Mathon shall reek on mine: but shall I slay him sleeping, Son of Mora? No! he shall feel his wound: my fame shall not soar on the blood of slumber. Rise, Mathon, rise! The Son of Conna calls; thy life is his; rise to combat."

Mathon starts from sleep: but did he rise alone? No: the gathering Chiefs bound on the plain.

"Fly! Calmar, fly!" said dark-haired Orla. "Mathon is mine. I shall die in joy: but Lochlin crowds around. Fly through the shade of night."

Orla turns. The helm of Mathon is cleft; his shield falls from his arm: he shudders in his blood^d. He rolls by the side of the blazing oak. Strumon sees him fall: his wrath rises: his weapon glitters on the head of Orla: but a spear pierced his eye. His brain gushes through the wound, and foams on the spear of Calmar. As roll the waves of the Ocean on two mighty barks of the North, so pour the men of Lochlin

on the Chiefs. As, breaking the surge in foam, proudly steer the barks of the North, so rise the Chiefs of Morven on the scattered crests of Lochlin. The din of arms came to the ear of Fingal. He strikes his shield; his sons throng around; the people pour along the heath. Ryno bounds in joy. Ossian stalks in his arms. Oscar shakes the spear. The eagle wing of Fillan floats on the wind. Dreadful is the clang of death! many are the Widows of Lochlin. Morven prevails in its strength.

Morn glimmers on the hills: no living foe is seen; but the sleepers are many; grim they lie on Erin. The breeze of Ocean lifts their locks; yet they do not awake. The hawks scream above their prey.

Whose yellow locks wave o'er the breast of a chief? Bright as the gold of the stranger, they mingle with the dark hair of his friend. 'Tis Calmar: he lies on the bosom of Orla. Theirs is one stream of blood. Fierce is the look of the gloomy Orla. He breathes not; but his eye is still a flame. It glares in death unclosed. His hand is grasped in Calmar's; but Calmar lives! he lives, though low. "Rise," said the king, "rise, son of Mora: 'tis mine to heal the wounds of Heroes. Calmar may yet bound on the hills of Morven."^e

"Never more shall Calmar chase the deer of Morven with Orla," said the Hero. "What were the chase to me alone? Who would share the spoils of battle with Calmar? Orla is at rest! Rough was thy soul, Orla! yet soft to me as the dew of morn. It glared on others in lightning: to me a silver beam of night. Bear my sword to blue-eyed Mora; let it hang in my empty hall. It is not pure from blood: but it could not save Orla. Lay me with my friend: raise the song when I am dark!"

They are laid by the stream of Lubar. Four grey stones mark the dwelling of Orla and Calmar. When Swaran was bound, our sails rose on the blue waves. The winds gave our barks to Morven:--the bards raised the song.

"What Form rises on the roar of clouds? Whose dark Ghost gleams on the red streams of tempests? His voice rolls on the thunder. 'Tis Orla, the brown Chief of Oithona. He was unmatched in war. Peace to thy

soul, Orla! thy fame will not perish. Nor thine, Calmar! Lovely wast thou, son of blue-eyed Mora; but not harmless was thy sword. It hangs in thy cave. The Ghosts of Lochlin shriek around its steel. Hear thy praise, Calmar! It dwells on the voice of the mighty. Thy name shakes on the echoes of Morven. Then raise thy fair locks, son of Mora. Spread them on the arch of the rainbow, and smile through the tears of the storm³.

Footnote 1: Ý The MS. is preserved at Newstead.
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Footnote a:Ý

Erin's sons--

[MS. Newstead]

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Footnote 2: Ý It may be necessary to observe, that the story, though considerably varied in the catastrophe, is taken from *Nisus and Euryalus*, of which episode a translation is already given in the present volume [[see](#) pp. 151-168].
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Footnote b:Ý

The horn of Fingal--

[MS. Newstead]

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Footnote 3: Ý I fear Laing's late edition has completely overthrown every hope that Macpherson's *Ossian* might prove the translation of a series of poems complete in themselves; but, while the imposture is discovered, the merit of the work remains undisputed, though not without faults--particularly, in some parts, turgid and bombastic diction.--The present humble imitation will be pardoned by the admirers of the original as an attempt, however inferior, which evinces an

Footnote c:Ý

--the fires gleam--

[MS. Newstead]

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attachment to their favourite author.

[Malcolm Laing (1762-1818) published, in 1802, a *History of Scotland, etc.*, with a dissertation "on the supposed authenticity of Ossian's Poems," and, in 1805, a work entitled *The Poems of Ossian, etc., containing the Poetical Works of James Macpherson, Esq., in Prose and Rhyme, with Notes and Illustrations.*

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Footnote d:Ý

He trembles in his blood. He rolls convulsive...

[MS. Newstead]

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Footnote e:Ý

-the mountain of Morven.

[MS. Newstead]

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To Edward Noel Long, Esq.¹ _a

"Nil ego contulerim jucundo sanus amico."

Horace.

Dear **Long**, in this sequester'd scene^b,
While all around in slumber lie,
The joyous days, which ours have been
Come rolling fresh on Fancy's eye;
Thus, if, amidst the gathering storm,
While clouds the darken'd noon deform,
Yon heaven assumes a varied glow,
I hail the sky's celestial bow,
Which spreads the sign of future peace,
And bids the war of tempests cease.
Ah! though the present brings but pain,
I think those days may come again;
Or if, in melancholy mood,
Some lurking envious fear intrude^c,
To check my bosom's fondest thought,
And interrupt the golden dream,
I crush the fiend with malice fraught,
And, still, indulge my wonted theme.
Although we ne'er again can trace,
In Granta's vale, the pedant's lore,
Nor through the groves of Ida chase
Our raptured visions, as before;
Though Youth has flown on rosy pinion,
And Manhood claims his stern dominion,
Age will not every hope destroy,
But yield some hours of sober joy.
Yes, I will hope that Time's broad wing

Will shed around some dews of spring:
But, if his scythe must sweep the flowers
Which bloom among the fairy bowers,
Where smiling Youth delights to dwell,
And hearts with early rapture swell;
If frowning Age, with cold controul,
Confines the current of the soul,
Congeals the tear of Pity's eye,
Or checks the sympathetic sigh,
Or hears, unmov'd, Misfortune's groan
And bids me feel for self alone;
Oh! may my bosom never learn
To soothe its wonted heedless flow^d;
Still, still, despise the censor stern,
But ne'er forget another's woe.
Yes, as you knew me in the days,
O'er which Remembrance yet delays^e,
Still may I rove untutor'd, wild,
And even in age, at heart a child^f.
Though, now, on airy visions borne,
To you my soul is still the same.
Oft has it been my fate to mourn^g,
And all my former joys are tame:
But, hence! ye hours of sable hue!
Your frowns are gone, my sorrows o'er:
By every bliss my childhood knew,
I'll think upon your shade no more.
Thus, when the whirlwind's rage is past,
And caves their sullen roar enclose^h
We heed no more the wintry blast,
When lull'd by zephyr to repose.
Full often has my infant Muse,
Attun'd to love her languid lyre;
But, now, without a theme to choose,
The strains in stolen sighs expire.
My youthful nymphs, alas! are flownⁱ;

E---- is a wife, and C---- a mother,
And Carolina sighs alone,
And Mary's given to another;
And Cora's eye, which roll'd on me,
Can now no more my love recall--
In truth, dear **Long**, 'twas time to flee--j
For Cora's eye will shine on all.
And though the Sun, with genial rays,
His beams alike to all displays,
And every lady's eye's a *sun*,
These last should be confin'd to one.
The soul's meridian don't become herk,
Whose Sun displays a general *summer*!
Thus faint is every former flame,
And Passion's self is now a namem n;
As, when the ebbing flames are low,
The aid which once improv'd their light,
And bade them burn with fiercer glow,
Now quenches all their sparks in night;
Thus has it been with Passion's fires,
As many a boy and girl remembers,
While all the force of love expires,
Extinguish'd with the dying embers.
But now, dear **Long**, 'tis midnight's noon,
And clouds obscure the watery moon,
Whose beauties I shall not rehearse,
Describ'd in every stripling's verse;
For why should I the path go o'er
Which every bard has trod beforeo?
Yet ere yon silver lamp of night
Has thrice perform'd her stated round,
Has thrice retrac'd her path of light,
And chas'd away the gloom profound,
I trust, that we, my gentle Friend,
Shall see her rolling orbit wend,
Above the dear-lov'd peaceful seat,
Which once contain'd our youth's retreat;

And, then, with those our childhood knew,
We'll mingle in the festive crew;
While many a tale of former day
Shall wing the laughing hours away;
And all the flow of souls shall pour
The sacred intellectual shower,
Nor cease, till Luna's waning horn,
Scarce glimmers through the mist of Morn.

Footnote 1: Ý The MS. of these verses is at Newstead. Long was with Byron at Harrow, and was the only one of his intimate friends who went up at the same time as he did to Cambridge, where both were noted for feats of swimming and diving. Long entered the Guards, and served in the expedition to Copenhagen. He was drowned early in 1809, when on his way to join the army in the Peninsula; the transport in which he sailed being run down in the night by another of the convoy.

"Long's father," says Byron,
"wrote to me to write his
son's epitaph. I promised--but
I had not the heart to
complete it. He was such a
good, amiable being as rarely
remains long in this world;
with talent and
accomplishments, too, to

Footnote a:Ý

To E. N. L. Esq...

[Hours of Idleness. Poems O. and T.]

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make him the more
regretted."

Diary, 1821; *Life*, p. 32. See also
memorandum (*Life*, p. 31, col. ii.).
[return to footnote mark](#)

Footnote b:Ý

Dear L-----.

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote c:Ý

Some daring envious...

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote d:Ý

its young romantic flow...

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote e:Ý

O'er which my fancy...

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote f:Ý

*Still may my breast to
boyhood cleave,
With every early passion
heave;
Still may I rove untutored,
wild,*

*But never cease to seem a
child....*

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote g:Ý

*Since we have met, I learnt to
mourn...*

[MS. Newstead]

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Footnote h:Ý

And caves their sullen war...

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote i:Ý

--thank Heaven are flown...

[MS. Newstead]

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Footnote j:Ý

In truth dear L----...

[Hours of Idleness. Poems O. and
T.]

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Footnote k:Ý

*The glances really don't
become her...*

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote m:Ý

*No more I linger on its
name...*

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote n:Ý

*And passion's self is but a
name...*

[MS. Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote o:Ý

*And what's much worse than
this I find
Have left their deepen'd
tracks behind
Yet as yon...*

[MS. Newstead]

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[cross-reference: return to "On the Eyes of Miss A—— H——](#)

To a Lady^a

1.

Oh! had my Fate been join'd with thine¹,
As once this pledge appear'd a token,
These follies had not, then, been mine,
For, then, my peace had not been broken.

2.

To thee, these early faults I owe,
To thee, the wise and old reproof:
They know my sins, but do not know
'Twas thine to break the bonds of loving.

3.

For once my soul, like thine, was pure,
And all its rising fires could smother;
But, now, thy vows no more endure,
Bestow'd by thee upon another¹.

4.

Perhaps, his peace I could destroy,
And spoil the blisses that await him;
Yet let my Rival smile in joy,
For thy dear sake, I cannot hate him.

5.

Ah! since thy angel form is gone,
My heart no more can rest with any;
But what it sought in thee alone,

Attempts, alas! to find in many.

6.

Then, fare thee well, deceitful Maid!
'Twere vain and fruitless to regret thee;
Nor Hope, nor Memory yield their aid,
But Pride may teach me to forget thee.

7.

Yet all this giddy waste of years,
This tiresome round of palling pleasures;
These varied loves, these matrons' fears,
These thoughtless strains to Passion's measures--

8.

If thou wert mine, had all been hush'd:--
This cheek, now pale from early riot,
With Passion's hectic ne'er had flush'd,
But bloom'd in calm domestic quiet.

9.

Yes, once the rural Scene was sweet,
For Nature seem'd to smile before thee;
And once my Breast abhorr'd deceit,--
For then it beat but to adore thee.

10.

But, now, I seek for other joys--
To think, would drive my soul to madness;
In thoughtless throngs, and empty noise,
I conquer half my Bosom's sadness.

11.

Yet, even in these, a thought will steal,
In spite of every vain endeavour;
And fiends might pity what I feel--
To know that thou art lost for ever.

Footnote 1: Ý These verses were
addressed to Mrs. Chaworth
Musters. Byron wrote in 1822,

Footnote a:Ý
To-----...

"Our meetings were stolen
ones. ... A gate leading from
Mr. Chaworth's grounds to
those of my mother was the
place of our interviews. The
ardour was all on my side. I
was serious; she was volatile:
she liked me as a younger
brother, and treated and
laughed at me as a boy; she,
however, gave me her
picture, and that was
something to make verses
upon. Had I married her,
perhaps, the whole tenour of
my life would have been
different."

[*Hours of Idleness. Poems O. and
T.*]
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Medwin's *Conversations*, 1824, p.
81.

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Poems Original and Translated

When I Roved a Young Highlander^a

1.

When I rov'd a young Highlander o'er the dark heath,
And climb'd thy steep summit, oh Morven of snow¹!
To gaze on the torrent that thunder'd beneath,
Or the mist of the tempest that gather'd below²;
Untutor'd by science, a stranger to fear,
And rude as the rocks, where my infancy grew,
No feeling, save one, to my bosom was dear;
Need I say, my sweet Mary³, 'twas centred in you?

2.

Yet it could not be Love, for I knew not the name,--
What passion can dwell in the heart of a child?
But, still, I perceive an emotion the same
As I felt, when a boy, on the crag-cover'd wild:
One image, alone, on my bosom impress'd,
I lov'd my bleak regions, nor panted for new;
And few were my wants, for my wishes were bless'd,
And pure were my thoughts, for my soul was with you.

3.

I arose with the dawn, with my dog as my guide,
From mountain to mountain I bounded along;
I breasted⁴ the billows of Dee's⁵ rushing tide,
And heard at a distance the Highlander's song:
At eve, on my heath-cover'd couch of repose.
No dreams, save of Mary, were spread to my view;
And warm to the skies my devotions arose,
For the first of my prayers was a blessing on you.

4.

I left my bleak home, and my visions are gone;
The mountains are vanish'd, my youth is no more;
As the last of my race, I must wither alone,
And delight but in days, I have witness'd before:
Ah! splendour has rais'd, but embitter'd my lot;
More dear were the scenes which my infancy knew:
Though my hopes may have fail'd, yet they are not
forgot,
Though cold is my heart, still it lingers with you.

5.

When I see some dark hill point its crest to the sky,
I think of the rocks that o'ershadow Colbleen⁶;
When I see the soft blue of a love-speaking eye,
I think of those eyes that endear'd the rude scene;
When, haply, some light-waving locks I behold,
That faintly resemble my Mary's in hue,
I think on the long flowing ringlets of gold,
The locks that were sacred to beauty, and you.

6.

Yet the day may arrive, when the mountains once more
Shall rise to my sight, in their mantles of snow;
But while these soar above me, unchang'd as before,
Will Mary be there to receive me?--ah, no!
Adieu, then, ye hills, where my childhood was bred!
Thou sweet flowing Dee, to thy waters adieu!
No home in the forest shall shelter my head,--
Ah! Mary, what home could be mine, but with you?

Footnote 1: Ý Morven, a lofty mountain in Aberdeenshire.

"Gormal of snow" is an expression frequently to be found in Ossian.

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Footnote a:Ý

Song...

[*Poems O. and T.*]

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Footnote 2: Ý This will not appear extraordinary to those who have been accustomed to the mountains. It is by no means uncommon, on attaining the top of Ben-e-vis, Ben-y-bourd, etc., to perceive, between the summit and the valley, clouds pouring down rain, and occasionally accompanied by lightning, while the spectator literally looks down upon the storm, perfectly secure from its effects.

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Footnote 3: Ý Byron, in early youth, was "unco' wastefu" of Marys.

- There was his distant cousin, Mary Duff (afterwards Mrs. Robert Cockburn), who lived not far from the "Plain-Stanes" at Aberdeen. Her "brown, dark hair, and hazel eyes--her very dress," were long years after "a perfect image" in his memory (*Life*, p. 9).
- Secondly, there was the Mary of these stanzas, "with long-flowing ringlets of gold," the "Highland Mary" of local tradition. She was (writes the Rev. J. Michie, of The Manse, Dinnet) the daughter of James Robertson, of the farmhouse of Ballatrach on Deeside, where Byron used to spend his summer holidays (1796-98). She was of gentle birth, and through her mother, the daughter of Captain Macdonald of Rinneton, traced her descent to the Lord of the Isles. "She died at Aberdeen, March 2, 1867, aged eighty-five years."
- A third Mary (see "[Lines to Mary,](#)" etc., p. 32) flits through the early poems, evanescent but unspiritual.
- Last of all, there was Mary Anne Chaworth, of Annesley (see "[A Fragment,](#)" etc., p. 210; "[The Adieu,](#)" st. 6, p.

239, etc.), whose marriage, in 1805, "threw him out again-- alone on a wide, wide sea" (*Life*, p. 85).

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Footnote 4: Ý "Breasting the lofty surge" (Shakespeare).

[return](#)

Footnote 5: Ý The Dee is a beautiful river, which rises near Mar Lodge, and falls into the sea at New Aberdeen.

[return](#)

Footnote 6: Ý Colbleen is a mountain near the verge of the Highlands, not far from the ruins of Dee Castle.

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To the Duke of Dorset^a 1

Dorset! whose early steps with
mine have stray'd^b,
Exploring every path of Ida's
glade;

Whom, still, affection taught me
to defend,
And made me less a tyrant than a
friend,
Though the harsh custom of our 10
youthful band
Bade *thee* obey, and gave *me* to
command²;
Thee, on whose head a few short
years will shower
The gift of riches, and the pride
of power;
E'en now a name illustrious is
thine own,
Renown'd in rank, not far beneath 20
the throne.
Yet, Dorset, let not this seduce
thy soul^c
To shun fair science, or evade
controul;
Though passive tutors³, fearful to
dispraise
The titled child, whose future
breath may raise,
View ducal errors with indulgent 30
eyes,
And wink at faults they tremble
to chastise.
When youthful parasites, who
bend the knee
To wealth, their golden idol, not
to thee,--
And even in simple boyhood's
opening dawn
Some slaves are found to flatter 40
and to fawn,--
When these declare, "that pomp

alone should wait
On one by birth predestin'd to be
great;
That books were only meant for
drudging fools,
That gallant spirits scorn the
common rules;"
Believe them not,--they point the
path to shame, 50
And seek to blast the honours of
thy name:
Turn to the few in Ida's early
throng,
Whose souls disdain not to
condemn the wrong;
Or if, amidst the comrades of thy
youth,
None dare to raise the sterner
voice of truth, 60
Ask thine own heart--'twill bid
thee, boy, forbear!
For *well* I know that virtue lingers
there.
Yes! I have mark'd thee many a
passing day,
But now new scenes invite me far
away;
Yes! I have mark'd within that
generous mind 70
A soul, if well matur'd, to bless
mankind;
Ah! though myself, by nature
haughty, wild,
Whom Indiscretion hail'd her
favourite child;
Though every error stamps me
for her own,

And dooms my fall, I fain would
fall alone; 80
Though my proud heart no
precept, now, can tame,
I love the virtues which I cannot
claim.
'Tis not enough, with other sons
of power,
To gleam the lambent meteor of
an hour;
To swell some peerage page in
feeble pride, 90
With long-drawn names that
grace no page beside;
Then share with titled crowds the
common lot--
In life just gaz'd at, in the grave
forgot;
While nought divides thee from
the vulgar dead,
Except the dull cold stone that
hides thy head,
The mouldering 'scutcheon, or the 100
Herald's roll,
That well-emblazon'd but
neglected scroll,
Where Lords, unhonour'd, in the
tomb may find
One spot, to leave a worthless
name behind.
There sleep, unnotic'd as the
gloomy vaults 110
That veil their dust, their follies,
and their faults,
A race, with old armorial lists
o'erspread,
In records destin'd never to be

read.

Fain would I view thee, with
prophetic eyes,
Exalted more among the good
and wise;

A glorious and a long career
pursue,

As first in Rank, the first in
Talent too:

Spurn every vice, each little
meanness shun;

Not Fortune's minion, but her
noblest son.

Turn to the annals of a former
day;

Bright are the deeds thine earlier
Sires display;

One, though a courtier, lived a
man of worth,

And call'd, proud boast! the
British drama forth⁴.

Another view! not less renown'd
for Wit;

Alike for courts, and camps, or
senates fit;

Bold in the field, and favour'd by
the Nine;

In every splendid part ordain'd to
shine;

Far, far distinguished from the
glittering throng,

The pride of Princes, and the
boast of Song⁵.

Such were thy Fathers; thus
preserve their name,

Not heir to titles only, but to
Fame.

The hour draws nigh, a few brief
days will close,
To me, this little scene of joys
and woes;
Each knell of Time now warns
me to resign
Shades where Hope, Peace, and
Friendship all were mine:
Hope, that could vary like the
rainbow's hue,
And gild their pinions, as the
moments flew;
Peace, that reflection never
frown'd away,
By dreams of ill to cloud some
future day;
Friendship, whose truth let
Childhood only tell;
Alas! they love not long, who
love so well.
To these adieu! nor let me linger
o'er
Scenes hail'd, as exiles hail their
native shore,
Receding slowly, through the
dark-blue deep,
Beheld by eyes that mourn, yet
cannot weep.
Dorset, farewell! I will not ask
one part^d
Of sad remembrance in so young
a heart;
The coming morrow from thy
youthful mind
Will sweep my name, nor leave a
trace behind.
And, yet, perhaps, in some

maturer year,
Since chance has thrown us in the
self-same sphere,
Since the same senate, nay, the
same debate,
May one day claim our suffrage
for the state,
We hence may meet, and pass
each other by
With faint regard, or cold and
distant eye.
For me, in future, neither friend
nor foe,
A stranger to thyself, thy weal or
woe--
With thee no more again I hope to
trace
The recollection of our early race;
No more, as once, in social hours
rejoice,
Or hear, unless in crowds, thy
well-known voice;
Still, if the wishes of a heart
untaught
To veil those feelings, which,
perchance, it ought,
If these,--but let me cease the
lengthen'd strain,--
Oh! if these wishes are not
breath'd in vain,
The Guardian Seraph who directs
thy fate
Will leave thee glorious, as he
found thee great.
1805.

Footnote 1: Ý In looking over my papers to select a few additional poems for this second edition, I found the above lines, which I had totally forgotten, composed in the summer of 1805, a short time previous to my departure from H[arrow]. They were addressed to a young schoolfellow of high rank, who had been my frequent companion in some rambles through the neighbouring country: however, he never saw the lines, and most probably never will. As, on a re-perusal, I found them not worse than some other pieces in the collection, I have now published them, for the first time, after a slight revision.

[The foregoing note was prefixed to the poem in *Poems O. and T.* George John Frederick, 4th Duke of Dorset, born 1793, was killed by a fall from his horse when hunting, in 1815, while on a visit to his step-father the Earl of Whitworth, Lord-Lieutenant of Ireland. (See Byron's letter to Moore, Feb. 22, 1815).]

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Footnote 2: Ý At every public school the junior boys are completely subservient to the upper forms till they attain a seat in the higher classes. From this state of probation, very properly, no rank is exempt; but after a

Footnote a:Ý

o the Duke of D-----...

[*Poems O. and T.*]

[return](#)

Footnote b:Ý

D-r-t -----...

[*Poems O. and T.*]

return

certain period, they command in turn those who succeed.

[return](#)

Footnote 3: Ý Allow me to disclaim any personal allusions, even the most distant. I merely mention generally what is too often the weakness of preceptors.

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Footnote 4: Ý

"Thomas Sackville, Lord Buckhurst, was born in 1527. While a student of the Inner Temple, he wrote his tragedy of *Gorboduc*, which was played before Queen Elizabeth at Whitehall, in 1561. This tragedy, and his contribution of the Induction and legend of the Duke of Buckingham to the *Mirroure for Magistraytes*, compose the poetical history of Sackville. The rest of it was political. In 1604, he was created Earl of Dorset by James I. He died suddenly at the council-table, in consequence of a dropsy on the brain."

--*Specimens of the British Poets*,
by Thomas Campbell, London,
1819, ii. 134, sq.

[return](#)

Footnote c:Ý

Yet D-r-t-----...

[*Poems O. and T.*]

[return](#)

Footnote d:Ý

D--r--t farewell...

[*Poems O. and T.*]

[return](#)

Footnote 5: Ý Charles Sackville, Earl of Dorset [1637-1706], esteemed the most accomplished man of his day, was alike distinguished in the voluptuous court of Charles II. and the gloomy one of William III. He behaved with great gallantry in the sea-fight with the Dutch in 1665; on the day previous to which he composed his celebrated song ("*To all you Ladies now at Land*"). His character has been drawn in the highest colours by Dryden, Pope, Prior, and Congreve. *Vide* Anderson's *British Poets*, 1793, vi. 107, 108.

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To the Earl of Clare^a

*Tu semper amoris
Sis memor, et cari comitis ne abscedat imago.*

Val. Flac. 'Argonaut', iv. 36.

1.

Friend of my youth! when young we rov'd,
Like striplings, mutually belov'd,
With Friendship's purest glow;
The bliss, which wing'd those rosy hours,
Was such as Pleasure seldom showers
On mortals here below.

2.

The recollection seems, alone,
Dearer than all the joys I've known,
When distant far from you:
Though pain, 'tis still a pleasing pain,
To trace those days and hours again,
And sigh again, adieu!

3.

My pensive mem'ry lingers o'er,
Those scenes to be enjoy'd no more,
Those scenes regretted ever;
The measure of our youth is full,
Life's evening dream is dark and dull,
And we may meet--ah! never!

4.

As when one parent spring supplies
Two streams, which from one fountain rise,
Together join'd in vain;

How soon, diverging from their source,
Each, murmuring, seeks another course,
Till mingled in the Main!

5.

Our vital streams of weal or woe,
Though near, alas! distinctly flow,
Nor mingle as before:
Now swift or slow, now black or clear,
Till Death's unfathom'd gulph appear,
And both shall quit the shore.

6.

Our souls, my Friend! which once supplied
One wish, nor breathed a thought beside,
Now flow in different channels:
Disdaining humbler rural sports,
'Tis yours to mix in polish'd courts,
And shine in Fashion's annals;

7.

'Tis mine to waste on love my time,
Or vent my reveries in rhyme,
Without the aid of Reason;
For Sense and Reason (critics know it)
Have quitted every amorous Poet,
Nor left a thought to seize on.

8.

Poor **Little!** sweet, melodious bard!
Of late esteem'd it monstrous hard
That he, who sang before all;
He who the lore of love expanded,
By dire Reviewers should be branded,
As void of wit and moral¹.

9.

And yet, while Beauty's praise is thine,
Harmonious favourite of the Nine!
Repine not at thy lot.
Thy soothing lays may still be read,
When Persecution's arm is dead,
And critics are forgot.

10.

Still I must yield those worthies merit
Who chasten, with unsparing spirit,
Bad rhymes, and those who write them:
And though myself may be the next
By critic sarcasm to be vext,
I really will not fight them².

11.

Perhaps they would do quite as well
To break the rudely sounding shell
Of such a young beginner:
He who offends at pert nineteen,
Ere thirty may become, I ween,
A very harden'd sinner.

12.

Now, Clare, I must return to you^b;

And, sure, apologies are due:

Accept, then, my concession.

In truth, dear Clare, in Fancy's flight^c

I soar along from left to right;

My Muse admires digression.

13.

I think I said 'twould be your fate

To add one star to royal state;--

May regal smiles attend you!

And should a noble Monarch reign,

You will not seek his smiles in vain,

If worth can recommend you.

14.

Yet since in danger courts abound,

Where specious rivals glitter round,

From snares may Saints preserve you;

And grant your love or friendship ne'er

From any claim a kindred care,

But those who best deserve you!

15.

Not for a moment may you stray

From Truth's secure, unerring way!

May no delights decoy!

O'er roses may your footsteps move,

Your smiles be ever smiles of love,
Your tears be tears of joy!

16.

Oh! if you wish that happiness
Your coming days and years may bless,
And virtues crown your brow;
Be still as you were wont to be,
Spotless as you've been known to me,--
Be still as you are now³.

17.

And though some trifling share of praise,
To cheer my last declining days,
To me were doubly dear;
Whilst blessing your beloved name,
I'd waive at once a *Poet's* fame,
To prove a *Prophet* here.

1807.

Footnote 1: Ý These stanzas were written soon after the appearance of a severe critique in a northern review, on a new publication of the British Anacreon. (Byron refers to the article in the *Edinburgh Review*, of July, 1807, on "*Epistles, Odes, and other*

Footnote a:Ý

To the Earl of -----...

[*Poems O. and T.*]

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Poems, by Thomas Little, Esq.")

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Footnote 2: Ý A bard [Moore] (*Horresco referens*) defied his reviewer [Jeffrey] to mortal combat. If this example becomes prevalent, our Periodical Censors must be dipped in the river Styx: for what else can secure them from the numerous host of their enraged assailants? [Cf. [English Bards](#), l. 466 (click on c3 to return), [note](#).]

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Footnote 3: Ý

"Of all I have ever known, Clare has always been the least altered in everything from the excellent qualities and kind affections which attached me to him so strongly at school. I should hardly have thought it possible for society (or the world, as it is called) to leave a being with so little of the leaven of bad passions. I do not speak from personal experience only, but from all I have ever heard of him from others, during absence and distance."

Detached Thoughts, Nov. 5, 1821;
Life, p. 540.

[return](#)

Footnote b: Ý

Now ---- I must...

[*Poems O. and T.*]

[return](#)

Footnote c: Ý

In truth dear ---- in fancy's flight...

[*Poems O. and T.*]

[return](#)

I would I were a Careless Child^a

1.

I would I were a careless child,
Still dwelling in my Highland cave,
Or roaming through the dusky wild,
Or bounding o'er the dark blue wave;
The cumbrous pomp of Saxon¹ pride,
Accords not with the freeborn soul,
Which loves the mountain's craggy side,
And seeks the rocks where billows roll.

2.

Fortune! take back these cultur'd lands,
Take back this name of splendid sound!
I hate the touch of servile hands,
I hate the slaves that cringe around:
Place me among the rocks I love,
Which sound to Ocean's wildest roar;
I ask but this--again to rove
Through scenes my youth hath known before.

3.

Few are my years, and yet I feel
The World was ne'er design'd for me:
Ah! why do dark'ning shades conceal
The hour when man must cease to be?
Once I beheld a splendid dream,
A visionary scene of bliss:
Truth!--wherefore did thy hated beam
Awake me to a world like this?

4.

I lov'd--but those I lov'd are gone;
Had friends--my early friends are fled:
How cheerless feels the heart alone,
When all its former hopes are dead!
Though gay companions, o'er the bowl
Dispel awhile the sense of ill;
Though Pleasure stirs the maddening soul,
The heart--the heart--is lonely still.

5.

How dull! to hear the voice of those
Whom Rank or Chance, whom Wealth or Power,
Have made, though neither friends nor foes,
Associates of the festive hour.
Give me again a faithful few,
In years and feelings still the same,
And I will fly the midnight crew,
Where boist'rous Joy is but a name.

6.

And Woman, lovely Woman! thou,
My hope, my comforter, my all!
How cold must be my bosom now,
When e'en thy smiles begin to pall!
Without a sigh would I resign,
This busy scene of splendid Woe,
To make that calm contentment mine,
Which Virtue knows, or seems to know.

7.

Fain would I fly the haunts of men²--
I seek to shun, not hate mankind;
My breast requires the sullen glen,
Whose gloom may suit a darken'd mind.
Oh! that to me the wings were given,
Which bear the turtle to her nest!
Then would I cleave the vault of Heaven,
To flee away, and be at rest³.

Footnote 1: Ý Sassenach, or
Saxon, a Gaelic word, signifying
either Lowland or English.

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Footnote a:Ý

Stanzas...

[Poems O. and T.]

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Footnote 2: Ý Shyness was a
family characteristic of the
Byrons. The poet continued in
later years to have a horror of
being observed by unaccustomed
eyes, and in the country would, if
possible, avoid meeting strangers

on the road.

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Footnote 3: Ý

"And I said, O that I had
wings like a dove, for then
would I fly away, and be at
rest."

(Psalm iv. 6.) This verse also
constitutes a part of the most
beautiful anthem in our language.

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Lines Written beneath an Elm in the Churchyard of Harrow^a [1](#)

Spot of my youth! whose hoary branches sigh,
Swept by the breeze that fans thy cloudless sky;
Where now alone I muse, who oft have trod,
With those I loved, thy soft and verdant sod;
With those who, scatter'd far, perchance deplore,
Like me, the happy scenes they knew before:
Oh! as I trace again thy winding hill,
Mine eyes admire, my heart adores thee still,
Thou drooping Elm! beneath whose boughs I lay,
And frequent mus'd the twilight hours away;

Where, as they once were wont, my limbs recline,
But, ah! without the thoughts which then were mine:
How do thy branches, moaning to the blast,
Invite the bosom to recall the past,
And seem to whisper, as they gently swell,
"Take, while thou canst, a lingering, last farewell!"

When Fate shall chill, at length, this fever'd breast,
And calm its cares and passions into rest,
Oft have I thought, 'twould soothe my dying hour,--
If aught may soothe, when Life resigns her power,--
To know some humbler grave, some narrow cell,
Would hide my bosom where it lov'd to dwell;
With this fond dream, methinks 'twere sweet to die--
And here it linger'd, here my heart might lie;
Here might I sleep where all my hopes arose,
Scene of my youth, and couch of my repose;
For ever stretch'd beneath this mantling shade,
Press'd by the turf where once my childhood play'd;
Wrapt by the soil that veils the spot I lov'd,
Mix'd with the earth o'er which my footsteps mov'd;
Blest by the tongues that charm'd my youthful ear,
Mourn'd by the few my soul acknowledged here;
Deplor'd by those in early days allied,
And unremember'd by the world beside.

September 2, 1807.

Footnote 1: Ý On the death of his daughter, Allegra, in April, 1822, Byron sent her remains to be buried at Harrow, "where," he says, in a letter to Murray, "I once hoped to have laid my own." "There is," he wrote, May 26, "a

Footnote a:Ý

*Lines written beneath an Elm
In the Churchyard of Harrow
on the Hill
September 2, 1807...*

spot in the churchyard, near the footpath, on the brow of the hill looking towards Windsor, and a tomb under a large tree (bearing the name of Peachie, or Peachey), where I used to sit for hours and hours when a boy. This was my favourite spot; but as I wish to erect a tablet to her memory, the body had better be deposited in the *church*." No tablet was, however, erected, and Allegra sleeps in her unmarked grave inside the church, a few feet to the right of the entrance.

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[*Poems O. and T.*]

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Early Poems from Various Sources

Fragment, Written Shortly after the Marriage of Miss Chaworth¹

First published in Moore's *Letters and Journals of Lord Byron*, 1830, i. 56

1.

Hills of Annesley, Bleak and Barren,
Where my thoughtless Childhood stray'd,
How the northern Tempests, warring,
Howl above thy tufted Shade!

2.

Now no more, the Hours beguiling,
Former favourite Haunts I see;
Now no more my Mary smiling,
Makes ye seem a Heaven to Me.

1805.

Footnote 1: Miss Chaworth was married to John Musters, Esq., in August, 1805. The stanzas were first published in Moore's *Letters and Journals of Lord Byron*, 1830, i. 56. (See, too, *The Dream*, st. ii. 1. 9.) The original MS. (which is in the possession of Mrs. Chaworth Musters) formerly belonged to Miss E. B. Pigot, according to whom they "were written by Lord Byron in 1804." "We were reading Burns' *Farewell to Ayrshire*--

Scenes of woe and Scenes of pleasure
Scenes that former thoughts renew
Scenes of woe and scenes of pleasure
Now a sad and last adieu, etc.

when he said, ' I like that metre; let me try it,' and taking up a pencil, wrote those on the other side in an instant. I read them to Moore, and at his particular request I copied them for him."-E. B. Pigot, 1859.

On the fly-leaf of the same volume (*Poetry of Robert Burns*, vol. iv. Third Edition, 1802), containing the *Farewell to Ayrshire*, Byron wrote in pencil the two stanzas "Oh! little lock of golden hue," in 1806 (*vide post*, p. 233).

It may be noted that the verses quoted, though included until recently among his poems, were not written by Burns, but by Richard Gall, who died in 1801, aged 25.

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Remembrance

First published in *Works of Lord Byron*, 1832, vii. 152.

'Tis done!--I saw it in my dreams:
No more with Hope the future beams;
My days of happiness are few:
Chill'd by Misfortune's wintry blast,
My dawn of Life is overcast;
Love, Hope, and Joy, alike adieu!
Would I could add Remembrance too!

1806. [First published, 1832.]

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To a Lady Who Presented the Author with the Velvet Band which bound her Tresses.

***Works*, 1832, vii. 151.**

1.

This Band, which bound thy yellow hair
Is mine, sweet girl! thy pledge of love;
It claims my warmest, dearest care,
Like relics left of saints above.

2.

Oh! I will wear it next my heart;
'Twill bind my soul in bonds to thee:
From me again 'twill ne'er depart,
But mingle in the grave with me.

3.

The dew I gather from thy lip
Is not so dear to me as this;
That I but for a moment sip,
And banquet on a transient bliss^a:

4.

This will recall each youthful scene,
E'en when our lives are on the wane;
The leaves of Love will still be green
When Memory bids them bud again.

1806. [First published, 1832.]

Footnote a: ^Ý

on a transient kiss...

[MS. Newstead]

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To a Knot of Ungenerous Critics¹

MS. Newstead

Rail on, Rail on, ye heartless crew!
My strains were never meant for you;
Remorseless Rancour still reveal,
And damn the verse you cannot feel.
Invoke those kindred passions' aid,
Whose baleful stings your breasts pervade;
Crush, if you can, the hopes of youth,
Trampling regardless on the Truth:
Truth's Records you consult in vain,
She will not blast her native strain;
She will assist her votary's cause,
His will at least be her applause,
Your prayer the gentle Power will spurn;
To Fiction's motley altar turn,
Who joyful in the fond address
Her favoured worshippers will bless:
And lo! she holds a magic glass,
Where Images reflected pass,
Bent on your knees the Boon receive--
This will assist you to deceive--
The glittering gift was made for you,

Now hold it up to public view;
Lest evil unforeseen betide,
A Mask each canker'd brow shall hide,
(Whilst Truth my sole desire is nigh,
Prepared the danger to defy,)
"There is the Maid's perverted name,
And there the Poet's guilty Flame,
Gloaming a deep phosphoric fire,
Threatening--but ere it spreads, retire.
Says Truth Up Virgins, do not fear!
The Comet rolls its Influence here;
'Tis Scandal's Mirror you perceive,
These dazzling Meteors but deceive--
Approach and touch--Nay do not turn
It blazes there, but will not burn."--
At once the shivering Mirror flies,
Teeming no more with varnished Lies;
The baffled friends of Fiction start,
Too late desiring to depart--
Truth poisoning high Ithuriel's spear
Bids every Fiend unmask'd appear,
The vizard tears from every face,
And dooms them to a dire disgrace.
For e'er they compass their escape,
Each takes perforce a native shape--
The Leader of the wrathful Band,
Behold a portly Female stand!
She raves, impelled by private pique,
This mean unjust revenge to seek;
From vice to save this virtuous Age,
Thus does she vent indecent rage!
What child has she of promise fair,
Who claims a fostering Mother's care?
Whose Innocence requires defence,
Or forms at least a smooth pretence,
Thus to disturb a harmless Boy,
His humble hope, and peace annoy?

She need not fear the amorous rhyme,
Love will not tempt her future time,
For her his wings have ceased to spread,
No more he flutters round her head;
Her day's Meridian now is past,
The clouds of Age her Sun o'ercast;
To her the strain was never sent,
For feeling Souls alone 'twas meant--
The verse she seized, unask'd, unbade,
And damn'd, ere yet the whole was read!
Yes! for one single erring verse,
Pronounced an unrelenting Curse;
Yes! at a first and transient view,
Condemned a heart she never knew.--
Can such a verdict then decide,
Which springs from disappointed pride?
Without a wondrous share of Wit,
To judge is such a Matron fit?
The rest of the censorious throng
Who to this zealous Band belong,
To her a general homage pay,
And right or wrong her wish obey:
Why should I point my pen of steel
To break "such flies upon the wheel?"
With minds to Truth and Sense unknown,
Who dare not call their words their own.
Rail on, Rail on, ye heartless Crew!
Your Leader's grand design pursue:
Secure behind her ample shield,
Yours is the harvest of the field.--
My path with thorns you cannot strew,
Nay more, my warmest thanks are due;
When such as you revile my Name,
Bright beams the rising Sun of Fame,
Chasing the shades of envious night,
Outshining every critic Light.--
Such, such as you will serve to show

Each radiant tint with higher glow.
Vain is the feeble cheerless toil,
Your efforts on yourselves recoil;
Then Glory still for me you raise,
Yours is the Censure, mine the Praise.

Byron,

December 1, 1806.

Footnote 1: Ý From an autograph MS. at Newstead, now for the first time printed.

There can be little doubt that these verses were called forth by the criticisms passed on the "Fugitive Pieces" by certain ladies of Southwell, concerning whom, Byron wrote to Mr. Pigot (Jan. 13, 1807), on sending him an early copy of the *Poems*,

"That *unlucky* poem to my poor Mary has been the cause of some animadversion from *ladies in years*. I have not printed it in this collection in consequence of my being pronounced a most *profligate sinner*, in short a '*young Moore*'"

--*Life*, p. 41.

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Soliloquy of a Bard in the Country¹

MS. Newstead

'Twas now the noon of night, and all was still,
Except a hapless Rhymer and his quill.
In vain he calls each Muse in order down,
Like other females, these will sometimes frown;
He frets, he fumes, and ceasing to invoke
The Nine, in anguish'd accents thus he spoke:
Ah what avails it thus to waste my time,
To roll in Epic, or to rave in Rhyme?
What worth is some few partial readers' praise.
If ancient Virgins croaking *censures* raise?
Where few attend, 'tis useless to indite;
Where few can read, 'tis folly sure to write;
Where none but girls and striplings dare admire,
And Critics rise in every country Squire--
But yet this last my candid Muse admits,
When Peers are Poets, Squires may well be Wits;
When schoolboys vent their amorous flames in verse,
Matrons may sure their characters asperse;
And if a little parson joins the train,
And echos back his Patron's voice again--
Though not delighted, yet I must forgive,
Parsons as well as other folks must live:--
From rage he rails not, rather say from dread,
He does not speak for Virtue, but for bread;
And this we know is in his Patron's giving,
For Parsons cannot eat without a *Living*.
The Matron knows I love the Sex too well,
Even unprovoked aggression to repel.

What though from private pique her anger grew,
And bade her blast a heart she never knew?
What though, she said, for one light heedless line,
That Wilmot's² verse was far more pure than mine!
In wars like these, I neither fight nor fly,
When *dames* accuse 'tis bootless to deny;
Her's be the harvest of the martial field,
I can't attack, where Beauty forms the shield.
But when a pert Physician loudly cries,
Who hunts for scandal, and who lives by lies,
A walking register of daily news,
Train'd to invent, and skilful to abuse--
For arts like these at bounteous tables fed,
When S—— condemns a book he never read.
Declaring with a coxcomb's native air,
The *moral's* shocking, though the *rhymes* are fair.
Ah! must he rise unpunish'd from the feast,
Nor lash'd by vengeance into truth at least?
Such lenity were more than Man's indeed!
Those who condemn, should surely deign to read.
Yet must I spare--nor thus my pen degrade,
I quite forgot that scandal was his trade.
For food and raiment thus the coxcomb rails,
For those who fear his physic, like his *tales*.
Why should his harmless censure seem offence?
Still let him eat, although at my expense,
And join the herd to Sense and Truth unknown,
Who dare not call their very thoughts their own,
And share with these applause, a godlike bribe,
In short, do anything, except *prescribe*--
For though in garb of Galen he appears,
His practice is not equal to his years.
Without improvement since he first began,
A young Physician, though an ancient Man--
Now let me cease--Physician, Parson, Dame,
Still urge your task, and if you can, defame.
The humble offerings of my Muse destroy,

And crush, oh! noble conquest! crush a Boy.
What though some silly girls have lov'd the strain,
And kindly bade me tune my Lyre again;
What though some feeling, or some partial few,
Nay, Men of Taste and Reputation too,
Have deign'd to praise the firstlings of my Muse--
If *you* your sanction to the theme refuse,
If *you* your great protection still withdraw,
Whose Praise is Glory, and whose Voice is law!
Soon must I fall an unresisting foe,
A hapless victim yielding to the blow.--
Thus Pope by Curl and Dennis was destroyed,
Thus Gray and Mason yield to furious Lloyd³;
From Dryden, Milbourne⁴ tears the palm away,
And thus I fall, though meaner far than they.
As in the field of combat, side by side,
A Fabius and some noble Roman died.

Dec. 1806.

Footnote 1: Ý From an autograph MS. at Newstead, now for the first time printed.

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Footnote 2: Ý John Wilmot, Earl of Rochester (1647-1680). His *Poems* were published in the year of his death.

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Footnote 3: Ý Robert Lloyd (1733-1764). The following lines occur in

the first of two odes to *Obscurity and Oblivion*--parodies of the odes of Gray and Mason:--

"Heard ye the din of modern rhymers bray?
It was cool M----n and warm G----y,
Involv'd in tenfold smoke."

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Footnote 4: Ý The Rev. Luke Milbourne (died 1720) published, in 1698, his *Notes on Dryden's Virgil*, containing a venomous attack on Dryden. They are alluded to in *The Dunciad*, and also by Dr. Johnson, who wrote (*Life of Dryden*),

"His outrages seem to be the ebullitions of a mind agitated by stronger resentment than bad poetry can excite."

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L'Amitié est L'Amour sans Ailes¹

Works, 1832, vii. 161

1.

Why should my anxious breast repine,
Because my youth is fled?

Days of delight may still be mine;
Affection is not dead.
In tracing back the years of youth,
One firm record, one lasting truth
Celestial consolation brings;
Bear it, ye breezes, to the seat,
Where first my heart responsive beat,--
"Friendship is Love without his wings!"

2

Through few, but deeply chequer'd years,
What moments have been mine!
Now half obscured by clouds of tears,
Now bright in rays divine;
Howe'er my future doom be cast,
My soul, enraptured with the past,
To one idea fondly clings;
Friendship! that thought is all thine own,
Worth worlds of bliss, that thought alone--
"Friendship is Love without his wings!"

3

Where yonder yew-trees lightly wave
Their branches on the gale,
Unheeded heaves a simple grave,
Which tells the common tale;
Round this unconscious schoolboys stray,
Till the dull knell of childish play
From yonder studious mansion rings;
But here, whene'er my footsteps move,
My silent tears too plainly prove,
"Friendship is Love without his wings!"

4

Oh, Love! before thy glowing shrine,
My early vows were paid;
My hopes, my dreams, my heart was thine,
But these are now decay'd;
For thine are pinions like the wind,
No trace of thee remains behind,
Except, alas! thy jealous stings.
Away, away! delusive power,
Thou shalt not haunt my coming hour;
Unless, indeed, without thy wings.

5

Seat of my youth²! thy distant spire
Recalls each scene of joy;
My bosom glows with former fire,--
In mind again a boy.
Thy grove of elms, thy verdant hill,
Thy every path delights me still,
Each flower a double fragrance flings;
Again, as once, in converse gay,
Each dear associate seems to say,
"Friendship is Love without his wings!"

6.

My Lycus³! wherefore dost thou weep?
Thy falling tears restrain;
Affection for a time may sleep,
But, oh, 'twill wake again.
Think, think, my friend, when next we meet,
Our long-wished interview, how sweet!

From this my hope of rapture springs;
While youthful hearts thus fondly swell,
Absence my friend, can only tell,
"Friendship is Love without his wings!"

7.

In one, and one alone deceiv'd,
Did I my error mourn?
No--from oppressive bonds reliev'd,
I left the wretch to scorn.
I turn'd to those my childhood knew,
With feelings warm, with bosoms true,
Twin'd with my heart's according strings;
And till those vital chords shall break,
For none but these my breast shall wake
Friendship, the power deprived of wings!

8

Ye few! my soul, my life is yours,
My memory and my hope;
Your worth a lasting love insures,
Unfetter'd in its scope;
From smooth deceit and terror sprung,
With aspect fair and honey'd tongue,
Let Adulation wait on kings;
With joy elate, by snares beset,
We, we, my friends, can ne'er forget,
"Friendship is Love without his wings!"

9

Fictions and dreams inspire the bard,

Who rolls the epic song;
Friendship and truth be my reward--
To me no bays belong;
If laurell'd Fame but dwells with lies,
Me the enchantress ever flies,
Whose heart and not whose fancy sings;
Simple and young, I dare not feign;
Mine be the rude yet heartfelt strain,
"Friendship is Love without his wings!"

December 29, 1806. [First published, 1832.]

Footnote 1: Ý The MS. is preserved at Newstead.
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Footnote 2: Ý Harrow.
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Footnote 3: Ý Lord Clare had written to Byron,

"I think by your last letter that you are very much piqued with most of your friends, and, if I am not much mistaken, a little so with me. In one part you say,

'There is little or no doubt a few years or months will render us as politely indifferent to each other, as if we had never passed a portion of our time together.'

Indeed, Byron, you wrong me; and I have no doubt, at least I hope, you are wrong yourself."

Life, p. 25.

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The Prayer of Nature¹

Letters and Journals, 1830, i. 106

1

Father of Light! great God of Heaven!
Hear'st thou the accents of despair?
Can guilt like man's be e'er forgiven?
Can vice atone for crimes by prayer?

2

Father of Light, on thee I call!
Thou see'st my soul is dark within;
Thou, who canst mark the sparrow's fall,
Avert from me the death of sin.

3

No shrine I seek, to sects unknown;
Oh, point to me the path of truth!
Thy dread Omnipotence I own;
Spare, yet amend, the faults of youth.

4

Let bigots rear a gloomy fane,
Let Superstition hail the pile,
Let priests, to spread their sable reign,
With tales of mystic rites beguile.

5

Shall man confine his Maker's sway
To Gothic domes of mouldering stone?
Thy temple is the face of day;
Earth, Ocean, Heaven thy boundless throne.

6

Shall man condemn his race to Hell,
Unless they bend in pompous form?
Tell us that all, for one who fell,
Must perish in the mingling storm?

7

Shall each pretend to reach the skies,
Yet doom his brother to expire,
Whose soul a different hope supplies,
Or doctrines less severe inspire?

8

Shall these, by creeds they can't expound,
Prepare a fancied bliss or woe?
Shall reptiles, groveling on the ground,
Their great Creator's purpose know?

9

Shall those, who live for self alone^a,
Whose years float on in daily crime--
Shall they, by Faith, for guilt atone,
And live beyond the bounds of Time?

10

Father! no prophet's laws I seek,--
Thy laws in Nature's works appear;--
I own myself corrupt and weak,
Yet will I *pray*, for thou wilt hear!

11

Thou, who canst guide the wandering star,
Through trackless realms of aether's space;
Who calm'st the elemental war,
Whose hand from pole to pole I trace:

12

Thou, who in wisdom plac'd me here,
Who, when thou wilt, canst take me hence,

Ah! whilst I tread this earthly sphere,
Extend to me thy wide defence.

13

To Thee, my God, to thee I call!
Whatever weal or woe betide,
By thy command I rise or fall,
In thy protection I confide.

14.

If, when this dust to dust's restor'd,
My soul shall float on airy wing,
How shall thy glorious Name ador'd
Inspire her feeble voice to sing!

15

But, if this fleeting spirit share
With clay the Grave's eternal bed,
While Life yet throbs I raise my prayer,
Though doom'd no more to quit the dead.

16

To Thee I breathe my humble strain,
Grateful for all thy mercies past,
And hope, my God, to thee again^b
This erring life may fly at last.

December 29, 1806.

Footnote 1:  These stanzas were first published in Moore's *Letters and Journals of Lord Byron*, 1830, i. 106.

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Footnote a: 

*Shalt these who live for self
alone,
Whose years fleet on in daily
crime--
Shall these by Faith for guilt
atone,
Exist beyond the bounds of
Time?*

[MS. Newstead]

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Footnote b: 

*My hope, my God, in thee
again
This erring life will fly at last.
...*

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Translation from Anacreon¹. Ode 5.

Εἰς ῥόδον.

Mingle with the genial bowl
The Rose, the *flow'ret* of the Soul,
The Rose and Grape together quaff'd,
How doubly sweet will be the draught!
With Roses crown our jovial brows,
While every cheek with Laughter glows;
While Smiles and Songs, with Wine incite,
To wing our moments with Delight.
Rose by far the fairest birth,
Which Spring and Nature cull from Earth--
Rose whose sweetest perfume given,
Breathes our thoughts from Earth to Heaven.
Rose whom the Deities above,
From Jove to Hebe, dearly love,
When Cytherea's blooming Boy,
Flies lightly through the dance of Joy,
With him the Graces then combine,
And rosy wreaths their locks entwine.
Then will I sing divinely crown'd,
With dusky leaves my temples bound--
Lyæus! in thy bowers of pleasure,
I'll wake a wildly thrilling measure.
There will my gentle Girl and I,
Along the mazes sportive fly,
Will bend before thy potent throne--
Rose, Wine, and Beauty, all my own.

1805.

Footnote 1: Ý From an autograph MS. at Newstead, now for the first time printed.

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Ossian's Address to the Sun in *Carthon*¹

Oh! thou that roll'st above thy glorious Fire,
Round as the shield which grac'd my godlike Sire,
Whence are the beams, O Sun! thy endless blaze,
Which far eclipse each minor Glory's rays?
Forth in thy Beauty here thou deign'st to shine!
Night quits her car, the twinkling stars decline;
Pallid and cold the Moon descends to cave
Her sinking beams beneath the Western wave;
But thou still mov'st alone, of light the Source--
Who can o'ertake thee in thy fiery course?
Oaks of the mountains fall, the rocks decay,
Weighed down with years the hills dissolve away.
A certain space to yonder Moon is given,
She rises, smiles, and then is lost in Heaven.
Ocean in sullen murmurs ebbs and flows,
But thy bright beam unchanged for ever glows!
When Earth is darkened with tempestuous skies,
When Thunder shakes the sphere and Lightning flies,
Thy face, O Sun, no rolling blasts deform,
Thou look'st from clouds and laughest at the Storm.

To Ossian, Orb of Light! thou look'st in vain,
Nor canst thou glad his aged eyes again,
Whether thy locks in Orient Beauty stream,
Or glimmer through the West with fainter gleam--
But thou, perhaps, like me with age must bend;
Thy season o'er, thy days will find their end,
No more yon azure vault with rays adorn,
Lull'd in the clouds, nor hear the voice of Morn.
Exult, O Sun, in all thy youthful strength!
Age, dark unlovely Age, appears at length,
As gleams the moonbeam through the broken cloud
While mountain vapours spread their misty shroud--
The Northern tempest howls along at last,
And wayworn strangers shrink amid the blast.
Thou rolling Sun who gild'st those rising towers,
Fair didst thou shine upon my earlier hours!
I hail'd with smiles the cheering rays of Morn,
My breast by no tumultuous Passion torn--
Now hateful are thy beams which wake no more
The sense of joy which thrill'd my breast before;
Welcome thou cloudy veil of nightly skies,
To thy bright canopy the mourner flies:
Once bright, thy Silence lull'd my frame to rest,
And Sleep my soul with gentle visions blest;
Now wakeful Grief disdains her mild controul,
Dark is the night, but darker is my Soul.
Ye warring Winds of Heav'n your fury urge,
To me congenial sounds your wintry Dirge:
Swift as your wings my happier days have past,
Keen as your storms is Sorrow's chilling blast;
To Tempests thus expos'd my Fate has been,
Piercing like yours, like yours, alas! unseen.
1805.

Footnote 1: Ý From an autograph MS. at Newstead, now for the first

time printed. (See *Ossian's Poems*, London, 1819, pp. xvii. 119.)
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Pignus Amoris¹

1.

As by the fix'd decrees of Heaven,
'Tis vain to hope that Joy can last;
The dearest boon that Life has given,
To me is--visions of the past.

2.

For these this toy of blushing hue
I prize with zeal before unknown,
It tells me of a Friend I knew,
Who loved me for myself alone.

3.

It tells me what how few can say
Though all the social tie commend;
Recorded in my heart 'twill lay²,
I tells me mine was once a Friend.

4.

Through many a weary day gone by,
With time the gift is dearer grown;
And still I view in Memory's eye
That teardrop sparkle through my own.

5.

And heartless Age perhaps will smile,
Or wonder whence those feelings sprung;
Yet let not sterner souls revile,
For Both were open, Both were young.

6.

And Youth is sure the only time,
When Pleasure blends no base alloy;
When Life is blest without a crime,
And Innocence resides with Joy.

7

Let those reprove my feeble Soul,
Who laugh to scorn Affection's name;
While these impose a harsh controul,
All will forgive who feel the same.

8

Then still I wear my simple toy,
With pious care from wreck I'll save it;

And this will form a dear employ
For dear I was to him who gave it.

? 1806.

Footnote 1: Ý From an autograph MS. at Newstead, now for the first time printed.

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Footnote 2: Ý For the irregular use of "lay" for "lie," compare [The Adieu](#) (st. 10, l. 4, p. 241), and the much-disputed line, "And dashest him to earth--there let him lay" (*Childe Harold*, canto iv. st. 180).

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[A Woman's Hair](#)¹

Works, 1832, vii. 151

Oh! little lock of golden hue
In gently waving ringlet curl'd,
By the dear head on which you grew,
I would not lose you for *a world*.

Not though a thousand more adorn
The polished brow where once you shone,
Like rays which guild a cloudless sky^a
Beneath Columbia's fervid zone.

1806.

Footnote 1: Ý These lines are preserved in MS. at Newstead, with the following memorandum in Miss Pigot's handwriting: "Copied from the fly-leaf in a vol. of my Burns' books, which is written in pencil by himself." They have hitherto been printed as stanzas 5 and 6 of the lines "[To a Lady,](#)" etc., p. 212.
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Footnote a:Ý
a cloudless morn...

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Stanzas to Jessy^{[1](#)}

Monthly Literary Recreations, July, 1807

1

There is a mystic thread of life
So dearly wreath'd with mine alone,
That Destiny's relentless knife
At once must sever both, or none.

2

There is a Form on which these eyes
Have fondly gazed with such delight--
By day, that Form their joy supplies,
And Dreams restore it, through the night.

3

There is a Voice whose tones inspire
Such softened feelings in my breast^a--
I would not hear a Seraph Choir,
Unless that voice could join the rest.

4

There is a Face whose Blushes tell
Affection's tale upon the cheek,
But pallid at our fond farewell,
Proclaims more love than words can speak.

5

There is a Lip, which mine has prest,
But none had ever prest before;
It vowed to make me sweetly blest,
That mine alone should press it more^b.

6

There is a Bosom all my own,
Has pillow'd oft this aching head,
A Mouth which smiles on me alone,
An Eye, whose tears with mine are shed.

7

There are two Hearts whose movements thrill,
In unison so closely sweet,
That Pulse to Pulse responsive still
They Both must heave, or cease to beat.

8

There are two Souls, whose equal flow
In gentle stream so calmly run,
That when they part--they part?--ah no!
They cannot part--those Souls are One.

[George Gordon, Lord] Byron.

Footnote 1: Ý "Stanzas to Jessy" **Footnote a:**Ý
have often been printed, but were

never acknowledged by Byron, or included in any authorized edition of his works. They are, however, unquestionably genuine. They appeared first in *Monthly Literary Recreations* (July, 1807), a magazine published by B. Crosby & Co., Stationers' Court. Crosby was London agent for Ridge, the Newark bookseller, and, with Longman and others, "sold" the recently issued *Hours of Idleness*. The same number of *Monthly Literary Recreations* (for July, 1807) contains Byron's review of Wordsworth's *Poems* (2 vols., 1807), and a highly laudatory notice of *Hours of Idleness*. The lines are headed "Stanzas to Jessy," and are signed "George Gordon, Lord Byron." They were republished in 1824, by Knight and Lacy, in vol. v. of the three supplementary volumes of the *Works*, and again in the same year by John Bumpus and A. Griffin, in their *Miscellaneous Poems*, etc. A note which is prefixed to these issues, "The following stanzas were addressed by Lord Byron to his Lady, a few months before their separation," and three variants in the text, make it unlikely that the pirating editors were acquainted with the text of the magazine. The MS. (British Museum, Eg. MSS. No. 2332) is

Such thrills of Rapture...

[Knight and Lacy, 1824, v. 56.]

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signed "George Gordon, Lord Byron," but the words "George Gordon, Lord" are in another hand, and were probably added by Crosby. The following letter (together with a wrapper addressed, "Mr. Crosby, Stationers' Court," and sealed in red wax with Byron's arms and coronet) is attached to the poem:--

July 21, 1807.

Sir,

I have sent according to my promise some Stanzas for Literary Recreations. The insertion I leave to the option of the Editors. They have never appeared before. I should wish to know whether they are admitted or not, and when the work will appear, as I am desirous of a copy.

Etc., etc., Byron.

P.S.--Send your answer when convenient."

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Footnote b:Ý

And mine, mine only...

[Knight and Lacy, v. 56.]
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The Adieu

Works, 1832, vii. 195

written under the impression that the author would soon die.

1.

Adieu, thou Hill¹! where early joy
Spread roses o'er my brow;
Where Science seeks each loitering boy
With knowledge to endow.
Adieu, my youthful friends or foes,
Partners of former bliss or woes;
No more through Ida's paths we stray;
Soon must I share the gloomy cell,
Whose ever-slumbering inmates dwell
Unconscious of the day.

2.

Adieu, ye hoary Regal Fanes^a,

Ye spires of Granta's vale,
Where Learning robed in sable reigns.
And Melancholy pale.
Ye comrades of the jovial hour,
Ye tenants of the classic bower,
On Cama's verdant margin plac'd,
Adieu! while memory still is mine,
For offerings on Oblivion's shrine,
These scenes must be effac'd.

3

Adieu, ye mountains of the clime
Where grew my youthful years;
Where Loch na Garr in snows sublime
His giant summit rears.
Why did my childhood wander forth
From you, ye regions of the North,
With sons of Pride to roam?
Why did I quit my Highland cave,
Marr's dusky heath, and Dee's clear wave,
To seek a Sotheron home?

4

Hall of my Sires! a long farewell-
Yet why to thee adieu?
Thy vaults will echo back my knell,
Thy towers my tomb will view:
The faltering tongue which sung thy fall,
And former glories of thy Hall,
Forgets its wonted simple note--
But yet the Lyre retains the strings,
And sometimes, on Æolian wings,
In dying strains may float.

5.

Fields, which surround yon rustic cot²,
While yet I linger here,
Adieu! you are not now forgot,
To retrospection dear.
Streamlet³! along whose rippling surge
My youthful limbs were wont to urge,
At noontide heat, their pliant course;
Plunging with ardour from the shore,
Thy springs will lave these limbs no more,
Deprived of active force.

6.

And shall I here forget the scene,
Still nearest to my breast?
Rocks rise and rivers roll between
The spot which passion blest;
Yet Mary⁴, all thy beauties seem
Fresh as in Love's bewitching dream,
To me in smiles display'd;
Till slow disease resigns his prey
To Death, the parent of decay,
Thine image cannot fade.

7.

And thou, my Friend! whose gentle love
Yet thrills my bosom's chords,
How much thy friendship was above
Description's power of words!
Still near my breast thy gift⁵ I wear^b

Which sparkled once with Feeling's tear,
Of Love the pure, the sacred gem:
Our souls were equal, and our lot
In that dear moment quite forgot;
Let Pride alone condemn!

8.

All, all is dark and cheerless now!
No smile of Love's deceit
Can warm my veins with wonted glow,
Can bid Life's pulses beat:
Not e'en the hope of future fame
Can wake my faint, exhausted frame,
Or crown with fancied wreaths my head.
Mine is a short inglorious race,--
To humble in the dust my face,
And mingle with the dead.

9.

Oh Fame! thou goddess of my heart;
On him who gains thy praise,
Pointless must fall the Spectre's dart,
Consumed in Glory's blaze;
But me she beckons from the earth,
My name obscure, unmark'd my birth,
My life a short and vulgar dream:
Lost in the dull, ignoble crowd,
My hopes recline within a shroud,
My fate is Lethe's stream.

10.

When I repose beneath the sod,
Unheeded in the clay,
Where once my playful footsteps trod,
Where now my head must lay⁶,
The meed of Pity will be shed
In dew-drops o'er my narrow bed,
By nightly skies, and storms alone;
No mortal eye will deign to steep
With tears the dark sepulchral deep
Which hides a name unknown.

11.

Forget this world, my restless sprite,
Turn, turn thy thoughts to Heaven:
There must thou soon direct thy flight,
If errors are forgiven.
To bigots and to sects unknown,
Bow down beneath the Almighty's Throne;
To Him address thy trembling prayer:
He, who is merciful and just,
Will not reject a child of dust,
Although His meanest care.

12.

Father of Light! to Thee I call;
My soul is dark within:
Thou who canst mark the sparrow's fall,
Avert the death of sin.
Thou, who canst guide the wandering star
Who calm'st the elemental war,
Whose mantle is yon boundless sky,
My thoughts, my words, my crimes forgive;
And, since I soon must cease to live,

Instruct me how to die^c.

1807. [First published, 1832.]

Footnote 1: Ý Harrow
[return to footnote mark](#)

Footnote 2: Ý Mrs. Pigot's
Cottage.
[return](#)

Footnote 3: Ý The river Grete, at
Southwell.
[return](#)

Footnote 4: Ý Mary Chaworth.
[return](#)

Footnote 5: Ý Compare the verses
on "[The Cornelian](#)," p. 66, and
"[Pignus Amoris](#)," p. 231.
[return to this poem](#)

Footnote 6: Ý See [note](#) to "Pignus
Amoris," st. 3, l. 3, p. 232.
[return to this poem](#)

Footnote a: Ý

--ye regal Towers...

[MS. Newstead.]

[return](#)

Footnote b: Ý

The gift I wear...

[MS. Newstead.]

[return](#)

Footnote c: Ý

*And since I must forbear to
live,
Instruct me how to die.*

[MS. Newstead]

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[cross-reference: return to footnote of "Pignus Amoris"](#)

To—1

1.

Oh! well I know your subtle Sex,
Frail daughters of the wanton Eve,--
While jealous pangs our Souls perplex,
No passion prompts you to relieve.

2

From Love, or Pity ne'er you fall,
By *you*, no mutual Flame is felt,
"Tis Vanity, which rules you all,
Desire alone which makes you melt.

3

I will not say no *souls* are yours,
Aye, ye have Souls, and dark ones too,
Souls to contrive those smiling lures,
To snare our simple hearts for you.

4

Yet shall you never bind me fast,
Long to adore such brittle toys,
I'll rove along, from first to last,
And change whene'er my fancy cloy.

5

Oh! I should be a *baby* fool,
To sigh the dupe of female art--
Woman! perhaps thou hast a *Soul*,
But where have *Demons* hid thy *Heart*?

January, 1807.

Footnote 1: Ý From an autograph MS. at Newstead, now for the first time printed.

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On the Eyes of Miss A—— H——1

Anne's Eye is liken'd to the *Sun*,
From it such Beams of Beauty fall;
And *this* can be denied by none,
For like the *Sun*, it shines on *All*.
Then do not admiration smother,
Or say these glances don't become her;
To *you*, or *I*, or *any other*
Her *Sun*, displays perpetual Summer².

January 14, 1807.

Footnote 1: Ý Miss Anne Houson. From an autograph MS. at Newstead, now for the first time printed.

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Footnote 2: Ý Compare, for the same simile, the lines "[To Edward Noel Long, Esq.](#)", p. 187, *ante*.

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To a Vain Lady¹

1

Ah, heedless girl! why thus disclose
What ne'er was meant for other ears;
Why thus destroy thine own repose,
And dig the source of future tears?

2

Oh, thou wilt weep, imprudent maid,
While lurking envious foes will smile,
For all the follies thou hast said
Of those who spoke but to beguile.

3

Vain girl! thy lingering woes are nigh,
If thou believ'st what striplings say:
Oh, from the deep temptation fly,
Nor fall the specious spoiler's prey.

4

Dost thou repeat, in childish boast,
The words man utters to deceive?
Thy peace, thy hope, thy all is lost,
If thou canst venture to believe.

5

While now amongst thy female peers
Thou tell'st again the soothing tale,
Canst thou not mark the rising sneers
Duplicity in vain would veil?

6

These tales in secret silence hush,
Nor make thyself the public gaze:

What modest maid without a blush
Recounts a flattering coxcomb's praise?

7.

Will not the laughing boy despise
Her who relates each fond conceit--
Who, thinking Heaven is in her eyes,
Yet cannot see the slight deceit?

8.

For she who takes a soft delight
These amorous nothings in revealing,
Must credit all we say or write,
While vanity prevents concealing.

9.

Cease, if you prize your Beauty's reign!
No jealousy bids me reprove:
One, who is thus from nature vain,
I pity, but I cannot love.

January 15, 1807. [First published, 1832.]

Footnote 1: Ý To A Young Lady (Miss Anne Houson) whose vanity induced her to repeat the compliments paid her by some young men of her acquaintance. *MS. Newstead*.

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To Anne¹

Works, 1832, vii. 201

1.

Oh, Anne, your offences to me have been grievous:
I thought from my wrath no atonement could save you;
But Woman is made to command and deceive us--
I look'd in your face, and I almost forgave you.

2.

I vow'd I could ne'er for a moment respect you,
Yet thought that a day's separation was long;
When we met, I determined again to suspect you--
Your smile soon convinced me *suspicion* was wrong.

3.

I swore, in a transport of young indignation,
With fervent contempt evermore to disdain you:
I saw you--my *anger* became *admiration*;
And now, all my wish, all my hope's to regain you.

4.

With beauty like yours, oh, how vain the contention!

Thus lowly I sue for forgiveness before you;--
At once to conclude such a fruitless dissension,
Be false, my sweet Anne, when I cease to adore you!

January 16, 1807. [First published, 1832.]

Footnote 1: Ý Miss Anne Houson.
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Egotism. A Letter to J.T. Becher¹

‘Εαυτὸν Βύρων αἶδει.

1.

If Fate should seal my Death to-morrow,
(Though much *I* hope she will *postpone* it,)
I've held a share *Joy* and *Sorrow*,
Enough for *Ten*; and *here* I own it.

2.

I've lived, as many others live,
And yet, I think, with more enjoyment;
For could I through my days again live,
I'd pass them in the *same* employment.

3.

That *is* to say, with *some exception*,
For though I will not make confession,
I've seen too much of man's deception
Ever again to trust profession.

4.

Some sage *Mammas* with gesture haughty,
Pronounce me quite a youthful Sinner--
But *Daughters* say, "although he's naughty,
You must not check a *Young Beginner!*"

5.

I've loved, and many damsels know it--
But whom I don't intend to mention,
As *certain stanzas* also show it,
Some say deserving Reprehension.

6.

Some ancient Dames, of virtue fiery,
(Unless Report does much belie them,)

Have lately made a sharp Enquiry,
And much it *grieves* me to *deny* them.

7.

Two whom I lov'd had *eyes* of *Blue*,
To which I hope you've no objection;
The *Rest* had eyes of *darker Hue*--
Each Nymph, of course, was *all perfection*.

8.

But here I'll close my *chaste* Description,
Nor say the deeds of animosity;
For *silence* is the best prescription,
To *physic* idle curiosity.

9.

Of *Friends* I've known a *goodly Hundred*--
For finding *one* in each acquaintance,
By *some deceived*, by others plunder'd,
Friendship, to me, was not *Repentance*.

10.

At *School* I thought like other *Children*;
Instead of *Brains*, a fine Ingredient,
Romance, my *youthful Head* bewildering,
To *Sense* had made me disobedient.

11.

A victim, *nearly* from affection,
To certain *very precious* scheming,
The still remaining recollection
Has *cured* my *boyish* soul of *Dreaming*.

12.

By Heaven! I rather would forswear
The Earth, and all the joys reserved me,
Than dare again the *specious Snare*,
From which *my Fate* and *Heaven* preserved me.

13.

Still I possess some Friends who love me--
In each a much esteemed and true one;
The Wealth of Worlds shall never move me
To quit their Friendship, for a new one.

14.

But Becher! you're a *reverend pastor*,
Now take it in consideration,
Whether for penance I should fast, or .
Pray for my *sins* in expiation.

15.

I own myself the child of *Folly*,
But not so wicked as they make me--
I soon must die of melancholy,
If *Female* smiles should e'er forsake me.

16.

*Philosophers have never doubted,
That Ladies' Lips were made for kisses!
For Love! I could not live without it,
For such a cursed place as This is.*

17.

Say, Becher, I shall be forgiven!
If you don't warrant my salvation,
I must resign all *Hopes of Heaven!*
For, *Faith*, I can't withstand Temptation.

P.S.--These were written between one and two, after *midnight*. I
have not *corrected*, or *revised*. Yours, **Byron**.

Footnote 1: Ý From an autograph MS. at Newstead, now for the first
time printed.

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To Anne¹

Works, 1832, vii. 202

1

Oh say not, sweet Anne, that the Fates have decreed
The heart which adores you should wish to dis sever;
Such Fates were to me most unkind ones indeed,--
To bear me from Love and from Beauty for ever.

2.

Your frowns, lovely girl, are the Fates which alone
Could bid me from fond admiration refrain;
By these, every hope, every wish were o'erthrown,
Till smiles should restore me to rapture again.

3.

As the ivy and oak, in the forest entwin'd,
The rage of the tempest united must weather;
My love and my life were by nature design'd
To flourish alike, or to perish together.

4.

Then say not, sweet Anne, that the Fates have decreed
Your lover should bid you a lasting adieu:
Till Fate can ordain that his bosom shall bleed,
His Soul, his Existence, are centred in you.

1807. [First published, 1832.]

Footnote 1: Ý Miss Anne Houson.
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**To the Author of a Sonnet Beginning, "'Sad is my verse,'
you say, 'and yet no tear.'"**

Works, 1832, vii. 202

1.

Thy verse is "sad" enough, no doubt:
A devilish deal more sad than witty!
Why we should weep I can't find out,
Unless for *thee* we weep in pity.

2.

Yet there is one I pity more;
And much, alas! I think he needs it:

For he, I'm sure, will suffer sore,
Who, to his own misfortune, reads it.

3.

Thy rhymes, without the aid of magic,
May *once* be read--but never after:
Yet their effect's by no means tragic,
Although by far too dull for laughter.

4.

But would you make our bosoms bleed,
And of no common pang complain--
If you would make us weep indeed,
Tell us, you'll read them o'er again.

March 8, 1807. [First published, 1832.]

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On Finding a Fan¹

Works, 1832, 203

1.

In one who felt as once he felt,
This might, perhaps, have fann'd the flame;
But now his heart no more will melt,
Because that heart is not the same.

2.

As when the ebbing flames are low,
The aid which once improved their light,
And bade them burn with fiercer glow,
Now quenches all their blaze in night.

3.

Thus has it been with Passion's fires--
As many a boy and girl remembers--
While every hope of love expires,
Extinguish'd with the dying embers.

4.

The *first*, though not a spark survive,
Some careful hand may teach to burn;
The *last*, alas! can ne'er survive;
No touch can bid its warmth return.

5.

Or, if it chance to wake again,
Not always doom'd its heat to smother,
It sheds (so wayward fates ordain)

Its former warmth around another.

1807. [First published, 1832.]

Footnote 1: *Y*Of Miss A. H. (MS. Newstead).
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Farewell to the Muse^a

***Works*, 1832, vii. 203.**

1.

Thou Power! who hast ruled me through Infancy's days,
Young offspring of Fancy, 'tis time we should part;
Then rise on the gale this the last of my lays,
The coldest effusion which springs from my heart.

2.

This bosom, responsive to rapture no more,

Shall hush thy wild notes, nor implore thee to sing;
The feelings of childhood, which taught thee to soar,
Are wafted far distant on Apathy's wing.

3.

Though simple the themes of my rude flowing Lyre,
Yet even these themes are departed for ever;
No more beam the eyes which my dream could inspire,
My visions are flown, to return,--alas, never!

4.

When drain'd is the nectar which gladdens the bowl,
How vain is the effort delight to prolong!
When cold is the beauty which dwelt in my soul^b,
What magic of Fancy can lengthen my song?

5.

Can the lips sing of Love in the desert alone,
Of kisses and smiles which they now must resign?
Or dwell with delight on the hours that are flown?
Ah, no! for those hours can no longer be mine.

6.

Can they speak of the friends that I lived but to love^c?
Ah, surely Affection ennobles the strain!
But how can my numbers in sympathy move,
When I scarcely can hope to behold them again?

7.

Can I sing of the deeds which my Fathers have done,
And raise my loud harp to the fame of my Sires?
For glories like theirs, oh, how faint is my tone!
For Heroes' exploits how unequal my fires!

8.

Untouch'd, then, my Lyre shall reply to the blast--
'Tis hush'd; and my feeble endeavours are o'er;
And those who have heard it will pardon the past,
When they know that its murmurs shall vibrate no more.

9.

And soon shall its wild erring notes be forgot,
Since early affection and love is o'ercast:
Oh! blest had my Fate been, and happy my lot,
Had the first strain of love been the dearest, the last.

10.

Farewell, my young Muse! since we now can ne'er meet^d;
If our songs have been languid, they surely are few:
Let us hope that the present at least will be sweet--
The present--which seals our eternal Adieu.

1807. [First published, 1832.]

Footnote a:Ý

Adieu to the Muse...

[MS Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote b:Ý

When cold is the form...

[MS Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote c:Ý

whom I lived but to love...

[MS Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote d:Ý

Since we never can meet...

[MS Newstead]

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To an Oak at Newstead¹

Works, 1832, vii. 206

1.

Young Oak! when I planted thee deep in the ground,
I hoped that thy days would be longer than mine;
That thy dark-waving branches would flourish around,
And ivy thy trunk with its mantle entwine.

2.

Such, such was my hope, when in Infancy's years,
On the land of my Fathers I rear'd thee with pride;
They are past, and I water thy stem with my tears,--
Thy decay, not the *weeds* that surround thee can hide.

3.

I left thee, my Oak, and, since that fatal hour,
A stranger has dwelt in the hall of my Sire;
Till Manhood shall crown me, not mine is the power,
But his, whose neglect may have bade thee expire.

4.

Oh! hardy thou wert--even now little care
Might revive thy young head, and thy wounds gently

heal:

But thou wert not fated affection to share--
For who could suppose that a Stranger would feel?

5.

Ah, droop not, my Oak! lift thy head for a while;
Ere twice round yon Glory this planet shall run,
The hand of thy Master will teach thee to smile,
When Infancy's years of probation are done.

6.

Oh, live then, my Oak! tow'r aloft from the weeds,
That clog thy young growth, and assist thy decay,
For still in thy bosom are Life's early seeds,
And still may thy branches their beauty display.

7.

Oh! yet, if Maturity's years may be thine,
Though *I* shall lie low in the cavern of Death,
On thy leaves yet the day-beam of ages may shine^a,
Uninjured by Time, or the rude Winter's breath.

8.

For centuries still may thy boughs lightly wave
O'er the corse of thy Lord in thy canopy laid;
While the branches thus gratefully shelter his grave,
The Chief who survives may recline in thy shade.

9.

And as he, with his boys, shall revisit this spot,
He will tell them in whispers more softly to tread.
Oh! surely, by these I shall ne'er be forgot;
Remembrance still hallows the dust of the dead.

10.

And here, will they say, when in Life's glowing prime,
Perhaps he has pour'd forth his young simple lay,
And here must he sleep, till the moments of Time
Are lost in the hours of Eternity's day.

1807. [First published 1832.]

["Copied for Mr. Moore, Jan. 24, 1828."--Note by Miss Pigot.]

Footnote 1: There is no heading to the original MS., but on the blank leaf at the end of the poem is written,

For ages may shine...

[MS Newstead]

"To an oak in the garden of Newstead Abbey, planted by the author in the 9th year of [his] age; this tree at his last visit was in a state of decay, though perhaps not irrecoverable."

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On arriving at Newstead, in 1798,
Byron, then in his eleventh year,

planted an oak, and cherished the fancy, that as the tree flourished so should he. On revisiting the abbey, he found the oak choked up by weeds and almost destroyed;-- hence these lines. Shortly after Colonel Wildman took possession, he said to a servant,

"Here is a fine young oak; but it must be cut down, as it grows in an improper place."

"I hope not, sir, "replied the man, "for it's the one that my lord was so fond of, because he set it himself."

Life, p. 50, note.

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On Revisiting Harrow¹

Letters and Journals, i. 102

1.

Here once engaged the stranger's view
Young Friendship's record simply trac'd;
Few were her words,--but yet, though few,
Resentment's hand the line defac'd.

2.

Deeply she cut--but not eras'd--
The characters were still so plain,
That Friendship once return'd, and gaz'd,--
Till Memory hail'd the words again.

3.

Repentance plac'd them as before;
Forgiveness join'd her gentle name;
So fair the inscription seem'd once more,
That Friendship thought it still the same.

4.

Thus might the Record now have been;
But, ah, in spite of Hope's endeavour,
Or Friendship's tears, Pride rush'd between,
And blotted out the line for ever.

September, 1807.

[First published in Moore's *Life and Letters, etc.*, 1830, i. 102.]

Footnote 1: Ý

"Some years ago, when at Harrow, a friend of the author engraved on a particular spot the names of both, with a few additional words, as a memorial. Afterwards, on receiving some real or imaginary injury, the author destroyed the frail record before he left Harrow. On revisiting the place in 1807, he wrote under it these stanzas."

Moore's *Life, etc.*, i. 102.

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To my Son¹

Letters and Journals, i. 104

1.

Those flaxen locks, those eyes of blue
Bright as thy mother's in their hue;
Those rosy lips, whose dimples play
And smile to steal the heart away,
Recall a scene of former joy,
And touch thy father's heart, my Boy!

2.

And thou canst lisp a father's name--
Ah, William, were thine own the same,--
No self-reproach--but, let me cease--
My care for thee shall purchase peace;
Thy mother's shade shall smile in joy,
And pardon all the past, my Boy!

3.

Her lowly grave the turf has prest,
And thou hast known a stranger's breast;
Derision sneers upon thy birth,
And yields thee scarce a name on earth;
Yet shall not these one hope destroy,--
A Father's heart is thine, my Boy!

4.

Why, let the world unfeeling frown,
Must I fond Nature's claims disown?
Ah, no--though moralists reprove,
I hail thee, dearest child of Love,
Fair cherub, pledge of youth and joy--
A Father guards thy birth, my Boy!

5.

Oh,'twill be sweet in thee to trace,
Ere Age has wrinkled o'er my face,
Ere half my glass of life is run,
At once a brother and a son;
And all my wane of years employ

In justice done to thee, my Boy!

6.

Although so young thy heedless sire,
Youth will not damp parental fire;
And, wert thou still less dear to me,
While Helen's form revives in thee,
The breast, which beat to former joy,
Will ne'er desert its pledge, my Boy!

1807.

[First published in Moore's *Life and Letters, etc.*, 1830, i. 104.]

Footnote 1: Ý For a reminiscence of what was, possibly, an actual event, see *Don Juan*, canto xvi. st. 61. He told Lady Byron that he had two natural children, whom he should provide for.

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Queries to Casuists¹

The Moralists tell us that Loving is Sinning,
And always are prating about and about it,

But as Love of Existence itself's the beginning,
Say, what would Existence itself be without it?

They argue the point with much furious Invective,
Though perhaps 'twere no difficult task to confute it;
But if Venus and Hymen should once prove defective,
Pray who would there be to defend or dispute it?

Byron.

Footnote 1: Ý From an autograph MS. (watermark 1805) at Newstead, now for the first time printed.

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Song. Breeze of the Night¹

1.

Breeze of the night in gentler sighs
More softly murmur o'er the pillow;
For Slumber seals my Fanny's eyes,
And Peace must never shun her pillow.

2.

Or breathe those sweet Æolian strains
Stolen from celestial spheres above,
To charm her ear while some remains,
And soothe her soul to dreams of love.

3.

But Breeze of night again forbear,
In softest murmurs only sigh:
Let not a Zephyr's pinion dare
To lift those auburn locks on high.

4.

Chill is thy Breath, thou breeze of night!
Oh! ruffle not those lids of Snow;
For only Morning's cheering light
May wake the beam that lurks below.

5.

Blest be that lip and azure eye!
Sweet Fanny, hallowed be thy Sleep!
Those lips shall never vent a sigh,
Those eyes may never wake to weep.

February 23rd, 1808.

Footnote 1: ^Y From the MS. in the possession of the Earl of Lovelace.
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To Harriet¹

1.

Harriet! to see such Circumspection²,
In Ladies I have no objection
Concerning what they read;
An ancient Maid's a sage adviser,
Like *her*, you will be much the wiser,
In word, as well as Deed.

2.

But Harriet, I don't wish to flatter,
And really think 't would make the matter
More perfect if not quite,
If other Ladies when they preach,
Would certain Damsels also teach
More cautiously to write.

Footnote 1: Ý From an autograph MS. at Newstead, now for the first time printed.

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Footnote 2: Ý See the poem [To Marion](#), and [note](#), p. 129. It would seem that J. T. Becher addressed some flattering lines to Byron with reference to a poem concerning Harriet Maltby, possibly the lines *To Marion*. The following note was attached by Miss Pigot to these stanzas, which must have been written on another occasion:--

"I saw Lord B. was *flattered* by John Becher's lines, as he read *Apollo*, etc., with a peculiar smile and emphasis; so out of *fun*, to vex him a little, I said,

'*Apollo!* He *should* have said *Apollyon*.'

'Elizabeth! for Heaven's sake don't say so again! I don't mind *you* telling me so; but if any one *else* got hold of *the word*, I should never hear the end of it.' So I laughed at him, and dropt it, for he was *red* with agitation."

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There was a Time, I need not name^{[1](#)} [a](#)

Imitations and Translations, 1809, p. 200

1.

There was a time, I need not name,
Since it will ne'er forgotten be,
When all our feelings were the same
As still my soul hath been to thee.

2.

And from that hour when first thy tongue
Confess'd a love which equall'd mine,
Though many a grief my heart hath wrung,
Unknown, and thus unfelt, by thine,

3.

None, none hath sunk so deep as this--
To think how all that love hath flown;
Transient as every faithless kiss,
But transient in thy breast alone.

4.

And yet my heart some solace knew,
When late I heard thy lips declare,
In accents once imagined true,
Remembrance of the days that were.

5.

Yes! my adored, yet most unkind!

Though thou wilt never love again,
To me 'tis doubly sweet to find
Remembrance of that love remain^b.

6.

Yes! 'tis a glorious thought to me,
Nor longer shall my soul repine,
Whate'er thou art or e'er shall be,
Thou hast been dearly, solely mine.

June 10, 1808. [First published, 1809]

Footnote 1: Ý This copy of verses, **Footnote a:** Ý
with eight others, originally
appeared in a volume published in *Stanzas to the Same.*
1809 by J. C. Hobhouse, under the [Imit. and Transl., p. 200.]
title of *Imitations and* [return](#)
Translations, From the Ancient
and Modern Classics, Together
with Original Poems never before
published. The MS. is in the
possession of the Earl of Lovelace.
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Footnote b: Ý

*The memory of that love
again...*

[MS. L.]
[return](#)

And wilt Thou weep when I am low?^a

Imitations and Translations, 1809, p. 202

1.

And wilt thou weep when I am low?
Sweet lady! speak those words again:
Yet if they grieve thee, say not so--
I would not give that bosom pain.

2.

My heart is sad, my hopes are gone,
My blood runs coldly through my breast;
And when I perish, thou alone
Wilt sigh above my place of rest.

3.

And yet, methinks, a gleam of peace
Doth through my cloud of anguish shine:
And for a while my sorrows cease,
To know thy heart hath felt for mine.

4.

Oh lady! blessèd be that tear--
It falls for one who cannot weep;
Such precious drops are doubly dear^b
To those whose eyes no tear may steep.

5.

Sweet lady! once my heart was warm
With every feeling soft as thine;
But Beauty's self hath ceased to charm
A wretch created to repine.

6.^c

Yet wilt thou weep when I am low?
Sweet lady! speak those words again:
Yet if they grieve thee, say not so--
I would not give that bosom pain¹.

Aug. 12, 1808. [First published, 1809.]

Footnote 1: Ý It was in one of
Byron's fits of melancholy that the
following verses were addressed
to him by his friend John Cam
Hobhouse:--

*Epistle To A Young Nobleman
In Love.*

Hail! generous youth, whom

Footnote a:Ý

Stanzas....

[*MS Newstead*]

To the Same.....

[*Imit. and Transl.*, p. 202.]

[return](#)

glory's sacred flame
Inspires, and animates to
deeds of fame;
Who feel the noble wish
before you die
To raise the finger of each
passer-by:
Hail! may a future age
admiring view
A Falkland or a Clarendon in
you.

But as your blood with
dangerous passion boils,
Beware! and fly from Venus'
silken toils:
Ah! let the head protect the
weaker heart,
And Wisdom's Ægis turn on
Beauty's dart.

...

But if 'tis fix'd that every lord
must pair,
And you and Newstead must
not want an heir,
Lose not your pains, and
scour the country round,
To find a treasure that can
ne'er be found!
No! take the first the town or
court affords,
Trick'd out to stock a market
for the lords;
By chance perhaps your
luckier choice may fall
On one, though wicked, not
the worst of all:

...

One though perhaps as any
Maxwell free,
Yet scarce a copy, Claribel, of
thee;
Not very ugly, and not very
old,
A little pert indeed, but not a
scold;
One that, in short, may help
to lead a life
Not farther much from
comfort than from strife;
And when she dies, and
disappoints your fears,
Shall leave some joys for
your declining years.
But, as your early youth some
time allows,
Nor custom yet demands you
for a spouse,
Some hours of freedom may
remain as yet,
For one who laughs alike at
love and debt:
Then, why in haste? put off
the evil day,
And snatch at youthful
comforts while you may!
Pause! nor so soon the
various bliss forego
That single souls, and such
alone, can know:
Ah! why too early careless
life resign,
Your morning slumber, and
your evening wine;
Your loved companion, and

his easy talk;
Your Muse, invoked in every
peaceful walk?
What! can no more your
scenes paternal please,
Scenes sacred long to wise,
unmated ease?
The prospect lengthen'd o'er
the distant down,
Lakes, meadows, rising
woods, and all your own?
What! shall your Newstead,
shall your cloister'd bowers,
The high o'erhanging arch
and trembling towers!
Shall these, profaned with
folly or with strife,
An ever fond, or ever angry
wife!
Shall these no more confess a
manly sway,
But changeful woman's
changing whims obey?
Who may, perhaps, as
varying humour calls,
Contract your cloisters and
o'erthrow your walls;
Let Repton loose o'er all the
ancient ground,
Change round to square, and
square convert to round;
Root up the elms' and yews'
too solemn gloom,
And fill with shrubberies gay
and green their room;
Roll down the terrace to a
gay parterre,

Where gravel'd walks and
flowers alternate glare;
And quite transform, in every
point complete,
Your Gothic abbey to a
country seat.
Forget the fair one, and your
fate delay;
If not avert, at least defer the
day,
When you beneath the female
yoke shall bend,
And lose your wit, your
temper, and your *friend*^A.
Trin. Coll. Camb., 1808.

Sub-Footnote A: In his
mother's copy of Hobhouse's
volume, Byron has written with a
pencil,

"I have lost them all, and
shall **wed** accordingly. 1811.
B."

[return to main footnote mark](#)

Footnote b:Ý

*For one whose life is torment
here, And only in the dust
may sleep....*

[MS. L.]

[return](#)

Footnote c:Ý The MS. inserts:--

*Lady I will not tell my tale
For it would rend thy melting
heart;
'Twere pity sorrow should
prevail
O'er one so gentle as thou
art....*

[MS. L.]

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Remind me not, Remind me not^a

Imitations and Translations, 1809, p. 197

1.

Remind me not, remind me not,
Of those beloved, those vanish'd hours,
When all my soul was given to thee;
Hours that may never be forgot,
Till Time unnerves our vital powers,
And thou and I shall cease to be.

2.

Can I forget--canst thou forget,
When playing with thy golden hair,
How quick thy fluttering heart did move?
Oh! by my soul, I see thee yet,
With eyes so languid, breast so fair,
And lips, though silent, breathing love.

3.

When thus reclining on my breast,
Those eyes threw back a glance so sweet,
As half reproach'd yet rais'd desire,
And still we near and nearer prest,
And still our glowing lips would meet,
As if in kisses to expire.

4.

And then those pensive eyes would close,
And bid their lids each other seek,
Veiling the azure orbs below;
While their long lashes' darken'd gloss
Seem'd stealing o'er thy brilliant cheek,
Like raven's plumage smooth'd on snow.

5.

I dreamt last night our love return'd,
And, sooth to say, that very dream
Was sweeter in its phantasy,
Than if for other hearts I burn'd,
For eyes that ne'er like thine could beam
In Rapture's wild reality.

6.

Then tell me not, remind me not^b,
Of hours which, though for ever gone,
Can still a pleasing dream restore^c,
Till thou and I shall be forgot,
And senseless, as the mouldering stone
Which tells that we shall be no more.

Aug. 13, 1808. [First published, 1809.]

Footnote a:Ý

A Love Song. To----...

[*Imit. and Transl.*, p. 197]

[return](#)

Footnote b:Ý

Remind me not, remind me not...

[*MS L.*]

[return](#)

Footnote c:Ý

Must still...

[MS L.]

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To a Youthful Friend^a

Imitations and Translations, 1809, p. 185

1.

Few years have pass'd since thou and I
Were firmest friends, at least in name,
And Childhood's gay sincerity
Preserved our feelings long the same^b.

2.

But now, like me, too well thou know'st^c
What trifles oft the heart recall;
And those who once have loved the most
Too soon forget they lov'd at all.^d

3.

And such the change the heart displays,

So frail is early friendship's reign^e,
A month's brief lapse, perhaps a day's,
Will view thy mind estrang'd again^f.

4.

If so, it never shall be mine
To mourn the loss of such a heart;
The fault was Nature's fault, not thine,
Which made thee fickle as thou art.

5.

As rolls the Ocean's changing tide,
So human feelings ebb and flow;
And who would in a breast confide
Where stormy passions ever glow?

6.

It boots not that, together bred,
Our childish days were days of joy:
My spring of life has quickly fled;
Thou, too, hast ceas'd to be a boy.

7.

And when we bid adieu to youth,
Slaves to the specious World's controul,
We sigh a long farewell to truth;
That World corrupts the noblest soul.

8.

Ah, joyous season! when the mind¹
Dares all things boldly but to lie;
When Thought ere spoke is unconfin'd,
And sparkles in the placid eye.

9.

Not so in Man's maturer years,
When Man himself is but a tool;
When Interest sways our hopes and fears,
And all must love and hate by rule.

10.

With fools in kindred vice the same^g,
We learn at length our faults to blend;
And those, and those alone, may claim
The prostituted name of friend.

11.

Such is the common lot of man:
Can we then 'scape from folly free?
Can we reverse the general plan,
Nor be what all in turn must be?

12.

No; for myself, so dark my fate
Through every turn of life hath been;
Man and the World so much I hate,

I care not when I quit the scene.

13.

But thou, with spirit frail and light,
Wilt shine awhile, and pass away;
As glow-worms sparkle through the night,
But dare not stand the test of day.

14.

Alas! whenever Folly calls
Where parasites and princes meet,
(For cherish'd first in royal halls,
The welcome vices kindly greet,)

15.

Ev'n now thou'rt nightly seen to add
One insect to the fluttering crowd;
And still thy trifling heart is glad
To join the vain and court the proud.

16.

There dost thou glide from fair to fair,
Still simpering on with eager haste,
As flies along the gay parterre,
That taint the flowers they scarcely taste.

17.

But say, what nymph will prize the flame
Which seems, as marshy vapours move,
To flit along from dame to dame,
An *ignis-fatuus* gleam of love?

18.

What friend for thee, howe'er inclin'd,
Will deign to own a kindred care?
Who will debase his manly mind,
For friendship every fool may share?

19.

In time forbear; amidst the throng
No more so base a thing be seen;
No more so idly pass along;
Be something, any thing, but--mean.

August 20th, 1808. [First published, 1809.]

Footnote 1: Ý Stanzas 8-9 are not in the MS.

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*To Sir W. D., on his using the
expression, "Soyes constant
en amitie."...*

[MS L.]

[return](#)

Footnote b: Ý

*'Twere well my friend if still
with thee
Through every scene of joy
and woe,
That thought could ever
cherish'd be
As warm as it was wont to
glow....*

[MS L.]

[return](#)

Footnote c:Ý

And yet like me...

[MS L.]

[return](#)

Footnote d:Ý

Forget they ever...

[MS. L. Imit. and Transl., p. 185.]

[return](#)

Footnote e:Ý

So short...

[MS L.]

[return](#)

Footnote f:Ý

*...a day
Will send my friendship back
again...*

[MS L.]

[return](#)

Footnote g:Ý

*Each fool whose vices are the
same
Whose faults with ours may
blend...*

[MS L.]

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Lines Inscribed upon a Cup Formed from a Skull¹

**First published, *Childe Harold*, Cantos i., ii. (Seventh Edition),
1814**

1.

Start not--nor deem my spirit fled:
In me behold the only skull,
From which, unlike a living head,
Whatever flows is never dull.

2.

I lived, I loved, I quaff'd, like thee:
I died: let earth my bones resign;

Fill up--thou canst not injure me;
The worm hath fouler lips than thine.

3.

Better to hold the sparkling grape,
Than nurse the earth-worm's slimy brood;
And circle in the goblet's shape
The drink of Gods, than reptile's food.

4.

Where once my wit, perchance, hath shone,
In aid of others' let me shine;
And when, alas! our brains are gone,
What nobler substitute than wine?

5.

Quaff while thou canst: another race,
When thou and thine, like me, are sped,
May rescue thee from earth's embrace,
And rhyme and revel with the dead.

6.

Why not? since through life's little day
Our heads such sad effects produce;
Redeem'd from worms and wasting clay,
This chance is theirs, to be of use.

Newstead Abbey, 1808.

[First published in the seventh edition of *Childe Harold*.]

Footnote 1: Ý Byron gave Medwin the following account of this cup: -

"The gardener in digging [discovered] a skull that had probably belonged to some jolly friar or monk of the abbey, about the time it was dis-monasteried. Observing it to be of giant size, and in a perfect state of preservation, a strange fancy seized me of having it set and mounted as a drinking cup. I accordingly sent it to town, and it returned with a very high polish, and of a mottled colour like tortoiseshell."

Medwin's *Conversations*, 1824, p. 87.

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Well! Thou art Happy¹ a

Imitations and Translations, 1809, p. 192

1.

Well! thou art happy, and I feel
That I should thus be happy too;
For still my heart regards thy weal
Warmly, as it was wont to do.

2.

Thy husband's blest--and 'twill impart
Some pangs to view his happier lot^b:
But let them pass--Oh! how my heart
Would hate him if he loved thee not!

3.

When late I saw thy favourite child,
I thought my jealous heart would break;
But when the unconscious infant smil'd,
I kiss'd it for its mother's sake.

4.

I kiss'd it,--and repress'd my sighs
Its father in its face to see;
But then it had its mother's eyes,
And they were all to love and me.

5^c.

Mary, adieu! I must away:
While thou art blest I'll not repine;
But near thee I can never stay;

My heart would soon again be thine.

6.

I deem'd that Time, I deem'd that Pride,
Had quench'd at length my boyish flame;
Nor knew, till seated by thy side,
My heart in all,--save hope,--the same.

7.

Yet was I calm: I knew the time
My breast would thrill before thy look;
But now to tremble were a crime--
We met,--and not a nerve was shook.

8.

I saw thee gaze upon my face,
Yet meet with no confusion there:
One only feeling couldst thou trace;
The sullen calmness of despair.

9.

Away! away! my early dream
Remembrance never must awake:
Oh! where is Lethe's fabled stream?
My foolish heart be still, or break.

November, 1808. [First published, 1809.]

Footnote 1: Ý These lines were written after dining at Annesley with Mr. and Mrs. Chaworth Musters. Their daughter, born 1806, and now Mrs. Hamond, of Westacre, Norfolk, is still (January, 1898) living.

[return to footnote mark](#)

Footnote a:Ý

To Mrs.----[erased]...

[MS L.]

To-----

[*Imit. and Transl.* Hobhouse, 1809.]

[return](#)

Footnote b:Ý

Some pang to see my rival's lot...

[MS L.]

[return](#)

Footnote c:Ý MS. L. inserts--

*Poor little pledge of mutual
love,
I would not hurt a hair of
thee,
Although thy birth should
chance to prove
Thy parents' bliss--my
misery....*

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Inscription on the Monument of a Newfoundland Dog¹

Imitations and Translations, 1809, p. 190

When some proud son of man returns to earth,
Unknown to glory, but upheld by birth,
The sculptor's art exhausts the pomp of woe
And storied urns record who rest below:
When all is done, upon the tomb is seen,
Not what he was, but what he should have been:
But the poor dog, in life the firmest friend,
The first to welcome, foremost to defend,
Whose honest heart is still his master's own,
Who labours, fights, lives, breathes for him alone,
Unhonour'd falls, unnoticed all his worth--
Denied in heaven the soul he held on earth:
While Man, vain insect! hopes to be forgiven,
And claims himself a sole exclusive Heaven.
Oh Man! thou feeble tenant of an hour,
Debased by slavery, or corrupt by power,
Who knows thee well must quit thee with disgust,
Degraded mass of animated dust!
Thy love is lust, thy friendship all a cheat,
Thy smiles hypocrisy, thy words deceit!
By nature vile, ennobled but by name,
Each kindred brute might bid thee blush for shame.
Ye! who perchance behold this simple urn,
Pass on--it honours none you wish to mourn:
To mark a Friend's remains these stones arise;
I never knew but one,--and here he lies^a.

Newstead Abbey, October 30, 1808. [First published, 1809.]

Footnote 1: Ý This monument is placed in the garden of Newstead. A prose inscription precedes the verses:--

"Near this spot
Are deposited the Remains of
one
Who possessed Beauty
without Vanity,
Strength without Insolence,
Courage without Ferocity,
And all the Virtues of Man
without his Vices.
This Praise, which would be
unmeaning Flattery
If inscribed over human
ashes,
Is but a just tribute to the
Memory of
Boatswain, a Dog,
Who was born at
Newfoundland, May, 1803,
And died at Newstead Abbey,
Nov. 18, 1808."

Byron thus announced the death of
his favourite to his friend
Hodgson:--

"Boatswain is dead!--he
expired in a state of madness
on the 18th after suffering
much, yet retaining all the
gentleness of his nature to the

Footnote a:Ý

*I knew but one unchang'd--
and here he lies.*

[*Imit. and Transl.* p. 191.]

[return](#)

last; never attempting to do
the least injury to any one
near him. I have now lost
everything except old
Murray."

In the will which the poet
executed in 1811, he desired to be
buried in the vault with his dog,
and Joe Murray was to have the
honour of making one of the party.
When the poet was on his travels,
a gentleman, to whom Murray
showed the tomb, said,

"Well, old boy, you will take your
place here some twenty years
hence."

"I don't know that, sir," replied
Joe; "if I was sure his lordship
would come here I should like it
well enough, but I should not like
to lie alone with the dog."

Life, pp. 73, 131.

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To a Lady¹, On Being asked my reason for quitting England in the Spring^a

Imitations and Translations, 1809, p. 195

1.

When Man, expell'd from Eden's bowers,
A moment linger'd near the gate,
Each scene recall'd the vanish'd hours,
And bade him curse his future fate.

2.

But, wandering on through distant climes,
He learnt to bear his load of grief;
Just gave a sigh to other times,
And found in busier scenes relief.

3.

Thus, Lady! will it be with me^b,
And I must view thy charms no more;
For, while I linger near to thee,
I sigh for all I knew before.

4.

In flight I shall be surely wise,
Escaping from temptation's snare:
I cannot view my Paradise
Without the wish of dwelling there^{2 c}.

December 2, 1808. [First published, 1809.]

Footnote 1: Ý Byron had written to his mother on November 2, 1808, announcing his intention of sailing for India in the following March. See *Childe Harold*, canto i. st. 3. See also Letter to Hodgson, Nov. 27, 1808.

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Footnote 2: ÝIn an unpublished letter of Byron to----, dated within a few days of his final departure from Italy to Greece, in 1823, he writes:

"Miss Chaworth was two years older than myself. She married a man of an ancient and respectable family, but her marriage was not a happier one than my own. Her conduct, however, was irreproachable; but there was not sympathy between their characters. I had not seen her for many years when an occasion offered to me, January, 1814. I was upon the point, with her consent, of paying her a visit, when my sister, who has always had more influence over me than any one else, persuaded me

Footnote a:Ý

The Farewell To a Lady...

[*Imit. and Transl.*]

[return](#)

Footnote b:Ý

Thus Mary!_ (Mrs. Musters)....

[MS]

[return](#)

Fill the Goblet Again^a. A Song

Imitations and Translations, 1809, p. 204

1.

Fill the goblet again! for I never before
Felt the glow which now gladdens my heart to its core;
Let us drink!--who would not?--since, through life's varied round,
In the goblet alone no deception is found.

2.

I have tried in its turn all that life can supply;
I have bask'd in the beam of a dark rolling eye;
I have lov'd!--who has not?--but what heart can declare
That Pleasure existed while Passion was there?

3.

In the days of my youth, when the heart's in its spring,
And dreams that Affection can never take wing,
I had friends!--who has not?--but what tongue will avow,
That friends, rosy wine! are so faithful as thou?

4.

The heart of a mistress some boy may estrange,
Friendship shifts with the sunbeam--thou never canst change;
Thou grow'st old--who does not?--but on earth what appears,
Whose virtues, like thine, still increase with its years?

5.

Yet if blest to the utmost that Love can bestow,
Should a rival bow down to our idol below,
We are jealous!--who's not?--thou hast no such alloy;
For the more that enjoy thee, the more we enjoy.

6.

Then the season of youth and its vanities past,
For refuge we fly to the goblet at last;
There we find--do we not?--in the flow of the soul,
That truth, as of yore, is confined to the bowl.

7.

When the box of Pandora was open'd on earth,
And Misery's triumph commenc'd over Mirth,
Hope was left,--was she not?--but the goblet we kiss,
And care not for Hope, who are certain of bliss.

8.

Long life to the grape! for when summer is flown,
The age of our nectar shall gladden our own:
We must die--who shall not?--May our sins be forgiven,
And Hebe shall never be idle in Heaven.

[First published, 1809.]

Footnote a:Ý

Song...

[*Imit. and Transl.*, p. 204]

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Stanzas to a Lady, on Leaving England^a

Imitations and Translations, 1809, p. 227

1.

Tis done--and shivering in the gale
The bark unfurls her snowy sail;
And whistling o'er the bending mast,
Loud sings on high the fresh'ning blast;
And I must from this land be gone,
Because I cannot love but one.

2.

But could I be what I have been,
And could I see what I have seen--
Could I repose upon the breast
Which once my warmest wishes blest--
I should not seek another zone,
Because I cannot love but one.

3.

'Tis long since I beheld that eye
Which gave me bliss or misery;
And I have striven, but in vain,
Never to think of it again:
For though I fly from Albion,
I still can only love but one.

4.

As some lone bird, without a mate,
My weary heart is desolate;
I look around, and cannot trace
One friendly smile or welcome face,
And ev'n in crowds am still alone,
Because I cannot love but one.

5.

And I will cross the whitening foam,
And I will seek a foreign home;
Till I forget a false fair face,
I ne'er shall find a resting-place;
My own dark thoughts I cannot shun,
But ever love, and love but one.

6.

The poorest, veriest wretch on earth
Still finds some hospitable hearth,
Where Friendship's or Love's softer glow
May smile in joy or soothe in woe;
But friend or leman I have none^b,
Because I cannot love but one.

7.

I go--but wheresoe'er I flee
There's not an eye will weep for me;
There's not a kind congenial heart,
Where I can claim the meanest part;
Nor thou, who hast my hopes undone,
Wilt sigh, although I love but one.

8.

To think of every early scene,
Of what we are, and what we've been,
Would whelm some softer hearts with woe--
But mine, alas! has stood the blow;
Yet still beats on as it begun,
And never truly loves but one.

9.

And who that dear lov'd one may be,
Is not for vulgar eyes to see;
And why that early love was cross'd,

Thou know'st the best, I feel the most;
But few that dwell beneath the sun
Have loved so long, and loved but one.

10.

I've tried another's fetters too,
With charms perchance as fair to view;
And I would fain have loved as well,
But some unconquerable spell
Forbade my bleeding breast to own
A kindred care for aught but one.

11.

'Twould soothe to take one lingering view,
And bless thee in my last adieu;
Yet wish I not those eyes to weep
For him that wanders o'er the deep;
His home, his hope, his youth are gone^c,
Yet still he loves, and loves but one^d.

1809. [First published, 1809.]

Footnote a: ^Y

To Mrs. Musters.

[MS]

To----on Leaving England.

[*Imit. and Transl.*, p. 227.]

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Footnote b:Ý

But friend or lover I have none...

[*Imit. and Transl.*, p. 229.]

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Footnote c:Ý

*Though wheresoever my bark may run,
I love but thee, I love but one...*

[*Imit. and Transl.*, p. 230.]

*The land recedes his Bark is gone,
Yet still he loves and laves but one*

[MS.]

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Footnote d:Ý

Yet far away he loves but one...

[MS.]

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English Bards and Scotch Reviewers

a satire.

by Lord Byron.

*"I had rather be a kitten, and cry, mew!
Than one of these same metre ballad-mongers."*

(Shakespeare.)

*"Such shameless Bards we have; and yet 'tis true,
There are as mad, abandon'd Critics, too."*

(Pope.)

Preface¹

All my friends, learned and unlearned, have urged me not to publish this Satire with my name. If I were to be "turned from the career of my humour by quibbles quick, and paper bullets of the brain" I should have complied with their counsel. But I am not to be terrified by abuse, or bullied by reviewers, with or without arms. I can safely say that I have attacked none *personally*, who did not commence on the

offensive. An Author's works are public property: he who purchases may judge, and publish his opinion if he pleases; and the Authors I have endeavoured to commemorate may do by me as I have done by them. I dare say they will succeed better in condemning my scribblings, than in mending their own. But my object is not to prove that I can write well, but, if *possible*, to make others write better.

As the Poem has met with far more success than I expected, I have endeavoured in this Edition to make some additions and alterations, to render it more worthy of public perusal.

In the First Edition of this Satire, published anonymously, fourteen lines on the subject of Bowles's Pope were written by, and inserted at the request of, an ingenious friend of mine², who has now in the press a volume of Poetry. In the present Edition they are erased, and some of my own substituted in their stead; my only reason for this being that which I conceive would operate with any other person in the same manner,--a determination not to publish with my name any production, which was not entirely and exclusively my own composition.

With³ regard to the real talents of many of the poetical persons whose performances are mentioned or alluded to in the following pages, it is presumed by the Author that there can be little difference of opinion in the Public at large; though, like other sectaries, each has his separate tabernacle of proselytes, by whom his abilities are over-rated, his faults overlooked, and his metrical canons received without scruple and without consideration. But the unquestionable possession of considerable genius by several of the writers here censured renders their mental prostitution more to be regretted. Imbecility may be pitied, or, at worst, laughed at and forgotten; perverted powers demand the most decided reprehension. No one can wish more than the Author that some known and able writer had undertaken their exposure; but Mr. Gifford has devoted himself to Massinger, and, in the absence of the regular physician, a country practitioner may, in cases of absolute necessity, be allowed to prescribe his nostrum to prevent the extension of so deplorable an epidemic, provided there be no quackery in his treatment of the malady. A caustic is here offered; as it is to be feared

nothing short of actual cautery can recover the numerous patients afflicted with the present prevalent and distressing rabies for rhyming.-
-As to the *Edinburgh Reviewers*, it would indeed require an Hercules to crush the Hydra; but if the Author succeeds in merely "bruising one of the heads of the serpent" though his own hand should suffer in the encounter, he will be amply satisfied.

Footnote 1: Ý The Preface, as it is here printed, was prefixed to the Second, Third, and Fourth Editions of *English Bards, and Scotch Reviewers*. The preface to the First Edition began with the words, "With regard to the real talents," etc. The text of the poem follows that of the suppressed Fifth Edition, which passed under Byron's own supervision, and was to have been issued in 1812. From that Edition the Preface was altogether excluded.

In an annotated copy of the Fourth Edition, of 1811, underneath the note,

"This preface was written for the Second Edition, and printed with it. The noble author had left this country previous to the publication of that Edition, and is not yet returned,"

Byron wrote, in 1816,

"He is, and gone again."

MS. Notes from this volume, which is now in Mr. Murray's possession, are marked--B., 1816.

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Footnote 2: Ý John Cam Hobhouse.

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Footnote 3: Ý Preface to the First Edition.
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Introduction

The article upon *Hours of Idleness* "which Lord Brougham ... after denying it for thirty years, confessed that he had written" (*Notes from a Diary*, by Sir M. E. Grant Duff, 1897, ii. 189), was published in the *Edinburgh Review* of January, 1808. *English Bards, and Scotch Reviewers* did not appear till March, 1809. The article gave the opportunity for the publication of the satire, but only in part provoked its composition. Years later, Byron had not forgotten its effect on his mind. On April 26, 1821, he wrote to Shelley:

"I recollect the effect on me of the *Edinburgh* on my first poem: it was rage and resistance and redress: but not despondency nor despair."

And on the same date to Murray:

"I know by experience that a savage review is hemlock to a sucking author; and the one on me (which produced the *English Bards*, etc.) knocked me down, but I got up again," etc.

It must, however, be remembered that Byron had his weapons ready for an attack before he used them in defence. In a letter to Miss Pigot, dated October 26, 1807, he says that "he has written one poem of 380 lines to be published in a few weeks with notes. The poem ... is a

Satire." It was entitled *British Bards*, and finally numbered 520 lines. With a view to publication, or for his own convenience, it was put up in type and printed in quarto sheets. A single copy, which he kept for corrections and additions, was preserved by Dallas, and is now in the British Museum. After the review appeared, he enlarged and recast the *British Bards*, and in March, 1809, the Satire was published anonymously. Byron was at no pains to conceal the authorship of *English Bards, and Scotch Reviewers*, and, before starting on his Pilgrimage, he had prepared a second and enlarged edition, which came out in October, 1809, with his name prefixed. Two more editions were called for in his absence, and on his return he revised and printed a fifth, when he suddenly resolved to suppress the work. On his homeward voyage he expressed, in a letter to Dallas, June 28, 1811, his regret at having written the Satire. A year later he became intimate, among others, with Lord and Lady Holland, whom he had assailed on the supposition that they were the instigators of the article in the *Edinburgh Review*, and on being told by Rogers that they wished the Satire to be withdrawn, he gave orders to his publisher, Cawthorn, to burn the whole impression. A few copies escaped the flames. One of two copies retained by Dallas, which afterwards belonged to Murray, and is now in his grandson's possession, was the foundation of the text of 1831, and of all subsequent issues. Another copy which belonged to Dallas is retained in the British Museum.

Towards the close of the last century there had been an outburst of satirical poems, written in the style of the *Dunciad* and its offspring the *Rosciad*, Of these, Gifford's *Baviad* and *Maviad*, (1794-5), and T. J. Mathias' *Pursuits of Literature* (1794-7), were the direct progenitors of *English Bards, and Scotch Reviewers*, The *Rolliad* (1794), the *Children of Apollo* (circ. 1794), Canning's *New Morality* (1798), and Wolcot's coarse but virile lampoons, must also be reckoned among Byron's earlier models. The ministry of "All the Talents" gave rise to a fresh batch of political *jeux d'esprits*, and in 1807, when Byron was still at Cambridge, the air was full of these ephemera. To name only a few, *All the Talents*, by Polypus (Eaton Stannard Barrett), was answered by *All the Blocks, an antidote to All the Talents*, by Flagellum (W. H. Ireland); *Elijah's Mantle, a tribute to the memory of*

the R. H. William Pitt, by James Sayer, the caricaturist, provoked *Melville's Mantle, being a Parody on ... Elijah's Mantle. The Simpliciad, A Satirico-Didactic Poem*, and Lady Anne Hamilton's *Epics of the Ton*, are also of the same period. One and all have perished, but Byron read them, and in a greater or less degree they supplied the impulse to write in the fashion of the day.

British Bards would have lived, but, unquestionably, the spur of the article, a year's delay, and, above all, the advice and criticism of his friend Hodgson, who was at work on his *Gentle Alterative for the Reviewers*, 1809 (for further details, see vol. i., *Letters*, Letter 102, note 1), produced the brilliant success of the enlarged satire. *English Bards, and Scotch Reviewers* was recognized at once as a work of genius. It has intercepted the popularity of its great predecessors, who are often quoted, but seldom read. It is still a popular poem, and appeals with fresh delight to readers who know the names of many of the "bards" only because Byron mentions them, and count others whom he ridicules among the greatest poets of the century.

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English Bards and Scotch Reviewers¹

Still² must I hear?--shall hoarse³
Fitzgerald bawl [c11](#)
His creaking couplets in a tavern
hall,
And I not sing, lest, haply, Scotch
Reviews
Should dub me scribbler, and

denounce my *Muse*?
Prepare for rhyme--I'll publish,
right or wrong:
Fools are my theme, let Satire be 10
my song^a.

Oh! Nature's noblest gift--my
grey goose-quill!
Slave of my thoughts, obedient to
my will,
Torn from thy parent bird to form
a pen,
That mighty instrument of little
men!
The pen! foredoomed to aid the 20
mental throes
Of brains that labour, big with
Verse or Prose;
Though Nymphs forsake, and
Critics may deride,
The Lover's solace, and the
Author's pride.
What Wits! what Poets dost thou
daily raise!
How frequent is thy use, how
small thy praise!
Condemned at length to be 30
forgotten quite,
With all the pages which 'twas
thine to write.
But thou, at least, mine own
especial pen^b!
Once laid aside, but now assumed
again,
Our task complete, like Hamet's⁴
shall be free;
Though spurned by others, yet

beloved by me: 40
Then let us soar to-day; no
common theme,
No Eastern vision, no
distempered dream⁵
Inspires--our path, though full of
thorns, is plain;
Smooth be the verse, and easy be
the strain.

When Vice triumphant holds her 50
sov'reign sway,
Obey'd by all who nought beside
obey^c;
When Folly, frequent harbinger
of crime,
Bedecks her cap with bells of
every Clime^d;
When knaves and fools combined
o'er all prevail,
And weigh their Justice in a 60
Golden Scale^e;
E'en then the boldest start from
public sneers,
Afraid of Shame, unknown to
other fears,
More darkly sin, by Satire kept in
awe,
And shrink from Ridicule, though
not from Law.

Such is the force of Wit! I but not 70
belong
To me the arrows of satiric song;
The royal vices of our age
demand
A keener weapon, and a mightier

hand^f.

Still there are follies, e'en for me
to chase,
And yield at least amusement in
the race:

Laugh when I laugh, I seek no
other fame, 80

The cry is up, and scribblers are
my game:

Speed, Pegasus!--ye strains of
great and small,
Ode! Epic! Elegy!--have at you
all!

I, too, can scrawl, and once upon
a time

I poured along the town a flood
of rhyme,
A schoolboy freak, unworthy 90
praise or blame;

I printed--older children do the
same.

'Tis pleasant, sure, to see one's
name in print;

A Book's a Book, altho' there's
nothing in't.

Not that a Title's sounding charm
can save^g

Or scrawl or scribbler from an 100
equal grave:

This **Lamb**⁶ must own, since his
patrician name

Failed to preserve the spurious
Farce from shame⁷.

No matter, **George** continues still
to write⁸,

Tho' now the name is veiled from

public sight.
Moved by the great example, I
pursue 110
The self-same road, but make my
own review:
Not seek great **Jeffrey's**, yet like
him will be
Self-constituted Judge of Poesy.

A man must serve his time to
every trade
Save Censure--Critics all are
ready made. 120
Take hackneyed jokes from
Miller⁹, got by rote,
With just enough of learning to
misquote;
A man well skilled to find, or
forge a fault;
A turn for punning--call it Attic
salt;
To **Jeffrey** go, be silent and
discreet,
His pay is just ten sterling pounds 130
per sheet:
Fear not to lie, 'twill seem a
sharper hit^h;
Shrink not from blasphemy, 'twill
pass for wit;
Care not for feeling--pass your
proper jest,
And stand a Critic, hated yet
caress'd.

And shall we own such 140
judgment? no--as soon
Seek roses in December--ice in

June;
Hope constancy in wind, or corn
in chaff,
Believe a woman or an epitaph,
Or any other thing that's false,
before
You trust in Critics, who
themselves are sore;
Or yield one single thought to be 150
misled
By **Jeffrey's** heart, or **Lamb's**
Boeotian head¹⁰.
To these young tyrants, by
themselves misplaced,
Combined usurpers on the Throne
of Taste;
To these, when Authors bend in
humble awe,
And hail their voice as Truth,
their word as Law; 160
While these are Censors, 'twould
be sin to spare¹¹;
While such are Critics, why
should I forbear?
But yet, so near all modern
worthies run,
'Tis doubtful whom to seek, or
whom to shun;
Nor know we when to spare, or
where to strike,
Our Bards and Censors are so 170
much alike.
Then should you ask me¹², why I
venture o'er
The path which **Pope** and
Gifford¹³ trod before;
If not yet sickened, you can still

proceed;
Go on; my rhyme will tell you as
you read.
"But hold!" exclaims a friend,-- 180
"here's some neglect:
This--that--and t'other line seem
incorrect."
What then? the self-same blunder
Pope has got,
And careless Dryden--"Aye, but
Pye has not:"--
Indeed!--'tis granted, faith!--but
what care I?
Better to err with **Pope**, than
shine with **Pye**¹⁴.

Time was, ere yet in these 190
degenerate days¹⁵
Ignoble themes obtained
mistaken praise,
When Sense and Wit with Poesy
allied,
No fabled Graces, flourished side
by side,
From the same fount their
inspiration drew,
And, reared by Taste, bloomed 200
fairer as they grew.
Then, in this happy Isle, a **Pope's**
pure strain
Sought the rapt soul to charm, nor
sought in vain;
A polished nation's praise aspired
to claim,
And raised the people's, as the
poet's fame.
Like him great **Dryden** poured 210

the tide of song,
In stream less smooth, indeed, yet
doubly strong.
Then **Congreve's** scenes could
cheer, or **Otway's** melt¹⁶;
For Nature then an English
audience felt--
But why these names, or greater
still, retrace,
When all to feebler Bards resign
their place? 220
Yet to such times our lingering
looks are cast,
When taste and reason with those
times are past.
Now look around, and turn each
trifling page,
Survey the precious works that
please the age;
This truth at least let Satire's self
allow, 230
No dearth of Bards can be
complained of now.ⁱ
The loaded Press beneath her
labour groans^j,
And Printers' devils shake their
weary bones;
While **Southey's** Epics cram the
creaking shelves^k,
And **Little's** Lyrics shine in hot-
pressed twelves¹⁷.
Thus saith the *Preacher*: "Nought 240
beneath the sun
Is new,"¹⁸ yet still from change to
change we run.
What varied wonders tempt us as

they pass!
The Cow-pox, Tractors,
Galvanism, and Gas¹⁹,
In turns appear, to make the
vulgar stare,
Till the swoln bubble bursts--and 250
all is air!
Nor less new schools of Poetry
arise,
Where dull pretenders grapple for
the prize:
O'er Taste awhile these Pseudo-
bards prevail^m;
Each country Book-club bows the
knee to Baal,
And, hurling lawful Genius from
the throne,
Erects a shrine and idol of its 260
ownⁿ;
Some leaden calf--but whom it
matters not,
From soaring **Southey**, down to
groveling **Stott**²⁰.

Behold! in various throngs the
scribbling crew,
For notice eager, pass in long
review:
Each spurs his jaded Pegasus 270
apace,
And Rhyme and Blank maintain
an equal race;
Sonnets on sonnets crowd, and
ode on ode;
And Tales of Terror²¹ jostle on
the road;

Immeasurable measures move
along;
For simpering Folly loves a 280
varied song,
To strange, mysterious Dulness
still the friend,
Admires the strain she cannot
comprehend.
Thus Lays of Minstrels²²--may
they be the last!--
On half-strung harps whine
mournful to the blast.
While mountain spirits prate to 290
river sprites,
That dames may listen to the
sound at nights;
And goblin brats, of Gilpin
Horner's²³ brood
Decoy young Border-nobles
through the wood,
And skip at every step, Lord
knows how high,
And frighten foolish babes, the
Lord knows why;
While high-born ladies in their 300
magic cell,
Forbidding Knights to read who
cannot spell,
Despatch a courier to a wizard's
grave,
And fight with honest men to
shield a knave.

Next view in state, proud
prancing on his roan,
The golden-crested haughty
Marmion, 310

Now forging scrolls, now
foremost in the fight,
Not quite a Felon, yet but half a
Knight⁰.
The gibbet or the field prepared
to grace;
A mighty mixture of the great and
base.
And think'st thou, **Scott!** by vain
conceit perchance,
On public taste to foist thy stale 320
romance,
Though **Murray** with his **Miller**
may combine
To yield thy muse just half-a-
crown per line²⁴?
No! when the sons of song
descend to trade,
Their bays are sear, their former
laurels fade,
Let such forego the poet's sacred
name,
Who rack their brains for lucre, 330
not for fame:
Still for stern Mammon may they
toil in vain²⁵!
And sadly gaze on Gold they
cannot gain!
Such be their meed, such still the
just reward^p
Of prostituted Muse and hireling
bard!
For this we spurn Apollo's venal 340
son,
And bid a long "good night to
Marmion."²⁶

These are the themes that claim
our plaudits now;
These are the Bards to whom the
Muse must bow;
While **Milton, Dryden, Pope,**
alike forgot,
Resign their hallowed Bays to 350
Walter Scott.

The time has been, when yet the
Muse was young,
When **Homer** swept the lyre, and
Maro sung,
An Epic scarce ten centuries
could claim,
While awe-struck nations hailed
the magic name: 360
The work of each immortal Bard
appears
The single wonder of a thousand
years²⁷.
Empires have mouldered from the
face of earth,
Tongues have expired with those
who gave them birth,
Without the glory such a strain
can give, 370
As even in ruin bids the language
live.
Not so with us, though minor
Bards, content^q,
On one great work a life of labour
spent:
With eagle pinion soaring to the
skies,
Behold the Ballad-monger

Southey rise!
To him let **Camoëns**, **Milton**, 380
Tasso yield,
Whose annual strains, like
armies, take the field.
First in the ranks see Joan of Arc
advance,
The scourge of England and the
boast of France!
Though burnt by wicked **Bedford**
for a witch,
Behold her statue placed in
Glory's niche; 390
Her fetters burst, and just released
from prison,
A virgin Phoenix from her ashes
risen.
Next see tremendous Thalaba
come on²⁸,
Arabia's monstrous, wild, and
wond'rous son;
Domdaniel's dread destroyer, who
o'erthrew
More mad magicians than the 400
world e'er knew.
Immortal Hero! all thy foes
o'ercome,
For ever reign--the rival of Tom
Thumb²⁹!
Since startled Metre fled before
thy face,
Well wert thou doomed the last of
all thy race!
Well might triumphant Genii bear 410
thee hence,
Illustrious conqueror of common
sense!

Now, last and greatest, Madoc
spreads his sails,
Cacique in Mexico³⁰, and Prince
in Wales;
Tells us strange tales, as other
travellers do,
More old than Mandeville's, and
not so true.
Oh, **Southey**! **Southey**³¹! cease 420
thy varied song!
A bard may chaunt too often and
too long:
As thou art strong in verse, in
mercy, spare! ^{c2}
A fourth, alas! were more than we
could bear.
But if, in spite of all the world
can say,
Thou still wilt verseward plod thy 430
weary way;
If still in Berkeley-Ballads most
uncivil,
Thou wilt devote old women to
the devil³²,
The babe unborn thy dread intent
may rue:
"God help thee," **Southey**³³, and
thy readers too.

Next comes the dull disciple of
thy school³⁴, 440
That mild apostate from poetic
rule,
The simple **Wordsworth**, framer
of a lay
As soft as evening in his favourite

May,
Who warns his friend "to shake
off toil and trouble,
And quit his books, for fear of
growing double;"³⁵ 450
Who, both by precept and
example, shows
That prose is verse, and verse is
merely prose;
Convincing all, by demonstration
plain,
Poetic souls delight in prose
insane;
And Christmas stories tortured
into rhyme
Contain the essence of the true 460
sublime.
Thus, when he tells the tale of
Betty Foy,
The idiot mother of "an idiot
Boy;"
A moon-struck, silly lad, who lost
his way, ^{c3}
And, like his bard, confounded
night with day³⁶
So close on each pathetic part he
dwells, 470
And each adventure so sublimely
tells,
That all who view the "idiot in his
glory"
Conceive the Bard the hero of the
story.

Shall gentle **Coleridge** pass
unnoticed here³⁷,
To turgid ode and tumid stanza 480

dear?
Though themes of innocence
amuse him best,
Yet still Obscurity's a welcome
guest.
If Inspiration should her aid
refuse
To him who takes a Pixy for a
muse³⁸,
Yet none in lofty numbers can 490
surpass
The bard who soars to elegize an
ass:
So well the subject suits his noble
mind^r,
He brays, the Laureate of the
long-eared kind^s.

Oh! wonder-working **Lewis**³⁹! 500
Monk, or Bard,
Who fain would make Parnassus
a church-yard^t!
Lo! wreaths of yew, not laurel,
bind thy brow,
Thy Muse a Sprite, Apollo's
sexton thou!
Whether on ancient tombs thou
tak'st thy stand,
By gibb'ring spectres hailed, thy
kindred band; 510
Or tracest chaste descriptions on
thy page,
To please the females of our
modest age;
All hail, M.P.⁴⁰! from whose
infernal brain

Thin-sheeted phantoms glide, a
grisly train;
At whose command "grim
women" throng in crowds,
And kings of fire, of water, and of 520
clouds,
With "small grey men,"--"wild
yagers," and what not,
To crown with honour thee and

Walter Scott:

Again, all hail! if tales like thine
may please,
St. Luke alone can vanquish the
disease:
Even Satan's self with thee might
dread to dwell, 530
And in thy skull discern a deeper
Hell.

Who in soft guise, surrounded by
a choir
Of virgins melting, not to Vesta's
fire,
With sparkling eyes, and cheek
by passion flushed
Strikes his wild lyre, whilst
listening dames are hushed?
'Tis **Little!** young Catullus of his 540
day,
As sweet, but as immoral, in his
Lay!
Grieved to condemn, the Muse
must still be just,
Nor spare melodious advocates of
lust.
Pure is the flame which o'er her
altar burns;

From grosser incense with disgust
she turns 550
Yet kind to youth, this expiation
o'er,
She bids thee "mend thy line, and
sin no more."u

For thee, translator of the tinsel
song,
To whom such glittering
ornaments belong,
Hibernian **Strangford!** with thine
eyes of blue⁴¹,
And boasted locks of red or 560
auburn hue,
Whose plaintive strain each love-
sick Miss admires,
And o'er harmonious fustian half c4
expires^v,
Learn, if thou canst, to yield thine
author's sense,
Nor vend thy sonnets on a false
pretence.
Think'st thou to gain thy verse a 570
higher place,
By dressing Camoëns⁴² in a suit
of lace?
Mend, **Strangford!** mend thy
morals and thy taste;
Be warm, but pure; be amorous,
but be chaste:
Cease to deceive; thy pilfered
harp restore,
Nor teach the Lusian Bard to
copy **Moore.** 580

Behold--Ye Tarts!--one moment

spare the text^w!--
Hayley's last work, and worst--
until his next;
Whether he spin poor couplets
into plays,
Or damn the dead with
purgatorial praise⁴³,
His style in youth or age is still
the same,
For ever feeble and for ever tame. 590
Triumphant first see "Temper's
Triumphs" shine!
At least I'm sure they triumphed
over mine.
Of "Music's Triumphs," all who
read may swear
That luckless Music never
triumph'd there⁴⁴.

Moravians, rise! bestow some 600
meet reward⁴⁵
On dull devotion--Lo! the
Sabbath Bard,
Sepulchral **Grahame**⁴⁶, pours his
notes sublime
In mangled prose, nor e'en aspires
to rhyme;
Breaks into blank the Gospel of
St. Luke^x,
And boldly pilfers from the 610
Pentateuch;
And, undisturbed by
conscientious qualms,
Perverts the Prophets, and
purloins the Psalms.

Hail, Sympathy! thy soft idea
brings"^y
A thousand visions of a thousand
things,
And shows, still whimpering thro'
threescore of years^z, 620
The maudlin prince of mournful
sonneteers.
And art thou not their prince,
harmonious Bowles⁴⁷!
Thou first, great oracle of tender
souls?
Whether them sing'st with equal
ease, and grief^A,
The fall of empires, or a yellow 630
leaf;
Whether thy muse most
lamentably tells
What merry sounds proceed from
Oxford bells^B,
Or, still in bells delighting, finds
a friend
In every chime that jingled from
Ostend;
Ah! how much juster were thy
Muse's hap, 640
If to thy bells thou would'st but
add a cap^C!
Delightful **Bowles**! still blessing
and still blest,
All love thy strain, but children
like it best.
'Tis thine, with gentle **Little's**
moral song,
To soothe the mania of the
amorous throng!

With thee our nursery damsels 650
shed their tears,
Ere Miss as yet completes her
infant years:
But in her teens thy whining
powers are vain;
She quits poor **Bowles** for
Little's purer strain.
Now to soft themes thou scornest
to confine^D
The lofty numbers of a harp like 660
thine;
"Awake a louder and a loftier
strain,"⁴⁸
Such as none heard before, or
will again!
Where all discoveries jumbled
from the flood,
Since first the leaky ark reposed
in mud,
By more or less, are sung in every 670
book,
From Captain Noah down to
Captain Cook.
Nor this alone--but, pausing on
the road,
The Bard sighs forth a gentle
episode^{49 E},
And gravely tells--attend, each
beauteous Miss!--
When first Madeira trembled to a 680
kiss.
Bowles! in thy memory let this
precept dwell,
Stick to thy Sonnets, Man!--at
least they sell.
But if some new-born whim, or

larger bribe, [c5](#)
Prompt thy crude brain, and claim
thee for a scribe:
If 'chance some bard, though
once by dunces feared,
Now, prone in dust, can only be 690
revered;
If Pope, whose fame and genius,
from the first [F](#),
Have foiled the best of critics,
needs the worst,
Do thou essay: each fault, each
failing scan;
The first of poets was, alas! but
man.
Rake from each ancient dunghill
ev'ry pearl, 700
Consult Lord Fanny, and confide
in **Curll** [50](#);
Let all the scandals of a former
age
Perch on thy pen, and flutter o'er
thy page;
Affect a candour which thou
canst not feel,
Clothe envy in a garb of honest
zeal;
Write, as if St. John's soul could 710
still inspire,
And do from hate what **Mallet** [51](#)
did for hire.
Oh! hadst thou lived in that
congenial time,
To rave with **Dennis**, and with
Ralph to rhyme [52](#);
Thronged with the rest around his
living head,

Not raised thy hoof against the lion dead, 720
A meet reward had crowned thy glorious gains,
And linked thee to the Dunciad
for thy pains⁵³.

Another Epic! Who inflicts again
More books of blank upon the
sons of men?
Boeotian **Cottle**, rich Bristowa's
boast, 730
Imports old stories from the
Cambrian coast,
And sends his goods to market--
all alive!
Lines forty thousand, Cantos
twenty-five!
Fresh fish from Hippocrene⁵⁴!
who'll buy? who'll buy?
The precious bargain's cheap--in
faith, not I.
Your turtle-feeder's verse must 740
needs be flat^G, ^{c10}
Though Bristol bloat him with the
verdant fat;
If Commerce fills the purse, she
clogs the brain,
And **Amos Cottle** strikes the
Lyre in vain.
In him an author's luckless lot
behold!
Condemned to make the books 750
which once he sold.
Oh, **Amos Cottle**!--Phoebus!
what a name
To fill the speaking-trump of

future fame!--

Oh, **Amos Cottle**! for a moment
think

What meagre profits spring from
pen and ink!

When thus devoted to poetic
dreams,

Who will peruse thy prostituted 760
reams?

Oh! pen perverted! paper
misapplied!

Had **Cottle**⁵⁵ still adorned the
counter's side,

Bent o'er the desk, or, born to
useful toils,

Been taught to make the paper
which he soils,

Ploughed, delved, or plied the oar
with lusty limb, c7 Ý770

He had not sung of Wales, nor I
of him.

As Sisyphus against the infernal
steep

Rolls the huge rock whose
motions ne'er may sleep,

So up thy hill, ambrosial
Richmond! heaves

Dull **Maurice**⁵⁶ all his granite 780
weight of leaves:

Smooth, solid monuments of
mental pain!

The petrifications of a plodding
brain,

That, ere they reach the top, fall c6
lumbering back again.

With broken lyre and cheek
serenely pale, 790
Lo! sad Alcæus wanders down
the vale;
Though fair they rose, and might
have bloomed at last,
His hopes have perished by the
northern blast:
Nipped in the bud by Caledonian
gales,
His blossoms wither as the blast
prevails!
O'er his lost works let *classic*
Sheffield weep; 800
May no rude hand disturb their
early sleep⁵⁷!

Yet say! why should the Bard, at
once, resign^H
His claim to favour from the
sacred Nine?
For ever startled by the mingled
howl
Of Northern Wolves, that still in 810
darkness prowl;
A coward Brood, which mangle
as they prey,
By hellish instinct, all that cross
their way;
Aged or young, the living or the
dead,"^J
No mercy find-these harpies must
be fed.
Why do the injured unresisting 820
yield
The calm possession of their
native field?

Why tamely thus before their
fangs retreat,
Nor hunt the blood-hounds back
to Arthur's Seat⁵⁸?

Health to immortal **Jeffrey**! once,
in name,
England could boast a judge 830
almost the same⁵⁹;
In soul so like, so merciful, yet
just,
Some think that Satan has
resigned his trust,
And given the Spirit to the world
again,
To sentence Letters, as he
sentenced men.
With hand less mighty, but with
heart as black, 840
With voice as willing to decree
the rack;
Bred in the Courts betimes,
though all that law
As yet hath taught him is to find a
flaw,--
Since well instructed in the
patriot school
To rail at party, though a party
tool--
Who knows? if chance his 850
patrons should restore
Back to the sway they forfeited
before,
His scribbling toils some
recompense may meet,
And raise this Daniel to the
Judgment-Seat⁶⁰.

Let **Jeffrey's** shade indulge the
pious hope,
And greeting thus, present him
with a rope: 860
"Heir to my virtues! man of equal
mind!
Skilled to condemn as to traduce
mankind,
This cord receive! for thee
reserved with care,
To wield in judgment, and at
length to wear."

Health to great **Jeffrey!** Heaven
preserve his life,
To flourish on the fertile shores of 870
Fife,
And guard it sacred in its future
wars,
Since authors sometimes seek the
field of Mars!
Can none remember that eventful
day⁶¹ K,
That ever-glorious, almost fatal
fray,
When **Little's** leadless pistol met 880
his eye⁶²,
And Bow-street Myrmidons
stood laughing by?
Oh, day disastrous! on her firm-
set rock,
Dunedin's castle felt a secret
shock;
Dark rolled the sympathetic
waves of Forth,
Low groaned the startled
whirlwinds of the north; 890

Tweed ruffled half his waves to
form a tear,

The other half pursued his calm
career⁶³;

Arthur's steep summit nodded to
its base,

The surly Tolbooth scarcely kept
her place.

The Tolbooth felt--for marble
sometimes can,

On such occasions, feel as much
as man-- 900

The Tolbooth felt defrauded of
his charms,

If **Jeffrey** died, except within her
arms⁶⁴:

Nay. last, not least, on that
portentous morn,

The sixteenth story, where
himself was born,

His patrimonial garret, fell to
ground,

And pale Edina shuddered at the 910
sound:

Strewed were the streets around
with milk-white reams,

Flowed all the Canongate with
inky streams;

This of his candour seemed the
sable dew,

That of his valour showed the
bloodless hue;

And all with justice deemed the
two combined

The mingled emblems of his 920
mighty mind.

But Caledonia's goddess hovered

o'er
The field, and saved him from the
wrath of Moore;
From either pistol snatched the
vengeful lead,
And straight restored it to her
favourite's head;
That head, with greater than
magnetic power, 930
Caught it, as Danæe caught the
golden shower,
And, though the thickening dross
will scarce refine,
Augments its ore, and is itself a
mine.
"My son," she cried, "ne'er thirst
for gore again,
Resign the pistol and resume the
pen;
O'er politics and poesy preside, 940
Boast of thy country, and
Britannia's guide!
For long as Albion's heedless
sons submit,
Or Scottish taste decides on
English wit,
So long shall last thine
unmolested reign,
Nor any dare to take thy name in
vain.
Behold, a chosen band shall aid 950
thy plan,
And own thee chieftain of the
critic clan.
First in the oat-fed phalanx⁶⁵
shall be seen
The travelled Thane, Athenian

Aberdeen⁶⁶.

Herbert shall wield **Thor's**
hammer⁶⁷, and sometimes
In gratitude, thou'lt praise his
rugged rhymes. 960

Smug **Sydney**⁶⁸ too thy bitter
page shall seek,
And classic **Hallam**⁶⁹, much
renowned for Greek;
Scott may perchance his name
and influence lend,
And paltry **Pillans**⁷⁰ shall traduce
his friend;

While gay Thalia's luckless
votary, **Lamb**⁷¹ M, 970
Damned like the Devil--Devil-
like will damn.

Known be thy name! unbounded
be thy sway!

Thy **Holland's** banquets shall
each toil repay!
While grateful Britain yields the
praise she owes
To **Holland's** hirelings and to
Learning's foes.

Yet mark one caution ere thy next
Review 980
Spread its light wings of Saffron
and of Blue,

Beware lest blundering
Brougham⁷² destroy the sale,
Turn Beef to Bannocks,
Cauliflowers to Kail."

Thus having said, the kilted
Goddess kist
Her son, and vanished in a

Scottish mist⁷³.

Then prosper, **Jeffrey!** pertest of 990
the train⁷⁴

Whom Scotland pampers with her
fiery grain!

Whatever blessing waits a
genuine Scot,

In double portion swells thy
glorious lot;

For thee Edina culls her evening
sweets,

And showers their odours on thy
candid sheets,

Whose Hue and Fragrance to thy 1000
work adhere--

This scents its pages, and that
gilds its rear⁷⁵.

Lo! blushing Itch, coy nymph,
enamoured grown,

Forsakes the rest, and cleaves to c13
thee alone,

And, too unjust to other Pictish
men,

Enjoys thy person, and inspires 1010
thy pen!

Illustrious **Holland!** hard would
be his lot,

His hirelings mentioned, and
himself forgot⁷⁶!

Holland, with **Henry Petty**⁷⁷ at
his back,

The whipper-in and huntsman of
the pack.

Blest be the banquets spread at 1020

Holland House,
Where Scotchmen feed, and
Critics may carouse!
Long, long beneath that
hospitable roof^N
Shall Grub-street dine, while
duns are kept aloof.
See honest **Hallam**⁷⁸ lay aside his
fork,
Resume his pen, review his
Lordship's work,
And, grateful for the dainties on
his plate^P, 1030
Declare his landlord can at least
translate⁷⁹!
Dunedin! view thy children with
delight,
They write for food--and feed
because they write^Q:
And lest, when heated with the
unusual grape,
Some glowing thoughts should to
the press escape, 1040
And tinge with red the female
reader's cheek,
My lady skims the cream of each
critique;
Breathes o'er the page her purity
of soul,
Reforms each error, and refines
the whole⁸⁰.

Now to the Drama turn--Oh! 1050
motley sight!
What precious scenes the
wondering eyes invite:

Puns, and a Prince within a barrel
 pent^{81 R},
And Dibdin's nonsense yield
 complete content⁸².
Though now, thank Heaven! the
 Rosciomania's o'er⁸³.
And full-grown actors are 1060
 endured once more;
 Yet what avail their vain attempts
 to please,
 While British critics suffer scenes
 like these;
While Reynolds vents his
 "dammes!" "poohs!" and
 "zounds!"^{84 S}
And common-place and common 1070
 sense confounds?
 While **Kenney's**⁸⁵ "World"--ah!
 where is **Kenney's** wit^T?--
Tires the sad gallery, lulls the
 listless Pit;
And Beaumont's pilfered
 Caratach affords
 A tragedy complete in all but
 words^{85a}?
Who but must mourn, while these
 are all the rage
 The degradation of our vaunted
 stage?
 Heavens! is all sense of shame
 and talent gone?
Have we no living Bard of merit?
 --none?
 Awake, **George Colman**⁸⁶!
Cumberland, awake⁸⁷!
Ring the alarum bell! let folly

quake!
Oh! **Sheridan**! if aught can move
thy pen,
Let Comedy assume her throne
again^V;
Abjure the mummery of German
schools;
Leave new Pizarros to translating
fools⁸⁸;
Give, as thy last memorial to the
age,
One classic drama, and reform
the stage.
Gods! o'er those boards shall
Folly rear her head,
Where **Garrick** trod, and
Siddons lives to tread^{89W}?
On those shall Farce display
buffoonery's mask,
And **Hook** conceal his heroes in a
cask⁹⁰?
Shall sapient managers new
scenes produce
From **Cherry**⁹¹, **Skeffington**⁹²,
and Mother **Goose**⁹³ ~~X~~?
While **Shakespeare**, **Otway**,
Massinger, forgot,
On stalls must moulder, or in
closets rot?
Lo! with what pomp the daily
prints proclaim
The rival candidates for Attic
fame!
In grim array though **Lewis**'
spectres rise,
Still **Skeffington** and **Goose**

divide the prize.
And sure *great* Skeffington must
claim our praise,
For skirtless coats and skeletons
of plays
Renowned alike; whose genius
ne'er confines
Her flight to garnish Greenwood's
gay designs⁹⁴ Y;
Nor sleeps with "Sleeping
Beauties," but anon
In five facetious acts comes
thundering on.
While poor John Bull, bewildered
with the scene,
Stares, wondering what the devil
it can mean;
But as some hands applaud, a
venal few!
Rather than sleep, why John
applauds it too.

Such are we now. Ah! wherefore
should we turn
To what our fathers were, unless
to mourn?
Degenerate Britons! are ye dead
to shame,
Or, kind to dulness, do you fear to
blame?
Well may the nobles of our
present race
Watch each distortion of a
Naldi's face;
Well may they smile on Italy's
buffoons,
And worship **Catalani's**

pantaloon⁹⁵,
Since their own Drama yields no
fairer trace
Of wit than puns, of humour than
grimace⁹⁶.

Then let Ausonia, skill'd in every
art
To soften manners, but corrupt
the heart,
Pour her exotic follies o'er the
town,
To sanction Vice, and hunt
Decorum down:
Let wedded strumpets languish
o'er **Deshayes**,
And bless the promise which his
form displays;
While Gayton bounds before th'
enraptured looks
Of hoary Marquises, and stripling
Dukes:
Let high-born lechers eye the
lively Presle
Twirl her light limbs, that spurn
the needless veil;
Let Angiolini bare her breast of
snow,
Wave the white arm, and point
the pliant toe;
Collini trill her love-inspiring
song,
Strain her fair neck, and charm
the listening throng!
Whet⁹⁷ not your scythe,
Suppressors of our Vice!
Reforming Saints! too delicately

nice!

By whose decrees, our sinful
souls to save,
No Sunday tankards foam, no
barbers shave;
And beer undrawn, and beards
unmown, display
Your holy reverence for the
Sabbath-day.

Or hail at once the patron and the
pile

Of vice and folly, Greville and
Argyle⁹⁸!

Where yon proud palace,
Fashion's hallow'd fane,

Spreads wide her portals for the
motley train,

Behold the new Petronius⁹⁹ of the
day^Z,

Our arbiter of pleasure and of
play!

There the hired eunuch, the
Hesperian choir,

The melting lute, the soft
lascivious lyre,

The song from Italy, the step
from France,

The midnight orgy, and the mazy
dance,

The smile of beauty, and the flush
of wine,

For fops, fools, gamesters,
knaves, and Lords combine:

Each to his humour--Comus all
allows;

Champaign, dice, music, or your

neighbour's spouse.
Talk not to us, ye starving sons of
trade!
Of piteous ruin, which ourselves
have made;
In Plenty's sunshine Fortune's
minions bask,
Nor think of Poverty, except "en
masque,"¹⁰⁰
When for the night some lately
titled ass
Appears the beggar which his
grandsire was,
The curtain dropped, the gay
Burletta o'er,
The audience take their turn upon
the floor:
Now round the room the circling
dow'gers sweep,
Now in loose waltz the thin-clad
daughters leap;
The first in lengthened line
majestic swim,
The last display the free
unfettered limb!
Those for Hibernia's lusty sons
repair
With art the charms which Nature
could not spare;
These after husbands wing their
eager flight,
Nor leave much mystery for the
nuptial night.

Oh! blest retreats of infamy and
ease,
Where, all forgotten but the

power to please,
Each maid may give a loose to
genial thought,
Each swain may teach new
systems, or be taught:
There the blithe youngster, just
returned from Spain,
Cuts the light pack, or calls the
rattling main;
The jovial Caster's set, and
seven's the Nick,
Or--done!--a thousand on the
coming trick!
If, mad with loss, existence 'gins
to tire,
And all your hope or wish is to
expire,
Here's **Powell's**¹⁰¹ pistol ready
for your life,
And, kinder still, two **Pagets** for
your wife^{Aa}:
Fit consummation of an earthly
race
Begun in folly, ended in disgrace,
While none but menials o'er the
bed of death,
Wash thy red wounds, or watch
thy wavering breath;
Traduced by liars, and forgot by
all,
The mangled victim of a drunken
brawl,
To live like **Clodius**¹⁰², and like
Falkland fall¹⁰³.

Truth! rouse some genuine Bard,
and guide his hand

To drive this pestilence from out
the land.
E'en I--least thinking of a
thoughtless throng,
Just skilled to know the right and
choose the wrong,
Freed at that age when Reason's
shield is lost,
To fight my course through
Passion's countless host¹⁰⁴,
Whom every path of Pleasure's
flow'ry way
Has lured in turn, and all have led
astray--
E'en I must raise my voice, e'en I
must feel
Such scenes, such men, destroy
the public weal:
Altho' some kind, censorious
friend will say,
"What art thou better, meddling
fool¹⁰⁵, than they?"
And every Brother Rake will
smile to see
That miracle, a Moralist in me.
No matter--when some Bard in
virtue strong,
Gifford perchance, shall raise the
chastening song,
Then sleep my pen for ever! and
my voice
Be only heard to hail him, and
rejoice,
Rejoice, and yield my feeble
praise, though I
May feel the lash that Virtue must
apply.

As for the smaller fry, who
swarm in shoals
From silly **Hafiz** up to simple
Bowles¹⁰⁶,
Why should we call them from
their dark abode,
In Broad St. Giles's or
Tottenham-Road?
Or (since some men of fashion
nobly dare
To scrawl in verse) from Bond-
street or the Square^{Bb}?
If things of Ton their harmless
lays indite,
Most wisely doomed to shun the
public sight,
What harm? in spite of every
critic elf,
Sir T. may read his stanzas to
himself;
Miles Andrews¹⁰⁷ still his
strength in couplets try,
And live in prologues, though his
dramas die.
Lords too are Bards: such things
at times befall,
And 'tis some praise in Peers to
write at all.
Yet, did or Taste or Reason sway
the times,
Ah! who would take their titles
with their rhymes¹⁰⁸?
Roscommon¹⁰⁹! **Sheffield**¹¹⁰!
with your spirits fled¹¹¹,
No future laurels deck a noble

head;
No Muse will cheer, with
renovating smile,
The paralytic puling of
Carlisle¹¹² [Cc](#).
The puny schoolboy and his early
lay
Men pardon, if his follies pass
away;
But who forgives the Senior's
ceaseless verse,
Whose hairs grow hoary as his
rhymes grow worse?
What heterogeneous honours
deck the Peer!
Lord, rhymester, petit-maître,
pamphleteer¹¹³!
So dull in youth, so drivelling in
his age,
His scenes alone had damned our
sinking stage;
But Managers for once cried,
"Hold, enough!"
Nor drugged their audience with
the tragic stuff.
Yet at their judgment let his
Lordship laugh^{Dd},
And case his volumes in
congenial calf;
Yes! doff that covering, where
Morocco shines,
And hang a calf-skin on those
recreant lines¹¹⁴.

With you, ye Druids! rich in
native lead,
Who daily scribble for your daily

bread:

With you I war not: **Gifford's**
heavy hand

Has crushed, without remorse,
your numerous band.

On "All the Talents" vent your
venal spleen¹¹⁵;

Want is your plea, let Pity be your
screen.

Let Monodies on Fox regale your
crew,

And Melville's Mantle¹¹⁶ prove a
Blanket too!

One common Lethe waits each
hapless Bard,

And, peace be with you! 'tis your
best reward.

Such damning fame; as Dunciads
only give^{Ee}

Could bid your lines beyond a
morning live;

But now at once your fleeting
labours close,

With names of greater note in
blest repose.

Far be't from me unkindly to
upbraid

The lovely **Rosa's** prose in
masquerade,

Whose strains, the faithful echoes
of her mind,

Leave wondering comprehension
far behind¹¹⁷.

Though Crusca's bards no more
our journals fill¹¹⁸,

Some stragglers skirmish round

the columns still;
Last of the howling host which
once was Bell's^{Ff},
Matilda snivels yet, and Hafiz
yells;
And Merry's¹¹⁹ metaphors appear
anew,
Chained to the signature of O. P.
Q.¹²⁰
When some brisk youth, the
tenant of a stall,
Employs a pen less pointed than
his awl,
Leaves his snug shop, forsakes
his store of shoes,
St. Crispin quits, and cobbles for
the Muse,
Heavens! how the vulgar stare!
how crowds applaud!
How ladies read, and Literati
laud¹²¹!
If chance some wicked wag
should pass his jest,
'Tis sheer ill-nature--don't the
world know best?
Genius must guide when wits
admire the rhyme,
And **Capel Lofft**¹²² declares 'tis
quite sublime.
Hear, then, ye happy sons of
needless trade!
Swains! quit the plough, resign
the useless spade!
Lo! **Burns** and **Bloomfield**, nay,
a greater far,
Gifford was born beneath an

adverse star,
Forsook the labours of a servile
state,
Stemmed the rude storm, and
triumphed over Fate:
Then why no more? if Phoebus
smiled on you,
Bloomfield! why not on brother
Nathan too¹²³?
Him too the Mania, not the Muse,
has seized;
Not inspiration, but a mind
diseased:
And now no Boor can seek his
last abode,
No common be inclosed without
an ode.
Oh! since increased refinement
deigns to smile
On Britain's sons, and bless our
genial Isle,
Let Poesy go forth, pervade the
whole,
Alike the rustic, and mechanic
soul!
Ye tuneful cobblers! still your
notes prolong,
Compose at once a slipper and a
song;
So shall the fair your handywork
peruse,
Your sonnets sure shall please--
perhaps your shoes.
May Moorland weavers¹²⁴ boast
Pindaric skill,
And tailors' lays be longer than
their bill!

While punctual beaux reward the
grateful notes,
And pay for poems--when they
pay for coats.

To the famed throng now paid the
tribute due^{Gg},
Neglected Genius! let me turn to
you.

Come forth, oh **Campbell!** give
thy talents scope;
Who dares aspire if thou must
cease to hope?

And thou, melodious **Rogers!**
rise at last,
Recall the pleasing memory of
the past¹²⁵;

Arise! let blest remembrance still
inspire,

And strike to wonted tones thy
hallowed lyre;

Restore Apollo to his vacant
throne,

Assert thy country's honour and
thine own.

What! must deserted Poesy still
weep

Where her last hopes with pious
Cowper sleep?

Unless, perchance, from his cold
bier she turns,

To deck the turf that wraps her
minstrel, **Burns!**

No! though contempt hath
marked the spurious brood,
The race who rhyme from folly,
or for food,

Yet still some genuine sons 'tis
hers to boast,
Who, least affecting, still affect
the most^{Hh}.
Feel as they write, and write but
as they feel--
Bear witness **Gifford**¹²⁶,
Sotheby¹²⁷, **Macneil**¹²⁸.
"Why slumbers **Gifford**?" once
was asked in vain;
Why slumbers **Gifford**? let us
ask again¹²⁹.
Are there no follies for his pen to
purge?
Are there no fools whose backs
demand the scourge?
Are there no sins for Satire's Bard
to greet?
Stalks not gigantic Vice in every
street?
Shall Peers or Princes tread
pollution's path,
And 'scape alike the Laws and
Muse's wrath?
Nor blaze with guilty glare
through future time,
Eternal beacons of consummate
crime?
Arouse thee, **Gifford**! be thy
promise claimed,
Make bad men better, or at least
ashamed.

Unhappy **White**¹³⁰! while life
was in its spring,
And thy young Muse just waved

her joyous wing,
The Spoiler swept that soaring
Lyre away^{131 Jj},
Which else had sounded an
immortal lay.
Oh! what a noble heart was here
undone,
When Science' self destroyed her
favourite son!
Yes, she too much indulged thy
fond pursuit,
She sowed the seeds, but Death
has reaped the fruit.
'Twas thine own Genius gave the
final blow,
And helped to plant the wound
that laid thee low:
So the struck Eagle, stretched
upon the plain,
No more through rolling clouds
to soar again,
Viewed his own feather on the
fatal dart,
And winged the shaft that
quivered in his heart;
Keen were his pangs, but keener
far to feel
He nursed the pinion which
impelled the steel;
While the same plumage that had
warmed his nest
Drank the last life-drop of his
bleeding breast.

There be who say, in these
enlightened days,
That splendid lies are all the

poet's praise;
That strained Invention, ever on
the wing,
Alone impels the modern Bard to
sing:
Tis true, that all who rhyme--nay,
all who write,
Shrink from that fatal word to
Genius--Trite;
Yet Truth sometimes will lend her
noblest fires,
And decorate the verse herself
inspires:
This fact in Virtue's name let
Crabbe¹³² attest;
Though Nature's sternest Painter,
yet the best.

And here let **Shee**¹³³ and Genius
find a place,
Whose pen and pencil yield an
equal grace;
To guide whose hand the sister
Arts combine,
And trace the Poet's or the
Painter's line;
Whose magic touch can bid the
canvas glow,
Or pour the easy rhyme's
harmonious flow;
While honours, doubly merited,
attend^{Kk}
The Poet's rival, but the Painter's
friend.

Blest is the man who dares
approach the bower

Where dwelt the Muses at their
natal hour;
Whose steps have pressed, whose
eye has marked afar,
The clime that nursed the sons of
song and war,
The scenes which Glory still must
hover o'er,
Her place of birth, her own
Achaian shore.
But doubly blest is he whose
heart expands
With hallowed feelings for those
classic lands;
Who rends the veil of ages long
gone by,
And views their remnants with a
poet's eye!
Wright¹³⁴: 'twas thy happy lot at
once to view
Those shores of glory, and to sing
them too;
And sure no common Muse
inspired thy pen
To hail the land of Gods and
Godlike men.

And you, associate Bards¹³⁵! who
snatched to light^{Mm}
Those gems too long withheld
from modern sight;
Whose mingling taste combined
to cull the wreath
While Attic flowers Aonian
odours breathe,
And all their renovated fragrance
flung,

To grace the beauties of your
native tongue;
Now let those minds, that nobly
could transfuse
The glorious Spirit of the Grecian
Muse,
Though soft the echo, scorn a
borrowed tone^{Nn}:
Resign Achaia's lyre, and strike
your own.

Let these, or such as these, with
just applause^{Pp},
Restore the Muse's violated laws;
But not in flimsy **Darwin's**¹³⁶
pompous chime^{Qq},
That mighty master of unmeaning
rhyme,
Whose gilded cymbals, more
adorned than clear,
The eye delighted, but fatigued
the ear,
In show the simple lyre could
once surpass,
But now, worn down, appear in
native brass;
While all his train of hovering
sylphs around
Evaporate in similes and sound:
Him let them shun, with him let
tinsel die:
False glare attracts, but more
offends the eye¹³⁷.

Yet let them not to vulgar
Wordsworth¹³⁸ stoop,

The meanest object of the lowly
group,
Whose verse, of all but childish
prattle void,
Seems blessed harmony to **Lamb**
and **Lloyd**¹³⁹:
Let them--but hold, my Muse, nor
dare to teach
A strain far, far beyond thy
humble reach:
The native genius with their
being given
Will point the path, and peal their
notes to heaven.

And thou, too, **Scott**¹⁴⁰! resign to
minstrels rude
The wilder Slogan of a Border
feud:
Let others spin their meagre lines
for hire;
Enough for Genius, if itself
inspire!
Let **Southey** sing, altho' his
teeming muse^{Rr},
Prolific every spring, be too
profuse;
Let simple **Wordsworth**¹⁴¹
chime his childish verse,
And brother **Coleridge** lull the
babe at nurse^{Ss}
Let Spectre-mongering **Lewis**
aim, at most^{Tt},
To rouse the Galleries, or to raise
a ghost;
Let **Moore** still sigh; let

Strangford steal from **Moore**^{Uu},
And swear that **Camoëns** sang
such notes of yore;
Let **Hayley** hobble on,
Montgomery rave,
And godly **Grahame** chant a
stupid stave;
Let sonneteering **Bowles**¹⁴² his
strains refine,
And whine and whimper to the
fourteenth line;
Let **Stott**, **Carlisle**¹⁴³, **Matilda**,
and the rest
Of Grub Street, and of Grosvenor
Place the best,
Scrawl on, 'till death release us
from the strain,
Or Common Sense assert her
rights again;
But Thou, with powers that mock
the aid of praise,
Should'st leave to humbler Bards
ignoble lays:
Thy country's voice, the voice of
all the Nine,
Demand a hallowed harp--that
harp is thine.
Say! will not Caledonia's annals
yield
The glorious record of some
nobler field,
Than the vile foray of a
plundering clan,
Whose proudest deeds disgrace
the name of man?
Or Marmion's acts of darkness,
fitter food

For **Sherwood's** outlaw tales of
Robin Hood^{Vv?}

Scotland! still proudly claim thy
native Bard,

And be thy praise his first, his
best reward!

Yet not with thee alone his name
should live,

But own the vast renown a world
can give;

Be known, perchance, when

Albion is no more,

And tell the tale of what she was
before;

To future times her faded fame
recall,

And save her glory, though his
country fall.

Yet what avails the sanguine

Poet's hope,

To conquer ages, and with time to
cope?

New eras spread their wings, new
nations rise,

And other Victors fill th'

applauding skies¹⁴⁴;

A few brief generations fleet
along,

Whose sons forget the Poet and
his song:

E'en now, what once-loved

Minstrels scarce may claim

The transient mention of a
dubious name!

When Fame's loud trump hath
blown its noblest blast,

Though long the sound, the echo
sleeps at last;
And glory, like the Phoenix¹⁴⁵
midst her fires,
Exhales her odours, blazes, and
expires.

Shall hoary Granta call her sable
sons,
Expert in science, more expert at
puns?
Shall these approach the Muse?
ah, no! she flies,
Even from the tempting ore of
Seaton's prize^{Ww};
Though Printers condescend the
press to soil
With rhyme by **Hoare**¹⁴⁶, and
epic blank by **Hoyle**¹⁴⁷ Xx:
Not him whose page, if still
upheld by whist,
Requires no sacred theme to bid
us list¹⁴⁸.
Ye! who in Granta's honours
would surpass,
Must mount her Pegasus, a full-
grown ass;
A foal well worthy of her ancient
Dam,
Whose Helicon¹⁴⁹ is duller than
her Cam^{Yy}.

There **Clarke**¹⁵⁰, still striving
piteously "to please,"^{Zz}
Forgetting doggerel leads not to
degrees,

A would-be satirist, a hired
Buffoon,
A monthly scribbler of some low
Lampoon¹⁵¹,
Condemned to drudge, the
meanest of the mean,
And furbish falsehoods for a
magazine,
Devotes to scandal his congenial
mind;
Himself a living libel on
mankind.

Oh! dark asylum of a Vandal
race¹⁵²!
At once the boast of learning, and
disgrace!
So lost to Phoebus, that nor
Hodgson's¹⁵³ verse
Can make thee better, nor poor
Hewson's¹⁵⁴ worse^{aA}.
But where fair Isis rolls her purer
wave,
The partial Muse delighted loves
to lave;
On her green banks a greener
wreath she wove^{bB},
To crown the Bards that haunt her
classic grove;
Where **Richards** wakes a genuine
poet's fires,
And modern Britons glory in
their Sires^{155 cC}.

For me, who, thus unasked, have
dared to tell

My country, what her sons should
know too well^{dD},
Zeal for her honour bade me here
engage^{eE}
The host of idiots that infest her
age;
No just applause her honoured
name shall lose,
As first in freedom, dearest to the
Muse.
Oh! would thy bards but emulate
thy fame,
And rise more worthy, Albion, of
thy name!
What Athens was in science,
Rome in power,
What Tyre appeared in her
meridian hour,
'Tis thine at once, fair Albion! to
have been--
Earth's chief Dictatress, Ocean's
lovely Queen^{fF}:
But Rome decayed, and Athens
strewed the plain,
And Tyre's proud piers lie
shattered in the main;
Like these, thy strength may sink,
in ruin hurled^{gG},
And Britain fall, the bulwark of
the world.
But let me cease, and dread
Cassandra's fate,
With warning ever scoffed at, till
too late;
To themes less lofty still my lay
confine,
And urge thy Bards to gain a

name like thine¹⁵⁶.

Then, hapless Britain! be thy
rulers blest,
The senate's oracles, the people's
jest!
Still hear thy motley orators
dispense
The flowers of rhetoric, though
not of sense,
While **Canning's** colleagues hate
him for his wit,
And old dame **Portland**¹⁵⁷ fills
the place of **Pitt**.

Yet once again, adieu! ere this the
sail
That wafts me hence is shivering
in the gale;
And Afric's coast and Calpe's
adverse height¹⁵⁸,
And Stamboul's minarets must
greet my sight:
Thence shall I stray through
Beauty's native clime¹⁵⁹,
Where Kaff¹⁶⁰ is clad in rocks,
and crowned with snows sublime.
But should I back return, no
tempting press^{hH}
Shall drag my Journal from the
desk's recess;
Let coxcombs, printing as they
come from far,
Snatch his own wreath of
Ridicule from Carr;
Let **Aberdeen** and **Elgin**¹⁶¹ still

pursue
The shade of fame through
regions of Virtù;
Waste useless thousands on their
Phidian freaks,
Misshapen monuments and
maimed antiques;
And make their grand saloons a
general mart
For all the mutilated blocks of art:
Of Dardan tours let Dilettanti tell,
I leave topography to rapid¹⁶²
Gell¹⁶³;
And, quite content, no more shall
interpose
To stun the public ear--at least
with Prose^j.

Thus far I've held my undisturbed
career,
Prepared for rancour, steeled
'gainst selfish fear;
This thing of rhyme I ne'er
disdained to own--
Though not obtrusive, yet not
quite unknown:
My voice was heard again,
though not so loud,
My page, though nameless, never
disavowed;
And now at once I tear the veil
away:--
Cheer on the pack! the Quarry
stands at bay,
Unscared by all the din of
Melbourne house¹⁶⁴,
By **Lamb's** resentment, or by

Holland's spouse,
By **Jeffrey's** harmless pistol,
Hallam's rage,
Edina's brawny sons and
brimstone page.
Our men in buckram shall have
blows enough,
And feel they too are "penetrable
stuff:"
And though I hope not hence
unscathed to go,
Who conquers me shall find a
stubborn foe.
The time hath been, when no
harsh sound would fall
From lips that now may seem
imbued with gall;
Nor fools nor follies tempt me to
despise
The meanest thing that crawled
beneath my eyes:
But now, so callous grown, so
changed since youth,
I've learned to think, and sternly
speak the truth;
Learned to deride the critic's
starch decree,
And break him on the wheel he
meant for me;
To spurn the rod a scribbler bids
me kiss,
Nor care if courts and crowds
applaud or hiss:
Nay more, though all my rival
rhymesters frown,
I too can hunt a Poetaster down;
And, armed in proof, the gauntlet

cast at once
 To Scotch marauder, and to
 Southern dunce.
 Thus much I've dared; if my
 incondite lay^{kK}
Hath wronged these righteous
 times, let others say:
This, let the world, which knows
 not how to spare,
 Yet rarely blames unjustly, now
 declare¹⁶⁵.

Footnote 1: Ý "The *binding* of this **Footnote a:**Ý

volume is considerably too
 valuable for the contents. Nothing
 but the consideration of its being
 the property of another, prevents
 me from consigning this miserable
 record of misplaced anger and
 indiscriminate acrimony to the
 flames."--B., 1816.

*Truth be my theme, and
 Censure guide my song.*

[MS M.]

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Footnote 2: Ý**Imitation:**

"Semper ego auditor tantum?
 nunquamne reponam,
 Vexatus toties, rauci Theseide
 Codri?"

Juvenal, *Satire I*.l. 1.

[return](#)

Footnote b:Ý

*But thou, at least, mine own
 especial quill
 Dipt in the dew drops from
 Parnassus' hill,
 Shalt ever honoured and
 regarded be,
 By more beside no doubt, yet
 still by me....*

[MS M.]

[return](#)

Footnote 3: Ý "*Hoarse Fitzgerald*.--"Right enough; but why notice such a mountebank?"-- B., 1816.

Footnote c:Ý
And men through life her willing slaves obey...

Mr. Fitzgerald, facetiously termed by Cobbett the "Small Beer Poet," inflicts his annual tribute of verse on the Literary Fund: not content with writing, he spouts in person, after the company have imbibed a reasonable quantity of bad port, to enable them to sustain the operation. [MS. Second, Third, and Fourth Editions.] [return](#)

[William Thomas Fitzgerald (circ. 1759-1829) played the part of unofficial poet laureate. His loyal recitations were reported by the newspapers. He published, *inter alia*, *Nelson's Triumph* (1798), *Tears of Hibernia, dispelled by the Union* (1802), and *Nelson's Tomb* (1806). He owes his fame to the first line of *English Bards*, and the famous parody in *Rejected Addresses*. The following *jeux d'esprits* were transcribed by R. C. Dallas on a blank leaf of a copy of the Fifth Edition:--

"Written on a copy of *English Bards* at the 'Alfred' by W. T. Fitzgerald, Esq.--

I find Lord Byron scorns my
Muse, Our Fates are ill

agreed; The Verse is safe, I
can't abuse Those lines, I
never read.

Signed W. T. F."

Answer written on the same page
by Lord Byron--

"What's writ on me," cries
Fitz, "I never read"! What's
writ by thee, dear Fitz, none
will, indeed. The case stands
simply thus, then, honest
Fitz, Thou and thine enemies
are fairly quits; Or rather
would be, if for time to come,
They luckily were *deaf*, or
thou wert dumb; But to their
pens while scribblers add
their tongues. The Waiter
only can escape their lungs^A.

Sub-Footnote A Compare *Hints*
from Horace, [l. 808](#) (click c12 to
return), [note 1](#).

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[cross-reference: return to Footnote](#)
[77 of Hints from Horace](#)

Footnote 4: Ý Cid Hamet
Benengeli promises repose to his
pen, in the last chapter of *Don*
Quixote. Oh! that our voluminous
gentry would follow the example
of Cid Hamet Benengeli!

[return](#)

Footnote d: Ý

*Unfolds her motley store to
suit the time...*

[MS. Second, Third, and Fourth
Editions.]

[return](#)

Footnote 5: Ý "This must have been written in the spirit of prophecy." (B., 1816.)
[return](#)

Footnote e: Ý

*When Justice halts and Right
begins to fail...*

[MS. Second, Third, and Fourth Editions.

[return](#)

Footnote 6: Ý "He's a very good fellow; and, except his mother and sister, the best of the set, to my mind."--B., 1816. [William (1779-1848) and George (1784-1834) Lamb, sons of Sir Peniston Lamb (Viscount Melbourne, 1828), by Elizabeth, only daughter of Sir Ralph Milbanke, were Lady Byron's first cousins. William married, in 1805, Lady Caroline Ponsonby, the writer of *Glenarvon*. George, who was one of the early contributors to the *Edinburgh Review*, married in 1809 Caroline Rosalie Adelaide St. Jules. At the time of the separation, Lady Caroline Lamb and Mrs. George Lamb warmly espoused Lady Byron's cause, Lady Melbourne and her daughter Lady Cowper (afterwards Lady Palmerston) were rather against than for Lady Byron. William Lamb was discreetly silent, and George Lamb declaimed against Lady Byron, calling her a d----d fool. Hence Lord Byron's praises of George. Cf. line 517 of *English*

Footnote f: Ý

A mortal weapon...

[MS M.]

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Bards.

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Footnote 7: Ý This ingenuous youth is mentioned more particularly, with his production, in another place. (*Vide post*, l. 516.)

"Spurious Brat" [see [Footnote g](#)], that is the farce; the ingenuous youth who begat it is mentioned more particularly with his offspring in another place. [Note. MS. M.]

[The farce *Whistle for It* was performed two or three times at Covent Garden Theatre in 1807.

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Footnote 8: Ý In the *Edinburgh Review*.

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Footnote 9: Ý The proverbial "Joe" Miller, an actor by profession (1684-1738), was a man of no education, and is said to have been unable to read. His reputation rests mainly on the book of jests compiled after his death, and attributed to him by John Mottley. (First Edition. T. Read. 1739.)

[return](#)

Footnote g: Ý

*Yet Titles sounding lineage
cannot save
Or scrawl or scribbler from
an equal grave,
Lamb had his farce but that
Patrician name
Failed to preserve the
spurious brat from shame....*

[MS.]

[return to poem](#)

[cross-reference: return to Footnote 7 of this poem](#)

Footnote h: Ý

a lucky hit....

[*Second, Third, and Fourth Editions*]

[return](#)

Footnote i: Ý

No dearth of rhyme...

[*British Bards*]

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Footnote 10: Ý Messrs. Jeffrey and Lamb are the alpha and omega, the first and last of the *Edinburgh Review*; the others are mentioned hereafter.

[The MS. Note is as follows:--

"Of the young gentlemen who write in the *E.R.*, I have now named the alpha and omega, the first and the last, the best and the worst. The intermediate members are designated with due honour hereafter."]

"This was not just. Neither the heart nor the head of these gentlemen are at all what they are here represented. At the time this was written, I was personally unacquainted with either."--
B., 1816.

[Francis Jeffrey (1773-1850) founded the *Edinburgh Review* in conjunction with Sydney Smith, Brougham, and Francis Horner, in 1802. In 1803 he succeeded Smith as editor, and conducted the *Review* till 1829. Independence of publishers and high pay to contributors ("Ten guineas a sheet," writes Southey to Scott, June, 1807, "instead of seven

Footnote j: Ý

The Press oppressed...

[*British Bards*]

[return](#)

pounds for the Annual," *Life and Corr.*, iii. 125) distinguished the new journal from the first. Jeffrey was called to the Scottish bar in 1794, and as an advocate was especially successful with juries. He was constantly employed, and won fame and fortune. In 1829 he was elected Dean of the Faculty of Advocates, and the following year, when the Whigs came into office, he became Lord Advocate. He sat as M.P. twice for Malton (1830-1832), and, afterwards, for Edinburgh. In 1834 he was appointed a Judge of the Court of Sessions, when he took the title of Lord Jeffrey. Byron had attacked Jeffrey in *British Bards* before his *Hours of Idleness* had been cut up by the *Edinburgh*, and when the article appeared (Jan. 1808), under the mistaken impression that he was the author, denounced him at large (ll. 460-528) in the first edition of *English Bards, and Scotch Reviewers*. None the less, the great critic did not fail to do ample justice to the poet's mature work, and won from him repeated acknowledgments of his kindness and generosity. (See *Edinburgh Review*, vol. xxii. p. 416, and Byron's comment in his *Diary* for March 20, 1814; *Life*, p. 232. See, too, *Hints from Horace*, ll. 589-626; and *Don Juan*, canto x. st. 11-

16, and canto xii. st. 16. See also Bagehot's *Literary Studies*, vol. i. article I.)]

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Footnote 11: Ý **Imitation:**

"Stulta est dementia, cum tot
ubique
----occurras perituræ parcere
chartæ."

Footnote k: Ý

While Southey's Epics load....

[*British Bards*]

[return](#)

Juvenal, Sat. I. ll. 17, 18.

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Footnote 12: Ý **Imitation.**

"Cur tamen hoc potius libeat
decurrere campo,
Per quem magnus equos
Auruncæ flexit alumnus,
Si vacat, et placidi rationem
admittitis, edam."

Footnote m: Ý

*O'er taste awhile these
Infidels prevail...*

[MS.]

[return](#)

Juvenal, Sat. I. ll. 19-21.

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Footnote 13: Ý William Gifford (1756-1826), a self-taught scholar, first a ploughboy, then boy on board a Brixham coaster, afterwards shoemaker's apprentice, was sent by friends to Exeter College, Oxford (1779-81). In the *Baviad* (1794) and the *Maeviad* (1795) he attacked many of the smaller writers of the day, who were either silly, like the Della Cruscan School, or discreditable, like Williams, who

Footnote n: Ý

*Erect and hail an idol of their
own....*

[MS.]

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wrote as "Anthony Pasquin." In his *Epistle to Peter Pindar* (1800) he laboured to expose the true character of John Wolcot. As editor of the *Anti-Jacobin, or Weekly Examiner* (November, 1797, to July, 1798), he supported the political views of Canning and his friends. As editor of the *Quarterly Review*, from its foundation (February, 1809) to his resignation in September, 1824, he soon rose to literary eminence by his sound sense and adherence to the best models, though his judgments were sometimes narrow-minded and warped by political prejudice. His editions of *Massinger* (1805), which superseded that of Monck Mason and Davies (1765), of *Ben Jonson* (1816), of *Ford* (1827), are valuable. To his translation of *Juvenal* (1802) is prefixed his autobiography. His translation of *Persius* appeared in 1821. To Gifford, Byron usually paid the utmost deference.

"Any suggestion of yours, even if it were conveyed," he writes to him, in 1813, "in the less tender text of the *Baviad*, or a Monck Mason note to *Massinger*, would be obeyed."

See also his letter (September 20, 1821, *Life*, p.531):

"I know no praise which
would compensate me in my
own mind for his censure."

Byron was attracted to Gifford,
partly by his devotion to the
classical models of literature,
partly by the outspoken frankness
of his literary criticism, partly
also, perhaps, by his physical
deformity.

[return](#)

Footnote 14: Ý Henry James Pye **Footnote o:** Ý
(1745-1813), M.P. for Berkshire,
and afterwards Police Magistrate
for Westminster, held the office of
poet laureate from 1790 till his
death in 1813, succeeding Thomas
Warton, and succeeded by

Not quite a footpad...

[*British Bards*]

[return](#)

Southey. He published *Farringdon
Hill* in 1774, *The Progress of
Refinement* in 1783, and a
translation of Burger's *Lenore* in
1795. His name recurs in the
Vision of Judgment, stanza xcii.
Lines 97-102 were inserted in the
Fifth Edition.

[return](#)

Footnote 15: Ý The first edition of **Footnote p:** Ý
the Satire opened with this line;
and Byron's original intention was
to prefix the following argument,
first published in *Recollections*, by
R. C. Dallas (1824):--

*Low may they sink to merited
contempt...*

[*British Bards*]

"Argument.

"The poet considereth times
past, and their poesy--makes
a sudden transition to times
present--is incensed against
book-makers--revileth Walter
Scott for cupidity and ballad-
mongering, with notable
remarks on Master Southey--
complains that Master
Southey had inflicted three
poems, epic and otherwise,
on the public--inveigheth
against William Wordsworth,
but laudeth Mister Coleridge
and his elegy on a young ass--
is disposed to vituperate Mr.
Lewis--and greatly rebuketh
Thomas Little (the late) and
Lord Strangford--
recommendeth Mr. Hayley to
turn his attention to prose--
and exhorteth the Moravians
to glorify Mr. Grahame--
sympathiseth with the Rev.
[William Bowles]--and
deplores the melancholy fate
of James Montgomery--
breaketh out into invective
against the Edinburgh
Reviewers--calls them hard
names, harpies and the like--
apostrophiseth Jeffrey, and
prophesies.--Episode of
Jeffrey and Moore, their
jeopardy and deliverance;

*And Scorn reimmerate the
mean attempt!*

[MS. First to Fourth Editions]
[return](#)

portents on the morn of the
 combat; the Tweed, Tolbooth,
 Firth of Forth [and Arthur's
 Seat], severally shocked;
 descent of a goddess to save
 Jeffrey; incorporation of the
 bullets with his sinciput and
 occiput.--Edinburgh Reviews
en masse.--Lord Aberdeen,
 Herbert, Scott, Hallam,
 Pillans, Lambe, Sydney
 Smith, Brougham, etc.--Lord
 Holland applauded for
 dinners and translations.--The
 Drama; Skeffington, Hook,
 Reynolds, Kenney, Cherry,
 etc.--Sheridan, Colman, and
 Cumberland called upon
 [requested, MS.] to write.--
 Return to poesy--scribblers of
 all sorts--lords sometimes
 rhyme; much better not--
 Hafiz, Rosa Matilda, and
 X.Y.Z.--Rogers, Campbell,
 Gifford, etc. true poets--
 Translators of the Greek
 Anthology--Crabbe--
 Darwin's style--Cambridge--
 Seatonian Prize--Smythe--
 Hodgson--Oxford--Richards--
 -Poeta loquitur--Conclusion."

[return](#)

Footnote 16: Ý Lines 115, 116,
 were a MS. addition to the printed
 text of *British Bards*. An

Footnote q: Ý

though lesser bards content...

alternative version has been
pencilled on the margin:--

[*British Bards*]
[return](#)

"Otway and Congreve mimic
scenes had wove
And Waller tuned his Lyre to
mighty Love."

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Footnote 17: Ý Thomas Little was
the name under which Moore's
early poems were published, *The
Poetical Works of the late Thomas
Little, Esq.* (1801). "Twelves"
refers to the "duodecimo." Sheets,
after printing, are pressed between
cold or hot rollers, to impart
smoothness of "surface." Hot
rolling is the more expensive
process.

Footnote r: Ý

How well the subject...

[*MS. First to Fourth Editions*]

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Footnote 18: Ý Eccles. chapter i.
verse 9.

Footnote s: Ý

*A fellow feeling makes us
wondrous kind...*

[*British Bards, First to Fourth
Editions.*]

[return](#)

Footnote 19: Ý At first sight
Byron appears to refer to the
lighting of streets by gas,
especially as the first shop lighted
with it was that of Lardner & Co.,
at the corner of the Albany (June,
1805), and as lamps were on view
at the premises of the Gas Light

Footnote t: Ý

Who fain would'st...

[*British Bards, First to Fifth
Editions*]

[return](#)

and Coke Company in Pall Mall from 1808 onwards. But it is almost certain that he alludes to the "sublimating gas" of Dr. Beddoes, which his assistant, Davy, mentions in his *Researches* (1800) as nitrous oxide, and which was used by Southey and Coleridge. The same four "wonders" of medical science are depicted in Gillray's caricatures, November, 1801, and May and June, 1802, and are satirized in Christopher Caustic's *Terrible Tractoration! A Poetical Petition against Galvanising Trumpery and the Perkinistit Institution* (in 4 cantos, 1803).

Against vaccination, or cow-pox, a brisk war was still being carried on. Gillray has a likeness of Jenner vaccinating patients.

Metallic "Tractors" were a remedy much advertised at the beginning of the century by an American quack, Benjamin Charles Perkins, founder of the Perkinian Institution in London, as a "cure for all Disorders, Red Noses, Gouty Toes, Windy Bowels, Broken Legs, Hump Backs."

In Galvanism several experiments, conducted by Professor Aldini, nephew of Galvani, are described

in the *Morning Post* for Jan. 6th,
Feb. 6th, and Jan. 22nd, 1803. The
latter were made on the body of
Forster the murderer.

For the allusion to Gas, compare
Terrible Tractation, canto 1--

"Beddoes (bless the good
doctor) has
Sent me a bag full of his gas,
Which snuff'd the nose up,
makes wit brighter,
And eke a dunce an airy
writer."

[return](#)

Footnote 20: Y Stott, better known **Footnote u:** Y

in the *Morning Post* by the name
of Hafiz. This personage is at
present the most profound
explorer of the bathos. I
remember, when the reigning
family left Portugal, a special Ode
of Master Stott's, beginning thus:--
(*Stott loquitur quoad Hibernia*)--

*Mend thy life, and sin no
more...*

[MS.]

[return](#)

"Princely offspring of
Braganza,
Erin greets thee with a
stanza," etc.

Also a Sonnet to Rats, well worthy
of the subject, and a most
thundering Ode, commencing as
follows:--

"Oh! for a Lay! loud as the
surge That lashes Lapland's
sounding shore."

Lord have mercy on us! the "Lay
of the Last Minstrel" was nothing
to this.

[The lines "Princely Offspring,"
headed "Extemporaneous Verse on
the expulsion of the Prince Regent
from Portugal by Gallic Tyranny,"
were published in the *Morning
Post*, Dec. 30, 1807. (See *post*, l.
708, and *note*.)]

[return](#)

Footnote 21: [Y](#) See p. 317, note 1 **Footnote v:** [Y](#)
[return](#).

*And o'er harmonious
nonsense...*

[MS. First Edition]

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Footnote 22: [Y](#) See the "Lay of the **Footnote w:** [Y](#)
Last Minstrel," *passim*. Never was

any plan so incongruous and
absurd as the groundwork of this
production. The entrance of
Thunder and Lightning
prologuising to Bayes' tragedy
[(*vide The Rehearsal*), *British
Bards*], unfortunately takes away
the merit of originality from the
dialogue between Messieurs the
Spirits of Flood and Fell in the
first canto. Then we have the
amiable William of Deloraine, "a

*In many marble-covered
volumes view
Hayley, in vain attempting
something new,
Whether he spin his comedies
in rhyme,
Or scrawls as Wood and
Barclay^A walk, 'gainst
Time....*

[MS Newstead]

stark moss-trooper," *videlicet*, a happy compound of poacher, sheep-stealer, and highwayman. The propriety of his magical lady's injunction not to read can only be equalled by his candid acknowledgment of his independence of the trammels of spelling, although, to use his own elegant phrase, "'twas his neckverse at Harribee," *i. e.* the gallows.

The biography of Gilpin Horner, and the marvellous pedestrian page, who travelled twice as fast as his master's horse, without the aid of seven-leagued boots, are *chefs d'oeuvre* in the improvement of taste. For incident we have the invisible, but by no means sparing box on the ear bestowed on the page, and the entrance of a Knight and Charger into the castle, under the very natural disguise of a wain of hay. Marmion, the hero of the latter romance, is exactly what William of Deloraine would have been, had he been able to read and write. The poem was manufactured for Messrs.

Constable, Murray, and Miller, worshipful Booksellers, in consideration of the receipt of a sum of money; and truly, considering the inspiration, it is a very creditable production. If Mr.

Sub-Footnote A: nbsp; Captain Robert Barclay (1779-1854) of Ury, agriculturalist and pedestrian, came of a family noted for physical strength and endurance. Byron saw him win his walk against Wood at Newmarket. (See Angelo's *Reminiscences* (1837), vol. ii. pp. 37-44.) In July, 1809, Barclay completed his task of walking a thousand miles in a thousand hours, at the rate of one mile in each and every hour. (See, too, for an account of Barclay, *The Eccentric Review* (1812), i. 133-150.)

[return to poem](#)

Scott will write for hire, let him do his best for his paymasters, but not disgrace his genius, which is undoubtedly great, by a repetition of Black-Letter Ballad imitations.

[Constable paid Scott a thousand pounds for *Marmion*, and

"offered one fourth of the copyright to Mr. Miller of Albemarle Street, and one fourth to Mr. Murray of Fleet Street (see line 173). Both publishers eagerly accepted the proposal."

...

"A severe and unjust review of *Marmion* by Jeffrey appeared in [the *Edinburgh Review* for April] 1808, accusing Scott of a mercenary spirit in writing for money.

...

Scott was much nettled by these observations"

(*Memoirs of John Murray*, i. 76, 95). In his diary of 1813 Byron wrote of Scott,

"He is undoubtedly the Monarch of Parnassus, and the most *English* of Bards."

--*Life*, p. 206.]

[return](#)

Footnote 23: Ý It was the suggestion of the Countess of Dalkeith, that Scott should write a ballad on the old border legend of *Gilpin Horner*, which first gave shape to the poet's ideas, and led to the *Lay of the Last Minstrel*.

[return](#)

Footnote 24: Ý In his strictures on Scott and Southey, Byron takes his lead from Lady Anne Hamilton's (1766-1846, daughter of Archibald, ninth Duke of Hamilton, and Lady-in-waiting to Caroline of Brunswick) *Epics of the Ton* (1807), a work which has not shared the dubious celebrity of her *Secret Memories of the Court*, etc. (1832). Compare the following lines (p. 9):--

"Then still might Southey
sing his crazy Joan,
Or feign a Welshman o'er the
Atlantic flown,
Or tell of Thalaba the
wondrous matter,
Or with clown Wordsworth,
chatter, chatter, chatter.

...

Good-natured Scott rehearse,
in well-paid lays,
The marv'lous chiefs and
elves of other days."

(For Scott's reference to "my share of flagellation among my betters,"

Footnote x: Ý

*Breaks into mawkish lines
each holy Book...*

[MS. First Edition.]

[return](#)

Footnote y: Ý

Thy "Sympathy" that...

[*British Bards*]

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and an explicit statement that he had remonstrated with Jeffrey against the "offensive criticism" of *Hours of Idleness*, because he thought it treated with undue severity, see Introduction to *Marmion*, 1830.)

[return](#)

Footnote 25: Ý Lines 179, 180, in the Fifth Edition, were substituted for variant i. p. 312.--Leigh Hunt's annotated Copy of the Fourth Edition.

[return](#)

Footnote z: Ý

*And shows dissolved in
sympathetic tears.
----in thine own melting
tears...*

[MS. First to Fourth Editions.]

[return](#)

Footnote 26: Ý "Good night to Marmion"--the pathetic and also prophetic exclamation of Henry Blount, Esquire, on the death of honest Marmion.

[return](#)

Footnote A: Ý

*Whether in sighing winds
them seek'st relief
Or Consolation in a yellow
leaf...*

[MS. first to Fourth Editions]

[return](#)

Footnote 27: Ý As the *Odyssey* is so closely connected with the story of the *Iliad*, they may almost be classed as one grand historical poem. In alluding to Milton and Tasso, we consider the *Paradise Lost* and *Gerusalemme Liberata* as their standard efforts; since neither the *Jerusalem Conquered* of the Italian, nor the *Paradise Regained* of the English bard, obtained a

Footnote B: Ý

What pretty sounds...

[*British Bards*]

[return](#)

proportionate celebrity to their former poems. Query: Which of Mr. Southey's will survive?

[return](#)

Footnote 28: *Y Thalaba*, Mr.

Southey's second poem, is written in defiance of precedent and poetry. Mr. S. wished to produce something novel, and succeeded to a miracle. *Joan of Arc* was marvellous enough, but *Thalaba* was one of those poems "which," in the word of **Porson**,

"will be read when Homer and Virgil are forgotten, but--
not till then."

["Of *Thalaba* the wild and wondrous song"--Proem to *Madoc*, Southey's *Poetical Works* (1838), vol. v. *Joan of Arc* was published in 1796, *Thalaba the Destroyer* in 1801, and *Madoc* in 1805.]

[return](#)

Footnote 29: *Y*The hero of Fielding's farce, *The Tragedy of Tragedies, or the Life and Death of Tom Thumb the Great*, first played in 1730 at the Haymarket.

[return](#)

Footnote 30: *Y*Southey's *Madoc* is divided into two parts--Part I., "Madoc in Wales;" Part II., "Madoc in Aztlan." The word "cacique" ("Cacique or cazique... a

Footnote C: *Y*

Thou fain woulds't----

[*British Bards*]

[return](#)

Footnote D: *Y*

But to soft themes...

[*British Bards, First Edition*]

[return](#)

Footnote E: *Y*

The Bard has wove...

native chief or 'prince' of the
aborigines in the West Indies:"
New Engl. Dict., Art. "Cacique")
occurs in the translations of
Spanish writers quoted by Southey
in his notes, but not in the text of
the poem.

[return](#)

Footnote 31: Ý We beg Mr.
Southey's pardon: "Madoc
disdains the degraded title of
Epic." See his Preface. ["It
assumes not the degraded title of
Epic."--Preface to *Madoc* (1805),
Southey's *Poetical Works* (1838),
vol. v. p. xxi.] Why is Epic
degraded? and by whom?
Certainly the late Romaunts of
Masters Cottle, Laureat Pye,
Ogilvy, Hole^A, and gentle Mistress
Cowley, have not exalted the Epic
Muse; but, as Mr. **Southey's** poem
"disdains the appellation," allow
us to ask--has he substituted
anything better in its stead? or
must he be content to rival Sir
Richard Blackmore in the
quantity as well as quality of his
verse?

Sub-Footnote A: nbsp; For "Hole,"
the *MS.* and *British Bards* read
"Sir J. B. Burgess; Cumberland."

[return to poem](#)

Footnote 32: Ý See *The Old
Woman of Berkeley*, a ballad by
Mr. Southey, wherein an aged

[*British Bards*]

[return](#)

Footnote F: Ý

*If Pope, since mortal, not
untaught to err
Again demand a dull
biographer...*

[*MS.*]

[return](#)

Footnote G: Ý

gentlewoman is carried away by
Beelzebub, on a "high trotting
horse."

[return](#)

*Too much in Turtle Bristol's
sons delight
Too much in Bowls of Rack
prolong the night....*

[MS. Second to Fourth Editions.]

Too much o'er Bowls...

[Second and Third Editions.]

[return](#)

Footnote 33: Ý The last line, "God
help thee," is an evident
plagiarism from the *Anti-Jacobin*
to Mr. Southey, on his Dactyls:--

"God help thee, silly one!"

Poetry of the Anti-Jacobin, p. 23.

[return](#)

Footnote 34: Ý In the annotated
copy of the Fourth Edition Byron
has drawn a line down the margin
of the passage on Wordsworth,
lines 236-248, and adds the word
"Unjust." The first four lines on
Coleridge (lines 255-258) are also
marked "Unjust." The recantation
is, no doubt, intended to apply to
both passages from beginning to
end. "*Unjust.*"--B., 1816. (See also
Byron's letter to S. T. Coleridge,
March 31, 1815.)

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Footnote 35: Ý *Lyrical Ballads*, p.
4.--"The Tables Turned," Stanza 1.

Footnote H: Ý

And yet why...

[*British Bards*]

[return](#)

Footnote J: Ý

Or old or young...

[*British Bards.*]

[return](#)

Footnote K: Ý

yes, I'm sure all may...

"Up, up, my friend, and clear
your looks,
Why all this toil and trouble?
Up, up, my friend, and quit
your books,
Or surely you'll grow
double."

[*Quarto Proof Sheet*]
[return](#)

[return](#)

Footnote: 36 Ý Mr. W. in his
preface labours hard to prove, that
prose and verse are much the
same; and certainly his precepts
and practice are strictly
conformable:--

Footnote M: Ý

*While Cloacina's holy pontiff
Lambe^A
As he himself was damned
shall try to damn...*

"And thus to Betty's
questions he
Made answer, like a traveller
bold.
"The cock did crow, to-whoo,
to-whoo,
And the sun did shine so
cold."

[*MS Newstead*]

Lyrical Ballads, p. 179.
[Compare *The Simpliciad*, II. 295-
305, and *note*.]

[return](#)

Sub-Footnote A: nbsp; We have
heard of persons who "when the
Bagpipe sings in the nose cannot
contain their urine for affection,"
but Mr. L. carries it a step further
than Shakespeare's diuretic
amateurs, being notorious at
school and college for his inability
to contain--anything. We do not
know to what "Pipe" to attribute
this additional effect, but the fact
is uncontrovertible.--[*Note to*
Quarto Proof bound up with
British Bards.]

[return to poem](#)

Footnote: 37 Ý "He has not
published for some years."--
British Bards. (A marginal note in
pencil.)

Footnote N: Ý

Lo! long beneath_...

[Coleridge's *Poems* (3rd edit.) appeared in 1803; the first number of *The Friend* on June 1, 1809.]

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Footnote 38: *Coleridge's Poems*, p. 11, "Songs of the Pixies," i. e. Devonshire Fairies; p. 42, we have "Lines to a Young Lady;" and, p. 52, "Lines to a Young Ass."

[Compare *The Simpliciad*, ll. 211, 213--

"Then in despite of scornful
Folly's pother,
Ask him to live with you and
hail him brother."

[return](#)

Footnote 39: *Matthew Gregory Lewis* (1775-1818), known as "Monk" Lewis, was the son of a rich Jamaica planter. During a six months' visit to Weimar (1792-3), when he was introduced to Goethe, he applied himself to the study of German literature, especially novels and the drama. In 1794 he was appointed *attaché* to the Embassy at the Hague, and in the course of ten weeks wrote *Ambrosio, or The Monk*, which was published in 1795. In 1798 he made the acquaintance of Scott, and procured his promise of co-operation in his contemplated *Tales of Terror*. In the same year

[*British Bards*]

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Footnote P: *Y*

*And grateful to the founder of
the feast
Declare his landlord can
translate at least...*

[*MS. British Bards. First to Fourth Editions.*]

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Footnote Q: *Y*

--are fed because they write...

[*British Bards.*]

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he published the *Castle Spectre* (first played at Drury Lane, Dec. 14, 1797), in which, to quote the postscript "To the Reader," he meant (but Sheridan interposed) "to have exhibited a whole regiment of Ghosts." *Tales of Terror* were printed at Weybridge in 1801, and two or three editions of *Tales of Wonder*, to which Byron refers, came out in the same year. Lewis borrowed so freely from all sources that the collection was called "Tales of Plunder." In the first edition (two vols., printed by W. Bulmer for the author, 1801) the first eighteen poems, with the exception of *The Fire King* (xii.) by Walter Scott, are by Lewis, either original or translated. Scott also contributed *Glenfinlas*, *The Eve of St. John*, *Frederick and Alice*, *The Wild Huntsmen* (*Der Wilde Jäger*). Southey contributed six poems, including *The Old Woman of Berkeley* (xxiv.). *The Little Grey Man* (xix.) is by H. Bunbury. The second volume is made up from Burns, Gray, Parnell, Glover, Percy's *Reliques*, and other sources.

A second edition, published in 1801, which consists of thirty-two ballads (Southey's are not included), advertises "*Tales of*

Terror printed uniform with this edition of *Tales of Wonder*." *Romantic Tales*, in four volumes, appeared in 1808. Of his other works, *The Captive*, A *Monodrama*, was played in 1803; the *Bravo of Venice*, A *Translation from the German*, in 1804; and *Timour the Tartar* in 1811. His *Journal of a West Indian Proprietor* was not published till 1834. He sat as M.P. for Hindon (1796-1802).

He had been a favourite in society before Byron appeared on the scene, but there is no record of any intimacy or acquaintance before 1813. When Byron was living at Geneva, Lewis visited the Maison Diodati in August, 1816, on which occasion he "translated to him Goethe's *Faust* by word of mouth," and drew up a codicil to his will, witnessed by Byron, Shelley, and Polidori, which contained certain humane provisions for the well-being of the negroes on his Jamaica estates. He also visited him at *La Mira* in August, 1817. Byron wrote of him after his death:

"He was a good man, and a clever one, but he was a bore, a damned bore--one may say. But I liked him."

To judge from his letters to his mother and other evidence (Scott's testimony, for instance), he was a kindly, well-intentioned man, but lacking in humour. When his father condemned the indecency of the *Monk*, he assured him "that he had not the slightest idea that what he was then writing could injure the principles of any human being." "He was," said Byron, "too great a bore to lie," and the plea is evidently offered in good faith. As a writer, he is memorable chiefly for his sponsorship of German literature. Scott said of him that he had the finest ear for rhythm he ever met with--finer than Byron's; and Coleridge, in a letter to Wordsworth, Jan., 1798 (*Letters of S. T. C.* (1895), i. 237), and again in *Table Talk* for March 20, 1834, commends his verses. Certainly his ballad of "Crazy Jane," once so famous that ladies took to wearing "Crazy Jane" hats, is of the nature of poetry. (See *Life*, 349, 362, 491, etc.; *Life and Correspondence* of M. G. Lewis (1839), i. 158, etc.; *Life of Scott*, by J. G. Lockhart (1842), pp. 80-83, 94.)

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[cross-reference: return to Footnote 21 of this poem](#)

[cross-reference: return to Footnote 22 of *Hints from Horace*](#)

Footnote 40: Ý "For every one knows little Matt's an M.P."--See a poem to Mr. Lewis, in *The Statesman*, supposed to be written by Mr. Jekyll.

[Joseph Jekyll (d. 1837) was celebrated for his witticisms and metrical *jeux d'esprit* which he contributed to the *Morning Chronicle* and the *Evening Statesman*. His election as M.P. for Calne in 1787, at the nomination of Lord Lansdowne, gave rise to *Jekyll, A Political Eclogue* (see *The Rottiad* (1799), pp. 219-224). He was a favourite with the Prince Regent, at whose instance he was appointed a Master in Chancery in 1815.]

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Footnote 41: Ý The reader, who may wish for an explanation of this, may refer to "Strangford's Camoëns," p. 127, note to p. 56, or to the last page of the *Edinburgh Review* of Strangford's Camoëns.

[Percy Clinton Sydney Smythe, sixth Viscount Strangford (1780-1855), published *Translations from the Portuguese by Luis de Camoens* in 1803. The note to which Byron refers is on the canzonet *Naõ sei quem assella*, "Thou hast an eye of tender blue." It runs thus:

Footnote R: Ý

*Princes in Barrels, Counts in
arbours pent...*

[*British Bards.*]

[return](#)

Footnote S: Ý

His "damme, poohs."...

[*MS. First Edition*]

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"Locks of auburn and eyes of blue have ever been dear to the sons of song.... Sterne even considers them as indicative of qualities the most amiable.... The Translator does not wish to deem ... this unfounded. He is, however, aware of the danger to which such a confession exposes him--but he flies for protection to the temple of **Aurea Venus**."

It may be added that Byron's own locks were auburn, and his eyes a greyish-blue.]

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Footnote 42: Ý It is also to be remarked, that the things given to the public as poems of Camoëns are no more to be found in the original Portuguese, than in the Song of Solomon.

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Footnote 43: Ý See his various Biographies of defunct Painters, etc. [William Hayley (1745-1820) published *The Triumphs of Temper* in 1781, and *The Triumph of Music* in 1804. His biography of Milton appeared in 1796, of Cowper in 1803-4, of Romney in 1809. He had produced, among

Footnote T: Ý

*While Kenny's World just
suffered to proceed Proclaims
the audience very kind
indeed...*

[MS. British Bards. First to Fourth Editions]

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other plays, *The Happy Prescription* and *The Two Connoisseurs* in 1784. In 1808 he would be regarded as out of date, "hobbling on" behind younger rivals in the race (see E.B., I. 923). For his life and works, see Southey's article in the *Quarterly Review* (vol. xxxi. p. 263). The appeal to "tarts" to "spare the text," is possibly an echo of *The Dunciad*, i. 155, 156--

"Of these twelve volumes,
twelve of amplest size,
Redeemed from topers and
defrauded pies."

The meaning of the appeal is fixed by such a passage as this from *The Blues*, where the company discuss Wordsworth's appointment to a Collectorship of Stamps--

"*Inkle*. I shall think of him oft
when I buy a new hat;
There his works will appear.

Lady Bluemount. Sir, they
reach to the Ganges.

Inkle. I sha'n't go so far. I can
have them at Grange's."

Grange's was a well-known
pastry-cook's in Piccadilly. In
Pierce Egan's *Life in London* (ed.

1821), p. 70, *note* 1, the author writes,

"As I sincerely hope that this work will shrink from the touch of a pastry-cook, and also avoid the foul uses of a trunk-maker,... I feel induced now to describe, for the benefit of posterity, the pedigree of a Dandy in 1820."

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Footnote 44: Ý Hayley's two most **Footnote V:** Ý

notorious verse productions are *Triumphs of Temper* and *The Triumph of Music*. He has also written much Comedy in rhyme, Epistles, etc., etc. As he is rather an elegant writer of notes and biography, let us recommend **Pope's** advice to **Wycherley** to Mr. H.'s consideration, viz., "to convert poetry into prose," which may be easily done by taking away the final syllable of each couplet.

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Footnote 45: Ý Lines 319-326 do **Footnote W:** Ý

not form part of the original *MS*. A slip of paper which contains a fair copy of the lines in Byron's handwriting has been, with other fragments, bound up with Dallas's copy of *British Bards*. In the *MS*. this place is taken by a passage

Resume her throne again...

[*MS. British Bards. First to Fourth Editions.*]

[return](#)

and Kemble lives to tread

[*British Bards. First to Fourth Editions*]

[return to poem](#)

and its pendant note, which Byron omitted at the request of Dallas, who was a friend of Pratt's:--

"In verse most stale,
unprofitable, flat--
Come, let us change the
scene, and '*glean*' with Pratt;
In him an author's luckless lot
behold,
Condemned to make the
books which once he sold:
Degraded man! again resume
thy trade--
The votaries of the Muse are
ill repaid,
Though daily puffs once
more invite to buy
A new edition of thy
'Sympathy.'"

"Mr. Pratt, once a Bath bookseller, now a London author, has written as much, to as little purpose, as any of his scribbling contemporaries. Mr. P.'s *Sympathy* is in rhyme; but his prose productions are the most voluminous."

Samuel Jackson Pratt (1749-1814), actor, itinerant lecturer, poet of the Cruscan school, tragedian, and novelist, published a large number of volumes. His *Gleanings* in England, Holland, Wales, and Westphalia attained

some reputation. His *Sympathy; a Poem* (1788) passed through several editions. His pseudonym was Courtney Melmoth. He was a patron of the cobbler-poet, Blacket
[return](#)

Footnote 46: Ý Mr. Grahame has poured forth two volumes of Cant, under the name of *Sabbath Walks* and *Biblical Pictures*.

[James Grahame (1765-1811), a lawyer, who subsequently took Holy Orders. *The Sabbath*, a poem, was published anonymously in 1804; and to a second edition were added *Sabbath Walks. Biblical Pictures* appeared in 1807.]

[return](#)

Footnote 47: Ý The Rev. W. Lisle Bowles (1768-1850). His edition of Pope's *Works*, in ten vols., which stirred Byron's gall, appeared in 1807. The *Fall of Empires*, Tyre, Carthage, etc., is the subject of part of the third book of *The Spirit of Discovery by Sea* (1805). Lines "To a Withered Leaf," are, perhaps, of later date; but the "sear tresses" and "shivering leaves" of "Autumn's gradual gloom" are familiar images in his earlier poems. Byron's senior by twenty years, he

Footnote X: Ý

*St. George^A and Goody
Goose divide the prize...*

[MS. alternative in *British Bards*.]

Sub-Footnote A: nbsp; We need not inform the reader that we do not allude to the Champion of England who slew the Dragon. Our St. George is content to draw status with a very different kind of animal.--[Pencil note to *British Bards*.]

[return](#)

Footnote Y: Ý

*Its humble flight to splendid
Pantomimes...*

[*British Bards. MS*]

[return](#)

was destined to outlive him by more than a quarter of a century; but when *English Bards, etc.*, was in progress, he was little more than middle-aged, and the "three score years" must have been written in the spirit of prophecy. As it chanced, the last word rested with him, and it was a generous one. Addressing Moore, in 1824, he says (*Childe Harold's Last Pilgrimage*)--

"So Harold ends, in Greece,
his pilgrimage!
There fitly ending--in that
land renown'd,
Whose mighty Genius lives
in Glory's page,--
He on the Muses' consecrated
ground,
Sinking to rest, while his
young brows are bound
With their unfading wreath!"

Among his poems are a "Sonnet to Oxford," and "Stanzas on hearing the Bells of Ostend."

[return](#)

Footnote 48: Ý "Awake a louder," **Footnote Z:** Ý

etc., is the first line in **Bowles's** *Spirit of Discovery*: a very spirited and pretty dwarf Epic. Among other exquisite lines we have the following:--

*Behold the new Petronius of
the times
The skilful Arbiter of modern
crimes....*

----"A kiss [MS.]
Stole on the list'ning silence, [return](#)
never yet
Here heard; they trembled
even as if the power," etc.,
etc.

That is, the woods of Madeira
trembled to a kiss; very much
astonished, as well they might be,
at such a phenomenon.

"Mis-quoted and
misunderstood by me; but not
intentionally. It was not the
'woods,' but the people in
them who trembled--why,
Heaven only knows--unless
they were overheard making
this prodigious smack."

(B., 1816.)

[return](#)

Footnote 49: Ý The episode above **Footnote Aa:** Ý
alluded to is the story of "Robert à
Machin" and "Anna d'Arfet," a *a Paget for your wife...*
pair of constant lovers, who
performed the kiss above [MS. First to Fourth Editions.]
mentioned, that startled the woods [return](#)
of Madeira.

[See Byron's letter to Murray, Feb.
7, 1821, "On Bowies' Strictures,"
Life, p. 688.]

[return](#)

Footnote 50: Ý **Curll** is one of the **Footnote Bb:** Ý
Heroes of the *Dunciad*, and was a
bookseller. Lord Fanny is the

poetical name of Lord **Hervey**,
author of *Lines to the Imitator of
Horace*.

[return](#)

*From Grosvenor Place or
Square...*

[MS. British Bards]

[return](#)

Footnote 51: Ý Lord **Bolingbroke**
hired **Mallet** to traduce **Pope** after
his decease, because the poet had
retained some copies of a work by
Lord Bolingbroke--the "Patriot
King,"--which that splendid, but
malignant genius had ordered to
be destroyed.

[return](#)

Footnote 52: Ý Dennis the critic,
and Ralph the rhymester:--

"Silence, ye Wolves! while
Ralph to Cynthia howls,
Making Night hideous:
answer him, ye owls!"

Dunciad.

[Book III. II. 165, 166, Pope
wrote, "And makes night," etc.]

[return](#)

Footnote 53: Ý See Bowles's late
edition of Pope's works, for which
he received three hundred pounds.
[Twelve hundred guineas.--*British
Bards*.] Thus Mr. B. has
experienced how much easier it is
to profit by the reputation of
another, than to elevate his own.

["Too savage all this on Bowles,"

Footnote Cc: Ý

*On one alone Apollo deigns
to smile
And crowns a new
Roscommon in Carlisle....*

[MS. Addition to British Bards]

[return](#)

Footnote Dd: Ý

*Yet at their fiat----
Yet at their nausea-----...*

[MS Newstead]

[return](#)

Footnote Ee: Ý

Such sneering fame....

[*British Bards*]

[return](#)

wrote Byron, in 1816, but he afterwards returned to his original sentiments. "Although," he says (Feb. 7, 1821), "I regret having published *English Bards, and Scotch Reviewers*, the part which I regret the least is that which regards Mr. Bowles, with reference to Pope. Whilst I was writing that publication, in 1807 and 1808, Mr. Hobhouse was desirous that I should express our mutual opinion of Pope, and of Mr. Bowles's edition of his works. As I had completed my outline, and felt lazy, I requested that *he* would do so. He did it. His fourteen lines on Bowles's Pope are in the first edition of *English Bards*, and are quite as severe, and much more poetical, than my own, in the second. On reprinting the work, as I put my name to it, I omitted Mr. Hobhouse's lines, by which the work gained less than Mr. Bowles.... I am grieved to say that, in reading over those lines, I repent of their having so far fallen short of what I meant to express upon the subject of his edition of Pope's works" (*Life*, pp. 688, 689). The lines supplied by Hobhouse are here subjoined:--

"Stick to thy sonnets, man!--
at least they sell.
Or take the only path that

open lies
For modern worthies who
would hope to rise:
Fix on some well-known
name, and, bit by bit,
Pare off the merits of his
worth and wit:
On each alike employ the
critic's knife,
And when a comment fails,
prefix a life;
Hint certain failings, faults
before unknown,
Review forgotten lies, and
add your own;
Let no disease, let no
misfortune 'scape,
And print, if luckily
deformed, his shape:
Thus shall the world, quite
undeceived at last,
Cleave to their present wits,
and quit their past;
Bards once revered no more
with favour view,
But give their modern
sonneteers their due;
Thus with the dead may
living merit cope,
Thus Bowles may triumph
o'er the shade of Pope."

[return](#)

Footnote 54: Ý

"'Helicon' is a mountain, and
not a fish-pond. It should

Footnote Ff: Ý

*Though Bell has lost his
nightingales and owls,*

have been 'Hippocrene.'"--B.,
1816.

[The correction was made in the
Fifth Edition.]

[return](#)

*Matilda snivels still and
Hafiz howls,
And Crusca's spirit rising
from the dead
Revives in Laura, Quiz, and
X. Y. Z.<...*

[*British Bards. First to Third
Editions*, 1810]

[return](#)

Footnote 55: Ý Mr. Cottle, Amos,
Joseph, I don't know which, but
one or both, once sellers of books
they did not write, and now
writers of books they do not sell,
have published a pair of Epics--
Alfred (poor Alfred! Pye has been
at him too!)--*Alfred* and the *Fall of
Cambria*.

Footnote Gg: Ý

*None since the past have
claimed the tribute due...*

[*British Bards. MS*]

[return](#)

"All right. I saw some letters
of this fellow (Jh. Cottle) to
an unfortunate poetess,
whose productions, which the
poor woman by no means
thought vainly of, he attacked
so roughly and bitterly, that I
could hardly regret assailing
him, even were it unjust,
which it is not--for verily he
is an ass."--B., 1816.

[Compare *Poetry of the Anti-
Jacobin*--

"And Cottle, not he whom
that Alfred made famous,

But Joseph of Bristol, the
brother of Amos."

The identity of the brothers Cottle appears to have been a matter beneath the notice both of the authors of the *Anti-Jacobin* and of Byron. Amos Cottle, who died in 1800 (see Lamb's Letter to Coleridge of Oct. 9, 1800; *Letters of C. Lamb*, 1888, i. 140), was the author of a *Translation of the Edda of Soemund*, published in 1797. Joseph Cottle, *inter alia*, published *Alfred* in 1801, and *The Fall of Cambria*, 1807. An *Expostulatory Epistle*, in which Joseph avenges Amos and solemnly castigates the author of *Don Juan*, was issued in 1819 (see Lamb's Letter to Cottle, Nov. 5, 1819), and was reprinted in the Memoir of Amos Cottle, inserted in his brother's *Early Recollections of Coleridge* (London, 1837, i. 119). The "unfortunate poetess" was, probably, Ann Yearsley, the Bristol milk-woman. Wordsworth, too (see *Recollections of the Table-Talk of S. Rogers*, 1856, p. 235), dissuaded her from publishing her poems. Roughness and bitterness were not among Cottle's faults or foibles, and it is possible that Byron misconceived the purport of the

correspondence.]

[return](#)

Footnote 56: Ý Mr. Maurice hath manufactured the component parts of a ponderous quarto, upon the beauties of "Richmond Hill," and the like:--it also takes in a charming view of Turnham Green, Hammersmith, Brentford, Old and New, and the parts adjacent. [The Rev. Thomas Maurice (1754-1824) had this at least in common with Byron--that his *History of Ancient and Modern Hindostan* was severely attacked in the *Edinburgh Review*. He published a vindication of his work in 1805. He must have confined his dulness to his poems (*Richmond Hill* (1807), etc.), for his *Memoirs* (1819) are amusing, and, though otherwise blameless, he left behind him the reputation of an "indiscriminate enjoyment" of literary and other society. Lady Anne Hamilton alludes to him in *Epics of the Ton* (1807), p. 165--

"Or warmed like Maurice by
Museum fire,
From Ganges dragged a
hurdy-gurdy lyre."

He was assistant keeper of MSS.
at the British Museum from 1799
till his death.

[return](#)

Footnote Hh: Ý

*From Albion's cliffs to
Caledonia's coast.
Some few who know to write
as well as feel...*

[MS.]

[return](#)

Footnote 57: Ý Poor

Montgomery, though praised by every English Review, has been bitterly reviled by the *Edinburgh*. After all, the Bard of Sheffield is a man of considerable genius. His *Wanderer of Switzerland* is worth a thousand *Lyrical Ballads*, and at least fifty *Degraded Epics*.

Footnote Jj: Ý

*The spoiler came; and all thy
promise fair
Has sought the grave, to
sleep for ever there....*

[*First to Fourth Editions*]
[return](#)

[James Montgomery (1771-1854) was born in Ayrshire, but settled at Sheffield, where he edited a newspaper, the *Iris*, a radical print, which brought him into conflict with the authorities. His early poems were held up to ridicule in the *Edinburgh Review* by Jeffrey, in Jan. 1807. It was probably the following passage which provoked Byron's note:

"When every day is bringing
forth some new work from
the pen of Scott, Campbell,...
Wordsworth, and Southey, it
is natural to feel some disgust
at the undistinguishing
voracity which can swallow
down these... verses to a
pillow."

The *Wanderer of Switzerland*, which Byron said he preferred to the *Lyrical Ballads*, was published in 1806. The allusion in line 419 is to the first stanza of *The Lyre*--

"Where the roving rill
meand'ed
Down the green, retiring vale,
Poor, forlorn Alcæus
wandered,
Pale with thoughts--serenely
pale."

He is remembered chiefly as the
writer of some admirable hymns.
(*Vide ante*, p. 107, [Answer to a
Beautiful Poem](#), and [note](#).)]
[return](#)

Footnote 58: Ý Arthur's Seat; the
hill which overhangs Edinburgh.
[return](#)

Footnote Kk: Ý

*On him may meritorious
honours tend
While doubly mingling,...*

[MS. erased]

[return](#)

Footnote 59: Ý Lines 439-527 are
not in the MS. The first draft of the
passage on Jeffrey, which appears
to have found a place in *British
Bards* and to have been afterwards
cut out, runs as follows:--

Footnote Mm: Ý

And you united Bards...

[MS. Addition to *British Bards*]

And you ye nameless...

"Who has not heard in this
enlightened age,
When all can criticise the
historic page,
Who has not heard in James's
Bigot Reign
Of Jefferies! monarch of the
scourge, and chain,
Jefferies the wretch whose

[MS. erased.]

[return](#)

pestilential breath,
Like the dread Simoom,
winged the shaft of Death;
The old, the young to Fate
remorseless gave
Nor spared one victim from
the common grave?

"Such was the Judge of
James's iron time,
When Law was Murder,
Mercy was a crime,
Till from his throne by weary
millions hurled
The Despot roamed in Exile
through the world.

"Years have rolled on;--in all
the lists of Shame,
Who now can parallel a
Jefferies' name?
With hand less mighty, but
with heart as black
With voice as willing to
decree the Rack,
With tongue envenomed,
with intentions foul
The same in name and
character and soul."

The first four lines of the above,
which have been erased, are to be
found on p. 16 of *British Bards*.
Pages 17, 18, are wanting, and
quarto proofs of lines 438-527
have been inserted. Lines 528-539
appear for the first time in the

Fifth Edition.

[return](#)

Footnote 60: Ý "Too ferocious--
this is mere insanity."--B., 1816.
[The comment applies to lines
432-453.]

[return](#)

Footnote 61: Ý "All this is bad,
because personal."--B., 1816.

[return](#)

Footnote 62: Ý In 1806, Messrs.
Jeffrey and Moore met at Chalk
Farm. The duel was prevented by
the interference of the Magistracy;
and on examination, the balls of
the pistols were found to have
evaporated. This incident gave
occasion to much waggery in the
daily prints. [The first four
editions read, "the balls of the
pistols, like the courage of the
combatants."]

[The following disclaimer to the
foregoing note appears in the MS.
in Leigh Hunt's copy of the Fourth
Edition, 1811. It was first printed
in the Fifth Edition:--]

Footnote Nn: Ý

*Translation's servile work at
length disown
And quit Achaia's Muse to
court your own...*

[MS. Addition to British Bards]

[return](#)

Footnote Pp: Ý

*Let these arise and anxious of
applause...*

[British Bards. MS]

[return](#)

Footnote Qq: Ý

But not in heavy...

[British Bards. MS]

[return](#)

"I am informed that Mr. Moore published at the time a disavowal of the statements in the newspapers, as far as regarded himself; and, in justice to him, I mention this circumstance. As I never heard of it before, I cannot state the particulars, and was only made acquainted with the fact very lately. November 4, 1811."

[As a matter of fact, it was Jeffrey's pistol that was found to be leadless.]

[return](#)

[cross-reference: return to footnote of lines "To the Earl of Clare](#)

Footnote 63: Ý The Tweed here behaved with proper decorum; it would have been highly reprehensible in the English half of the river to have shown the smallest symptom of apprehension.

[return](#)

Footnote 64: Ý This display of sympathy on the part of the Tolbooth (the principal prison in Edinburgh), which truly seems to have been most affected on this occasion, is much to be commended. It was to be apprehended, that the many unhappy criminals executed in the front might have rendered the

Footnote Rr: Ý

Let prurient Southey cease...

[MS. British Bards]

[return](#)

Footnote Ss: Ý

still the babe at nurse...

[MS.]

Let Lewis jilt our nurseries
with alarm
With tales that oft disgust and
never charm

Edifice more callous. She is said [return](#)
to be of the softer sex, because her
delicacy of feeling on this day was
truly feminine, though, like most
feminine impulses, perhaps a little
selfish.

[return](#)

Footnote 65: ÝLine 508. For "oat- **Footnote Tt:** Ý

fed phalanx," the Quarto Proof and
Editions 1-4 read "ranks

But thou with powers...

illustrious." The correction is

[MS. British Bards]

made in MS. in the Annotated

[return](#)

Edition. It was suggested that the

motto of the *Edinburgh Review*

should have been, "Musam tenui

meditamur avenâ."

[return](#)

Footnote 66: Ý His Lordship has **Footnote Uu:** Ý

been much abroad, is a member of
the Athenian Society, and reviewer
of Gell's *Topography of Troy*.

*Let **Moore** be lewd; let
Strangford steal from
Moore...*

[George Gordon, fourth Earl of
Aberdeen (1784-1860), published
in 1822 *An Inquiry into the*

[MS. First to Fourth Editions]

Principles of Beauty in Grecian

[return](#)

Architecture. His grandfather

purchased Gight, the property

which Mrs. Byron had sold to pay

her husband's debts. This may

have been an additional reason for

the introduction of his name.]

[return](#)

Footnote 67: Ý Mr. Herbert is a **Footnote Vv:** Ý

translator of Icelandic and other
poetry. One of the principal pieces

*For outlawed Sherwood's
tales...*

is a *Song on the Recovery of*

Thor's Hammer: the translation is

a pleasant chant in the vulgar
tongue, and endeth thus:--

[MS. Brit. Bards. Eds. 1-4]
[return](#)

"Instead of money and rings,
I wot,
The hammer's bruises were
her lot.
Thus Odin's son his hammer
got."

[William Herbert (1778-1847), son
of the first Earl of Carnarvon,
edited *Musæ Etonenses* in 1795,
whilst he was still at school. He
was one of the earliest
contributors to the *Edinburgh
Review*. At the time when Byron
was writing his satire, he was M.P.
for Hampshire, but in 1814 he
took Orders. He was appointed
Dean of Manchester in 1840, and
republished his poetical works,
and among them his Icelandic
Translations or *Horæ Scandicæ*
(*Miscellaneous Works*, 2 vols.), in
1842.]

[return](#)

Footnote 68: Ý The Rev. **Sydney
Smith**, the reputed Author of
Peter Plymley's Letters, and
sundry criticisms. [Sydney Smith
(1771-1845), the "witty Canon of
St. Paul's," was one of the
founders, and for a short time
(1802) the editor, of the *Edinburgh
Review*. His *Letters on the
Catholicks, from Peter Plymley to*

Footnote Ww: Ý

*And even spurns the great
Seatonian prize...*

[MS. First to Fourth Editions (a
correction in the Annotated
Copy).]

[return](#)

his brother Abraham, appeared in 1807-8.]

[return](#)

Footnote 69: Ý Mr. **Hallam** reviewed **Payne Knight's** "Taste," and was exceedingly severe on some Greek verses therein. It was not discovered that the lines were Pindar's till the press rendered it impossible to cancel the critique, which still stands an everlasting monument of Hallam's ingenuity.--
[Note added to Second Edition:

Footnote Xx: Ý

*With odes by Smyth^A and epic songs by Hoyle,
Hoyle whose learn'd page, if still upheld by whist
Required no sacred theme to bid us list...*

[MS. British Bards]

Hallam is incensed because he is falsely accused, seeing that he never dineth at Holland House. If this be true, I am sorry--not for having said so, but on his account, as I understand his Lordship's feasts are preferable to his compositions. If he did not review Lord **Holland's** performance, I am glad; because it must have been painful to read, and irksome to praise it. If Mr. **Hallam** will tell me who did review it, the real name shall find a place in the text; provided, nevertheless, the said name be of two orthodox musical syllables, and will come into the verse: till then, **Hallam**

Sub-Footnote A: nbsp; William Smyth (1766-1849). Professor of Modern History at Cambridge, published his *English Lyrics* (in 1806), and several other works.
[return to poem](#)

must stand for want of a
better.]

[Henry Hallam (1777-1859),
author of *Europe during the
Middle Ages*, 1808, etc.

"This," said Byron, "is the
style in which history ought
to be written, if it is wished to
impress it on the memory"

(*Lady Blessington's Conversations
with Lord Byron*, 1834, p. 213).

The article in question was written
by Dr. John Allen, Lord Holland's
domestic physician, and Byron
was misled by the similarity of
sound in the two names (see H. C.
Robinson's *Diary*, i. 277), or
repeated what Hodgson had told
him (see Introduction, and Letter
102, *note* i).

For a disproof that Hallam wrote
the article, see *Gent. Mag.*, 1830,
pt. i. p. 389; and for an allusion to
the mistake in the review, compare
All the Talents, p. 96, and *note*.

"Spare me not *Chronicles* and
Sunday News,
Spare me not *Pamphleteers*
and *Scotch Reviews*"

"The best literary joke I recollect
is its [the *Edin. Rev.*] attempting to
prove some of the Grecian Pindar

rank non sense, supposing it to have been written by Mr. P. Knight."]

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[go to Footnote 78](#)

Footnote 70: Ý Pillans is a [private, *MS.*] tutor at Eton. [James Pillans (1778-1864), Rector of the High School, and Professor of Humanity in the University, Edinburgh. Byron probably assumed that the review of Hodgson's *Translation of Juvenal*, in the *Edinburgh Review*, April, 1808, was by him.]

[return](#)

Footnote Yy: Ý

*Yet hold--as when by
Heaven's supreme behest,
If found, ten righteous had
preserved the Rest
In Sodom's fated town--for
Granta's name
Let Hodgson's Genius plead
and save her fame
But where fair Isis, etc....*

[*MS. and British Bards*]

[return](#)

Footnote 71: ÝThe Honourable G. Lambe reviewed "**Beresford's** *Miseries*," and is moreover Author of a farce enacted with much applause at the Priory, Stanmore; and damned with great expedition at the late theatre, Covent Garden. It was entitled *Whistle for It*. [See note, *supra*, on line 57.] His review of James Beresford's *Miseries of Human Life; or the Last Groans of Timothy Testy and Samuel Sensitive*, appeared in the *Edinburgh Review* for Oct. 1806.

[return](#)

Footnote Zz: Ý

*See Clarke still striving
piteously to please
Forgets that Doggrel leads
not to degrees...*

[*MS. Fragment bound up with British Bards*]

[return](#)

Footnote 72: Ý Mr. Brougham, in No. XXV. of the *Edinburgh Review*, throughout the article

Footnote aA: Ý

concerning Don Pedro de Cevallos, has displayed more politics than policy; many of the worthy burgesses of Edinburgh being so incensed at the infamous principles it evinces, as to have withdrawn their subscriptions.

*So sunk in dullness and so
lost in shame
That Smythe and Hodgson
scarce redeem thy fame...*

[MS. Addition to *British Bards*.
First to Fourth Editions]

[return](#)

[Here followed, in the First Edition:

"The name of this personage is pronounced Broom in the south, but the truly northern and *musical* pronunciation is **Brough-am**, in two syllables;"

but for this, Byron substituted in the Second Edition:

"It seems that Mr. Brougham is not a Pict, as I supposed, but a Borderer, and his name is pronounced Broom, from Trent to Tay:--so be it."

The title of the work was "Exposition of the Practices and Machinations which led to the usurpation of the Crown of Spain, and the means adopted by the Emperor of the French to carry it into execution," by Don Pedro Cevallos. The article, which appeared in Oct. 1808, was the joint composition of Jeffrey and Brougham, and proved a turning-

point in the political development of the *Review*.]

[return](#)

Footnote 73: Ý: I ought to apologise to the worthy Deities for introducing a new Goddess with short petticoats to their notice: but, alas! what was to be done? I could not say Caledonia's Genius, it being well known there is no genius to be found from Clackmannan to Caithness; yet without supernatural agency, how was Jeffrey to be saved? The national "Kelpies" are too unpoetical, and the "Brownies" and "gude neighbours" (spirits of a good disposition) refused to extricate him. A Goddess, therefore, has been called for the purpose; and great ought to be the gratitude of Jeffrey, seeing it is the only communication he ever held, or is likely to hold, with anything heavenly.

[return](#)

Footnote 74: Ý Lines 528-539 appeared for the first time in the Fifth Edition.

[return](#)

Footnote bB: Ý

is wove...

[MS. *British Bards* and *First to Fourth Editions*]

[return](#)

Footnote cC: Ý

*And modern Britons justly
praise their sires...*

[MS. *British Bards* and *First to Fourth Editions*]

[return](#)

Footnote 75: Ý See the colour of the back binding of the *Edinburgh*

Footnote dD: Ý

Review.

[return](#)

--what her sons must know
too well...

[*British Bards*]

[return](#)

Footnote 76: Ý "Bad enough, and
on mistaken grounds too."--B.,
1816.

[The comment applies to the
whole passage on Lord Holland.]

Footnote eE: Ý

*Zeal for her honour no
malignant Rage,
Has bade me spurn the follies
of the age....*

[Henry Richard Vassall, third Lord
Holland (1773-1840), to whom
Byron dedicated the *Bride of
Abydos* (1813). His *Life of Lope
de Vega* (see note 4) was published
in 1806, and *Three Comedies from
the Spanish*, in 1807.]

[*MS. British Bards. First Edition*]

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Footnote 77: Ý Henry Petty (1780-
1863) succeeded his brother as
third Marquis of Lansdowne in
1809. He was a regular attendant
at the social and political
gatherings of his relative, Lord
Holland; and as Holland House
was regarded as one of the main
rallying-points of the Whig party
and of the Edinburgh Reviewers,
the words, "whipper-in and hunts-
man," probably refer to their
exertions in this respect.

Footnote fF: Ý

--*Ocean's lonely Queen...*

[*British Bards*]

--*Ocean's mighty Queen...*

[*First to Fourth Editions*]

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Footnote 78: Ý See [note](#) 1, p. 337.

Footnote gG: Ý

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*Like these thy cliffs may sink
in ruin hurled*

*The last white ramparts of a
falling world...*

[*British Bards MS.*]

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Footnote 79: Ý Lord Holland has translated some specimens of Lope de Vega, inserted in his life of the author. Both are bepraised by his *disinterested* guests.

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Footnote hH: Ý

*But should I back return, no
lettered rage
Shall drag my common-place
book on the stage:
Let vain Valentia^A rival
luckless Carr,
And equal him whose work
he sought to mar...*

[*Second to Fourth Editions*]

Sub-Footnote A: nbsp;. Lord Valentia (whose tremendous travels are forthcoming with due decorations, graphical, topographical, typographical) deposed, on Sir John Carr's unlucky suit, that Mr. Dubois's satire prevented his purchase of *The Stranger* in Ireland.--Oh, fie, my lord! has your lordship no more feeling for a fellow-tourist?--but "two of a trade," they say, etc.

[George Annesley, Viscount Valentia (1769-1844), published, in 1809, *Voyages and Travels to India, Ceylon, the Red Sea, Abyssinia, and Egypt in the Years 1802-6*. Byron calls him "vain"]

Valentia, because his "accounts of ceremonies attending his lordship's interviews with several of the petty princes" suggest the thought "that his principal errand to India was to measure certain rank in the British peerage against the gradations of Asiatic royalty."-*-Eclectic Review*, August, 1809. In August, 1808, Sir John Carr, author of numerous *Travels*, brought an unsuccessful action for damages against Messrs. Hood and Sharpe, the publishers of the parody of his works by Edward Dubois,--*My Pocket Book: or Hints for a Ryghte Merrie and Conceitede Tour, in 4to, to be called "The Stranger in Ireland in 1805,"* By a Knight Errant, and dedicated to the papermakers. (See Letter to Hodgson, August 6, 1809, and suppressed stanza (stanza Ixxxvii.) of the first canto of *Childe Harold*.)]

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Footnote 80: Ý Certain it is, her ladyship is suspected of having displayed her matchless wit in the *Edinburgh Review*. However that may be, we know from good authority, that the manuscripts are submitted to her perusal--no doubt, for correction.

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Footnote jJ: Ý

*To stun mankind, with Poesy
or Prose*

[*Second to Fourth Editions.*]

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Footnote 81: Ý In the melo-drama of *Tekeli*, that heroic prince is clapt into a barrel on the stage; a new asylum for distressed heroes. [In the *MS.* and *British Bards* the note stands thus:

"In the melodrama of *Tekeli*, that heroic prince is clapt into a barrel on the stage, and Count Everard in the fortress hides himself in a green-house built expressly for the occasion. 'Tis a pity that Theodore Hook, who is really a man of talent, should confine his genius to such paltry productions as *The Fortress*, *Music Mad*, etc. etc."

Theodore Hook (1788-1841) produced *Tekeli* in 1806. *Fortress* and *Music Mad* were played in 1807. He had written some eight or ten popular plays before he was twenty-one.]

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Footnote 82: Ý *Vide post*, 1. 591, [note](#) 3.

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Footnote 83: Ý William Henry West Betty (1791-1874) ("the Young Roscius") made his first appearance on the London stage as Selim, disguised as Achmet, in *Barbarossa*, Dec. 1, 1804, and his

Footnote kK: Ý

*Thus much I've dared to do,
how far my lay*

. [First to Fourth Editions.]

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last, as a boy actor, in *Tancred*, and Captain Flash in *Miss in her Teens*, Mar. 17, 1806, but acted in the provinces till 1808. So great was the excitement on the occasion of his *début*, that the military were held in readiness to assist in keeping order. Having made a large fortune, he finally retired from the stage in 1824, and passed the last fifty years of his life in retirement, surviving his fame by more than half a century.

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Footnote 84: Ý All these are favourite expressions of Mr. Reynolds, and prominent in his comedies, living and defunct. [Frederick Reynolds (1764-1841) produced nearly one hundred plays, one of the most successful of which was *The Caravan, or the Driver and his Dog*. The text alludes to his endeavour to introduce the language of ordinary life on the stage. Compare *The Children of Apollo*, p. 9--

"But in his diction Reynolds
grossly errs;
For whether the love hero
smiles or mourns,
'Tis oh! and ah! and ah! and
oh! by turns."

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Footnote 85: Ý James Kenney (1780-1849). Among his very numerous plays, the most successful were *Raising the Wind* (1803), and *Sweethearts and Wives* (1823). *The World* was brought out at Covent Garden, March 30, 1808, and had a considerable run. He was intimate with Charles and Mary Lamb (see *Letters of Charles Lamb*, ii. 16, 44).

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Footnote 85a: Ý Mr. T. Sheridan, the new Manager of Drury Lane theatre, stripped the Tragedy of *Bonduca* [*Caratach* in the original MS.] of the dialogue, and exhibited the scenes as the spectacle of *Caractacus*. Was this worthy of his sire? or of himself? [Thomas Sheridan (1775-1817), most famous as the son of Richard Brinsley Sheridan, and father of Lady Dufferin, Mrs. Norton, and the Duchess of Somerset, was author of several plays. His *Bonduca* was played at Covent Garden, May 3, 1808. The following answer to a real or fictitious correspondent, in the *European Magazine* for May, 1808, is an indication of contemporary opinion: "The Fishwoman's letter to the author of *Caractacus* on the art of gutting is inadmissible." For anecdotes of

Thomas Sheridan, see Angelo's *Reminiscences*, 1828, ii. 170-175. See, too, *Epics of the Ton*, p. 264.

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Footnote 86: Ý George Colman, the younger (1762-1836), wrote numerous dramas, several of which, *e.g.* *The Iron Chest* (1796), *John Bull* (1803), *The Heir-at-Law* (1808), have been popular with more than one generation of playgoers. An amusing companion, and a favourite at Court, he was appointed Lieutenant of the Yeomen of the Guard, and examiner of plays by Royal favour, but his reckless mode of life kept him always in difficulties. *John Bull* is referred to in *Hints from Horace*, line 166.

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Footnote 87: Ý Richard Cumberland (1732-1811), the original of Sir Fretful Plagiary in *The Critic*, a man of varied abilities, wrote poetry, plays, novels, classical translations, and works of religious controversy. He was successively Fellow of Trinity College, Cambridge, secretary to the Lord Lieutenant of Ireland, and secretary to the Board of Trade. His best known plays are *The West Indian*, *The Wheels of Fortune*, and *The Jew*. He published his *Memoirs* in 1806-7.

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Footnote 88: Ý Sheridan's translation of *Pizarro*, by Kotzebue, was first played at Drury Lane, 1799. Southey wrote of it, "It is impossible to sink below *Pizarro*. Kotzebue's play might have passed for the worst possible if Sheridan had not proved the possibility of making it worse" (Southey's *Letters*, i. 87). Gifford alludes to it in a note to *The Mæviad* as "the translation so maliciously attributed to Sheridan."

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Footnote 89: Ý In all editions, previous to the fifth, it was, "Kemble lives to tread." Byron used to say, that, of actors,

"Cooke was the most natural, Kemble the most supernatural, Kean the medium between the two; but that Mrs. Siddons was worth them all put together."

Such effect, however, had Kean's acting on his mind, that once, on seeing him play Sir Giles Overreach, he was seized with a fit.

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Footnote 90: Ý See *supra*, [line 562](#). (click c4 to return)
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Footnote 91: ^Y Andrew Cherry (1762-1812) acted many parts in Ireland and in the provinces, and for a few years appeared at Drury Lane. He was popular in Dublin, where he was known as "Little Cherry." He was painted as Lazarillo in Jephson's *Two Strings to Your Bow*. He wrote *The Travellers* (1806), *Peter the Great* (1807), and other plays.

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Footnote 92: ^Y Mr. [now Sir Lumley] Skeffington is the illustrious author of *The Sleeping Beauty*; and some comedies, particularly *Maids and Bachelors: Baccalaurii baculo magis quam lauro digni*.

[Lumley St. George (afterwards Sir Lumley) Skeffington (1768-1850). Besides the plays mentioned in the note, he wrote *The Maid of Honour* (1803) and *The Mysterious Bride* (1808). *Amatory Verses, by Tom Shuffleton of the Middle Temple* (1815), are attributed to his pen. They are prefaced by a dedicatory letter to Byron, which includes a coarse but clever skit in the style of *English Bards*. "Great Skeffington" was a great dandy. According to Capt. Gronow (*Reminiscences*, i. 63), "he used to paint his face so that he looked

like a French toy; he dressed à la Robespierre, and practised all the follies;... was remarkable for his politeness and courtly manners... You always knew of his approach by an *avant courier* of sweet smell." His play *The Sleeping Beauty* had a considerable vogue.]

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Footnote 93: Ý Thomas John Dibdin (1771-1841), natural son of Charles Dibdin the elder, made his first appearance on the stage at the age of four, playing Cupid to Mrs. Siddons' Venus at the Shakespearian Jubilee in 1775. One of his best known pieces is *The Jew and the Doctor* (1798). His pantomime, *Mother Goose*, in which Grimaldi took a part, was played at Covent Garden in 1807, and is said to have brought the management £20,000.

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[cross-reference: return to Footnote 82 of this poem](#)

Footnote 94: Ý Mr. Greenwood is, we believe, scene-painter to Drury Lane theatre--as such, Mr. Skeffington is much indebted to him.

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Footnote 95: Ý Naldi and Catalani require little notice; for the visage of the one, and the salary of the other, will enable us long to recollect these amusing

vagabonds. Besides, we are still black and blue from the squeeze on the first night of the Lady's appearance in trousers. [Guiseppe Naldi (1770-1820) made his *début* on the London stage at the King's Theatre in April, 1806. In conjunction with Catalani and Braham, he gave concerts at Willis' Rooms. Angelica Catalani (circ. 1785-1849), a famous soprano, Italian by birth and training, made her *début* at Venice in 1795. She remained in England for eight years (1806-14). Her first appearance in England was at the King's Theatre, in Portogallo's *Semiramide*, in 1806. Her large salary was one of the causes which provoked the O. P. (Old Prices) Riots in December, 1809, at Covent Garden. Praed says of his *Ball Room Belle*--

"She warbled Handel: it was grand; She made the Catalani jealous."

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Footnote 96: Ý Moore says that the following twenty lines were struck off one night after Lord Byron's return from the Opera, and sent the next morning to the printer. The date of the letter to Dallas, with which the lines were enclosed, suggests that the

representation which provoked the outburst was that of *I Villegiatori Rezzani*, at the King's Theatre, February 21, 1809. The first piece, in which Naldi and Catalani were the principal singers, was followed by d'Egville's musical extravaganza, *Don Quichotte, on les Noces de Gamache*. In the *corps de ballet* were Deshayes, for many years master of the *ballet* at the King's Theatre; Miss Gayton, who had played a Sylph at Drury Lane as early as 1806 (she was married, March 18, 1809, to the Rev. William Murray, brother of Sir James Pulteney, Bart.--*Morning Chronicle*, December 30, 1810), and Mademoiselle Angiolini, "elegant of figure, *petite*, but finely formed, with the manner of Vestris." Mademoiselle Presle does not seem to have taken part in *Don Quichotte*; but she was well known as *première danseuse* in *La Belle Laitière*, *La Fête Chinoise*, and other ballets.

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Footnote 97: Ý For "whet" Editions 1-5 read "raise." Lines 632-637 are marked "good" in the Annotated Fourth Edition.

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Footnote 98: Ý To prevent any blunder, such as mistaking a street for a man, I beg leave to state, that it is the institution, and not the

Duke of that name, which is here alluded to.

A gentleman, with whom I am slightly acquainted, lost in the Argyle Rooms several thousand pounds at Backgammon^A_B. It is but justice to the manager in this instance to say, that some degree of disapprobation was manifested: but why are the implements of gaming allowed in a place devoted to the society of both sexes? A pleasant thing for the wives and daughters of those who are blessed or cursed with such connections, to hear the Billiard-Balls rattling in one room, and the dice in another! That this is the case I myself can testify, as a late unworthy member of an Institution which materially affects the morals of the higher orders, while the lower may not even move to the sound of a tabor and fiddle, without a chance of indictment for riotous behaviour.

[The Argyle Institution, founded by Colonel Greville, flourished many years before the Argyll Rooms were built by Nash in 1818. This mention of Greville's name caused him to demand an explanation from Byron, but the matter was amicably settled by Moore and G. F. Leckie, who

acted on behalf of the disputants
(see *Life*, pp. 160, 161).]

Sub-Footnote A: nbsp; "True. It was Billy Way who lost the money. I knew him, and was a subscriber to the Argyle at the time of this event."--B., 1816.

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Footnote 99: Ý Petronius, "Arbiter elegantiarum" to Nero, "and a very pretty fellow in his day," as Mr. Congreve's "Old Bachelor" saith of Hannibal.

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Footnote 100: Ý "We are authorised to state that Mr. Greville, who has a small party at his private assembly rooms at the Argyle, will receive from 10 to 12 [p.m.] masks who have Mrs. Chichester's Institution tickets.--*Morning Post*, June 7, 1809.

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Footnote 101: Ý See [note](#) on [line 686](#) (click c5 to return), infra.

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Footnote 102: Ý *Clodius*--"Mutato nomine de te Fabula narratur."--
[MS] [The allusion is to the well-known incidents of his intrigue with Pompeia, Cæsar's wife, and his sacrilegious intrusion into the mysteries of the Bona Dea. The Romans had a proverb, "Clodius

accuset Moechos?" (Juv., *Sat.* ii. 27). That "Steenie" should lecture on the "turpitude of incontinence!" (*The Fortunes of Nigel*, cap. xxxii.)]

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Footnote 103: 'I knew the late Lord Falkland well. On Sunday night I beheld him presiding at his own table, in all the honest pride of hospitality; on Wednesday morning, at three o'clock, I saw stretched before me all that remained of courage, feeling, and a host of passions. He was a gallant and successful officer: his faults were the faults of a sailor--as such, Britons will forgive them. ["His behaviour on the field was worthy of a better fate, and his conduct on the bed of death evinced all the firmness of a man without the farce of repentance--I say the farce of repentance, for death-bed repentance is a farce, and as little serviceable to the soul at such a moment as the surgeon to the body, though both may be useful if taken in time. Some hireling in the papers forged a tale about an agonized voice, etc. On mentioning the circumstance to Mr. Heaviside, he exclaimed, 'Good God! what absurdity to talk in this manner of one who died like a lion!'--he did more."--[MS] He died like a brave man in a

better cause; for had he fallen in like manner on the deck of the frigate to which he was just appointed, his last moments would have been held up by his countrymen as an example to succeeding heroes.

[Charles John Carey, ninth Viscount Falkland, died from a wound received in a duel with Mr. A. Powell on Feb. 28, 1809. (See Byron's letter to his mother, March 6, 1809.) The story of "the agonized voice" may be traced to a paragraph in the *Morning Post*, March 2, 1809: "Lord Falkland, after hearing the surgeon's opinion, said with a faltering voice and as intelligibly as the agonized state of his body and mind permitted, "I acquit Mr. Powell of all blame; in this transaction I alone am culpable.""]

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[cross-reference: return to Footnote 101](#)

[cross-reference: return to Footnote 55 of *Hints from Horace*](#)

Footnote 104: Ý "Yes: and a precious chase they led me."--B., 1816.

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Footnote 105: Ý "*Fool* enough, certainly, then, and no wiser since."--B., 1816.

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Footnote 106: ¿What would be the sentiments of the Persian Anacreon, **Hafiz**, could he rise from his splendid sepulchre at Sheeraz (where he reposes with **Ferdousi** and **Sadi**, the Oriental Homer and Catullus), and behold his name assumed by one **Stott of Dromore**, the most impudent and execrable of literary poachers for the Daily Prints?

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Footnote 107: ¿Miles Peter Andrews (d. 1824) was the owner of large powder-mills at Dartford. He was M.P. for Bewdley. He held a good social position, but his intimate friends were actors and playwrights. His *Better Late than Never* (which Reynolds and Topham helped him to write) was played for the first time at Drury Lane, October 17, 1790, with Kemble as Saville, and Mrs. Jordan as Augusta. He is mentioned in *The Baviad*, l. 10; and in a note Gifford satirizes his prologue to *Lorenzo*, and describes him as an "industrious paragraph-monger."

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Footnote 108: ¿In a manuscript fragment, bound in the same volume as *British Bards*, we find these lines:--

"In these, our times, with
daily wonders big,
A Lettered peer is like a
lettered pig;
Both know their Alphabet,
but who, from thence,
Infers that peers or pigs have
manly sense?
Still less that such should
woo the graceful nine;
Parnassus was not made for
lords and swine."

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Footnote 109: Ý Wentworth Dillon, 4th Earl of Roscommon (1634-1685), author of many translations and minor poems, endeavoured (circ. 1663) to found an English literary academy.

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Footnote 110: Ý John Sheffield, Earl of Mulgrave (1658), Marquis of Normanby (1694), Duke of Buckingham (1703) (1649-1721), wrote an *Essay upon Poetry*, and several other works.

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Footnote 111: Ý Lines 727-740 were added after *British Bards* had been printed, and are included in the First Edition, but the appearance in *British Bards* of lines 723-726 and 741-746, which have been cut out from Mr. Murray's MS., forms one of many proofs as to the identity of the text

of the MS. and the printed Quarto.

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Footnote 112: Ý Frederick Howard, 5th Earl of Carlisle, K.G. (1748-1825), Viceroy of Ireland, 1780-1782, and Privy Seal, etc., published *Tragedies and Poems*, 1801. He was Byron's first cousin once removed, and his guardian. *Poems Original and Translated*, were dedicated to Lord Carlisle, and, as an erased MS. addition to *British Bards* testifies, he was to have been excepted from the roll of titled poetasters--

"Ah, who would take their
titles from their rhymes?
On *one* alone Apollo deigns
to smile,
And crowns a new
Roscommon in Carlisle."

Before, however, the revised Satire was sent to the press, Carlisle ignored his cousin's request to introduce him on taking his seat in the House of Lords, and, to avenge the slight, eighteen lines of castigation supplanted the flattering couplet. Lord Carlisle suffered from a nervous disorder, and Byron was informed that some readers had scented an allusion in the words "paralytic puling." "I thank Heaven," he exclaimed, "I did not know it; and

would not, could not, if I had. I must naturally be the last person to be pointed on defects or maladies."

In 1814 he consulted Rogers on the chance of conciliating Carlisle, and in *Childe Harold*, iii. 29, he laments the loss of the "young and gallant Howard" (Carlisle's youngest son) at Waterloo, and admits that "he did his sire some wrong." But, according to Medwin (*Conversations*, 1824, p. 362), who prints an excellent parody on Carlisle's lines addressed to Lady Holland in 1822, in which he urges her to decline the legacy of Napoleon's snuff-box, Byron made fun of his "noble relative" to the end of the chapter (*vide post*, p. 370, *note 2*).

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Footnote 113: The Earl of Carlisle has lately published an eighteen-penny pamphlet on the state of the Stage, and offers his plan for building a new theatre. It is to be hoped his Lordship will be permitted to bring forward anything for the Stage--except his own tragedies. [This pamphlet was entitled *Thoughts upon the present condition of the stage, and upon the construction of a new Theatre*, anon. 1808.]

Line 732. None of the earlier editions, including the fifth and Murray, 1831, insert "and" between "petit-maître" and "pamphleteer." No doubt Byron sounded the final syllable of "maître," *anglicé* "mailer."

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Footnote 114: Ý

"Doff that lion's hide,
And hang a calf-skin on those
recreant limbs."

Shakespeare, *King John*.

Lord Carlisle's works, most resplendently bound, form a conspicuous ornament to his bookshelves:--

"The rest is all but [only,
MS.] leather and prunella."

"Wrong also--the provocation was not sufficient to justify such acerbity."--B., 1816.

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Footnote 115: Ý *All the Blocks, or an Antidote to "All the Talents"* by Flagellum (W. H. Ireland), London, 1807:
The Groan of the Talents, or Private Sentiments on Public Occasions, 1807;
"Gr--vile Agonistes, A Dramatic

Poem, 1807, etc., etc."

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Footnote 116: Ý "Melville's Mantle," a parody on *Elijah's Mantle*, a poem. [*Elijah's Mantle*, being verses occasioned by the death of that illustrious statesman, the Right Hon. W. Pitt. Dedicated to the Right Rev. the Lord Bishop of Lincoln (1807), was written by James Sayer. *Melville's Mantle*, being a Parody on the poem entitled "*Elijah's Mantle*" was published by Budd, 1807. A *Monody on the death of the R. H. C. J. Fox*, by Richard Payne Knight, was printed for J. Payne, 1806-7. Another "Monody," *Lines written on returning from the Funeral of the R. H. C. J. Fox*, Friday Oct. 10, 1806, addressed to Lord Holland, was by M. G. Lewis, and there were others.]

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Footnote 117: Ý This lovely little Jessica, the daughter of the noted Jew King, seems to be a follower of the Della Crusca school, and has published two volumes of very respectable absurdities in rhyme, as times go; besides sundry novels in the style of the first edition of *The Monk*.

"She since married the *Morning Post*--an exceeding good match; and is now dead--which is better."

-B., 1816. [The last seven words are in pencil, and, possibly, by another hand. The novelist "Rosa," the daughter of "Jew King," the lordly money-lender who lived in Clarges Street, and drove a yellow chariot, may possibly be confounded with "Rosa Matilda," Mrs. Byrne (Gronow, *Rem.* (1889), i. 132-136). (See note 1, p. 358.)]

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Footnote 118: Y Lines 759, 760 were added for the first time in the Fourth Edition.

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Footnote 119: Y Lines 756-764, with variant ii., refer to the Della Cruscan school, attacked by Gifford in *The Baviad* and *The Mæviad*. Robert Merry (1755-1798), together with Mrs. Piozzi, Bertie Greatheed, William Parsons, and some Italian friends, formed a literary society called the *Oziosi* at Florence, where they published *The Arno Miscellany* (1784) and *The Florence Miscellany* (1785), consisting of verses in which the authors "say kind things of each other" (Preface to *The Florence Miscellany*, by Mrs. Piozzi). In 1787 Merry, who had become a member of the Della Cruscan Academy at Florence, returned to London, and wrote in the *World* (then edited by Captain

Topham) a sonnet on "Love," under the signature of "Della Crusca." He was answered by Mrs. Hannah Cowley, *née* Parkhouse (1743-1809), famous as the authoress of *The Belle's Stratagem* (acted at Covent Garden in 1782), in a sonnet called "The Pen," signed "Anna Matilda." The poetical correspondence which followed was published in *The British Album* (1789, 2 vols.) by John Bell. Other writers connected with the Della Cruscan school were "Perdita" Robinson, *née* Darby (1758-1800), who published *The Mistletoe* (1800) under the pseudonym "Laura Maria," and to whom Merry addressed a poem quoted by Gifford in *The Baviad* (note to line 284); Charlotte Dacre, who married Byrne, Robinson's successor as editor of the *Morning Post*, wrote under the pseudonym of "Rosa Matilda," and published poems (*Hours of Solitude*, 1805) and numerous novels (*Confessions of the Nun of St. Omer's*, 1805; *Zofloya*; *The Libertine*, etc.); and "Hafiz" (Robert Stott, of the *Morning Post*). Of these writers, "Della Crusca" Merry, and "Laura Maria" Robinson, were dead; "Anna Matilda" Cowley, "Hafiz" Stott, and "Rosa Matilda" Dacre were

still living. John Bell (1745-1831), the publisher of *The British Album*, was also one of the proprietors of the *Morning Post*, the *Oracle*, and the *World*, in all of which the Della Cruscans wrote. His "Owls and Nightingales" are explained by a reference to *The Baviad* (l. 284), where Gifford pretends to mistake the nightingale, to which Merry ("Arno") addressed some lines, for an owl. "On looking again, I find the owl to be a nightingale!-- N'importe."]

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Footnote 120: Ý These are the signatures of various worthies who figure in the poetical departments of the newspapers.

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Footnote 121: Ý "This was meant for poor Blackett, who was then patronised by A. I. B." (Lady Byron); "but *that* I did not know, or this would not have been written, at least I think not."--B., 1816.

[Joseph Blacket (1786-1810), said by Southey (*Letters*, i. 172) to possess "force and rapidity," and to be endowed with "more powers than Robert Bloomfield, and an intellect of higher pitch," was the son of a labourer, and by trade a cobbler. He was brought into

notice by S. J. Pratt (who published Blacket's *Remains* in 1811), and was befriended by the Milbanke family. Miss Milbanke, afterwards Lady Byron, wrote (Sept. 2, 1809), "Seaham is at present the residence of a poet, by name Joseph Blacket, one of the Burns-like and Dermody kind, whose genius is his sole possession. I was yesterday in his company for the first time, and was much pleased with his manners and conversation. He is extremely diffident, his deportment is mild, and his countenance animated melancholy and of a satirical turn. His poems certainly display a superior genius and an enlarged mind...." Blacket died on the Seaham estate in Sept., 1810, at the age of twenty-three. (See Byron's letter to Dallas, June 28, 1811; his *Epitaph for Joseph Blackett*; and *Hints from Horace*, [l. 734](#). (click c8 to return))]

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[cross-reference: return to Footnote 70 of *Hints from Horace*](#)

Footnote 122: Ý Capel Lofft, Esq., the Mæcenas of shoemakers, and Preface-writer-General to distressed verse-men; a kind of gratis Accoucheur to those who wish to be delivered of rhyme, but do not know how to bring it forth.

[Capel Lofft (1751-1824), jurist, poet, critic, and horticulturist, honoured himself by his kindly patronage of Robert Bloomfield (1766-1823), who was born at Honington, near Lofft's estate of Throston, Suffolk. Robert Bloomfield was brought up by his elder brothers--Nathaniel a tailor, and George a shoemaker. It was in the latter's workshop that he composed *The Farmer's Boy*, which was published (1798) with the help of Lofft. He also wrote *Rural Tales* (1802), *Good Tidings; or News from the Farm* (1804), *The Banks of the Wye* (1811), etc. (See *Hints from Horace*, [line 734](#) (click c9 to return), notes [1](#) and [2](#).)]

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Footnote 123: Ý See Nathaniel Bloomfield's ode, elegy, or whatever he or any one else chooses to call it, on the enclosures of "Honington Green." [Nathaniel Bloomfield, as a matter of fact, called it a ballad.--*Poems* (1803).]

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Footnote 124: Ý *Vide Recollections of a Weaver in the Moorlands of Staffordshire*. [The exact title is *The Moorland Bard; or Poetical Recollections of a Weaver*, etc. 2 vols., 1807. The author was T. Bakewell, who also

wrote *A Domestic Guide to Insanity*, 1805.]

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Footnote 125: Ý It would be superfluous to recall to the mind of the reader the authors of *The Pleasures of Memory* and *The Pleasures of Hope*, the most beautiful didactic poems in our language, if we except Pope's *Essay on Man*: but so many poetasters have started up, that even the names of Campbell and Rogers are become strange.--
[Beneath this note Byron scribbled, in 1816,--

"Pretty Miss Jaqueline
Had a nose aquiline,
And would assert rude
Things of Miss Gertrude,
While Mr. Marmion
Led a great army on,
Making Kehama look
Like a fierce Mameluke."

"I have been reading," he says, in 1813, *Memory* again, and *Hope* together, and retain all my preference of the former. His elegance is really wonderful--there is no such a thing as a vulgar line in his book." In the annotations of 1816, Byron remarks, "Rogers has not fulfilled the promise of his first poems, but has still very great

merit."

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Footnote 126: **Ÿ Gifford**, author of the *Baviad* and *Mæviad*, the first satires of the day, and translator of Juvenal, [and one (though not the best) of the translators of Juvenal.--*British Bards*.

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Footnote 127: **Ÿ Sotheby**, translator of **Wieland's** *Oberon* and Virgil's *Georgics*, and author of *Saul*, an epic poem.

[William Sotheby (1757-1833) began life as a cavalry officer, but being a man of fortune, sold out of the army and devoted himself to literature, and to the patronage of men of letters. His translation of the *Oberon* appeared in 1798, and of the *Georgics* in 1800. *Saul* was published in 1807. When Byron was in Venice, he conceived a dislike to Sotheby, in the belief that he had made an anonymous attack on some of his works; but, later, his verdict was, "a good man, rhymes well (if not wisely); but is a bore" (*Diary*, 1821; *Works*, p. 509, note). He is "the solemn antique man of rhyme" (*Beppo*, st. lxiii.), and the "Botherby" of *The Blues*; and in *Don Juan*, Canto I. st. cxvi., we read--

"Thou shalt not covet Mr.
Sotheby's house
His Pegasus nor anything
that's his."

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Footnote 128: Ý **Macneil**, whose poems are deservedly popular, particularly "**Scotland's** Scaith," and the "Waes of War," of which ten thousand copies were sold in one month.

[Hector Macneil (1746-1816) wrote in defence of slavery in Jamaica, and was the author of several poems: *Scotland's Skaith, or the History of Will and Jean* (1795), *The Waes of War, or the Upshot of the History of Will and Jean* (1796), etc., etc.]

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Footnote 129: Ý Mr. **Gifford** promised publicly that the *Baviad* and *Mæviad* should not be his last original works: let him remember, "Mox in reluctantes dracones."
[Cf. *New Morality*, lines 29-42.]

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Footnote 130: Ý Henry Kirke White died at Cambridge, in October 1806, in consequence of too much exertion in the pursuit of studies that would have matured a mind which disease and poverty could not impair, and which Death itself destroyed rather than

subdued. His poems abound in such beauties as must impress the reader with the liveliest regret that so short a period was allotted to talents, which would have dignified even the sacred functions he was destined to assume.

[H. K. White (1785-1806) published *Clifton Grove* and other poems in 1803. Two volumes of his *Remains*, consisting of poems, letters, etc., with a life by Southey, were issued in 1808. His tendency to epilepsy was increased by over-work at Cambridge. He once remarked to a friend that "were he to paint a picture of Fame, crowning a distinguished undergraduate after the Senate house examination, he would represent her as concealing a Death's head under a mask of Beauty" (*Life of H. K. W.*, by Southey, i. 45). By "the soaring lyre, which else had sounded an immortal lay," Byron, perhaps, refers to the unfinished *Christiad*, which, says Southey, "Henry had most at heart."]

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Footnote 131: Ý Lines 832-834, as they stand in the text, were inserted in MS. in both the Annotated Copies of the Fourth Edition.

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Footnote 132: Ý "I consider Crabbe and Coleridge as the first of these times, in point of power and genius."--B., 1816.

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Footnote 133: Ý Mr. Shee, author of *Rhymes on Art* and *Elements of Art*.

[Sir Martin Archer Shee (1770-1850) was President of the Royal Academy (1830-45). His *Rhymes on Art* (1805) and *Elements of Art* (1809), a poem in six cantos, will hardly be regarded as worthy of Byron's praise, which was probably quite genuine. He also wrote a novel, *Harry Calverley*, and other works.]

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Footnote 134: Ý Mr. Wright, late Consul-General for the Seven Islands, is author of a very beautiful poem, just published: it is entitled *Horæ Ionicæ*, and is descriptive of the isles and the adjacent coast of Greece.

[Walter Rodwell Wright was afterwards President of the Court of Appeal in Malta, where he died in 1826. *Horæ Ionicæ, a Poem descriptive of the Ionian Islands, and Part of the Adjacent Coast of Greece*, was published in 1809. He is mentioned in one of Byron's long notes to *Childe Harold*, canto

ii., dated Franciscan Convent,
Mar. 17, 1811.]

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Footnote 135: Ý The translators of
the Anthology have since
published separate poems, which
evinced genius that only requires
opportunity to attain eminence.

[The Rev. Robert Bland (1779-
1825) published, in 1806,
*Translations chiefly from the
Greek Anthology, with Tales and
Miscellaneous Poems*. In these he
was assisted (see *Life of the Rev.
Francis Hodgson*, vol. i. pp. 226-
260) by Denman (afterwards Chief
Justice), by Hodgson himself, and,
above all, by John Herman
Merivale (1779-1844), who
subsequently, in 1813, was joint
editor with him of *Collections
from the Greek Anthology*, etc.]

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Footnote 136: Ý Erasmus Darwin
(1731-1802), the grandfather of
Charles Robert Darwin. Coleridge
describes his poetry as "nothing
but a succession of landscapes or
paintings. It arrests the attention
too often, and so prevents the
rapidity necessary to pathos."--
Anima Poetæ, 1895, p. 5. His chief
works are *The Botanic Garden*
(1789-92) and *The Temple of
Nature* (1803). Byron's censure of
The Botanic Garden is

inconsistent with his principles, for Darwin's verse was strictly modelled on the lines of Pope and his followers. But the *Loves of the Triangles* had laughed away the *Loves of the Plants*.

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Footnote 137: Ý The neglect of *The Botanic Garden* is some proof of returning taste. The scenery is its sole recommendation.

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Footnote 138: Ý This was not Byron's mature opinion, nor had he so expressed himself in the review of Wordsworth's *Poems* which he contributed to *Crosby's Magazine* in 1807 (*Life*, p. 669). His scorn was, in part, provoked by indignities offered to Pope and Dryden, and, in part, assumed because one Lake poet called up the rest; and it was good sport to flout and jibe at the "Fraternity." That the day would come when the message of Wordsworth would reach his ears and awaken his enthusiasm, he could not, of course, foresee (see *Childe Harold*, canto iii. stanzas 72, *et seqq.*).

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Footnote 139: Ý Messrs. Lamb and Lloyd, the most ignoble followers of Southey and Co.

[Charles Lloyd (1775-1839)]

resided for some months under Coleridge's roof, first in Bristol, and afterwards at Nether Stowey (1796-1797). He published, in 1796, a folio edition of his *Poems on the Death of Priscilla Farmer*, in which a sonnet by Coleridge and a poem of Lamb's were included. Lamb and Lloyd contributed several pieces to the second edition of Coleridge's *Poems*, published in 1797; and in 1798 they brought out a joint volume of their own composition, named *Poems in Blank Verse*. *Edmund Oliver*, a novel, appeared also in 1798. An estrangement between Coleridge and Lloyd resulted in a quarrel with Lamb, and a drawing together of Lamb, Lloyd, and Southey. But Byron probably had in his mind nothing more than the lines in the *Anti-Jacobin*, where Lamb and Lloyd are classed with Coleridge and Southey as advocates of French socialism:--

"Coleridge and Southey,
Lloyd and Lamb and Co.,
Tune all your mystic harps to
praise Lepaux."

In later life Byron expressed a very different opinion of Lamb's literary merits. (See the preface to

Werner, now first published.)]

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Footnote 140: Ý By the bye, I hope that in Mr. Scott's next poem, his hero or heroine will be less addicted to "Gramarye," and more to Grammar, than the Lady of the Lay and her Bravo, William of Deloraine.

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Footnote 141: Ý "Unjust."--B., 1816.

[In *Frost at Midnight*, first published in 1798, Coleridge twice mentions his "Cradled infant."]

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Footnote 142: Ý The Rev. W. L. Bowles (*vide ante*, p. 323, note 2), published, in 1789, *Fourteen Sonnets written chiefly on Picturesque Spots during a Journey*.

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Footnote 143: Ý It may be asked, why I have censured the Earl of **Carlisle**, my guardian and relative, to whom I dedicated a volume of puerile poems a few years ago?--The guardianship was nominal, at least as far as I have been able to discover; the relationship I cannot help, and am very sorry for it; but as his Lordship seemed to forget it on a

very essential occasion to me, I shall not burden my memory with the recollection. I do not think that personal differences sanction the unjust condemnation of a brother scribbler; but I see no reason why they should act as a preventive, when the author, noble or ignoble, has, for a series of years, beguiled a "discerning public" (as the advertisements have it) with divers reams of most orthodox, imperial nonsense. Besides, I do not step aside to vituperate the earl: no--his works come fairly in review with those of other Patrician Literati. If, before I escaped from my teens, I said anything in favour of his Lordship's paper books, it was in the way of dutiful dedication, and more from the advice of others than my own judgment, and I seize the first opportunity of pronouncing my sincere recantation. I have heard that some persons conceive me to be under obligations to Lord **Carlisle**: if so, I shall be most particularly happy to learn what they are, and when conferred, that they may be duly appreciated and publicly acknowledged. What I have humbly advanced as an opinion on his printed things, I am prepared to support, if necessary, by quotations from Elegies, Eulogies, Odes, Episodes, and certain

facetious and dainty tragedies
bearing his name and mark:--

"What can ennoble knaves, or
fools, or cowards?
Alas! not all the blood of all
the Howards."

So says Pope. Amen!

"Much too savage, whatever the
foundation might be."--B., 1816.

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Footnote 144: Ý Line 952. Note--

"Tollere humo, victorque
virum volitare per ora."

(Virgil.)

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Footnote 145: Ý

"The devil take that
'Phoenix'! How came it
there?"

(B., 1816.)

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Footnote 146: ÝThe Rev. Charles
James Hoare (1781-1865), a close
friend of the leaders of the
Evangelical party, gained the
Seatonian Prize at Cambridge in
1807 with his poem on the
Shipwreck of St. Paul.

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Footnote 147: Ý Edmund Hoyle, the father of the modern game of whist, lived from 1672 to 1769. The Rev. Charles Hoyle, his "poetical namesake," was, like Hoare, a Seatonian prizeman, and wrote an epic in thirteen books on the *Exodus*.

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Footnote 148: Ý The *Games of Hoyle*, well known to the votaries of Whist, Chess, etc., are not to be superseded by the vagaries of his poetical namesake ["illustrious Synonyme" in *MS.* and *British Bards*, whose poem comprised, as expressly stated in the advertisement, all the "Plagues of Egypt."

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Footnote 149: Ý Here, as in line 391, "Fresh fish from Helicon," etc., Byron confounds Helicon and Hippocrene.

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Footnote 150: Ý This person, who has lately betrayed the most rabid symptoms of confirmed authorship, is writer of a poem denominated *The Art of Pleasing*, as "Lucus a non lucendo," containing little pleasantry, and less poetry. He also acts as ["lies as" in *MS.*] monthly stipendiary and collector of calumnies for the *Satirist*. If this unfortunate young man would exchange the

magazines for the mathematics, and endeavour to take a decent degree in his university, it might eventually prove more serviceable than his present salary.

[Note.--An unfortunate young person of Emanuel College, Cambridge, ycleped Hewson Clarke, has lately manifested the most rabid symptoms of confirmed Authorship. His Disorder commenced some years ago, and the *Newcastle Herald* teemed with his precocious essays, to the great edification of the Burgesses of Newcastle, Morpeth, and the parts adjacent even unto Berwick upon Tweed. These have since been abundantly scurrilous upon the [town] of Newcastle, his native spot, Mr. Mathias and Anacreon Moore. What these men had done to offend Mr. Hewson Clarke is not known, but surely the town in whose markets he had sold meat, and in whose weekly journal he had written prose deserved better treatment. Mr. H.C. should recollect the proverb "'tis a villainous bird that defiles his own nest." He now writes in the *Satirist*. We recommend the young man to abandon the magazines for mathematics, and to believe that a high degree at Cambridge will be more

advantageous, as well as profitable
in the end, than his present
precarious gleanings.]

[Hewson Clarke (1787-circ. 1832)
was entered at Emmanuel Coll.
Camb. circ. 1806 (see *Postscript*).
He had to leave the University
without taking a degree, and
migrated to London, where he
devoted his not inconsiderable
talents to contributions to the
Satirist, the *Scourge*, etc. He also
wrote: *An Impartial History of the
Naval, etc., Events of Europe ...
from the French Revolution ... to
the Conclusion of a General
Peace* (1815); and a continuation
of Hume's *History of England*, 2
vols. (1832).

The *Satirist*, a monthly magazine
illustrated with coloured cartoons,
was issued 1808-1814. *Hours of
Idleness* was reviewed Jan. 1808
(i. 77-81). "The Diary of a
Cantab" (June, 1808, ii. 368)
contains some verses of "Lord B--
--n to his Bear. To the tune of
Lachin y gair." The last verse runs
thus:-

"But when with the ardour of
Love I am burning,
I feel for thy torments, I feel
for thy care;
And weep for thy bondage,

so truly discerning
What's felt by a *Lord*, may be
felt by a *Bear*."

In August, 1808 (iii. 78-86), there is a critique on *Poems Original and Translated*, in which the bear plays many parts. The writer "is without his bear and is himself muzzled," etc. Towards the close of the article a solemn sentence is passed on the author for his disregard of the advice of parents, tutors, friends; "but," adds the reviewer, "in the paltry volume before us we think we observe some proof that the still small voice of conscience will be heard in the cool of the day. Even now the gay, the gallant, the accomplished bear-leader is not happy," etc. Hence the castigation of "the sizar of Emmanuel College."

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[cross-reference: return to Footnote
19 of *Hints from Horace*](#)

[Footnote 151: Ý](#)

"Right enough: this was well
deserved, and well laid on."

(B., 1816.)

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[Footnote 152: Ý](#)

"Into Cambridgeshire the
Emperor Probus transported a
considerable body of
Vandals."

(Gibbon's *Decline and Fall*, ii.
83.) There is no reason to doubt
the truth of this assertion; the
breed is still in high perfection.

We see no reason to doubt the
truth of this statement, as a large
stock of the same breed are to be
found there at this day.--*British
Bards*.

[Lines 981-984 do not occur in the
MS. Lines 981, 982, are inserted in
MS. in *British Bards*.]

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Footnote 153: 'This gentleman's
name requires no praise: the man
who [has surpassed Dryden and
Gifford as a Translator.--MS.
British Bards] in translation
displays unquestionable genius
may be well expected to excel in
original composition, of which, it
is to be hoped, we shall soon see a
splendid specimen.

[Francis Hodgson (1781-1852)
was Byron's lifelong friend. His
Juvenal appeared in 1807; *Lady
Jane Grey and other Poems*, in
1809; *Sir Edgar, a Tale*, in 1810.
For other works and details, see

Life of the Rev. Francis Hodgson,
by the Rev. James T. Hodgson
(1878).]

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Footnote 154: Ý Hewson Clarke,
Esq., as it is written.

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Footnote 155: Ý *The Aboriginal Britons*, an excellent ["most excellent" in *MS.*] poem, by Richards.

[The Rev. George Richards, D.D. (1769-1835), a Fellow of Oriel, and afterwards Rector of St. Martin's-in-the-Fields. *The Aboriginal Britons*, a prize poem, was published in 1792, and was followed by *The Songs of the Aboriginal Bards of Britain* (1792), and various other prose and poetical works.]

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Footnote 156: Ý With this verse the satire originally ended.

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Footnote 157: Ý A friend of mine being asked, why his Grace of Portland was likened to an old woman? replied, "he supposed it was because he was past bearing." (Even Homer was a punster--a solitary pun.)--[*MS.*] His Grace is now gathered to his grandmothers, where he sleeps as sound as ever; but even his sleep was better than

his colleagues' waking. 1811.

[William Henry Cavendish, third Duke of Portland (1738-1809), Prime Minister in 1807, on the downfall of the Ministry of "All the Talents," till his death in 1809, was, as the wits said, "a convenient block to hang Whigs on," but was not, even in his vigour, a man of much intellectual capacity. When Byron meditated a tour to India in 1808, Portland declined to write on his behalf to the Directors of the East India Company, and couched his refusal in terms which Byron fancied to be offensive.]

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Footnote 158: Ý "Saw it August, 1809.--B., 1816.

[The following notes were omitted from the Fifth Edition:--

"Calpe is the ancient name of Gibraltar. Saw it August, 1809.--B., 1816.

"Stamboul is the Turkish word for Constantinople. Was there the summer 1810."

To "Mount Caucasus," he adds, "Saw the distant ridge of,--1810, 1811"]

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Footnote 159: Ý Georgia.

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Footnote 160: Ý Mount Caucasus.

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Footnote 161: Ý Lord Elgin would fain persuade us that all the figures, with and without noses, in his stoneshop, are the work of Phidias! "Credat Judæus!"

[R. Payne Knight, in his introduction to *Specimens of Ancient Sculpture*, published 1809, by the Dilettanti Society, throws a doubt on the Phidian workmanship of the "Elgin" marbles. See the [Introduction](#) to *The Curse of Minerva*.]

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Footnote 162: Ý Sir William Gell (1777-1836) published the *Topography of Troy* (1804), the *Geography and Antiquities of Ithaca* (1807), and the *Itinerary of Greece* (1808). Byron reviewed the two last works in the *Monthly Review* (August, 1811), (*Life*, pp. 670, 676). Fresh from the scenes, he speaks with authority.

"With Homer in his pocket and Gell on his sumpter-mule, the Odysseus tourist may now make a very classical and delightful excursion."

The epithet in the original MS. was "coxcomb," but becoming acquainted with Gell while the satire was in the press, Byron changed it to "classic." In the fifth edition he altered it to "rapid," and appended this note:--

"'Rapid,' indeed! He topographised and typographised King Priam's dominions in three days! I called him 'classic' before I saw the Troad, but since have learned better than to tack to his name what don't belong to it."

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Footnote 163: Ý Mr. Gell's *Topography of Troy and Ithaca* cannot fail to ensure the approbation of every man possessed of classical taste, as well for the information Mr. Gell conveys to the mind of the reader, as for the ability and research the respective works display.

"'Troy and Ithaca.' Visited both in 1810, 18ll."--B., 1816.

"'Ithaca' passed first in 1809."--B., 1816.

"Since seeing the plain of
Troy, my opinions are
somewhat changed as to the
above note. Cell's survey was
hasty and superficial."--B.,
1816.

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Footnote 164: Ý

"Singular enough, and *din*
enough, God knows."

(B., 1816).

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Footnote 165: Ý

"The greater part of this satire
I most sincerely wish had
never been written-not only
on account of the injustice of
much of the critical, and
some of the personal part of
it--but the tone and temper
are such as I cannot approve."

Byron. July 14, 1816. *Diodati*,
Geneva.

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Postscript to the Second Edition

I have been informed, since the present edition went to the press, that my trusty and well-beloved cousins, the Edinburgh Reviewers, are preparing a most vehement critique on my poor, gentle, *unresisting* Muse, whom they have already so be-deviled with their ungodly ribaldry;

"Tantæne animis coelestibus Iræ!"

I suppose I must say of **Jeffrey** as Sir **Andrew Aguecheek** saith,

"an I had known he was so cunning of fence, I had seen him damned ere I had fought him."

What a pity it is that I shall be beyond the Bosphorus before the next number has passed the Tweed! But I yet hope to light my pipe with it in Persia^{[1](#)}.

My Northern friends have accused me, with justice, of personality towards their great literary Anthropophagus, Jeffery; but what else was to be done with him and his dirty pack, who feed by "lying and slandering," and slake their thirst by "evil speaking"? I have adduced facts already well known, and of **Jeffrey's** mind I have stated my free opinion, nor has he thence sustained any injury:--what scavenger was ever soiled by being pelted with mud? It may be said that I quit

England because I have censured there "persons of honour and wit about town;" but I am coming back again, and their vengeance will keep hot till my return. Those who know me can testify that my motives for leaving England are very different from fears, literary or personal: those who do not, may one day be convinced. Since the publication of this thing, my name has not been concealed; I have been mostly in London, ready to answer for my transgressions, and in daily expectation of sundry cartels; but, alas! "the age of chivalry is over," or, in the vulgar tongue, there is no spirit now-a-days.

There is a youth ycleped Hewson Clarke (subaudi *esquire*), a sizer of Emanuel College, and, I believe, a denizen of Berwick-upon-Tweed, whom I have introduced in these pages to much better company than he has been accustomed to meet; he is, notwithstanding, a very sad dog, and for no reason that I can discover, except a personal quarrel with a bear, kept by me at Cambridge to sit for a fellowship, and whom the jealousy of his Trinity contemporaries prevented from success, has been abusing me, and, what is worse, the defenceless innocent above mentioned, in the *Satirist* for one year and some months. I am utterly unconscious of having given him any provocation; indeed, I am guiltless of having heard his name, till coupled with the *Satirist*. He has therefore no reason to complain, and I dare say that, like Sir Fretful Plagiary, he is rather *pleased* than otherwise. I have now mentioned all who have done me the honour to notice me and mine, that is, my bear and my book, except the editor of the *Satirist*, who, it seems, is a gentleman--God wot! I wish he could impart a little of his gentility to his subordinate scribblers. I hear that Mr. **Jerningham**² is about to take up the cudgels for his Mæcenas, Lord Carlisle. I hope not: he was one of the few, who, in the very short intercourse I had with him, treated me with kindness when a boy; and whatever he may say or do, "pour on, I will endure." I have nothing further to add, save a general note of thanksgiving to readers, purchasers, and publishers, and, in the words of *Scott*, I wish

"To all and each a fair good night,
And rosy dreams and slumbers light."

Footnote 1: Ý The article never appeared, and Lord Byron, in the *Hints from Horace*, taunted Jeffrey with a silence which seemed to indicate that the critic was beaten from the field.

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Footnote 2: Ý Edward Jerningham (1727-1812), third son of Sir George Jerningham, Bart., was an indefatigable versifier. Between the publication of his first poem, *The Nunnery*, in 1766, and his last, *The Old Bard's Farewell*, in 1812, he sent to the press no less than thirty separate compositions. As a contributor to the *British Album*, Gifford handled him roughly in the *Baviad* (lines 21, 22); and Mathias, in a note to *Pursuits of Literature*, brackets him with Payne Knight as "ecrivain du commun et poëte vulgaire." He was a dandy with a literary turn, who throughout a long life knew every one who was worth knowing. Some of his letters have recently been published (see *Jerningham Letters*, two vols., 1896).

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[cross-reference: return to Footnote 19 of *Hints from Horace*](#)

Hints from Horace^a

being An Allusion in English Verse to the Epistle "ad Pisones, de Arte Poeticâ," and Intended as a Sequel to *English Bards, And*

Scotch Reviewers.

----"Ergo fungar vice cotis, acutum
Reddere quæ ferrum valet, exsors ipsa secandi."

Hor. *De Arte Poet.*, II. 304 and 305.

"Rhymes are difficult things--they are stubborn things, Sir."

Fielding's *Amelia*, Vol. iii. Book; and Chap. v.

Footnote a: Ý

Hints from Horace (Athens, Capuchin Convent, March 12, 1811);
being an Imitation in English Verse from the Epistle, etc.

[MS. M.]

Hints from Horace: being a Partial Imitation, in English Verse, of
the Epistle *Ad Pisones*, *De Arte Poeticâ*; and intended as a sequel
to *English Bards, and Scotch Reviewers*.

Athens, Franciscan Convent, March 12, 1811.

[*Proof b.*]

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Introduction to *Hints from Horace*

Three MSS. of *Hints from Horace* are extant, two in the possession of Lord Lovelace (MSS. L. a and b), and a third in the possession of Mr. Murray (MS. M.).

Proofs of lines 173-272 and 1-272 (*Proofs a, b*), are among the Egerton MSS. in the British Museum. They were purchased from the Rev. Alexander Dallas, January 12, 1867, and are, doubtless, fragments of the proofs set up in type for Cawthorn in 1811. They are in "book-form," and show that the volume was intended to be uniform with the Fifth Edition of *English Bards, and Scotch Reviewers*, of 1811. The text corresponds closely but not exactly with that adopted by Murray in 1831, and does not embody the variants of the several MSS. It is probable that complete proofs were in Moore's possession at the time when he included the selections from the *Hints* in his *Letters and Journals*, pp. 263-269, and that the text of the entire poem as published in 1831 was derived from this source. Selections, numbering in all 156 lines, had already appeared in *Recollections of the Life of Lord Byron*, by R. C. Dallas, 1824, pp. 104-113. Byron, estimating the merit by the difficulty of the performance, rated the *Hints from Horace* extravagantly high. He only forbore to publish them after the success of *Childe Harold*, because he felt, as he states, that he should be "heaping coals of fire upon his head" if he were in his hour of triumph to put forth a sequel to a lampoon provoked by failure. Nine years afterwards, when he resolved to print the work with some omissions, he gravely maintained that it excelled the productions of his mature genius.

"As far," he said, "as versification goes, it is good; and on looking back at what I wrote about that period, I am astonished to see how little I have trained on. I wrote better then than now; but that comes of my having fallen into the atrocious bad taste of the times"

[September 23, 1820]. The opinion of J. C. Hobhouse that the *Hints* would require "a good deal of slashing" to adapt them to the passing hour, and other considerations, again led Byron to suspend the publication. Authors are frequently bad judges of their own works, but of all the literary hallucinations upon record there are none which exceed the mistaken preferences of Lord Byron. Shortly after the appearance of *The Corsair* he fancied that *English Bards* was still his masterpiece; when all his greatest works had been produced, he contended that his translation from Pulci was his "grand performance,-the best thing he ever did in his life;" and throughout the whole of his literary career he regarded these *Hints from Horace* with a special and unchanging fondness.

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Hints from Horace

Athens: Capuchin Convent, March. 12, 1811^a.

Who would not laugh, if Lawrence¹, hired to grace^b
His costly canvas with each flattered face,
Abused his art, till Nature, with a blush,
Saw cits grow Centaurs underneath his brush?
Or, should some limner join, for show or sale,
A Maid of Honour to a Mermaid's tail^c?
Or low Dubost²--as once the world has seen--
Degrade God's creatures in his graphic spleen?
Not all that forced politeness, which defends
Fools in their faults, could gag his grinning friends.
Believe me, Moschus, like that picture seems^d

The book which, sillier than a sick man's dreams,
 Displays a crowd of figures incomplete,
 Poetic Nightmares, without head or feet.
 Poets and painters, as all artists know³,
May shoot a little with a lengthened bow;
 We claim this mutual mercy for our task,
 And grant in turn the pardon which we ask;
 But make not monsters spring from gentle dams-- 20
 Birds breed not vipers, tigers nurse not lambs.
 A laboured, long Exordium, sometimes tends
 (Like patriot speeches) but to paltry ends^f;
And nonsense in a lofty note goes down,
 As Pertness passes with a legal gown^g:
Thus many a Bard describes in pompous strain^h
The clear brook babbling through the goodly plain:
 The groves of Granta, and her Gothic halls,
 King's Coll-Cam's stream-stained windows, and old walls: 30
Or, in adventurous numbers, neatly aims
 To paint a rainbow, or the river Thames³.
 You sketch a tree, and so perhaps may shine^j--
But daub a shipwreck like an alehouse sign;
 You plan a vase--it dwindles to a *pot*;
 Then glide down Grub-street--fasting and forgot:
 Laughed into Lethe by some quaint Review,
 Whose wit is never troublesome till--true.
 In fine, to whatsoever you aspire,
 Let it at least be simple and entire. 40
 The greater portion of the rhyming tribe^k
 (Give ear, my friend, for thou hast been a scribe)
 Are led astray by some peculiar lure^m.
I labour to be brief--become obscure;
 One falls while following Elegance too fast;
 Another soars, inflated with Bombast;
 Too low a third crawls on, afraid to fly,
 He spins his subject to Satiety;
Absurdly varying, he at last engraves

Fish in the woods, and boars beneath the wavesⁿ! 50
 Unless your care's exact, your judgment nice,
 The flight from Folly leads but into Vice;
 None are complete, all wanting in some part,
Like certain tailors, limited in art.
 For galligaskins Slowshears is your man^o
 But coats must claim another artisan⁴.
Now this to me, I own, seems much the same
 As Vulcan's feet to bear Apollo's frame;
 Or, with a fair complexion, to expose 60
 Black eyes, black ringlets, but--a bottle nose!
 Dear Authors! suit your topics to your strength,
 And ponder well your subject, and its length;
 Nor lift your load, before you're quite aware
 What weight your shoulders will, or will not, bear.
 But lucid Order, and Wit's siren voice^p,
Await the Poet, skilful in his choice;
 With native Eloquence he soars along,
 Grace in his thoughts, and Music in his song.
 Let Judgment teach him wisely to combine 70
 With future parts the now omitted line:
 This shall the Author choose, or that reject,
 Precise in style, and cautious to select;
 Nor slight applause will candid pens afford
 To him who furnishes a wanting word^q.
Then fear not, if 'tis needful, to produce
 Some term unknown, or obsolete in use,
 (As Pitt has furnished us a word or two⁵,
Which Lexicographers declined to do;)

So you indeed, with care,--(but be content 80
 To take this license rarely)--may invent.
 New words find credit in these latter days,
 If neatly grafted on a Gallic phrase^r;
What Chaucer, Spenser did, we scarce refuse
 To Dryden's or to Pope's maturer Muse.
 If you can add a little, say why not,

As well as William Pitt, and Walter Scott?
 Since they, by force of rhyme and force of lungs^s,
Enriched our Island's ill-united tongues;
 'Tis then--and shall be--lawful to present 90
 Reform in writing, as in Parliament.
 As forests shed their foliage by degrees,
 So fade expressions which in season please;
 And we and ours, alas! are due to Fate,
 And works and words but dwindle to a date.
 Though as a Monarch nods, and Commerce calls^t,
Impetuous rivers stagnate in canals;
 Though swamps subdued, and marshes drained, sustain^u
The heavy ploughshare and the yellow grain, 100
 And rising ports along the busy shore
 Protect the vessel from old Ocean's roar,
 All, all, must perish; but, surviving last,
The love of Letters half preserves the past.
 True, some decay, yet not a few revive;^{6 v}
Though those shall sink, which now appear to thrive,
 As Custom arbitrates, whose shifting sway^w
Our life and language must alike obey.
 The immortal wars which Gods and Angels wage,
 Are they not shown in Milton's sacred page? 110
His strain will teach what numbers best belong
 To themes celestial told in Epic song^x.
 The slow, sad stanza will correctly paint
 The Lover's anguish, or the Friend's complaint.
 But which deserves the Laurel--Rhyme or Blank^y?
Which holds on Helicon the higher rank?
 Let squabbling critics by themselves dispute
 This point, as puzzling as a Chancery suit.
 Satiric rhyme first sprang from selfish spleen.
 You doubt--see Dryden, Pope, St. Patrick's Dean⁷. 120
Blank verse is now, with one consent, allied
 To Tragedy, and rarely quits her side.
 Though mad Almanzor⁸ rhymed in Dryden's days,

No sing-song Hero rants in modern plays;
 Whilst modest Comedy her verse foregoes
 For jest and *pun*⁹ in very middling prose.
Not that our Bens or Beaumonts show the worse,
 Or lose one point, because they wrote in verse.
 But so Thalia pleases to appear^z,
Poor Virgin! damned some twenty times a year! 130
 Whate'er the scene, let this advice have weight:--
 Adapt your language to your Hero's state.
 At times Melpomene forgets to groan,
 And brisk Thalia takes a serious tone;
 Nor unregarded will the act pass by
 Where angry Townly¹⁰ "lifts his voice on high."
Again, our Shakespeare limits verse to Kings,
When common prose will serve for common things;
And lively Hal resigns heroic ire^A,--
 To "hollaing Hotspur"¹¹ and his sceptred sire^B. 140
 'Tis not enough, ye Bards, with all your art,
 To polish poems; they must touch the heart:
 Where'er the scene be laid, whate'er the song,
 Still let it bear the hearer's soul along;
 Command your audience or to smile or weep,
 Whiche'er may please you--anything but sleep.
 The Poet claims our tears; but, by his leave,
 Before I shed them, let me see *him* grieve.
 If banished Romeo feigned nor sigh nor tear,
 Lulled by his languor, I could sleep or sneer^C. 150
Sad words, no doubt, become a serious face,
 And men look angry in the proper place.
 At double meanings folks seem wondrous sly,
 And Sentiment prescribes a pensive eye;
 For Nature formed at first the inward man,
 And actors copy Nature--when they can.
 She bids the beating heart with rapture bound,
 Raised to the Stars, or levelled with the ground;
 And for Expression's aid, 'tis said, or sung^D, 160

She gave our mind's interpreter--the tongue,
 Who, worn with use, of late would fain dispense
 (At least in theatres) with common sense;
 O'erwhelm with sound the Boxes, Gallery, Pit,
 And raise a laugh with anything--but Wit.
 To skilful writers it will much import,
 Whence spring their scenes, from common life or Court;
Whether they seek applause by smile or tear,
 To draw a Lying Valet,¹² or a Lear,¹³
A sage, or rakish youngster wild from school, 170
 A wandering Peregrine, or plain John Bull;
 All persons please when Nature's voice prevails,
 Scottish or Irish, born in Wilts or Wales.
 Or follow common fame, or forge a plot;^E
Who cares if mimic heroes lived or not!
 One precept serves to regulate the scene:
 Make it appear as if it *might* have *been*.
 If some Drawcansir¹⁴ you aspire to draw,
Present him raving, and above all law: 180
 If female furies in your scheme are planned,
 Macbeth's fierce dame is ready to your hand;
 For tears and treachery, for good and evil,
 Constance, King Richard, Hamlet, and the Devil!
 But if a new design you dare essay,
 And freely wander from the beaten way,
 True to your characters, till all be past,
 Preserve consistency from first to last.
 Tis hard¹⁵ to venture where our betters fail, [xxx]
Or lend fresh interest to a twice-told tale; 190
 And yet, perchance, 'tis wiser to prefer
 A hackneyed plot, than choose a new, and err;
 Yet copy not too closely, but record,
 More justly, thought for thought than word for word;
 Nor trace your Prototype through narrow ways,
 But only follow where he merits praise.
 For you, young Bard! whom luckless fate may lead¹⁶

To tremble on the nod of all who read,
 Ere your first score of cantos Time unrolls,F
Beware--for God's sake, don't begin like Bowles! 200
 "Awake a louder and a loftier strain,"17--
And pray, what follows from his boiling brain?--
 He sinks to Southey's level in a trice,
 Whose Epic Mountains never fail in mice!
 Not so of yore awoke your mighty Sire
 The tempered warblings of his master-lyre;
 Soft as the gentler breathing of the lute,
 "Of Man's first disobedience and the fruit"
 He speaks, but, as his subject swells along, 210
 Earth, Heaven, and Hades echo with the song."G
Still to the "midst of things" he hastens on,
 As if we witnessed all already done;H
Leaves on his path whatever seems too mean
 To raise the subject, or adorn the scene;
 Gives, as each page improves upon the sight,
 Not smoke from brightness, but from darkness--light;
 And truth and fiction with such art compounds,
 We know not where to fix their several bounds.
 If you would please the Public, deign to hear 220
 What soothes the many-headed monster's ear:J
If your heart triumph when the hands of all
 Applaud in thunder at the curtain's fall,
 Deserve those plaudits--study Nature's page,
 And sketch the striking traits of every age;
 While varying Man and varying years unfold
 Life's little tale, so oft, so vainly told;
 Observe his simple childhood's dawning days,
 His pranks, his prate, his playmates, and his plays:
Till time at length the mannish tyro weans, 230
 And prurient vice outstrips his tardy teens!K
 Behold him Freshman! forced no more to groanM
O'er Virgil's¹⁸ devilish verses and his own;
Prayers are too tedious, Lectures too abstruse,

He flies from Tavell's frown to "Fordham's Mews;"
 (Unlucky Tavell!¹⁹ doomed to daily cares^N
By pugilistic pupils, and by bears,)

Fines, Tutors, tasks, Conventions threat in vain,
 Before hounds, hunters, and Newmarket Plain.

Rough with his elders, with his equals rash, 240
 Civil to sharpeners, prodigal of cash;
 Constant to nought--save hazard and a whore,^P
Yet cursing both--for both have made him sore:
 Unread (unless since books beguile disease,
The P----x becomes his passage to Degrees);
 Fooled, pillaged, dunned, he wastes his terms away,^Q
And unexpelled, perhaps, retires M.A.;

Master of Arts! as *hells* and *clubs*²⁰ proclaim,^R
Where scarce a blackleg bears a brighter name! 250
 Launched into life, extinct his early fire,
 He apes the selfish prudence of his Sire;
 Marries for money, chooses friends for rank,
 Buys land, and shrewdly trusts not to the Bank;
 Sits in the Senate; gets a son and heir;
 Sends him to Harrow--for himself was there.
 Mute, though he votes, unless when called to cheer,
 His son's so sharp--he'll see the dog a Peer!
 Manhood declines--Age palsies every limb;
 He quits the scene--or else the scene quits him;

Scrapes wealth, o'er each departing penny grieves,^S 260
And Avarice seizes all Ambition leaves;
 Counts cent per cent, and smiles, or vainly frets,
 O'er hoards diminished by young Hopeful's debts;
 Weighs well and wisely what to sell or buy,
 Complete in all life's lessons--but to die;
 Peevish and spiteful, doting, hard to please,
 Commending every time, save times like these;
 Crazed, querulous, forsaken, half forgot,
 Expires unwept--is buried--Let him rot!

But from the Drama let me not digress, 270

Nor spare my precepts, though they please you less.^T
 Though Woman weep, and hardest hearts are stirred,^U
When what is done is rather seen than heard,
 Yet many deeds preserved in History's page
 Are better told than acted on the stage;
 The ear sustains what shocks the timid eye,
 And Horror thus subsides to Sympathy,
 True Briton all beside, I here am French--
 Bloodshed 'tis surely better to retrench: 280
 The gladiatorial gore we teach to flow
 In tragic scenes disgusts though but in show;
 We hate the carnage while we see the trick,
 And find small sympathy in being sick.
 Not on the stage the regicide Macbeth
 Appals an audience with a Monarch's death;^V
To gaze when sable Hubert threatens to sear
 Young Arthur's eyes, can *ours* or *Nature* bear?
 A haltered heroine²¹ Johnson sought to slay-- 290
We saved Irene, but half damned the play,
 And (Heaven be praised!) our tolerating times
 Stint Metamorphoses to Pantomimes;
 And Lewis'²² self, with all his sprites, would quake
To change Earl Osmond's negro to a snake!
 Because, in scenes exciting joy or grief,
 We loathe the action which exceeds belief:
And yet, God knows! what may not authors do,
 Whose Postscripts prate of dyeing "heroines blue"?²³
 Above all things, *Dan* Poet, if you can, 300
 Eke out your acts, I pray, with mortal man,
 Nor call a ghost, unless some cursed scrape^W
Must open ten trap-doors for your escape.
 Of all the monstrous things I'd fain forbid,
 I loathe an Opera worse than Dennis did;²⁴
Where good and evil persons, right or wrong,
 Rage, love, and aught but moralise--in song.
 Hail, last memorial of our foreign friends,^X

Which Gaul allows, and still Hesperia lends! 310
 Napoleon's edicts no embargo lay
 On whores--spies--singers--wisely shipped away.
 Our giant Capital, whose squares are spread^Y
Where rustics earned, and now may beg, their bread,
 In all iniquity is grown so nice,
 It scorns amusements which are not of price.
Hence the pert shopkeeper, whose throbbing ear
 Aches with orchestras which he pays to hear,^Z
Whom shame, not sympathy, forbids to snore,
 His anguish doubling by his own "encore;"^{Aa} 320
 Squeezed in "Fop's Alley,"²⁵ jostled by the beaux,
Teased with his hat, and trembling for his toes;
 Scarce wrestles through the night, nor tastes of ease,
 Till the dropped curtain gives a glad release:
Why this, and more, he suffers--can ye guess?--
 Because it costs him dear, and makes him dress!²⁶
 So prosper eunuchs from Etruscan schools;
Give us but fiddlers, and they're sure of fools!
 Ere scenes were played by many a reverend clerk,^{27 Bb}
 (What harm, if David danced before the ark?)^{Cc} 330
In Christmas revels, simple country folks
 Were pleased with morrice-mumm'ry and coarse jokes.
 Improving years, with things no longer known,
Produced blithe Punch and merry Madame Joan,
 Who still frisk on with feats so lewdly low,^{Dd}
 'Tis strange Benvolio²⁸ suffers such a show;
Suppressing peer! to whom each vice gives place,^{Ee}
Oaths, boxing, begging--all, save rout and race.
 Farce followed Comedy, and reached her prime,
 In ever-laughing Foote's fantastic time:²⁹ 340
Mad wag! who pardoned none, nor spared the best,
 And turned some very serious things to jest.
 Nor Church nor State escaped his public sneers,
 Arms nor the Gown--Priests--Lawyers--Volunteers:
 "Alas, poor Yorick!" now for ever mute!

Whoever loves a laugh must sigh for Foote.
 We smile, perforce, when histrionic scenes
 Ape the swoln dialogue of Kings and Queens,
 When "Crononhotonthologos must die,"³⁰
And Arthur struts in mimic majesty. 350
 Moschus! with whom once more I hope to sit,^{Ff}
And smile at folly, if we can't at wit;
 Yes, Friend! for thee I'll quit my cynic cell,
 And bear Swift's motto, "Vive la bagatelle!"
 Which charmed our days in each Ægean clime,
 As oft at home, with revelry and rhyme.
 Then may Euphrosyne, who sped the past,
Soothe thy Life's scenes, nor leave thee in the last;
 But find in thine--like pagan Plato's bed,^{31 Gg}
Some merry Manuscript of Mimes, when dead. 360
 Now to the Drama let us bend our eyes,
 Where fettered by whig Walpole low she lies;³²
Corruption foiled her, for she feared her glance;
 Decorum left her for an Opera dance!
 Yet Chesterfield,³³ whose polished pen inveighs
'Gainst laughter, fought for freedom to our Plays;
 Unchecked by Megrimms of patrician brains,
 And damning Dulness of Lord Chamberlains.
 Repeal that act! again let Humour roam 370
Wild o'er the stage--we've time for tears at home;
 Let Archer³⁴ plant the horns on Sullen's brows,
 And Estifania gull her "Copper"³⁵ spouse;
The moral's scant--but that may be excused,
 Men go not to be lectured, but amused.
He whom our plays dispose to Good or Ill
 Must wear a head in want of Willis' skill;³⁶
Aye, but Macheath's example--psa!--no more!
 It formed no thieves--the thief was formed before;³⁷
 And spite of puritans and Collier's curse,^{Hh} 380
Plays make mankind no better, and no worse.³⁸
Then spare our stage, ye methodistic men!

Nor burn damned Drury if it rise again.^{[39](#)}
But why to brain-scorched bigots thus appeal?
 Can heavenly Mercy dwell with earthly Zeal?
 For times of fire and faggot let them hope!
 Times dear alike to puritan or Pope.
 As pious Calvin saw Servetus blaze,
 So would new sects on newer victims gaze. 390
 E'en now the songs of Solyma begin;
 Faith cants, perplexed apologist of Sin!
While the Lord's servant chastens whom he loves,
And Simeon kicks,^{[40](#)} where Baxter only "shoves."^{[41](#)}
 Whom Nature guides, so writes, that every dunce,^{[Jj](#)}
Enraptured, thinks to do the same at once;
 But after inky thumbs and bitten nails,^{[Kk](#)}
And twenty scattered quires, the coxcomb fails.
 Let Pastoral be dumb; for who can hope
To match the youthful eclogues of our Pope? 400
 Yet his and Philips^{[42](#)} faults, of different kind,
 For Art too rude, for Nature too refined,^{[Mm](#)}
Instruct how hard the medium 'tis to hit
 'Twixt too much polish and too coarse a wit.
 A vulgar scribbler, certes, stands disgraced
 In this nice age, when all aspire to taste;
 The dirty language, and the noisome jest,
 Which pleased in Swift of yore, we now detest;
 Proscribed not only in the world polite,^{[Nn](#)}
But even too nasty for a City Knight! 410
 Peace to Swift's faults! his wit hath made them pass,
 Unmatched by all, save matchless Hudibras!
 Whose author is perhaps the first we meet,
 Who from our couplet lopped two final feet;
 Nor less in merit than the longer line,
 This measure moves a favourite of the Nine.
Though at first view eight feet may seem in vain
 Formed, save in Ode, to bear a serious strain,^{[Pp](#)}
 Yet Scott has shown our wondering isle of late

This measure shrinks not from a theme of weight, 420
 And, varied skilfully, surpasses far
 Heroic rhyme, but most in Love and War,
 Whose fluctuations, tender or sublime,
 Are curbed too much by long-recurring rhyme.
 But many a skilful judge abhors to see,
 What few admire--irregularity.
 This some vouchsafe to pardon; but 'tis hard
 When such a word contents a British Bard.
 And must the Bard his glowing thoughts confine, ^{Qq}
Lest Censure hover o'er some faulty line? 430
 Remove whate'er a critic may suspect,
 To gain the paltry suffrage of "Correct"?
 Or prune the spirit of each daring phrase,
 To fly from Error, not to merit Praise?
 Ye, who seek finished models, never cease, ^{Rr}
By day and night, to read the works of Greece.
 But our good Fathers never bent their brains
 To heathen Greek, content with native strains.
 The few who read a page, or used a pen,
 Were satisfied with Chaucer and old Ben; 440
 The jokes and numbers suited to their taste
 Were quaint and careless, anything but chaste;
 Yet, whether right or wrong the ancient rules,
 It will not do to call our Fathers fools!
 Though you and I, who eruditely know
 To separate the elegant and low,
 Can also, when a hobbling line appears,
 Detect with fingers--in default of ears.
 In sooth I do not know, or greatly care
 To learn, who our first English strollers were; 450
 Or if, till roofs received the vagrant art,
 Our Muse, like that of Thespis, kept a cart;
 But this is certain, since our Shakespeare's days,
 There's pomp enough--if little else--in plays;
 Nor will Melpomene ascend her Throne ^{Ss}
Without high heels, white plume, and Bristol stone.

Old Comedies still meet with much applause,
Though too licentious for dramatic laws;
At least, we moderns, wisely, 'tis confest,
Curtail, or silence, the lascivious jest.^{Tt} 460
Whate'er their follies, and their faults beside,
Our enterprising Bards pass nought untried;
Nor do they merit slight applause who choose
An English subject for an English Muse,
And leave to minds which never dare invent
French flippancy and German sentiment.
Where is that living language which could claim
Poetic more, as philosophic, fame,
If all our Bards, more patient of delay,
Would stop, like Pope, to polish by the way?⁴³ 470
Lords of the quill, whose critical assaults
O'erthrow whole quartos with their quires of faults,^{Uu}
Who soon detect, and mark where'er we fail,
And prove our marble with too nice a nail!
Democritus himself was not so bad;
He only *thought*--but *you* would make us--mad!
But truth to say, most rhymers rarely guard
Against that ridicule they deem so hard;
In person negligent, they wear, from sloth,
Beards of a week, and nails of annual growth; 480
Reside in garrets, fly from those they meet,
And walk in alleys rather than the street.

With little rhyme, less reason, if you please,
The name of Poet may be got with ease,
So that not tuns of helleboric juice^{Vv}
Shall ever turn your head to any use;
Write but like Wordsworth--live beside a lake,
And keep your bushy locks a year from Blake;⁴⁴
Then print your book, once more return to town, 490
And boys shall hunt your Bardship up and down.⁴⁵
Am I not wise, if such some poets' plight,

To purge in spring--like Bayes⁴⁶--before I write?
If this precaution softened not my bile,
 I know no scribbler with a madder style;
 But since (perhaps my feelings are too nice)
 I cannot purchase Fame at such a price,
 I'll labour gratis as a grinders' wheel,^{Ww}
And, blunt myself, give edge to other's steel, 500
 Nor write at all, unless to teach the art
 To those rehearsing for the Poet's part;
 From Horace show the pleasing paths of song,^{Xx}
And from my own example--what is wrong.
 Though modern practice sometimes differs quite,
 'Tis just as well to think before you write;
 Let every book that suits your theme be read,
 So shall you trace it to the fountain-head.
 He who has learned the duty which he owes 510
 To friends and country, and to pardon foes;
 Who models his deportment as may best
 Accord with Brother, Sire, or Stranger-guest;
 Who takes our Laws and Worship as they are,
 Nor roars reform for Senate, Church, and Bar;
 In practice, rather than loud precept, wise,
 Bids not his tongue, but heart, philosophize:
 Such is the man the Poet should rehearse,
 As joint exemplar of his life and verse.
 Sometimes a sprightly wit, and tale well told, 520
 Without much grace, or weight, or art, will hold
 A longer empire o'er the public mind
 Than sounding trifles, empty, though refined.
 Unhappy Greece! thy sons of ancient days
 The Muse may celebrate with perfect praise,
 Whose generous children narrowed not their hearts
 With Commerce, given alone to Arms and Arts.^{Yy}
Our boys (save those whom public schools compel
 To "Long and Short" before they're taught to spell)
 From frugal fathers soon imbibe by rote, 530
 "A penny saved, my lad, 's a penny got."

Babe of a city birth! from sixpence take^{Zz}
The third, how much will the remainder make?--
 "A groat."--"Ah, bravo! Dick hath done the sum!"^{aA}
He'll swell my fifty thousand to a Plum."⁴⁷
 They whose young souls receive this rust betimes,
 'Tis clear, are fit for anything but rhymes;
 And Locke will tell you, that the father's right
Who hides all verses from his children's sight;
 For Poets (says this Sage⁴⁸, and many more,) 540
 Make sad mechanics with their lyric lore:^{bB}
And Delphi now, however rich of old,
Discovers little silver, and less gold,
Because Parnassus, though a Mount divine,
Is poor as Irus,⁴⁹ or an Irish mine.^{50 cC}
 Two objects always should the Poet move,
 Or one or both,--to please or to improve.
 Whate'er you teach, be brief, if you design
 For our remembrance your didactic line;
Redundance places Memory on the rack, 550
 For brains may be o'erloaded, like the back.^{dD}
 Fiction does best when taught to look like Truth,
 And fairy fables bubble none but youth:
 Expect no credit for too wondrous tales,
 Since Jonas only springs alive from Whales!
 Young men with aught but Elegance dispense;
 Maturer years require a little Sense.
 To end at once:--that Bard for all is fit^{eE}
Who mingles well instruction with his wit;
 For him Reviews shall smile; for him o'erflow 560
 The patronage of Paternoster-row;
 His book, with Longman's liberal aid, shall pass
 (Who ne'er despises books that bring him brass);
 Through three long weeks the taste of London lead,
 And cross St. George's Channel and the Tweed.
 But every thing has faults, nor is't unknown
 That harps and fiddles often lose their tone,

And wayward voices, at their owner's call,
 With all his best endeavours, only squall;
Dogs blink their covey, flints withhold the spark, 570
And double-barrels (damn them!) miss their mark.^{51 ff}
 Where frequent beauties strike the reader's view,
 We must not quarrel for a blot or two;
 But pardon equally to books or men,
 The slips of Human Nature, and the Pen.
 Yet if an author, spite of foe or friend,
 Despises all advice too much to mend,
 But ever twangs the same discordant string,
Give him no quarter, howsoe'er he sing.
 Let Havard's⁵² fate o'ertake him, who, for once, 580
 Produced a play too dashing for a dunce:
 At first none deemed it his; but when his name
 Announced the fact--what then?--it lost its fame.
 Though all deplore when Milton deigns to doze,^{gG}
In a long work 'tis fair to steal repose.
 As Pictures, so shall Poems be; some stand
 The critic eye, and please when near at hand;^{hH}
But others at a distance strike the sight;
 This seeks the shade, but that demands the light, 590
 Nor dreads the connoisseur's fastidious view,
 But, ten times scrutinised, is ten times new.
 Parnassian pilgrims! ye whom chance, or choice,^{jJ}
Hath led to listen to the Muse's voice,
 Receive this counsel, and be timely wise;
 Few reach the Summit which before you lies.
 Our Church and State, our Courts and Camps, concede
 Reward to very moderate heads indeed!
In these plain common sense will travel far;
 All are not Erskines who mislead the Bar:^{53 kK} 600
But Poesy between the best and worst
 No medium knows; you must be last or first;
For middling Poets' miserable volumes
 Are damned alike by Gods, and Men, and Columns.^{mM}

Again, my Jeffrey--as that sound inspires,⁵⁴
How wakes my bosom to its wonted fires!
 Fires, such as gentle Caledonians feel
 When Southrons writhe upon their critic wheel,
 Or mild Eclectics,⁵⁵ when some, worse than Turks,
Would rob poor Faith to decorate "Good Works." 610
 Such are the genial feelings them canst claim--
 My Falcon flies not at ignoble game.
 Mightiest of all Dunedin's beasts of chase!
 For thee my Pegasus would mend his pace.
 Arise, my Jeffrey! or my inkless pen
 Shall never blunt its edge on meaner men;
 Till thee or thine mine evil eye discerns,
 "Alas! I cannot strike at wretched kernes."⁵⁶
Inhuman Saxon! wilt thou then resign 620
 A Muse and heart by choice so wholly thine?
 Dear d--d contemner of my schoolboy songs,
 Hast thou no vengeance for my Manhood's wrongs?
 If unprovoked thou once could bid me bleed,
 Hast thou no weapon for my daring deed?
 What! not a word!--and am I then so low?
 Wilt thou forbear, who never spared a foe?
 Hast thou no wrath, or wish to give it vent?
 No wit for Nobles, Dunces by descent?
 No jest on "minors," quibbles on a name,⁵⁷ 630
Nor one facetious paragraph of blame?
 Is it for this on Ilion I have stood,
 And thought of Homer less than Holyrood?
 On shore of Euxine or Ægean sea,
 My hate, untravelled, fondly turned to thee.
 Ah! let me cease! in vain my bosom burns,
 From Corydon unkind Alexis turns:⁵⁸
Thy rhymes are vain; thy Jeffrey then forego,
 Nor woo that anger which he will not show.
 What then?--Edina starves some lanker son, 640
 To write an article thou canst not shun;

Some less fastidious Scotchman shall be found,
 As bold in Billingsgate, though less renowned.
 As if at table some discordant dish,⁵⁹
Should shock our optics, such as frogs for fish;
 As oil in lieu of butter men decry,
 And poppies please not in a modern pie^{nN}
If all such mixtures then be half a crime,
 We must have Excellence to relish rhyme.
 Mere roast and boiled no Epicure invites; 650
 Thus Poetry disgusts, or else delights.
 Who shoot not flying rarely touch a gun:
 Will he who swims not to the river run?
 And men unpractised in exchanging knocks
 Must go to Jackson⁶⁰ ere they dare to box.
Whate'er the weapon, cudgel, fist, or foil,
 None reach expertness without years of toil;
 But fifty dunces can, with perfect ease,
 Tag twenty thousand couplets, when they please. 660
 Why not?--shall I, thus qualified to sit
For rotten boroughs, never show my wit?
 Shall I, whose fathers with the "Quorum" sate,^{pP}
 And lived in freedom on a fair estate;
 Who left me heir, with stables, kennels, packs,^{qQ}
To *all* their income, and to--*twice* its tax;
 Whose form and pedigree have scarce a fault,
 Shall I, I say, suppress my Attic Salt?
 Thus think "the Mob of Gentlemen;" but you,
 Besides all this, must have some Genius too. 670
 Be this your sober judgment, and a rule,
 And print not piping hot from Southey's school,
 Who (ere another Thalaba appears),
 I trust, will spare us for at least nine years.
 And hark'ye, Southey!⁶¹ pray--but don't be vexed--
Burn all your last three works--and half the next.
But why this vain advice? once published, books
 Can never be recalled--from pastry-cooks!^{rR}

Though "Madoc," with "Pucelle,"⁶² instead of Punk,
May travel back to Quito--on a trunk!⁶³ 680
 Orpheus, we learn from Ovid and Lempriere,
 Led all wild beasts but Women by the ear;
 And had he fiddled at the present hour,
 We'd seen the Lions waltzing in the Tower;⁶⁴
And old Amphion, such were minstrels then,
 Had built St. Paul's without the aid of Wren.
 Verse too was Justice, and the Bards of Greece
 Did more than constables to keep the peace;
 Abolished cuckoldom with much applause, 690
 Called county meetings, and enforced the laws,
 Cut down crown influence with reforming scythes,
 And served the Church--without demanding tithes;
 And hence, throughout all Hellas and the East,
 Each Poet was a Prophet and a Priest,
 Whose old-established Board of Joint Controls⁶⁵
Included kingdoms in the cure of souls.
 Next rose the martial Homer, Epic's prince,
 And Fighting's been in fashion ever since;
 And old Tyrtæus, when the Spartans warred, 700
 (A limping leader, but a lofty bard)^{ss}
Though walled Ithome had resisted long,
 Reduced the fortress by the force of song.
 When Oracles prevailed, in times of old,
 In song alone Apollo's will was told.^{rt}
Then if your verse is what all verse should be,
 And Gods were not ashamed on't, why should we?
 The Muse, like mortal females, may be wooed;⁶⁶
In turns she'll seem a Paphian, or a prude;
 Fierce as a bride when first she feels affright, 710
 Mild as the same upon the second night;
 Wild as the wife of Alderman or Peer,
 Now for His Grace, and now a grenadier!
 Her eyes beseem, her heart belies, her zone--
 Ice in a crowd--and Lava when alone.

If Verse be studied with some show of Art.
 Kind Nature always will perform her part;
 Though without Genius, and a native vein
 Of wit, we loathe an artificial strain,
 Yet Art and Nature joined will win the prize, 720
 Unless they act like us and our allies.
 The youth who trains to ride, or run a race,
 Must bear privations with unruffled face,
 Be called to labour when he thinks to dine,
 And, harder still, leave wenching and his wine.
 Ladies who sing, at least who sing at sight,
 Have followed Music through her farthest flight;^{uU}
But rhymers tell you neither more nor less,
 "I've got a pretty poem for the Press;"
 And that's enough; then write and print so fast;-- 730
If Satan take the hindmost, who'd be last?
 They storm the Types, they publish, one and all,^{67 vV}
They leap the counter, and they leave the stall.
 Provincial Maidens, men of high command, ^{c8 Ýc9}
 Yea! Baronets have inked the bloody hand!
 Cash cannot quell them; Pollio played this prank,^{wW}
 (Then Phoebus first found credit in a Bank!)
 Not all the living only, but the dead,
 Fool on, as fluent as an Orpheus' Head;⁶⁸
Damned all their days, they posthumously thrive, 740
 Dug up from dust, though buried when alive!
 Reviews record this epidemic crime,
 Those Books of Martyrs to the rage for rhyme.
 Alas! woe worth the scribbler! often seen
 In Morning Post, or Monthly Magazine.
 There lurk his earlier lays; but soon, hot pressed,^{xX}
Behold a Quarto!--Tarts must tell the rest.
 Then leave, ye wise, the Lyre's precarious chords
 To muse-mad baronets, or madder lords,^{yY}
Or country Crispins, now grown somewhat stale, 750
 Twin Doric minstrels, drunk with Doric ale!

Hark to those notes, narcotically soft!
The Cobbler-Laureats⁶⁹ sing to Capel Lofft!⁷⁰
Till, lo! that modern Midas, as he hears,^{zZ}
Adds an ell growth to his egregious ears!^{AA}
 There lives one Druid, who prepares in time⁷¹
 'Gainst future feuds his poor revenge of rhyme;
 Racks his dull Memory, and his duller Muse, 760
 To publish faults which Friendship should excuse.
 If Friendship's nothing, Self-regard might teach
 More polished usage of his parts of speech.
 But what is shame, or what is aught to him?^{BB}
He vents his spleen, or gratifies his whim.
 Some fancied slight has roused his lurking hate,
 Some folly crossed, some jest, or some debate;
 Up to his den Sir Scribbler hies, and soon
 The gathered gall is voided in Lampoon.
 Perhaps at some pert speech you've dared to frown, 770
 Perhaps your Poem may have pleased the Town:
 If so, alas! 'tis nature in the man--
 May Heaven forgive you, for he never can!
 Then be it so; and may his withering Bays
 Bloom fresh in satire, though they fade in praise
 While his lost songs no more shall steep and stink
 The dullest, fattest weeds on Lethe's brink,
 But springing upwards from the sluggish mould,
Be (what they never were before) be--sold!
 Should some rich Bard (but such a monster now,⁷² 780
 In modern Physics, we can scarce allow),^{CC}
Should some pretending scribbler of the Court,
Some rhyming Peer--there's plenty of the sort--^{73 DD}
All but one poor dependent priest withdrawn,
 (Ah! too regardless of his Chaplain's yawn!)
 Condemn the unlucky Curate to recite
 Their last dramatic work by candle-light,
 How would the preacher turn each rueful leaf,
 Dull as his sermons, but not half so brief!

Yet, since 'tis promised at the Rector's death, 790
 He'll risk no living for a little breath.
 Then spouts and foams, and cries at every line,
 (The Lord forgive him!) "Bravo! Grand! Divine!"
 Hoarse with those praises (which, by Flatt'ry fed, [EE](#)
Dependence barter for her bitter bread),
 He strides and stamps along with creaking boot;
 Till the floor echoes his emphatic foot,
 Then sits again, then rolls his pious eye, [FF](#)
As when the dying vicar will not die!
 Nor feels, forsooth, emotion at his heart;-- 800
 But all Dissemblers overact their part.
 Ye, who aspire to "build the lofty rhyme," [74](#)
Believe not all who laud your false "sublime;"
 But if some friend shall hear your work, and say,
 "Expunge that stanza, lop that line away,"
 And, after fruitless efforts, you return
 Without amendment, and he answers, "Burn!"
 That instant throw your paper in the fire, [c12](#)
Ask not his thoughts, or follow his desire;
 But (if true Bard!) you scorn to condescend, [GG](#) 810
 And will not alter what you can't defend,
 If you will breed this Bastard of your Brains, [75](#)
We'll have no words--I've only lost my pains.
 Yet, if you only prize your favourite thought,
 As critics kindly do, and authors ought;
 If your cool friend annoy you now and then,
 And cross whole pages with his plaguy pen;
 No matter, throw your ornaments aside,--
 Better let him than all the world deride. 820
 Give light to passages too much in shade,
 Nor let a doubt obscure one verse you've made;
 Your friend's a "Johnson," not to leave one word,
 However trifling, which may seem absurd;
Such erring trifles lead to serious ills,
 And furnish food for critics, or their quills. [76](#)

As the Scotch fiddle, with its touching tune,
 Or the sad influence of the angry Moon,
All men avoid bad writers' ready tongues,
As yawning waiters fly⁷⁷ Fitzscribble's lungs;^{HH} 830
Yet on he mouths--ten minutes--tedious each^{78 JJ}
As Prelate's homily, or placeman's speech;
 Long as the last years of a lingering lease,
 When Riot pauses until Rents increase.
 While such a minstrel, muttering fustian, strays
 O'er hedge and ditch, through unfrequented ways,
 If by some chance he walks into a well,
 And shouts for succour with stentorian yell,
 "A rope! help, Christians, as ye hope for grace!"
 Nor woman, man, nor child will stir a pace; 840
 For there his carcass he might freely fling,^{KK}
From frenzy, or the humour of the thing.
 Though this has happened to more Bards than one;
 I'll tell you Budgell's story,--and have done.
 Budgell, a rogue and rhymester, for no good,
 (Unless his case be much misunderstood)
 When teased with creditors' continual claims,
 "To die like Cato,"⁷⁹ leapt into the Thames!
And therefore be it lawful through the town
 For any Bard to poison, hang, or drown.
 Who saves the intended Suicide receives
 Small thanks from him who loathes the life he leaves;^{MM}
And, sooth to say, mad poets must not lose
 The Glory of that death they freely choose.
 Nor is it certain that some sorts of verse^{NN}
Prick not the Poet's conscience as a curse;
 Dosed⁸⁰ with vile drams on Sunday he was found,
Or got a child on consecrated ground!
 And hence is haunted with a rhyming rage--
 Feared like a bear just bursting from his cage.
 If free, all fly his versifying fit,
 Fatal at once to Simpleton or Wit:

But *him*, unhappy! whom he seizes,--*him*
He flays with Recitation limb by limb;
Probes to the quick where'er he makes his breach,
And gorges like a Lawyer--or a Leech.

The last page of *MS. M.* is dated--

Byron,

Capuchin Convent,

Athens. *March 14th, 1811.*

The following memorandum, in Byron's handwriting, is also inscribed on the last page:

"722 lines, and 4 inserted after and now counted, in all 726.--B.
Since this several lines are added.--B. June 14th, 1811.

Copied fair at Malta, May 3rd, 1811.--B."

Byron

March 11th and 12th,
Athens. 1811.,

[*MS. L. (a).*]

Byron,

March 14th, 1811.
Athens, Capuchin Convent.

. [*MS. L. (b).*]

Footnote 1: Ý Sir Thomas Lawrence (1769-1830) succeeded West as P.R.A. in 1820. Benjamin West (1738-1820) had been elected P.R.A. in 1792, on the death of Sir Joshua Reynolds.
[return to footnote mark](#)

Footnote 2: Ý In an English newspaper, which finds its way abroad wherever there are Englishmen, I read an account of this dirty dauber's caricature of Mr. H--- as a "beast," and the consequent action, etc. The circumstance is, probably, too well known to require further comment.
[Thomas Hope (1770-1831) was celebrated for his collections of pictures, sculpture, and *bric-à-brac*. He was the author of *Anastasius, or Memoirs of a Greek, etc.*, which was attributed to Byron, and, according to Lady Blessington, excited his envy. "Low Dubost" was a French painter, who, in revenge for some fancied injustice, caricatured Hope and his wife as Beauty and the Beast. An exhibition of the sketch is said to have brought in from twenty to thirty pounds a week. A brother of Mrs. Hope (Louisa Beresford, daughter of Lord

Footnote a: Ý
Athens, March 2nd, 1811.

[MS. L. (a).]

Athens, March 12th, 1811.

[MS. L. (i), MS. M.]

[return](#)

Footnote b: Ý

If^{cA} West or Lawrence, (take whichever you will)
Sons of the Brush, supreme
in graphic skill,
Should clap a human head-
piece on a mare,
How would our Exhibition's
loungers stare!
Or should some dashing
limner set to sale
My Lady's likeness with a
Mermaid's tail.

[MS. L. (a).]

The features finished, should
superbly deck
My Lady's likeness with a
Filly's neck;
Or should some limner mad
or maudlin group
A Mermaid's tail and Maid of
Honour's Hoop.

[MS. L.(b).]

Decies, Archbishop of Tuam)
mutilated the picture, and, an
action having been brought, was
ordered to pay a nominal sum of
five pounds. Dubost's academy
portrait of Mrs. Hope did not
please Peter Pindar.

"In Mistress Hope, Monsieur
Dubost! Thy Genius yieldeth
up the Ghost."

Works (1812), v. 372.]

[return](#)

Footnote 3: Ý

"While pure Description held
the place of Sense."

Pope, *Prol. to the Sat.*, L. 148.

"While Mr. Sol decked out all
so glorious
Shines like a Beau in his
Birthday Embroidery."

Sub-Footnote A: nbsp; I have been
obliged to dive into the "Bathos"
for the simile, as I could not find a
description of these Painters'
merits above ground.

"Si liceat parvis
Componere magna"--

"Like London's column
pointing to the skies
Like a *tall Bully*, lifts its head
and lies"

I was in hopes might bear me out,
if the monument be like a Bully.
West's glory may be reduced by
the scale of comparison. If not, let
me have recourse to *Tom Thumb
the Great* [Fielding's farce, first
played 1730] to keep my simile in
countenance.--[*MS. L. (b) erased*]

[return to main footnote](#)

[return to poem](#)

Footnote c: Ý After line 6, the
following lines (erased) were
inserted:--

Or patch a Mammoth up with
wings and limbs,
And fins of aught that flies or
walks or swims.

[*MS. M.*]

Another variant ran--

[Fielding, *Tom Thumb*, act i. sc. I.]
[MS. M.] "*Fas est et ab Hoste doceri.*" In the 7th Art. of the 31st No. of the *Edinburgh Review* (vol. xvi. Ap. 1810) the "Observations" of an Oxford Tutor are compared to "Children's Cradles" (page 181), then to a "Barndoor fowl flying" (page 182), then the man himself to "a Coach-horse on the Trottoir" (page 185) etc., etc., with a variety of other conundrums all tending to prove that the ingenuity of comparison increases in proportion to the dissimilarity between the things compared.--
[MS. L. (b) *erased.*]

[return](#)

Footnote 4: Ý Mere common mortals were commonly content with one Taylor and with one bill, but the more particular gentlemen found it impossible to confide their lower garments to the makers of their body clothes. I speak of the beginning of 1809: what reform may have since taken place I neither know, nor desire to know.--[MSS. L. (b), M.]

[return](#)

Footnote 5: Ý Mr. Pitt was liberal in his additions to our Parliamentary tongue; as may be seen in many publications, particularly the *Edinburgh Review*. [The reference may be to financial terms, such as sinking fund (a

Or paint (astray from Truth and Nature led)
A Judge with wings, a
Statesman with a Head!

[MS. M.]

[return](#)

Footnote d: Ý

Believe me, Hobhouse...

[MS M.]

[return](#)

Footnote e: Ý

as we scribblers...

[MSS. L. (a and b), MS. M.]

[return](#)

phrase not introduced by Pitt), the English equivalent of *caisse d'amortissement*, or income tax (*impôt sur le revenu*), or to actual French words such as *chouannerie*, *projet*, etc. But Pitt's "additions" are unnoticed by Frere and other reporters and critics of his speeches. For a satirical description of Pitt's words, "which are finer and longer than can be conceived," see *Rolliad*, 1799; *Political Miscellanies*, p. 421; and *Political Eclogues*, p. 195.

"And Billy best of all things
loves--a trope."

Compare, too, Peter Pindar, "To Sylvanus Urban," *Works* (1812), ii. 259.

"Lycurgus Pitt whose
penetrating eyes
Behold the fount of Freedom
in excise,
Whose *patriot* logic possibly
maintains
The *identity* of *liberty* and
chains."

[return](#)

Footnote 6: Ý Old ballads, old plays, and old women's stories, are at present in as much request as old wine or new speeches. In fact, this is the millennium of black

Footnote f: Ý

Like Wardle's^A speeches.

[MS. L. (a).] **Sub-Footnote A:**
nbsp; Gwyllim Lloyd Wardle

letter: thanks to our Hebers,
Webers, and Scotts!
[Richard Heber (1773-1833),
book-collector and man of letters,
was half-brother of the Bishop of
Calcutta. He edited, *inter alia*,
*Specimens of the Early English
Poets*, by George Ellis, 3 vols.,
London: 1811.

W. H. Weber (1783-1818), a
German by birth, was employed
by Sir Walter Scott as an
amanuensis and "searcher." He
edited, in 1810, *Metrical
Romances of the 13th, 14th, and
15th Centuries*, a work described
by Southey (*Letters*, ii. 308) as
"admirably edited, exceedingly
curious, and after my own heart."
He also published editions of
Ford, and Beaumont and Fletcher,
which were adversely criticized by
Gifford. For an account of his
relations to Scott and of his
melancholy end, see Lockhart's
Life of Scott (1871), p. 251.]

[return](#)

Footnote 7: *Ý Mac Flecknoe*, the
Dunciad, and all Swift's
lampooning ballads. Whatever
their other works may be, these
originated in personal feelings,
and angry retort on unworthy
rivals; and though the ability of
these satires elevates the poetical,
their poignancy detracts from the

(1762-1834), who served in
Ireland in 1798, as Colonel of the
Welsh Fusiliers, known as
"Wynne's lambs," was M.P. for
Okehampton 1807-12. In January,
1809, he brought forward a motion
for a parliamentary investigation
into the exercise of military
patronage by the Duke of York,
and the supposed influence of the
Duke's mistress, Mary Anne
Clarke.

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[return to poem](#)

Footnote g: *Ý*

As pertness lurks beneath a
legal gown.
And nonsense in a lofty note
goes down.

[MS. L. (a).]

personal character of the writers. or,
[return](#)

Which covers all things like a
Prelate's gown.

[MS. L. (a).]]

or,

Which wraps presumption.

[MS. M. *erased.*]

[return](#)

Footnote 8: *YAlmanzor: or the Conquest of Granada by the Spaniards*, a Tragedy by John Dryden. The bombastic character of the hero was severely criticized in Dryden's own time, and was defended by him thus:

"'Tis said that Almanzor is no perfect pattern of heroic virtue, that he is a contemner of kings, and that he is made to perform impossibilities. I must therefore avow, in the first place, from whence I took the character. The first image I had of him was from the Achilles of Homer: the next from Tasso's Rinaldo, and the third from the Artaban of Mons. Calprenède.... He talks extravagantly in his passion, but if I would take the trouble to quote from Ben Jonson's

Footnote h: *Y*

*As when the poet to
description yields
Of waters gliding through the
goodly fields;
The Groves of Granta and
her Gothic Halls,
Oxford and Christchurch,
London and St. Pauls,
Or with a ruder flight he
feebly aims
To paint a rainbow or the
River Thames.
Perhaps you draw a fir tree
or a beech,
But then a landscape is
beyond your reach;
Or, if that allegory please you
not,
Take this--you'd form a vase,
but make a pot...*

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

Cethegus, I could easily show
you that the rhodomontades
of Almanzor are neither so
irrational as his nor so
impossible to be put in
execution."

*An Essay on Heroic Plays. Works
of John Dryden* (1821), iv. 23-25.
[return](#)

Footnote 9: Ý With all the vulgar
applause and critical abhorrence of
puns, they have Aristotle on their
side; who permits them to orators,
and gives them consequence by a
grave disquisition.

Footnote j: Ý

*Although you sketch a tree
which Taste endures,
Your ill-daubed Shipwreck
shocks the Connoisseurs....*

["Cicero also," says Addison,
"has sprinkled several of his
works with them; and in his
book on Oratory, quotes
abundance of sayings as
pieces of wit, which, upon
examination, prove arrant
puns."

[MS M.]
[return](#)

Essay on Wit, Works (1888), ii.
354.]]
[return](#)

Footnote 1: Ý In Vanbrugh and
Gibber's comedy of *The Provoked
Husband*, first played at Drury
Lane, January 10, 1728.
[return](#)

Footnote k: Ý

*The greater portion of the
men of rhyme
Parents and children or their
Sires sublime...*

Footnote 11: Ý

"And in his ear I'll holla--
Mortimer!"

[*I Henry IV.*, act i. sc. 3.]

[return](#)

Footnote 12: Ý Garrick's *Lying Valet* was played for the first time at Goodman's Fields, November 30, 1741.

["Peregrine" is a character in George Colman's *John Bull*, or *An Englishman's Fire-Side*, Covent Garden. March 5, 1803.]

[return](#)

Footnote 13: Ý I have Johnson's authority for making Lear a monosyllable--

"Perhaps where Lear rav'd or
Hamlet died
On flying cars new sorcerers
may ride."

["Perhaps where Lear has
rav'd, and Hamlet dy'd."

Prologue to *Irene*. *Johnson's Works* (1806), i. 168.] and (if it need be mentioned) the *authority* of the epigram on Barry and Garrick. [Note *erased*, *Proof b*,

[MS M.]

[return](#)

Footnote m: Ý

*But change the malady they
strive to cure...*

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

Footnote n: Ý

*Fish in the woods and wild-
boars in the waves...*

[MS M.]

[return](#)

Footnote o: Ý

*For Coat and waistcoat
Slowshears is your man,
But Breeches claim another
Artisan;
Now this to me I own seems
much the same
As one leg perfect and the
other lame.*

[MSS. M., L. (a).]

Sweitzer is your man.

[MS. M. *erased*.]

[return](#)

British Museum.]

[return](#)

Footnote 14: Ý

"Johnson: Pray, Mr. Bayes,
who is that Drawcansir?

Bayes. Why, Sir, a great
[fierce] hero, that frights his
mistress, snubs up kings,
baffles armies, and does what
he will, without regard to
numbers, good sense, or
justice [good manners,
justice, or numbers]."

The Rehearsal, act iv. sc. I.

The Rehearsal, by George Villiers,
second Duke of Buckingham
(1627-1688), appeared in 1671.
Sprat and others are said to have
shared the authorship. So popular
was the play that "Drawcansir"
passed into a synonyme for a
braggadocio. It is believed that
"Bayes" (that is, of course,
"laureate") was meant for a
caricature of Dryden: "he himself
complains bitterly that it was so."
(See *Lives of the Poets* (1890), i.
386; and Boswell's *Life of Johnson*
(1876), p. 235, and note.)

[return](#)

Footnote 15: Ý

Footnote p: Ý

*Him who hath sense to make
a skilful choice
Nor lucid Order, nor the
Siren Voice
Of Eloquence shall shun, and
Wit and Grace
(Or I'm deceived) shall aid
him in the Race:
These too will teach him to
defer or join
To future parts the now
omitted line:
This shall the Author like or
that reject,
Sparing in words and
cautious to select:
Nor slight applause will
candid pens afford
To him who well compounds
a wanting word,
And if, by chance, 'tis needful
to produce
Some term long laid and
obsolete in use...*

[MSS. M., L. (a and b). The last
line partly erased.]

Footnote q: Ý

"Difficile est proprie
communia dicere; tuque
Rectius Iliacum carmen
deducis in actus,
Quam si proferres ignota
indictaque primus."

*The dextrous Coiner of a
wanting word...*

[Proof b, British Museum]
[return](#)

Hor: *De Arte Poet*: 128-130.

Mons. Dacier, Mons. de Sévigné,
Boileau, and others, have left their
dispute on the meaning of this
sentence in a tract considerably
longer than the poem of Horace. It
is printed at the close of the
eleventh volume of Madame de
Sévigné's Letters, edited by
Grouvelle, Paris, 1806. Presuming
that all who can construe may
venture an opinion on such
subjects, particularly as so many
who *can't* have taken the same
liberty, I should have held "my
farthing candle" as awkwardly as
another, had not my respect for the
wits of Louis 14th's Augustan
"Siècle" induced me to subjoin
these illustrious authorities. I
therefore offer

1. Boileau: "Il est difficile de
trailer des sujets qui sont à la
portée de tout le monde d'une
maniere qui vous les rende
propres, ce qui s'appelle
s'approprier un sujet par le
tour qu'on y donne."

2. Batteux: "Mais il est bien difficile de donner des traits propres et individuels aux etres purement possibles."
3. Dacier: "Il est difficile de traiter convenablement ces caractères que tout le monde peut inventer."

Mr. Sévigné's opinion and translation, consisting of some thirty pages, I omit, particularly as Mr. Grouvelle observes,

"La chose est bien remarquable, aucune de ces diverses interpretations ne parait être la veritable."

But, by way of comfort, it seems, fifty years afterwards, "Le lumineux Dumarsais" made his appearance, to set Horace on his legs again, "dissiper tous les nuages, et concilier tous les dissentiments;" and I suppose some fifty years hence, somebody, still more luminous, will doubtless start up and demolish Dumarsais and his system on this weighty affair, as if he were no better than Ptolemy or Copernicus and comments of no more consequence than astronomical calculations. I am happy to say, "la longueur de la dissertation" of Mr. D. prevents Mr. G. from saying

any more on the matter. A better poet than Boileau, and at least as good a scholar as Mr. de Sévigné, has said,

"A little learning is a dangerous thing."

And by the above extract, it appears that a good deal may be rendered as useless to the Proprietors.

[Byron chose the words in question, *Difficile*, etc., as a motto for the first five cantos of *Don Juan*]

[return](#)

Footnote 16: Ý About two years ago a young man named Townsend was announced by Mr. Cumberland, in a review (since deceased) [the *London Review*], as being engaged in an epic poem to be entitled "Armageddon." The plan and specimen promise much; but I hope neither to offend Mr. Townsend, nor his friends, by recommending to his attention the lines of Horace to which these rhymes allude. If Mr. Townsend succeeds in his undertaking, as there is reason to hope, how much will the world be indebted to Mr. Cumberland for bringing him before the public! But, till that eventful day arrives, it may be doubted whether the premature

Footnote r: Ý

Adroitly grafted...

[*Proof b, British Museum*]

[return](#)

display of his plan (sublime as the ideas confessedly are) has not,--by raising expectation too high, or diminishing curiosity, by developing his argument,--rather incurred the hazard of injuring Mr. Townsend's future prospects. Mr. Cumberland (whose talents I shall not depreciate by the humble tribute of my praise) and Mr. Townsend must not suppose me actuated by unworthy motives in this suggestion. I wish the author all the success he can wish himself, and shall be truly happy to see epic poetry weighed up from the bathos where it lies sunken with Southey, Cottle, Cowley (Mrs. or Abraham), Ogilvy, Wilkie, Pye, and all the "dull of past and present days." Even if he is not a *Milton*, he may be better than *Blackmore*; if not a *Homer*, an *Antimachus*. I should deem myself presumptuous, as a young man, in offering advice, were it not addressed to one still younger. Mr. Townsend has the greatest difficulties to encounter; but in conquering them he will find employment; in having conquered them, his reward. I know too well "the scribbler's scoff, the critic's contumely;" and I am afraid time will teach Mr. Townsend to know them better. Those who succeed, and those

who do not, must bear this alike,
and it is hard to say which have
most of it. I trust that Mr.
Townsend's share will be from
envy; he will soon know mankind
well enough not to attribute this
expression to malice.

[This note was written [at Athens]
before the author was apprised of
Mr. Cumberland's death [in May,
1811].--MS. (See Byron's letter to
Dallas, August 27, 1811.) The Rev.
George Townsend (1788-1857)
published *Poems* in 1810, and
eight books of his *Armageddon* in
1815. They met with the fate
which Byron had predicted. In
later life he compiled numerous
works of scriptural exegesis. He
was a Canon of Durham from
1825 till his death.]

[return](#)

Footnote 17: ÝThe first line of *A
Spirit of Discovery by Sea*, by the
Rev. W. Lisle Bowles, first
published in 1805.

[return](#)

Footnote 18: ÝHarvey, the
circulator of the *circulation* of the
blood, used to fling away Virgil in
his ecstasy of admiration and say,
"the book had a devil." Now such
a character as I am copying would

Footnote s: Ý

*Since they enriched our
language in their time
In modern speeches or Black
letter rhyme....*

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

Footnote t: Ý

*Though at a Monarch's nod,
and Traffic's call
Reluctant rivers deviate to
Canal...*

probably fling it away also, but rather wish that "the devil had the book;" not from dislike to the poet, but a well-founded horror of hexameters. Indeed, the public school penance of "Long and Short" is enough to beget an antipathy to poetry for the residue of a man's life, and, perhaps, so far may be an advantage.

[return](#)

Footnote 19: Ý

*"Infandum, regina, jubes
renovare dolorem."*

I dare say Mr. Tavell (to whom I mean no affront) will understand me; and it is no matter whether any one else does or no.--To the above events, "*quæque ipse miserrima vidi, et quorum pars magna fui*," all times and terms bear testimony.

[The Rev. G.F. Tavell was a fellow and tutor of Trinity College, Cambridge, during Byron's residence, and owed this notice to the "zeal with which he protested against his juvenile vagaries." During a part of his residence at Trinity, Byron kept a tame bear in his rooms in Neville's Court. (See *English Bards*, l. 973, [note](#), and [postscript to the Second Edition](#), ante, p. 383. See also letter to

[MSS M., L. (a and b).]

[return](#)

Footnote u: Ý

marshes dried, sustain...

[Proof b, British Museum]

[return](#)

Miss Pigot, October 26, 1807.)

The following copy of a bill (no date) tells its own story:--

The Honble. Lord Byron.

To John Clarke.

To Bread & Milk for the Bear
deliv'd. to Haladay £
1 9 7

Cambridge Reve. A Clarke.]
[return](#)

Footnote 20: Ý

- "Hell," a gaming-house so called, where you risk little, and are cheated a good deal.
- "Club," a pleasant purgatory, where you lose more, and are not supposed to be cheated at all.

[return](#)

Footnote 21: Ý

"Irene had to speak two lines with the bowstring round her neck; but the audience cried out ['Murder!'] 'Murder!' and she was obliged to go off the stage alive."

Boswell's Johnson [1876, p. 60].

Footnote v: Ý

*Thus--future years dead
volumes shall revive...*

[*Proof b, British Museum*]
[return](#)

Footnote w: Ý

*As Custom fluctuates whose
Iron Sway
Though ever changing
Mortals must obey...*

[*MS M.*]
[return](#)

[Irene (first played February 6, 1749) for the future was put to death behind the scenes. The strangling her, contrary to Horace's rule, *coram populo*, was suggested by Garrick. (See Davies' *Life of Garrick* (1808), i. 157.)]

[return](#)

Footnote 22: Ý Matthew Gregory Lewis (1775-1818). (*Vide English Bards, etc.*, l. 265, [n. 8.](#)) The character of Hassan, "my misanthropic negro," as Lewis called him, was said by the critics of the day to have been borrowed from Zanga in Young's *Revenge*. Lewis, in his "Address to the Reader," quoted by Byron (in [note 3](#)), defends the originality of the conception.

[return](#)

Footnote 23: Ý In the postscript to *The Castle Spectre*, Mr. Lewis tells us, that though blacks were unknown in England at the period of his action, yet he has made the anachronism to set off the scene: and if he could have produced the effect "by making his heroine blue,"--I quote him--"blue he would have made her!" [*The Castle Spectre*, by M.G. Lewis, Esq., M.P., London, 1798, page 102.]

[return](#)

[cross-reference: return to Footnote 22 of this poem](#)

Footnote x: Ý

To mark the Majesty of Epic song...

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

Footnote y: Ý

*But which is preferable
rhyme or blank
Which holds in poesy...*

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

Footnote 24: Ý In 1706 John Dennis, the critic (1657-1734), wrote an *Essay on the Operas after the Italian manner, which are about to be established on the English Stage*; to show that they were more immoral than the most licentious play.

[return](#)

Footnote 25: Ý One of the gangways in the Opera House, where the young men of fashion used to assemble. (See letter to Murray, Nov. 9, 1820; *Life*, p. 62.)

[return](#)

Footnote 26: Ý In the year 1808, happening at the opera to tread on the toes of a very well-dressed man, I turned round to apologize, when, to my utter astonishment, I recognized the face of the porter of the very hotel where I then lodged in Albemarle Street. So here was a gentleman who ran every morning forty errands for half a crown, throwing away half a guinea at night, besides the expense of his habiliments, and the hire of his "Chapeau de Bras."-

-[MS. L. (a).]]

[return](#)

Footnote 27: Ý The first theatrical representations, entitled "Mysteries and Moralities," were

Footnote z: Ý

ventures to appear...

[MS. Corr. in Proof b, British Museum]

[return](#)

Footnote A: Ý

*And Harry Monmouth, till the scenes require,
Resigns heroics to his
sceptred Sire....*

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

Footnote B: Ý

*To "hollaing Hotspur" and
the sceptred sire...*

[MS. Corr. in Proof b, British Museum]

[return](#)

Footnote C: Ý

generally enacted at Christmas, by monks (as the only persons who could read), and latterly by the clergy and students of the universities. The dramatis personae were usually Adam, Pater Coelestis, Faith, Vice, and sometimes an angel or two; but these were eventually superseded by *Gammer Gurton's Needle*.--*Vide Warton's History of English Poetry [passim]*.--[MSS. M., L. (b).

[return](#)

Footnote 28: *Y Benvolio* [Lord Grosvenor, MS. L. (b)] does not bet; but every man who maintains racehorses is a promoter of all the concomitant evils of the turf. Avoiding to bet is a little pharisaical. Is it an exculpation? I think not. I never yet heard a bawd praised for chastity, because *she herself* did not commit fornication.

[Robert, second Earl Grosvenor (1767-1845), was created Marquis of Westminster in 1831. Like his father, Gifford's patron, the first Earl Grosvenor, he was a breeder of racehorses, and a patron of the turf. As Lord Belgrave, he brought forward a motion for the suppression of Sunday newspapers, June 11, 1799, denouncing them in a violent speech. The motion was lost; but

Dull as an Opera, I should sleep or sneer...

[MS M.]

[return](#)

Footnote D: *Y*

And for Emotion's aid 'tis said and sung...

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

many years after, in a speech delivered in the House of Lords, January 2, 1807, he returned to the charge. (See *Parl. Hist.*, 34. 1006, 1010; and *Parl. Deb.*, 8. 286.) (For a skit on Lord Belgrave's sabbatarian views, see Peter Pindar, *Works* (1812), iv. 519.)]

[return](#)

Footnote 29: Ý Samuel Foote

(1720-1777), actor and

playwright. His solo

entertainments, in *The Dish of Tea*,

An Auction of Pictures, 1747-8

(see his comedy *Taste*), were the

precursors of *Mathews at Home*,

and a long line of successors. His

farces and curtain-pieces were

often "spiced-up" with more or

less malicious character-sketches

of living persons. Among his

better known pieces are *The Minor*

(1760), ridiculing Whitefield and

the Methodists, and *The Mayor of*

Garratt (1763), in which he

played the part of Sturgeon (Byron

used this piece, for an illustration

in his speech on the Frame-

workers Bill, February 27, 1812).

The Lyar, first played at Covent

Garden, January 12, 1762, was the

latest to hold the stage. It was

reproduced at the Opera Comique

in 1877.

[return](#)

Footnote 30: Ý Henry Carey, poet

and musician (d. 1743), a natural

Footnote E: Ý

or form a plot...

[*Proof b*, British Museum]

[return](#)

Footnote F: Ý

son of George Savile, Marquis of Halifax, was the author of *Chrononhotonthologos*, "the most tragical tragedy ever yet tragedised by any company of tragedians," which was first played at the Haymarket, February 22, 1734. The well-known lines, "Go, call a coach, and let a coach be called," etc., which Scott prefixed to the first chapter of *The Antiquary*, are from the last scene, in which Bombardinion fights with and kills the King Chrononhotonthologos. But his one achievement was *Sally in our Alley*, of which he wrote both the words and the music. The authorship of "God Save the King" has been attributed to him, probably under a misapprehension.

[return](#)

Footnote 31: Under Plato's pillow a volume of the *Mimes* of Sophron was found the day he died.--Vide Barthélémi, De Pauw, or Diogenes Laërtius, [Lib. iii. p. 168--Chouet 1595] if agreeable. De Pauw calls it a jest-book. Cumberland, in his *Observer*, terms it moral, like the sayings of Publius Syrus.

[return](#)

Footnote 32: In 1737 the manager of Goodman's Fields Theatre having brought Sir Robert

*What'eer the critic says or
poet sings
'Tis no slight task to write on
common things...*

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

Footnote G: Ý

*Ere o'er our heads your
Muse's Thunder rolls....*

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

Footnote H: Ý

Walpole a farce called *The Golden Rump*, the minister detained the copy. He then made extracts of the most offensive passages, read them to the house, and brought in a bill to limit the number of playhouses and to subject all dramatic writings to the inspection of the Lord Chamberlain. Horace Walpole ascribed *The Golden Rump* to Fielding, and said that he had found an imperfect copy of the play among his father's papers. But this has been questioned. (See *A Book of the Play*, by Dutton Cook (1881), p. 27.)

Earth, Heaven and Hell, are shaken with the Song....

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

[return](#)

Footnote 33: *Y* His speech on the Licensing Act [in which he opposed the Bill], is reckoned one of his most eloquent efforts.

Footnote J: *Y*

Through deeds we know not, though already done,...

[The following sentences have been extracted from the speech which was delivered:--

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

"The bill is not only an encroachment upon liberty, it is likewise an encroachment on property. Wit, my lords, is a sort of property; it is the property of those who have it, and too often the only property they have to depend on...

"Those gentlemen who have

any such property are all, I
hope, our friends; do not let
us subject them to any
unnecessary or arbitrary
restraint...

"The stage and the press, my
lord, are two of our out-
sentries; if we remove them,
if we hoodwink them, if we
throw them into fetters, the
enemy may surprise us.
Therefore I must now look
upon the bill before us as a
step for introducing arbitrary
power into this kingdom."

Lord Chesterfield's sentiments
with regard to laughter are
contained in an apophthegm,
repeated more than once in his
correspondence:

"The vulgar laugh aloud, but
never smile; on the contrary,
people of fashion often smile,
but seldom or never laugh
aloud."

*Chesterfield's Letters to his
Godson*, Oxford, 1890, p. 27.]

[return](#)

Footnote 34: Ý Archer and Squire
Sullen are characters in Farquhar's
play (1678-1707), *The Beaux'*
Stratagem, March 8, 1707.

[return](#)

Footnote K: Ý

*What soothes the people's,
Peer's, and Critic's ear....*

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

Footnote 35: Ý Michael Perez, the "Copper Captain," in [Fletcher's] *Rule a Wife and Have a Wife* [licensed October 19, 1624].

[return](#)

Footnote M: Ý
*And Vice buds forth
developed with his Teens....*

[MS M.]

[return](#)

Footnote 36: Ý The Rev. Dr. Francis Willis died in 1807, in the 90th year of his age. He attended George III. in his first attack of madness in 1788. The power of his eye on other persons is illustrated by a story related by Frederick Reynolds (*Life and Times*, ii. 23), who describes how Edmund Burke quailed under his look. His son, John Willis, was entrusted with the entire charge of the king in 1811. Compare Shelley's *Peter Bell the Third*, part vi.--

Footnote N: Ý
*The beardless Tyro freed at
length from school.*
[MSS. L. (b), M. erased.]
*And blushing Birch disdains
all College rule.*

[MS. M. erased.]

And dreaded Birch.

[MS. L. (a and b).]

[return](#)

"Let him shave his head:
Where's Dr. Willis?"

(See, too, *Bland-Burges Papers* (1885), pp. 113-115, and *Life of George IV.*, by Percy Fitzgerald (1881), ii. 18.)

[return](#)

Footnote 37: Ý Dr. Johnson was of **Footnote P:** Ý the like opinion.

"Highwaymen and
housebreakers," he says, in

*Unlucky Tavell! damned to
daily cares*

his Life of Gay, "seldom frequent the playhouse, or mingle in any elegant diversion; nor is it possible for any one to imagine that he may rob with safety, because he sees Macheath reprieved upon the stage."

*By pugilistic Freshmen, and
by Bears....*

[MS. M. erased]

[return](#)

Lives of the Poets, by Samuel Johnson (1890), ii. 266. It was asserted, on the other hand, by Sir John Fielding, the Bow-street magistrate, that on every run of the piece, *The Beggar's Opera*, an increased number of highwaymen were brought to his office; and so strong was his conviction, that in 1772 he remonstrated against the performance with the managers of both the houses.

[return](#)

Footnote 38: Ý Jerry Collier's controversy with Congreve, etc., on the subject of the drama, is too well known to require further comment.

Footnote Q: Ý

*Ready to quit whatever he
loved before,
Constant to nought, save
hazard and a whore....*

[Jeremy Collier (1650-1756), non-juring bishop and divine. The occasion of his controversy with Congreve was the publication of his *Short View of the Immorality and Profaneness of the English Stage* (1697-8). Congreve, who had been attacked by name, replied in a tract entitled

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

*Amendments upon Mr. Collier's false and imperfect citations from the **Old Batcheleur**, etc.]*

[return](#)

Footnote 39: *Ý* A few months after **Footnote R:** *Ý*

lines 370-381 were added to *The Hints*, in September, 1812, Byron, at the request of Lord Holland, wrote the address delivered on the opening of the theatre, which had been rebuilt after the fire of February 24, 1809. He subsequently joined the Committee of Management

The better years of youth he wastes away....

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

[return](#)

Footnote 40: *Ý* Mr. Simeon is the **Footnote S:** *Ý*

very bully of beliefs, and castigator of "good works." He is ably supported by John Stickles, a labourer in the same vineyard:-- but I say no more, for, according to Johnny in full congregation, "No hopes for them as laughs."

Master of Arts, as all the Clubs proclaim...

[MS L. (b)]

[return](#)

[The Rev. Charles Simeon (1758-1836) was the leader of the evangelical movement in Cambridge. The reference may be to the rigour with which he repelled a charge brought against him by Dr. Edwards, the Master of Sidney Sussex, that a sermon which he had preached in November, 1809, savoured of antinomianism. It may be noted that a friend (the Rev. W. Parish), to whom he submitted the MS. of

a rejoinder to Pearson's *Cautions*,
etc., advised him to print it,
"especially if you should rather
keep down a lash or two which
might irritate." Simeon was
naturally irascible, and, in reply to
a friend who had mildly reproved
him for some display of temper,
signed himself, in humorous
penitence, "Charles proud and
irritable." (See *Memoirs of the Life
of the Rev. Mr. Simeon*, by Rev. W.
Carus (1847), pp. 195, 282, etc.)]

[return](#)

Footnote 41: *Y Baxter's Shove to
heavy-a--d Christians*, the
veritable title of a book once in
good repute, and likely enough to
be so again.

["Baxter" is a slip of the pen. The
tract or sermon, *An Effectual
Shove to the heavy-arse Christian*,
was, according to the title-page,
written by William Bunyan,
minister of the gospel in South
Wales, and "printed for the author"
in London in 1768.]

[return](#)

Footnote 42: *Y Ambrose Philips*
(1675?-1749) published his *Epistle
to the Earl of Dorset* and his
Pastorals in 1709. It is said that
Pope attacked him in his satires in
consequence of an article in the
Guardian, in which the *Pastorals*

Footnote T: *Y*

Scrapes wealth, o'er
Grandam's endless jointure
grieves...

[MS. *erased.*]

O'er Grandam's mortgage, or
young hopeful's debts...

[MS. *L. (a).*]

O'er Uncle's mortgage...

[MS. *L. (b).*]

[return](#)

Footnote U: *Y*

*Your plot is told or acted
more or less...*

[MS *M.*]

[return](#)

were unduly extolled. His verses, addressed to the children of his patron, Lord Carteret, were parodied by Henry Carey, in *Namby Pamby, or a Panegyric on the New Versification*.

[return](#)

Footnote 43: Ý See letters to Murray, Sept. 15, 1817; Jan. 25, 1819; Mar. 29, 1820; Nov. 4, 1820; etc. See also the two *Letters* against Bowles, written at Ravenna, Feb. 7 and Mar. 21, 1821, in which Byron's enthusiastic reverence for Pope is the dominant note.

[return](#)

Footnote 44: Ý As famous a tonsor as Licinus himself, and better paid [and may be like him a senator, one day or other: no disparagement to the High Court of Parliament.--*MS.L. (b)*], and may, like him, be one day a senator, having a better qualification than one half of the heads he crops, viz.--Independence.

[According to the Scholiast, Cassar made his barber Licinus a senator, "quod odisset Pompeium." Blake (see Letter to Murray, Nov. 9, 1820) was, presumably, Benjamin Blake, a perfumer, who lived at 46, Park

Footnote V: Ý

To greater sympathy our feelings rise When what is done is done before our eyes....

[*MS L. (a)*]

[return](#)

Footnote W: Ý

Appalls an audience with the work of Death-- To gaze when Hubert simply threatens to sere....

[*MS L. (a)*]

[return](#)

Street, Grosvenor Square.]

[return](#)

Footnote 45: Ý There was some foundation for this. When Wordsworth and his sister Dorothy called on Daniel Stuart, editor of the *Courier*, at his fine new house in Harley Street, the butler would not admit them further than the hall, and was not a little taken aback when he witnessed the deference shown to these strangely-attired figures by his master.-- Personal Reminiscence of the late Miss Stuart, of 106, Harley Street.

[return](#)

Footnote 46: Ý

"*Bayes*: If I am to write familiar things, as sonnets to Armida, and the like, I make use of stewed prunes only; but when I have a grand design in hand, I ever take physic and let blood; for when you would have pure swiftness of thought, and fiery flights of fancy, you must have a care of the pensive part. In fine, you must purge."

Rehearsal, act ii. sc. 1.

This passage is instanced by

Footnote X: Ý

*Nor call a Ghost, unless some
cursed hitch
Requires a trapdoor Goblin
or a Witch....*

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

Footnote Y: Ý

*This comes from Commerce
with our foreign friends
These are the precious fruits
Ausonia sends....*

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

Johnson as a proof that "Bayes"
was a caricature of Dryden.

"Bayes, when he is to write,
is blooded and purged; this,
as Lamotte relates, ... was the
real practice of the poet."

Lives of the Poets 1890), i. 388.

[return](#)

Footnote 47: Ý Cant term for
£100,000.

[return](#)

Footnote 48: Ý I have not the
original by me, but the Italian
translation runs as follows:--

"E una cosa a mio credere
molto stravagante, che un
Padre desideri, o permetta,
che suo figliuolo coltivi e
perfezioni questo talento."

A little further on: "

Si trovano di rado nel
Parnaso le miniere d' oro e d'
argento,"

Footnote Z: Ý

*Our Giant Capital where
streets still spread
Where once our simpler sins
were bred....*

[MS L. (a)]

*Our fields where once the
rustic earned his bread....*

[MS L. (b)] [return](#)

Footnote Aa: Ý

*Aches with the Orchestra he
pays to hear...*

[MS M.]

[return](#)

*Educazione dei Fanciulli del
Signer Locke* (Venice, 1782), ii.
87.

["If the child have a poetic
vein, it is to me the strangest
thing in the world, that the
father should desire or suffer
it to be cherished or
improved."

...

"It is very seldom seen, that
any one discovers mines of
gold or silver on Parnassus."

*Some Thoughts concerning
Education*, by John Locke (1880),
p. 152.]

[return](#)

Footnote 49: Ý "Iro pauperior:" a
proverb: this is the same beggar
who boxed with Ulysses for a
pound of kid's fry, which he lost
and half a dozen teeth besides.
(See *Odyssey*, xviii. 98.)

[return](#)

Footnote 50: Ý The Irish gold
mine in Wicklow, which yields
just ore enough to swear by, or
gild a bad guinea.

[return](#)

Footnote 51: Ý As Mr. Pope took
the liberty of damning Homer, to

Footnote Bb: Ý

*Scarce kept awake by roaring
out encore...*

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

Footnote Cc: Ý

*Ere theatres were built and
reverend clerks
Wrote plays as some old book
remarks...*

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

Footnote Dd: Ý

whom he was under great obligations--"And Homer (damn him!) calls"--it may be presumed that anybody or anything may be damned in verse by poetical licence [I shall suppose one may damn anything else in verse with impunity.--MS. L. (b)]; and, in case of accident, I beg leave to plead so illustrious a precedent.

[return](#)

Footnote 52: Ý For the story of Billy Havard's tragedy, see Davies's *Life of Garrick*. I believe it is *Regulus*, or *Charles the First* [Lincoln's Inn Fields, March 1, 1737]. The moment it was known to be his the theatre thinned, and the book-seller refused to give the customary sum for the copyright. [See *Life of Garrick*, by Thomas Davies (1808), ii. 205.]

[return](#)

Footnote 53: Ý: Thomas Erskine (third son of the fifth Earl of Buchan) afterwards Lord Erskine (1750-1823), Lord Chancellor (1806-7), an eloquent orator, a supremely great advocate, was, by comparison, a failure as a judge. His power over a jury, "his little twelvvers," as he would sometimes address them, was practically unlimited. (See *Recollections of*

*Who did what Vestris--yet, at least,--cannot,
And cut his kingly capers
"Sans culotte."...*

[MS M.]

[return](#)

Footnote Ee: Ý

*Who yet squeaks on nor fears
to be forgot
If good Earl Grosvenor
supersede them not...*

[MS L. (a)]

*Who still frisk on with feats
so vastly low
'Tis strange Earl Grosvenor
suffers such a show...*

[MS M.] [return](#)

Footnote Ff: Ý

*Suppressing Peer! to whom
all vice gives place,
Save Gambling--for his
Lordship loves a Race...*

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

the Table-Talk of Samuel Rogers
(1856), p. 126.)

[return](#)

Footnote 54: Ý Lines 589-626 are **Footnote Gg:** Ý
not in the *Murray MS.*, nor in
either of the *Lovelace MSS.*

[return](#)

*Hobhouse, since we have
roved through Eastern
climes,
While all the Ægean echoed
to our rhymes,
And bound to Momus by
some pagan spell
Laughed, sang and quaffed to
"Vive la Bagatelle!...*

[MS L. (a)]

Hobhouse, with whom once
more I hope to sit And smile
at what our Stage retails for
wit. Since few, I know, enjoy
a laugh so well Sardonic
slave to "Vive la Bagatelle"
So that in your's like Pagan
Plato's bed They'll find some
book of Epigrams when dead

[MS L. (b)] [return](#)

Footnote 55: Ý To the Eclectic or
Christian Reviewers I have to
return thanks for the fervour of
that charity which, in 1809,
induced them to express a hope
that a thing then published by me
might lead to certain
consequences, which, although
natural enough, surely came but

Footnote Hh: Ý

*My wayward Spirit weakly
yields to gloom,
But thine will waft thee
lightly to the Tomb,
So that in thine, like Pagan
Plato's, bed*

rashly from reverend lips. I refer them to their own pages, where they congratulated themselves on the prospect of a tilt between Mr. Jeffrey and myself, from which some great good was to accrue, provided one or both were knocked on the head. Having survived two years and a half those "Elegies" which they were kindly preparing to review, I have no peculiar gusto to give them "so joyful a trouble," except, indeed, "upon compulsion, Hal;" but if, as David says in *The Rivals*, it should come to "bloody sword and gun fighting," we "won't run, will we, Sir Lucius?"

[Byron, writing at Athens, away from his books, misquotes *The Rivals*. The words, "Sir Lucius, we--we--we--we won't run," are spoken by Acres, not by David.]

I do not know what I had done to these Eclectic gentlemen: my works are their lawful perquisite, to be hewn in pieces like Agag, if it seem meet unto them: but why they should be in such a hurry to kill off their author, I am ignorant. "The race is not always to the swift, nor the battle to the strong:" and now, as these Christians have "smote me on one cheek," I hold them up the other; and, in return

They'll find some Manuscript of Mimes, when dead...

[MS M.]

[return](#)

for their good wishes, give them
an opportunity of repeating them.
Had any other set of men
expressed such sentiments, I
should have smiled, and left them
to the "recording angel;" but from
the pharisees of Christianity
decency might be expected. I can
assure these brethren, that,
publican and sinner as I am, I
would not have treated "mine
enemy's dog thus." To show them
the superiority of my brotherly
love, if ever the Reverend Messrs.
Simeon or Ramsden should be
engaged in such a conflict as that
in which they requested me to fall,
I hope they may escape with being
"winged" only, and that Heavyside
may be at hand to extract the ball.-

-

["If, however, the noble Lord
and the learned advocate
have the courage requisite to
sustain their mutual insults,
we shall probably soon hear
the explosions of another
kind of *paper* war, after the
fashion of the ever-
memorable duel which the
latter is said to have fought,
or seemed to fight, with
'Little' Moore. We confess
there is sufficient
provocation, if not in the
critique, at least in the satire,

to urge a 'man of honour' to
defy his assailant to mortal
combat, and perhaps to
warrant a man of law to
declare war in Westminster
Hall. Of this we shall no
doubt hear more in due time"

(*Eclectic Review*, May, 1809).

Byron pretends to believe that the
"Christian" Reviewers, actuated
by stern zeal for piety, were
making mischief in sober earnest.

"Heaviside" (see last line of
Byron's note) was the surgeon in
attendance at the duel between
Lord Falkland and Mr. A. Powell.
(See *English Bards*, 1. 686, [note](#)
2.)

[return](#)

[Footnote 56:](#) *Macbeth*, act v. sc. [Footnote Jj:](#) *Macbeth*,
7.

[return](#)

*And spite of Methodism and
Collier's curse...*

[MS M.]

*He who's seduced by plays
must be a fool*

*If boys want teaching let
them stay at school...*

[MS L. (a)] [return](#)

Footnote 57: Ý See the critique of Footnote Kk: Ý
the *Edinburgh Review* on *Hours of*
Idleness, January, 1808.

[return](#)

*Whom Nature guides so
writes that he who sees
Enraptured thinks to do the
same with ease...*

[MS M.]

[return](#)

Footnote 58: Ý

"Invenies alium, si te hic
fastidit, Alexin."

[return](#)

Footnote Mm: Ý

*But after toil-inked thumbs
and bitten nails
Scratched head, ten quires--
the easy scribbler fails...*

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

Footnote 59: Ý Here MS. L. (a)
recommences.

[return](#)

Footnote Nn: Ý

*The one too rustic, t'other too
refined...*

[MS L. (a and b)]

[return](#)

Footnote 60: Ý John Jackson
(1769-1845), better known as
"Gentleman" Jackson, was
champion of England from 1795
to 1803. His three fights were
against Fewterel (1788), George
Ingleston, nicknamed "the
Brewer" (1789), and Mendoza
(1795). In 1803 he retired from the
ring. His rooms at 13, Bond Street,
became the head-quarters of the
Pugilistic Club. (See Pierce Egan's

Footnote Pp: Ý

*Offensive most to men with
house and land
Possessed of Pedigree and
bloody hand...*

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

Life in London, pp. 252-254,
where the rooms are described,
and a drawing of them by
Cruikshank is given.) Jackson's
character stood high.

"From the highest to the
lowest person in the Sporting
World, his *decision* is law."

He was Byron's guest at
Cambridge, Newstead, and
Brighton; received from him many
letters; and is described by him, in
a note to *Don Juan* (xi. 19), as

"my old friend and corporeal
pastor and master."

[return](#)

Footnote 61: Ý Mr. Southey has
lately tied another canister to his
tail in *The Curse of Kehama*,
maugre the neglect of *Madoc*, etc.,
and has in one instance had a
wonderful effect. A literary friend
of mine, walking out one lovely
evening last summer, on the
eleventh bridge of the Paddington
canal, was alarmed by the cry of
"one in jeopardy:" he rushed
along, collected a body of Irish
haymakers (supping on butter-
milk in an adjacent paddock),
procured three rakes, one eel-spear
and a landing net, and at last
(*horresco referens*) pulled out--his

Footnote Qq: Ý

*Composed for any but the
lightest strain...*

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

own publisher. The unfortunate man was gone for ever, and so was a large quarto wherewith he had taken the leap, which proved, on inquiry, to have been Mr. Southey's last work. Its "alacrity of sinking" was so great, that it has never since been heard of; though some maintain that it is at this moment concealed at Alderman Birch's pastry premises, Cornhill. Be this as it may, the coroner's inquest brought in a verdict of "*Felo de bibliopolâ*" against a "quarto unknown;" and circumstantial evidence being since strong against *The Curse of Kehama* (of which the above words are an exact description), it will be tried by its peers next session, in Grub-street--Arthur, Alfred, Davideis, Richard Coeur de Lion, Exodus, Exodiad, Epigoniad, Calvary, Fall of Cambria, Siege of Acre, Don Roderick, and Tom Thumb the Great, are the names of the twelve jurors. The judges are Pye, Bowles, and the bell-man of St. Sepulchre's.

The same advocates, pro and con, will be employed as are now engaged in Sir F. Burdett's celebrated cause in the Scotch courts. The public anxiously await the result, and all *live* publishers

will be subpoenaed as witnesses.--
But Mr. Southey has published
The Curse of Kehama,--an inviting
title to quibblers. By the bye, it is
a good deal beneath Scott and
Campbell, and not much above
Southey, to allow the booby
Ballantyne to entitle them, in the
Edinburgh Annual Register (of
which, by the bye, Southey is
editor) "the grand poetical
triumvirate of the day." But, on
second thoughts, it can be no great
degree of praise to be the one-eyed
leaders of the blind, though they
might as well keep to themselves
"Scott's thirty thousand copies
sold," which must sadly
discomfort poor Southey's
unsaleables. Poor Southey, it
should seem, is the "Lepidus" of
this poetical triumvirate. I am only
surprised to see him in such good
company.

"Such things, we know, are
neither rich nor rare,
But wonder how the devil *he*
came there."

The trio are well defined in the
sixth proposition of Euclid:--

"Because, in the triangles D
B C, A C B; D B is equal to A
C; and B C common to both;
the two sides D B, B C, are

equal to the two A C, C B,
each to each, and the angle D
B C is equal to the angle A C
B: therefore, the base D C is
equal to the base A B, and the
triangle D B C (Mr. Southey)
is equal to the triangle A C B,
the less to the greater, which
is absurd" etc.

The editor of the *Edinburgh Register* will find the rest of the theorem hard by his stabling; he has only to cross the river; 'tis the first turnpike t' other side *Pons Asinorum*^A.

- [*The Curse of Kehama*, by Robert Southey, was published 1810;
- *Arthur, or The Northern Enchantment*, by the Rev. Richard Hole, in 1789;
- *Alfred*, by Joseph Cottle, in 1801;
- *Davideis`*, by Abraham Cowley, in 1656;
- *Richard the First*, by Sir James Bland Surges, in 1801;
- *Exodiad*, by Sir J. Bland Surges and R. Cumberland, in 1808;
- *Exodus*, by Charles Hoyle, in 1802;
- *Epigoniad*, by W. Wilkie, D.D., in 1757;

- *Calvary*, by R. Cumberland, in 1792;
- *Fall of Cambria*, by Joseph Cottle, in 1809;
- *Siege of Acre*, by Hannah Cowley, in 1801;
- *The Vision of Don Roderick*, by Sir Walter Scott, in 1811;
- *Tom Thumb the Great*, by Henry Fielding, in 1730.

The *Courier* of July 16, 1811, reports in full the first stage of the case Sir F. Burdett v. William Scott (*vide supra*), which was brought before Lord Meadowbank as ordinary in the outer court. Jeffrey was counsel for the pursuer, who sought to recover a sum of £5000 lent under a bond. For the defence it was alleged that the money had been entrusted for a particular purpose, namely, the maintenance of an infant. Jeffrey denied the existence of any such claim, and maintained that whatever was scandalous or calumnious in the defence was absolutely untrue. The case, which was not included in the Scottish Law Reports, was probably settled out of court. Evidently the judge held that on technical grounds an action did not lie. Burdett's enemies were not slow in turning the scandal to account. (See a contemporary pamphlet, *Adultery and*

Patriotism, London, 1811.)]

Sub-Footnote A: This Latin has sorely puzzled the University of Edinburgh. Ballantyne said it meant the "Bridge of Berwick," but Southey claimed it as half English; Scott swore it was the "Brig o' Stirling:" he had just passed two King James's and a dozen Douglasses over it. At last it was decided by Jeffrey, that it meant nothing more nor less than the "counter of Archy Constable's shop."

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[63 of this poem](#)

Footnote 62: ^YVoltaire's *Pucelle* is Footnote Rr: ^Y

not quite so immaculate as Mr. Southey's *Joan of Arc*, and yet I am afraid the Frenchman has both more truth and poetry too on his side--(they rarely go together)--than our patriotic minstrel, whose first essay was in praise of a fanatical French strumpet, whose title of witch would be correct with the change of the first letter.

And must I then my...

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

[return](#)

Footnote 63: ^Y Like Sir Bland Burges's *Richard*; the tenth book of which I read at Malta, on a trunk of Eyre's, 19, Cockspur-street. If this be doubted, I shall buy a portmanteau to quote from.

Footnote Ss: ^Y

*Ye who require
Improvement...*

[MS L. (a)]

[Sir James Bland Burges (1752-1824), who assumed, in 1821, the name of Lamb, married, as his first wife, the Hon. Elizabeth Noel, daughter of Lord Wentworth, and younger sister of Byron's mother-in-law, Lady Milbanke. He was called to the bar in 1777, and in the same year was appointed a Commissioner in Bankruptcy. In 1787 he was returned M.P. for the borough of Helleston; and from 1789 to 1795 held office as Under-Secretary for Foreign Affairs. In 1795, at the instance of his chief, Lord Grenville, he vacated his post, and by way of compensation was created a baronet with a sinecure post as Knight-Marshal of the Royal Household. Thenceforth he devoted himself to literature. In 1796 he wrote the *Birth and Triumph of Love*, by way of letter-press to some elegant designs of the Princess Elizabeth. (For *Richard the First* and the *Exodiad*, see [note](#), p. 436.) His plays, *Riches and Tricks for Travellers*, appeared in 1810, and there were other works. In spite of Wordsworth's testimony (Wordsworth signed, but Coleridge dictated and no doubt composed, the letter: see *Thomas Poole and His Friends*, ii. 27) "to

[return](#)

a pure and unmixed vein of native English" in *Richard the First* (*Bland-Burges Papers*, 1885, p. 308), Burges as a poet awaits rediscovery. His diaries, portions of which were published in 1885, are lively and instructive. He has been immortalized in Person's *Macaronics*--

"Poetis nos lætamur tribus,
Pye, Petro Pindar, parvo
Pybus.
Si ulterius ire pergis,
Adde his Sir James Bland
Burges!"

[return](#)

Footnote 64: Ý [Charles Lamb, in **Footnote Tt:** Ý
"Christ's Hospital Five and Thirty
Years Ago" (*Prose Works*, 1836, ii.
30), records his repeated visits, as
a Blue Coat boy, "to the Lions in
the Tower--to whose levée, by
courtesy immemorial, we had a
prescriptive title to admission."

[return](#)

*And Tragedy, whatever stuff
he spoke
Now wants high heels, long
sword and velvet cloak...*

[MS L. (a) erased]

[return](#)

Footnote 65: Ý Lines 677, 678 are Footnote Uu: Ý
not in MS. L. (a).

[return](#)

*Curtail or silence the
offensive jest...*

[MS M.]

*Curtail the personal or
smutty jest...*

[MS L. (a) erased] [return](#)

Footnote 66: Ý Lines 689-696 are Footnote Vv: Ý
not in MS. L. (a) or MS. L. (b).

[return](#)

*Overthrow whole books with
all their hosts of faults...*

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

Footnote 67: Ý MS. L. (a and b)
continue at line 758.

[return](#)

Footnote Ww: Ý

*So that not Hellebore with all
its juice...*

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

Footnote 68: Ý

Footnote Xx: Ý

*"Tum quoque marmorea
caput a cervice revulsum,
Gurgite cum medio portans
OEagrius Hebrus,
Volveret Eurydicen vox ipsa,
et frigida lingua;
Ah, miseram Eurydicen!
animâ fugiente vocabat;
Eurydicen toto referebant
flumine ripæ."*

*I'll act instead of whetstone--
blunted, but
Of use to make another's
razor cut...*

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

[Georgic, iv. 523-527.]

[return](#)

Footnote 69: Ý I beg Nathaniel's

pardon: he is not a cobbler; *it* is a
tailor, but begged Capel Lofft to
sink the profession in his preface

to two pair of panta--psha!--of
cantos, which he wished the public

to try on; but the sieve of a patron

let it out, and so far saved the
expense of an advertisement to his
country customers--Merry's

"Moorfields whine" was nothing
to all this. The "Delia Cruscans"
were people of some education,

and no profession; but these

Arcadians ("Arcades ambo"--

bumpkins both) send out their

native nonsense without the

smallest alloy, and leave all the

shoes and small-clothes in the

parish unrepaired, to patch up

Elegies on Enclosures, and Pæans

to Gunpowder. Sitting on a shop-

board, they describe the fields of

battle, when the only blood they

ever saw was shed from the finger;

and an "Essay on War" is

produced by the ninth part of a

"poet;"

"And own that *nine* such
poets made a Tate."

Did Nathan ever read that line of
Pope? and if he did, why not take
it as his motto?

Footnote Yy: Ý

*From Horace show the better
arts of song...*

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

[*An Essay on War; Honington Green, a Ballad,. . . an Elegy and other Poems*, was published in 1803.]

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Footnote 70: Ý This well-meaning **Footnote Zz:** Ý

gentleman has spoiled some excellent shoemakers, and been accessory to the poetical undoing of many of the industrious poor.

Nathaniel Bloomfield and his brother Bobby have set all Somersetshire singing; nor has the

malady confined itself to one county. Pratt too (who once was wiser) has caught the contagion of patronage, and decoyed a poor fellow named Blackett into poetry; but he died during the operation, leaving one child and two volumes of "Remains" utterly destitute. The girl, if she don't take a poetical twist, and come forth as a shoemaking Sappho, may do well; but the "tragedies" are as rickety as if they had been the offspring of an Earl or a Seatonian prize poet.

The patrons of this poor lad are certainly answerable for his end; and it ought to be an indictable offence. But this is the least they have done: for, by a refinement of barbarity, they have made the (late) man posthumously ridiculous, by printing what he would have had sense enough

*To Trade, but gave their
hours to arms and arts...*

[MS L. (a)]

With traffic...

[MS L. (b)] [return](#)

never to print himself. Certes these rakers of "Remains" come under the statute against "resurrection men." What does it signify whether a poor dear dead dunce is to be stuck up in Surgeons' or in Stationers' Hall? Is it so bad to unearth his bones as his blunders? Is it not better to gibbet his body on a heath, than his soul in an octavo? "We know what we are, but we know not what we may be;" and it is to be hoped we never shall know, if a man who has passed through life with a sort of eclat is to find himself a mountebank on the other side of Styx, and made, like poor Joe Blackett, the laughing-stock of purgatory. The plea of publication is to provide for the child; now, might not some of this *Sutor ultra Crepidaitis* friends and seducers have done a decent action without inveigling Pratt into biography? And then his inscription split into so many modicums!-- "To the Duchess of Somuch, the Right Hon. So-and-So, and Mrs. and Miss Somebody, these volumes are," etc. etc.-- why, this is doling out the "soft milk of dedication" in gills,-- there is but a quart, and he divides it among a dozen. Why, Pratt, hadst thou not a puff left? Dost thou think six families of distinction can share this in quiet?

There is a child, a book, and a
dedication: send the girl to her
grace, the volumes to the grocer,
and the dedication to the devil.

[For Robert Bloomfield, see
English Bards, [ll. 774-786](#) (click
c6 to return), and [note 2](#). For
Joseph Blacket, see *English Bards*,
[ll. 765-770](#) (click c7 to return),
and [note 1](#). Blacket's *Remains*,
with Life by Pratt, appeared in
1811. The work was dedicated "To
Her Grace the Duchess of Leeds,
Lady Milbanke and Family,
Benevolent Patrons of the Author,"
etc.]

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Footnote 71: Ý Lines 737-758 are
not in either of the three original
MSS. of *Hints from Horace*, and
were probably written in the
autumn of 1811. They appear
among a sheet of "alterations to
English Bards, and *S. Reviewers*,
continued with additions" (MSS.
L.), drawn up for the fifth edition,
and they are inserted on a separate
sheet in *MS. M*. A second sheet
(MSS. *L.*) of "scraps of rhyme,...
principally additions and
corrections for *English Bards*,
etc." (for the fifth edition), some
of which are dated 1810, does not
give the whole passage, but
includes the following variants
(erased) of lines 753-756:--

Footnote aA: Ý

Babe of old Thellusson^A--...

[*MS L. (a) and (b)*]

Sub-Footnote A: [nbsp](#); Peter Isaac
Thellusson, banker (died July 21,
1797), by his will directed that his
property should accumulate for the
benefit of the unborn heir of an
unborn grandson. The will was,
finally, upheld, but, meanwhile, on
July 28, 1800, an act (39 and 40
Geo. III.c.98) was passed limiting
such executory devises.] [return to
poem](#)

(i.)

"Then let thy ponderous
quarto steep and stink,
The dullest fattest weed on
Lethe's brink.
Down with that volume to the
depths of hell!
Oblivion seems rewarding it
too well."

(ii.)

"Yet then thy quarto still
may," etc.

A "Druid" (see *English Bards*, [line 741](#) (click c10 to return)) was Byron's name for a scribbler who wrote for his living. In *MS. M.*, "scribbler" has been erased, and "Druid" substituted. It is doubtful to whom the passage, in its final shape, was intended to apply, but it is possible that the erased lines, in which "ponderous quarto" stands for "lost songs," were aimed at Southey (see *ante*, [line 657](#), [note 1](#)).
[return to poem](#)

Footnote 72: *ÝMS. L. (a)*
recommences at line 758.
[return](#)

Footnote bB: *Ý*

*A groat--ah bravo! Dick's the
boy for sums
He'll swell my fifty thousand
into plums...*

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

Footnote 73: Ý Here will Mr. Gifford allow me to introduce once more to his notice the sole survivor, the *ultimus Romanorum*, the last of the Cruscanti--"Edwin" the "profound" by our Lady of Punishment! here he is, as lively as in the days of "well said Baviad the Correct." I thought Fitzgerald had been the tail of poesy; but, alas! he is only the penultimate. **A Familiar Epistle to the Editor of the *Morning Chronicle*.**

"What reams of paper, floods of ink,"
Do some men spoil, who never think!
And so perhaps you'll say of me,
In which your readers may agree.
Still I write on, and tell you why;
Nothing's so bad, you can't deny,
But may instruct or entertain
Without the risk of giving pain, etc., etc.

Footnote cC: Ý

Are idle dogs and (damn them!) always poor...

[MS L. (a) and (b)]

[return](#)

On Some Modern Quacks and Reformists.

In tracing of the human mind
Through all its various
courses,
Though strange, 'tis true, we
often find
It knows not its resources:

And men through life assume
a part
For which no talents they
possess,
Yet wonder that, with all their
art,
They meet no better with
success, etc., etc.

[*A Familiar Epistle, etc.*, by T. Vaughan, Esq., was published in the *Morning Chronicle*, October 7, 1811. Gifford, in the *Baviad* (l. 350), speaks of "Edwin's mewlings," and in a note names "Edwin" as the "profound Mr. T. Vaughan." *Love's Metamorphoses*, by T. Vaughan, was played at Drury Lane, April 15, 1776. He also wrote *The Hotel, or Double Valet*, November 26, 1776, which Jephson rewrote under the title of *The Servant with Two Masters*. Compare *Children of Apollo*, p. 49:--

"Jephson, who has no
humour of his own,
Thinks it no crime to borrow
from the town;

The farce (almost forgot) of
The Hotel
Or *Double Valet* seems to
answer well.
This and his own make *Two*
Strings to his Bow."]

[return](#)

Footnote 74: Ý See Milton's
Lycidas.

[return](#)

Footnote dD: Ý

*Unlike Potosi holds no silver
mine...*

[MS L. (a)]

*Keeps back his ingots like/Is
rather costive--like/Is no
Potosi, but...an Irish Mine*

[MS L. (b)] [return](#)

Footnote 75: Ý Minerva being the
first by Jupiter's head-piece, and a
variety of equally unaccountable
parturitions upon earth, such as
Madoc, etc. etc.

[return](#)

Footnote eE: Ý

*Write but recite not, e'en
Apollo's song
Mouthed in a mortal ear
would seem too long,
Long as the last year of a
lingering lease,
When Revel pauses until
Rents increase...*

[MS M. erased]

[return](#)

Footnote 76: Ý

A crust for the critics....

Footnote fF: Ý

To finish all...

[MS L. (b)]

[Bayes, in "the Rehearsal", [act ii. sc. 2]]

[return](#)

Footnote 77: Ý And the "waiters" are the only fortunate people who can "fly" from them; all the rest, viz. the sad subscribers to the "Literary Fund," being compelled, by courtesy, to sit out the recitation without a hope of exclaiming, "Sic" (that is, by choking Fitz. with bad wine, or worse poetry) "me servavit Apollo!"

[See *English Bards*, [line 1](#) and [note 3](#).]

[return to poem](#)

Footnote 78: Ý Lines 813-816 not in *MS. L. (a)* or *MS. L. (b)*.

[return](#)

Footnote 79: Ý On his table were found these words:--"What Cato did, and Addison approved, cannot be wrong." But Addison did not "approve;" and if he had, it would not have mended the matter. He had invited his daughter on the same water-party; but Miss Budgell, by some accident, escaped this last paternal attention. Thus fell the sycophant of "Atticus," and the enemy of Pope!

That Bard the mask will fit...

[*MS L. (b)*] [return](#)

Footnote gG: Ý

*Revenge defeats its object in the dark
And pistols (courage bullies!) miss their mark...*

[*MS L. (a)*]

And pistols (courage duellists!) miss their mark...

[*MS L. (b)*] [return](#)

Footnote hH: Ý

Though much displeased...

[*MS L. (a) and (b)*]

[return](#)

Footnote jJ: Ý

The The scrutiny....

[*MS L. (a)*]

[return](#)

[Eustace Budgell (1686-1737), a friend and relative of Addison's, "leapt into the Thames" to escape the dishonour which attached to him in connection with Dr. Tindal's will, and the immediate pressure of money difficulties. He was, more or less, insane.

"We talked (says Boswell) of a man's drowning himself. I put the case of Eustace Budgell.

'Suppose, sir,' said I, 'that a man is absolutely sure that, if he lives a few days longer, he shall be detected in a fraud, the consequence of which will be utter disgrace, and expulsion from society?'

Johnson. 'Then, sir, let him go abroad to a distant country; let him go to some place where he is *not* known. Don't let him go to the devil, where he *is* known.'

Boswell's *Life of Johnson* (1886), p. 281.]

[return](#)

Footnote 80: Ý If "dosed with," etc. be censured as low, I beg leave to refer to the original for something still lower; and if any

Footnote kK: Ý

*Oh ye aspiring youths whom
fate or choice...*

reader will translate "Minxerit in
patrios cineres," etc. into a decent
couplet, I will insert said couplet
in lieu of the present.

[return](#)

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

Footnote mM: Ý

*All are not Erskines who
adorn the bar...*

[MS M.]

[return](#)

Footnote nN: Ý

*With very middling verses to
offend
The Devil and Jeffrey grant
but to a friend....*

[MS L. (a)]

*Though what "Gods, men,
and columns" interdict,
The Devil and Jeffrey^A
pardon--in a Pict....*

[MS M.]

Sub-Footnote A: ; "The Devil
and Jeffrey are here placed
antithetically to gods and men,
such being their usual position,
and their due one--according to
the facetious saying, 'If God won't
take you, the Devil must;' and I am
sure no one durst object to his
taking the poetry, which, rejected

by Horace, is accepted by Jeffrey. That these gentlemen are in some cases kinder,--the one to countrymen, and the other from his odd propensity to prefer evil to good,--than the 'gods, men, and columns' of Horace, may be seen by a reference to the review of Campbell's *Gertrude of Wyoming*; and in No. 31 of the *Edinburgh Review* (given to me the other day by the captain of an English frigate off Salamis), there is a similar concession to the mediocrity of Jamie Graham's *British Georgics*. It is fortunate for Campbell, that his fame neither depends on his last poem, nor the puff of the *Edinburgh Review*. The catalogues of our English are also less fastidious than the pillars of the Roman librarians. A word more with the author of *Gertrude of Wyoming*. At the end of a poem, and even of a couplet, we have generally 'that unmeaning thing we call a thought;' so Mr. Campbell concludes with a thought in such a manner as to fulfil the whole of Pope's prescription, and be as 'unmeaning' as the best of his brethren:--

'Because I may not *stain* with
grief

The death-song of an Indian
chief.'

"When I was in the fifth form, I carried to my master the translation of a chorus in Prometheus, wherein was a pestilent expression about 'staining a voice,' which met with no quarter. Little did I think that Mr. Campbell would have adopted my fifth form 'sublime'--at least in so conspicuous a situation. 'Sorrow' has been 'dry' (in proverbs), and 'wet' (in sonnets), this many a day; and now it '*stains*,' and stains a sound, of all feasible things! To be sure, death-songs might have been stained with that same grief to very good purpose, if Outalissi had clapped down his stanzas on wholesome paper for the *Edinburgh Evening Post*, or any other given hyperborean gazette; or if the said Outalissi had been troubled with the slightest second sight of his own notes embodied on the last proof of an overcharged quarto; but as he is supposed to have been an improvisatore on this occasion, and probably to the last tune he ever chanted in this world, it would have done him no discredit to have made his exit with a mouthful of common sense. Talking of '*staining*' (as Caleb Quotem says) 'puts me in mind' of

a certain couplet, which Mr.
Campbell will find in a writer for
whom he, and his school, have no
small contempt:--

'E'en copious Dryden wanted,
or forgot,
The last and greatest art--the
art to *blot!*' "

[MS. M.]

[return to this footnote](#) [return to poem](#)

Footnote pP: Ý

*And mustard rarely pleases in
a pie...*

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

Footnote qQ: Ý

At the Sessions...

[MS L. (b) in pencil]

[return](#)

Footnote rR: Ý Lines 647-650--

*Whose character contains no
glaring fault...
Shall I, I say...*

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

Footnote sS: Ý After 660--

*But why this hint-what author
e'er could stop*

*His poems' progress in a
Grocers shop....*

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

Footnote tT: Ý

*As lame as I am, but a better
bard...*

[MS M.]

[return](#)

Footnote uU: Ý

*Apollo's song the fate of men
foretold...*

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

Footnote vV: Ý

*Have studied with a Master
day and night...*

[MS L. (a, b)]

[return](#)

Footnote wW: Ý

*They storm Bolt Court, they
publish one and all...*

[MS M. erased]

[return](#)

Footnote xX: Ý

Rogers played this prank...

[MS M.]

[return](#)

Footnote yY: Ý

*There see their sonnets first--
but Spring--hot prest
Beholds a Quarto--Tarts must
tell the Rest....*

[MS M. erased]

[return](#)

Footnote zZ: Ý

*To fuddled Esquires or to
flippant Lords...*

[MS M.]

[return](#)

Footnote AA: Ý

*Till lo! that modern Midas of
the swains--
Feels his ears lengthen--with
the lengthening strains...*

[MS M. erased]

[return](#)

Footnote BB: Ý

*Adds a week's growth to his
enormous ears...*

[MS M. erased]

[return](#)

Footnote CC: Ý

*But what are these? Benefits
might bind
Some decent ties about a
manly mind...*

[MS M.]

[return](#)

Footnote DD: Ý

*Our modern sceptics can no
more allow....*

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

Footnote DD: Ý

*Some rhyming peer--Carlisle
or Carysfort^A...*

[MS Newstead]

Sub-Footnote A: nbsp; [To variant
ii. (p. 444) (this footnote) is
subjoined this note:

"Of 'John Joshua, Earl of
Carysfort,' I know nothing at
present, but from an
advertisement in an old
newspaper of certain Poems
and Tragedies by his
Lordship, which I saw by
accident in the Morea. Being
a rhymmer himself, he will
forgive the liberty I take with
his name, seeing, as he must,

how very commodious it is at
the close of that couplet; and
as for what follows and goes
before, let him place it to the
account of the other Thane;
since I cannot, under these
circumstances, augur pro or
con the contents of his
'foolscap crown octavos.'"

[John Joshua Proby, first Earl of
Carysfort, was joint postmaster-
general in 1805, envoy to Berlin in
1806, and ambassador to
Petersburgh in 1807. Besides his
poems (*Dramatic and
Miscellaneous Works*, 1810), he
published two pamphlets
(1780,1783), to show the necessity
of universal suffrage and short
parliaments. He died in 1828.]

[return to poem](#)

Footnote EE: Ý

*Hoarse with bepraising, and
half choaked with lies,
Sweat on his brow and tear
drops in his eyes...*

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

Footnote FF: Ý

*hen sits again, then shakes
his piteous head
As if the Vicar were already
dead....*

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

Footnote GG: Ý

*But if you're too conceited to
amend...*

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

Footnote HH: Ý

*On pain of suffering from
their pen or tongues...*

[MS M. erased]

fly Fitzgerald's lungs...

[MS M.] [return](#)

Footnote JJ: Ý

*Ah when Bards mouth! how
sympathetic Time
Stagnates, and Hours stand
still to hear their rhyme...*

[MS M. erased]

[return](#)

Footnote KK: Ý

*Besides how know ye? that he
did not fling
Himself there--for the
humour of the thing....*

[MS M.]

[return](#)

Footnote MM: Ý

*Small thanks, unwelcome life
he quickly leaves;
And raving poets--really
should not lose...*

[MS M.]

[return](#)

Footnote NN: Ý

*Nor is it clearly understood
that verse
Has not been given the poet
for a curse;
Perhaps he sent the parson's
pig to pound,
Or got a child on consecrated
ground;
But, be this as it may, his
rhyming rage
Exceeds a Bear who strives
to break his cage.
If free, all fly his versifying
fit;
The young, the old, the
simpleton and wit...*

[MS L. (a)]

[return](#)

The Curse of Minerva

--"Pallas te hoc vulnere, Pallas
Immolat, et poenam scelerato ex sanguine sumit."

Æneid, lib. xii. 947, 948.

Notes to this edition

Note 1

In *The Malediction of Minerva* (*New Monthly Magazine*, vol. iii. p. 240) additional footnotes are appended

1. to line 106, recording the obliteration of Lord Elgin's name, "which had been inscribed on a pillar of one of the principal temples," while that of Lady Elgin had been left untouched; and
2. to line 196, giving quotations from pp. 158, 269, 419 of Eustace's *Classical Tour in Italy*.

After line 130, which reads, "And well I know within that murky land" (*i.e.* Caledonia), the following apology for a hiatus was inserted:

"Here follows in the original certain lines which the editor has exercised his discretion by suppressing; inasmuch as they comprise national reflections which the bard's justifiable indignation has made him pour forth against a people which, if

not universally of an amiable, is generally of a respectable character, and deserves not in this case to be censured *en masse* for the faults of an individual."

Note 2

The text of *The Curse of Minerva* is based on that of the quarto printed by T. Davison in 1813. With the exception of the variants, as noted, the text corresponds with the MS. in the possession of Lord Stanhope. Doubtless it represents Byron's final revision. The text of an edition of *The Curse, etc.*, Philadelphia, 1815, 8vo [printed by De Silver and Co.], was followed by Galignani (third edit., 1818, etc.). The same text is followed, but not invariably, in the selections printed by Hone in 1816 (111 lines); Wilson, 1818 (112 lines); and Knight and Lacy, 1824 (111 lines). It exhibits the following variants from the quarto of 1813:--

Line Variant

- 56 ---- *lands and main.*
- 81 *Her helm was deep indented and her lance.*
- 94 *Seek'st thou the cause? O mortal, look around.*
- 102 *That Hadrian ----*
- 116 *The last base brute ----*
- 143 *Ten thousand schemes of petulance and pride.*
- 152 ----*victors o'er the grave.*
- 162 ----*Time shall tell the rest.*
- 199 *Loath'd throughout life--scarce pardon'd in the dust.*
- 203 *Erostratus and Elgin, etc.*
- 206 ----*viler than the first.*
- 222 *Shall shake your usurpation to its base.*
- 233 *While Lusitania ----*
- 273 *Then in the Senates ----*

290 ---- *decorate his fall.*

The following variants may also be noted:--

Line	Variant	Publisher
1	<i>Slow sinks now lovely, etc.--</i>	Hone
110	<i>The Gothic monarch and the British----</i>	Hone
110	<i>----and his fit compeer</i>	Wilson
131	<i>And well I know within that murky land.</i>	Hone
	...	
	<i>Dispatched her reckoning children far and wide.</i>	
131	<i>And well I know, albeit afar, the land, Where starving Avarice keeps her chosen band; Or sends their hungry numbers eager forth.</i>	Wilson
	...	
	<i>And aye accursed, etc.</i>	

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Introduction to *The Curse of Minerva*

The Curse of Minerva, which was written at Athens, and is dated March 17, 1811, remained unpublished, as a whole, in this country, during Byron's life-time. The arrangement which had been made with Cawthorn, to bring out a fifth edition of *English Bards*, included the issue of a separate volume, containing *Hints from Horace* and *The Curse of Minerva*; and, as Moore intimates, it was the withdrawal of

the latter, in deference to the wishes of Lord Elgin or his connections, which led to the suppression of the other satires.

The quarto edition of *The Curse of Minerva*, printed by T. Davison in 1812, was probably set up at the same time as Murray's quarto edition of *Childe Harold*, and reserved for private circulation. With or without Byron's consent, the poem as a whole was published in Philadelphia by De Silver and Co., 1815, 8vo (for variants, see p. 453, [note](#)). In a letter to Murray, March 6, 1816, he says that he "disowns" *The Curse, etc.*, "as stolen and published in a miserable and villainous copy in the magazine." The reference is to *The Malediction of Minerva, or The Athenian Marble-Market*, which appeared in the *New Monthly Magazine* for April, 1818, vol. iii. 240. It numbers 111 lines, and is signed "Steropes" (The Lightner, a Cyclops). The text of the magazine, with the same additional footnotes, but under the title of *The Curse, etc.*, was republished in the eighth edition of *Poems on His Domestic Circumstances*, W. Hone, London, 1816, 8vo, and, thenceforth, in other piratical issues. Whatever may have been his feelings or intentions in 1812, four years later Byron was well aware that *The Curse of Minerva* would not increase his reputation as a poet, while the object of his satire--the exposure and denunciation of Lord Elgin--had been accomplished by the scathing stanzas (canto ii. 10-15), with their accompanying note, in *Childe Harold*. "Disown" it as he might, his words were past recall, and both indictments stand in his name.

Byron was prejudiced against Elgin before he started on his tour. He had, perhaps, glanced at the splendid folio, *Specimens of Ancient Sculpture*, which was issued by the Dilettanti Society in 1809. Payne Knight wrote the preface, in which he maintains that the friezes and metopes of the Parthenon were not the actual work of Phidias, "but ... architectural studies ... probably by workmen scarcely ranked among artists." So judged the leader of the *cognoscenti*, and, in accordance with his views, Elgin and Aberdeen are held up to ridicule in *English Bards* (second edition, October, 1809, [l. 1007](#) (click c13 to return), and [note](#)) as credulous and extravagant collectors of "maimed antiques." It was, however, not till the first visit to Athens (December, 1809-March, 1810), when he saw with his own eyes the "ravages of barbarous and

antiquarian despoilers" (Lord Broughton's *Travels in Albania*, 1858, i. 259), that contempt gave way to indignation, and his wrath found vent in the pages of *Childe Harold*.

Byron cared as little for ancient buildings as he did for the authorities, or for patriotic enterprise, but he was stirred to the quick by the marks of fresh and, as he was led to believe, wanton injury to "Athena's poor remains." The southern side of the half-wrecked Parthenon had been deprived of its remaining metopes, which had suffered far less from the weather than the other sides which are still in the building; all that remained of the frieze had been stripped from the three sides of the cella, and the eastern pediment had been despoiled of its diminished and mutilated, but still splendid, group of figures; and, though five or six years had gone by, the blank spaces between the triglyphs must have revealed their recent exposure to the light, and the shattered edges of the cornice, which here and there had been raised and demolished to permit the dislodgment of the metopes, must have caught the eye as they sparkled in the sun. Nor had the removal and deportation of friezes and statues come to an end. The firman which Dr. Hunt, the chaplain to the embassy, had obtained in 1801, which empowered Elgin and his agents to take away *qualche pezzi di pietra*, still ran, and Don Tita Lusieri, the Italian artist, who remained in Elgin's service, was still, like the *canes venatici* (Americané, "smell-dogs") employed by Verres in Sicily (see *Childe Harold*, canto ii. st. 12, *note*), finding fresh relics, and still bewailing to sympathetic travellers the hard fate which compelled him to despoil the temples *malgré lui*. The feelings of the inhabitants themselves were not much in question, but their opinions were quoted for and against the removal of the marbles. Elgin's secretary and prime agent, W.R. Hamilton, testifies, from personal knowledge, that, "so far from exciting any unpleasant sensations, the people seemed to feel it as the means of bringing foreigners into the country, and of having money spent there" (*Memoir on the Earl of Elgin's Pursuits in Greece*, 1811). On the other hand, the traveller, Edward Daniel Clarke, with whom Byron corresponded (see *Childe Harold*, canto ii. st. 12, *note*), speaks of the attachment of the Turks to the Parthenon, and their religious veneration for the building as a mosque, and tells a pathetic story of the grief of

the Disdar when "a metope was lowered, and the adjacent masonry scattered its white fragments with thundering noise among the ruins" (*Travels in Various Countries*, part ii. sect. ii. p. 483).

Other travellers of less authority than Clarke--Dodwell, for instance, who visited the Parthenon before it had been dismantled, and, afterwards, was present at the removal of metopes; and Hughes, who came after Byron (autumn, 1813)--make use of such phrases as "shattered desolation," "wanton devastation and avidity of plunder." Even Michaelis, the great archaeologist, who denounces *The Curse of Minerva* as a "libellous poem," and affirms "that only blind passion could doubt that Lord Elgin's act was an act of preservation," admits that "the removal of several metopes and of the statue from the Erechtheion had severely injured the surrounding architecture" (*Ancient Marbles in Great Britain*, by A. Michaelis, translated by C.A.M. Fennell, 1882, p. 135). Highly coloured and emotional as some of these phrases may be, they explain, if they do not justify, the *sæva indignatio* of Byron's satire.

It is almost, if not quite, unnecessary to state the facts on the other side. History regards Lord Elgin as a disinterested official, who at personal loss (at least thirty-five thousand pounds on his own showing), and in spite of opposition and disparagement, secured for his own country and the furtherance of art the perishable fragments of Phidian workmanship, which, but for his intervention, might have perished altogether. If they had eluded the clutches of Turkish mason and Greek dealer in antiquities--if, by some happy chance, they had escaped the ravages of war, the gradual but gradually increasing assaults of rain and frost would have already left their effacing scars on the "Elgin marbles." As it is, the progress of decay has been arrested, and all the world is the gainer. Byron was neither a prophet nor an archaeologist, and time and knowledge have put him in the wrong. But in 1810 the gaps in the entablature of the Parthenon were new, the Phidian marbles were huddled in a "damp dirty penthouse" in Park Lane (see *Life of Haydon*, i. 84), and the logic of events had not justified a sad necessity.

The Curse of Minerva

*Pallas te hoc Vulnere Pallas
Immolat et poenam scelerato ex Sanguine Sumit.*

Athens: Capuchin Convent, March 17, 1811.

Slow sinks, more lovely ere his race be run¹,
Along Morea's hills the setting Sun;
Not, as in northern climes, obscurely bright,
But one unclouded blaze of living light;
O'er the hushed deep the yellow beam he throws^a,
Gilds the green wave that trembles as it glows;
On old Ægina's rock and Hydra's isle²
The God of gladness sheds his parting smile;
O'er his own regions lingering loves to shine,
Though there his altars are no more divine^b.
Descending fast, the mountain-shadows kiss
Thy glorious Gulf, unconquered Salamis!
Their azure arches through the long expanse^c,
More deeply purpled, meet his mellowing glance,
And tenderest tints, along their summits driven,

Mark his gay course, and own the hues of Heaven;
Till, darkly shaded from the land and deep,
Behind his Delphian rock he sinks to sleep^d.

On such an eve his palest beam he cast
When, Athens! here thy Wisest looked his last. 20
How watched thy better sons his farewell ray,
That closed their murdered Sage's³ latest day!
Not yet--not yet--Sol pauses on the hill,
The precious hour of parting lingers still;
But sad his light to agonizing eyes,
And dark the mountain's once delightful dyes;
Gloom o'er the lovely land he seemed to pour,
The land where Phoebus never frowned before;
But ere he sunk below Cithaeron's head,
The cup of Woe was quaffed--the Spirit fled; 30
The soul of Him that scorned to fear or fly^e,
Who lived and died as none can live or die.

But lo! from high Hymettus to the plain
The Queen of Night asserts her silent reign;^{4 f}
No murky vapour, herald of the storm^g,
Hides her fair face, or girds her glowing form;
With cornice glimmering as the moonbeams play,
There the white column greets her grateful ray,
And bright around, with quivering beams beset,
Her emblem sparkles o'er the Minaret; 40
The groves of olive scattered dark and wide,
Where meek Cephissus sheds his scanty tide,
The cypress saddening by the sacred mosque,
The gleaming turret of the gay kiosk⁵,
And sad and sombre 'mid the holy calm,
Near Theseus' fane, yon solitary palm;
All, tinged with varied hues, arrest the eye;
And dull were his that passed them heedless by⁶.
Again the Ægean, heard no more afar,

Lulls his chafed breast from elemental war:
Again his waves in milder tints unfold 50
Their long expanse of sapphire and of gold,
Mixed with the shades of many a distant isle
That frown, where gentler Ocean deigns to smile^h.

As thus, within the walls of Pallas' fane,
I marked the beauties of the land and main,
Alone, and friendless, on the magic shore,
Whose arts and arms but live in poets' lore;
Oft as the matchless dome I turned to scan,
Sacred to Gods, but not secure from Man,
The Past returned, the Present seemed to cease, 60
And Glory knew no clime beyond her Greece!

Hour rolled along, and Dian's orb on high
Had gained the centre of her softest sky;
And yet unwearied still my footsteps trod
O'er the vain shrine of many a vanished Godⁱ:
But chiefly, Pallas! thine, when Hecate's glare
Checked by thy columns, fell more sadly fair
O'er the chill marble, where the startling tread
Thrills the lone heart like echoes from the dead.
Long had I mused, and treasured every trace 70
The wreck of Greece recorded of her race,
When, lo! a giant-form before me strode,
And Pallas hailed me in her own Abode!

Yes,'twas Minerva's self; but, ah! how changed,
Since o'er the Dardan field in arms she ranged!
Not such as erst, by her divine command,
Her form appeared from Phidias' plastic hand:
Gone were the terrors of her awful brow,
Her idle Ægis bore no Gorgon now;
Her helm was dented, and the broken lance 80
Seemed weak and shaftless e'en to mortal glance;
The Olive Branch, which still she deigned to clasp,

Shrunk from her touch, and withered in her grasp;
And, ah! though still the brightest of the sky,
Celestial tears bedimmed her large blue eye;
Round the rent casque her owlet circled slow,
And mourned his mistress with a shriek of woe!

"Mortal!"--'twas thus she spake--"that blush of shame
Proclaims thee Briton, once a noble name;
First of the mighty, foremost of the free^k, 90
Now honoured *less* by all, and *least* by me:
Chief of thy foes shall Pallas still be found.
Seek'st thou the cause of loathing!--look around.
Lo! here, despite of war and wasting fire,
I saw successive Tyrannies expire;
'Scaped from the ravage of the Turk and Goth^m,
Thy country sends a spoiler worse than both.
Survey this vacant, violated fane;
Recount the relics torn that yet remain:
These Cecrops placed, *this* Pericles adorned⁷, 100
That Adrian reared when drooping Science mourned.
What more I owe let Gratitude attest--
Know, Alaric and Elgin did the rest.
That all may learn from whence the plunderer came,
The insulted wall sustains his hated name⁸:
For Elgin's fame thus grateful Pallas pleads,
Below, his name--above, behold his deeds!
Be ever hailed with equal honour here
The Gothic monarch and the Pictish peerⁿ:
Arms gave the first his right, the last had none, 110
But basely stole what less barbarians won.
So when the Lion quits his fell repast,
Next prowls the Wolf, the filthy Jackal last^o:
Flesh, limbs, and blood the former make their own,
The last poor brute securely gnaws the bone.
Yet still the Gods are just, and crimes are crossed:
See here what Elgin won, and what he lost!

Another name with *his* pollutes my shrine:
Behold where Dian's beams disdain to shine!
Some retribution still might Pallas claim,
When Venus half avenged Minerva's shame."⁹ 120

She ceased awhile, and thus I dared reply,
To soothe the vengeance kindling in her eye:
"Daughter of Jove! in Britain's injured name^p,
A true-born Briton may the deed disclaim.
Frown not on England; England owns him not:
Athena, no! thy plunderer was a Scot.
Ask'st thou the difference? From fair Phyles' towers
Survey Boeotia;--Caledonia's ours.
And well I know within that bastard land¹⁰ 130
Hath Wisdom's goddess never held command;
A barren soil, where Nature's germs, confined
To stern sterility, can stint the mind;
Whose thistle well betrays the niggard earth,
Emblem of all to whom the Land gives birth;
Each genial influence nurtured to resist;
A land of meanness, sophistry, and mist^q.
Each breeze from foggy mount and marshy plain
Dilutes with drivel every drizzly brain,
Till, burst at length, each wat'ry head o'erflows, 140
Foul as their soil, and frigid as their snows:
Then thousand schemes of petulance and pride
Despatch her scheming children far and wide;
Some East, some West, some--everywhere but North!
In quest of lawless gain, they issue forth.
And thus--accursed be the day and year!
She sent a Pict to play the felon here.
Yet Caledonia claims some native worth¹¹,
As dull Boeotia gave a Pindar birth;
So may her few, the lettered and the brave,
Bound to no clime, and victors of the grave, 150
Shake off the sordid dust of such a land,

And shine like children of a happier strand;
As once, of yore, in some obnoxious place,
Ten names (if found) had saved a wretched race."

"Mortal!" the blue-eyed maid resumed, "once more
Bear back my mandate to thy native shore.¹²
Though fallen, alas! this vengeance yet is mine,
To turn my counsels far from lands like thine.
Hear then in silence Pallas' stern behest;
Hear and believe, for Time will tell the rest. 160

"First on the head of him who did this deed
My curse shall light,--on him and all his seed:
Without one spark of intellectual fire,
Be all the sons as senseless as the sire:
If one with wit the parent brood disgrace,
Believe him bastard of a brighter race:
Still with his hireling artists let him prate,
And Folly's praise repay for Wisdom's hate;
Long of their Patron's gusto let them tell,
Whose noblest, *native* gusto is--to sell: 170
To sell, and make--may shame record the day!--
The State--Receiver of his pilfered prey.
Meantime, the flattering, feeble dotard, West,
Europe's worst dauber, and poor Britain's best,
With palsied hand shall turn each model o'er,
And own himself an infant of fourscore.¹³
Be all the Bruisers culled from all St. Giles',
That Art and Nature may compare their styles^r;
While brawny brutes in stupid wonder stare, 180
And marvel at his Lordship's 'stone shop' there.¹⁴
Round the thronged gate shall sauntering coxcombs creep
To lounge and lucubrate, to prate and peep;
While many a languid maid, with longing sigh,
On giant statues casts the curious eye;
The room with transient glance appears to skim,
Yet marks the mighty back and length of limb;

Mourns o'er the difference of *now* and *then*;
Exclaims, 'These Greeks indeed were proper men!'
Draws slight comparisons of *these* with *those*,^s
And envies Laïs all her Attic beaux. 190

When shall a modern maid have swains like these?^t
Alas! Sir Harry is no Hercules!
And last of all, amidst the gaping crew,
Some calm spectator, as he takes his view,
In silent indignation mixed with grief,
Admires the plunder, but abhors the thief.
Oh, loathed in life, nor pardoned in the dust,
May Hate pursue his sacrilegious lust!
Linked with the fool that fired the Ephesian dome,
Shall vengeance follow far beyond the tomb,¹⁵ 200
And Eratostratus¹⁶ and Elgin shine
In many a branding page and burning line;
Alike reserved for aye to stand accursed,
Perchance the second blacker than the first.

"So let him stand, through ages yet unborn,
Fixed statue on the pedestal of Scorn;
Though not for him alone revenge shall wait,
But fits thy country for her coming fate:
Hers were the deeds that taught her lawless son
To do what oft Britannia's self had done. 210
Look to the Baltic--blazing from afar,
Your old Ally yet mourns perfidious war.¹⁷
Not to such deeds did Pallas lend her aid,
Or break the compact which herself had made;
Far from such counsels, from the faithless field
She fled--but left behind her Gorgon shield;
A fatal gift that turned your friends to stone,
And left lost Albion hated and alone.

"Look to the East,¹⁸ where Ganges' swarthy race
Shall shake your tyrant empire to its base; 220

Lo! there Rebellion rears her ghastly head,
And glares the Nemesis of native dead;
Till Indus rolls a deep purpureal flood,
And claims his long arrear of northern blood.
So may ye perish!--Pallas, when she gave
Your free-born rights, forbade ye to enslave.

"Look on your Spain!--she clasps the hand she hates,
But boldly clasps, and thrusts you from her gates.
Bear witness, bright Barossa!¹⁹ thou canst tell
Whose were the sons that bravely fought and fell.
But Lusitania, kind and dear ally,
Can spare a few to fight, and sometimes fly.
Oh glorious field! by Famine fiercely won,
The Gaul retires for once, and all is done!
But when did Pallas teach, that one retreat
Retrieved three long Olympiads of defeat?

230

"Look last at home--ye love not to look there
On the grim smile of comfortless despair:
Your city saddens: loud though Revel howls,
Here Famine faints, and yonder Rapine prowls.
See all alike of more or less bereft;
No misers tremble when there's nothing left.
'Blest paper credit;²⁰ who shall dare to sing?
It clogs like lead Corruption's weary wing.
Yet Pallas pluck'd each Premier by the ear,
Who Gods and men alike disdained to hear;
But one, repentant o'er a bankrupt state,
On Pallas calls,--but calls, alas! too late:
Then raves for '——'; to that Mentor bends,
Though he and Pallas never yet were friends.
Him senates hear, whom never yet they heard,
Contemptuous once, and now no less absurd.
So, once of yore, each reasonable frog,
Swore faith and fealty to his sovereign 'log.'
Thus hailed your rulers their patrician clod,

240

250

As Egypt chose an onion^{[21](#)} for a God.

"Now fare ye well! enjoy your little hour;
Go, grasp the shadow of your vanished power; [c13](#)
Gloss o'er the failure of each fondest scheme;
Your strength a name, your bloated wealth a dream.
Gone is that Gold, the marvel of mankind. 260
And Pirates barter all that's left behind.^{[22](#)}
No more the hirelings, purchased near and far,
Crowd to the ranks of mercenary war.
The idle merchant on the useless quay
Droops o'er the bales no bark may bear away;
Or, back returning, sees rejected stores
Rot piecemeal on his own encumbered shores:
The starved mechanic breaks his rusting loom,
And desperate mans him 'gainst the coming doom.
Then in the Senates of your sinking state
Show me the man whose counsels may have weight. 270
Vain is each voice where tones could once command;
E'en factions cease to charm a factious land:
Yet jarring sects convulse a sister Isle,
And light with maddening hands the mutual pile.

""Tis done, 'tis past--since Pallas warns in vain;
The Furies seize her abdicated reign:
Wide o'er the realm they wave their kindling brands,
And wring her vitals with their fiery hands.
But one convulsive struggle still remains,^{[u](#)} 280
And Gaul shall weep ere Albion wear her chains,
The bannered pomp of war, the glittering files,^{[v](#)}
O'er whose gay trappings stern Bellona smiles;
The brazen trump, the spirit-stirring drum,
That bid the foe defiance ere they come;
The hero bounding at his country's call,
The glorious death that consecrates his fall,
Swell the young heart with visionary charms.
And bid it antedate the joys of arms.

But know, a lesson you may yet be taught,
 With death alone are laurels cheaply bought; 290
 Not in the conflict Havoc seeks delight,
 His day of mercy is the day of fight.
 But when the field is fought, the battle won,
 Though drenched with gore, his woes are but begun:
 His deeper deeds as yet ye know by name;
 The slaughtered peasant and the ravished dame,
 The rifled mansion and the foe-reaped field,
 Ill suit with souls at home, untaught to yield.
 Say with what eye along the distant down
 Would flying burghers mark the blazing town? 300
 How view the column of ascending flames
 Shake his red shadow o'er the startled Thames?
 Nay, frown not, Albion! for the torch was thine
 That lit such pyres from Tagus to the Rhine:
 Now should they burst on thy devoted coast,
 Go, ask thy bosom who deserves them most?
 The law of Heaven and Earth is life for life,
 And she who raised, in vain regrets, the strife."

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Footnote 1: Ý The lines (1-54) with which the Satire begins,
 down to "As thus, within the walls of Pallas' fane," first appeared
 (1814) as the opening stanza of the [MS.^A]
 Third Canto of *The Corsair*. At that time the publication of *The
 Curse of Minerva* had been abandoned. (See Byron's *note* to
The Corsair, Canto III. st. i. line

Footnote a: Ý *O'er the blue ocean way his...*
Sub-Footnote A: ; The only MS. of *The Curse of Minerva*
 which the editor has seen, is in the possession of the Earl of

i.)

[return to footnote mark](#)

Stanhope. A second MS., formerly in the possession of the Duke of Newcastle, is believed to have perished in a fire which broke out at Clumber in 1879.

[return to poem](#)

Footnote 2: Ý Idra; *The Corsair*, III. st. i. line 7. Hydra, or Hydrea, is an island on the east coast of the Peloponnese, between the gulfs of Nauplia and Ægina. As an "isle of Greece" it had almost no history until the War of Independence, when its chief town became a "city of refuge" for the inhabitants of the Morea and Northern Greece. Byron was, perhaps, the first poet to give it a name in song.

[return](#)

Footnote 3: Ý Socrates drank the hemlock a short time before sunset (the hour of execution), notwithstanding the entreaties of his disciples to wait till the sun went down.

[return](#)

Footnote 4: Ý The twilight in Greece is much shorter than in our own country; the days in winter are longer, but in summer of less duration.

[return](#)

Footnote 5: Ý The kiosk is a Turkish summer-house; the palm is without the present walls of

Footnote b: Ý

Nor yet forbears each long-abandoned shrine...

[MS.]

[return](#)

Footnote c: Ý

*Their varying azure mingled with the sky
Beneath his rays assumes a deeper dye...*

[MS.]

[return](#)

Footnote d: Ý

Behind his Delphian cliff...

[*Corsair*, III. st. i. l. 18.]

[return](#)

Footnote e: Ý

The soul of him who...

Athens, not far from the temple of Theseus, between which and the tree the wall intervenes. Cephissus' stream is indeed scanty, and Ilissus has no stream at all.

[return](#)

Footnote 6: Ý

"The Temple of Theseus is the most perfect ancient edifice in the world. In this fabric, the most enduring stability, and a simplicity of design peculiarly striking, are united with the highest elegance and accuracy of workmanship."

Travels in Albania, etc., by Lord Broughton (1858), i. 259.

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Footnote 7: Ý This is spoken of the city in general, and not of the Acropolis in particular. The temple of Jupiter Olympius, by some supposed the Pantheon, was finished by Hadrian; sixteen columns are standing, of the most beautiful marble and architecture.

[return](#)

Footnote 8: Ý The following lines, of which the first two were written on the original *MS.*, are in Byron's handwriting:--

"Aspice quos Scoto Pallas
concedit honores;

Footnote f: Ý

silver reign...

[*MS.*]

[return](#)

Footnote g: Ý

*How sweet and Silent, not a
passing cloud
Hides her fair face with
intervening shroud...*

[*MS.*]

[return](#)

Footnote h: Ý

seems to smile...

[*Corsair*, III. st. i. 1. 54.]

[return](#)

Subter stat nomen, facta
superque vide.
Scote miser! quamvis
nocuisti Palladis ædi,
Infandum facinus vindicat
ipsa Venus.
Pygmalion statuam pro
sponsâ arsisse refertur;
Tu statuam rapias, Scote, sed
uxor abest."

Compare *Horace in London*, by
the authors of *Rejected Addresses*
(James and Horace Smith),
London, 1813, ode xv., "The
Parthenon," "*Pastor quum traheret
per freta navibus.*"

"And Hymen shall thy
nuptial hopes consume,
Unless, like fond Pygmalion,
thou canst wed
Statues thy hand could never
give to bloom.
In wifeless wedlock shall thy
life be led,
No marriage joys to bless thy
solitary bed."

[Lord Elgin's first marriage with
Mary, daughter of William
Hamilton Nisbet, was dissolved by
Act of Parliament in 1808.]

[return](#)

Footnote 9: Ý His lordship's name, **Footnote j:** Ý
and that of one who no longer
bears it, are carved conspicuously *Sad shrine...*

on the Parthenon; above, in a part [MS.]
not far distant, are the torn [return](#)
remnants of the bassorelievos,
destroyed in a vain attempt to
remove them.

[On the Erechtheum there was
deeply cut in a plaster wall the
words--

**"Quod Non Fecerunt Goti,
Hoc Fecerunt Scoti."]**

[return](#)

Footnote 10: Ý "Irish bastards,"
according to Sir Callaghan
O'Brallaghan. ["A wild Irish
soldier in the Prussian Army," in
Macklin's *Love-à-la-Mode* (first
played December 12, 1759).]

[return](#)

Footnote 11: Ý Lines 149-156 not
in original MS.

[return](#)

Footnote k: Ý

*Welcome to slaves, and
foremost...*

[MS.]

[return](#)

Footnote m: Ý

*Ah, Athens! scarce escaped
from Turk and Goth,
Hell sends a paltry
Scotchman worse than
both....*

[MS.]

[return](#)

Footnote 12: Ý Compare *Horace*
in London, ode xv.--

Footnote n: Ý

British peer...

"All who behold my
mutilated pile,
Shall brand its ravages with

[MS.]

[return](#)

classic rage;
And soon a titled bard from
Britain's isle
Thy country's praise and
suffrage shall engage,
And fire with Athens' wrongs
an angry age."

[return](#)

Footnote 13: Ý Mr. West, on
seeing the "Elgin Collection," (I
suppose we shall hear of the
"Abershaw" and "Jack Shephard"
collection) declared himself a
"mere tyro" in art.

Footnote o: Ý

Sneaking Jackal...

[MS.]

[return](#)

[Compare Letters of Benjamin
West to the Earl of Elgin, February
6, 1809, March 20, 1811,
published in W.R. Hamilton's
Memorandum, 1811.]

[return](#)

Footnote 14: Ý Poor Crib was
sadly puzzled when the marbles
were first exhibited at Elgin
House; he asked if it was not "a
stone shop?"--He was right; it is a
shop.

Footnote p: Ý

guilty name...

[MS.]

[return](#)

[return](#)

Footnote 15: Ý Lines 202-265 are
not in the MS.

Footnote q: Ý

*A land of liars, mountebanks,
and Mist...*

[MS.]

[return](#)

Footnote 16: Ý Herostratus or Eratostratus fired the temple of Artemis on the same night that Alexander the Great was born. (See Plut., *Alex.*, 3, etc.)

[return](#)

Footnote 17: Ý The affair of Copenhagen. Copenhagen was bombarded by sea by Admiral Lord Gambier (1756-1833), and by land by General Lord Cathcart (1755-1843), September 2-8, 1807. The citadel was given up to the English, and the Danes surrendered their fleet, with all the naval stores, and their arsenals and dockyards. The expedition was "promptly and secretly equipped" by the British Government "with an activity and celerity," says Koch (*Hist. of Europe*, p. 214), "such as they had never displayed in sending aid to their allies," with a view to anticipate the seizure and appropriation of the Danish fleet by Napoleon and Alexander (Green's *Hist. English People* (1875), p. 799).

[return](#)

Footnote 18: Ý "The East" is brought within range of Minerva's curse, *symmetriae causâ*, and it is hard to say to which "rebellion" she refers. A choice lies between the mutiny which broke out in 1809, during Sir George Barlow's

Footnote r: Ý

*That Art may measure old
and modern styles...*

[MS.]

[return](#)

Footnote s: Ý

shy comparisons...

[MS.]

[return](#)

Footnote t: Ý

*In sooth the Nymph 'twere no
slight task to please
Since young Sir Harry, etc....*

presidency of Madras, among the [MS.]
officers of the Company's service, [return](#)
and which at one time threatened
the continuance of British sway in
India; and later troubles, in 1810,
arising from the Pindárí hordes,
who laid waste the villages of
Central India and Hindostan, and
from the Pathans, who invaded
Berar under Ameer Khan. But
here, as in [lines 245-258](#) (click on
c13 to return) (*vide infra*, p. 470,
[note i](#)), Byron is taking toll of a
note to *Epics of the Ton*, pp. 246,
247, which enlarges on the mutiny
of native soldiers which took place
at Vellore in 1806, where several
"European officers and a
considerable portion of the 69th
Regiment were massacred," in
consequence of "an injudicious
order with respect to the dress of
the Sepoys."--Gleig's *History of
the British Empire in India* (1835),
iii. 233, *note.x*

[return](#)

Footnote 19: Ý The victory of
"bright Barossa," March 5, 1811,
was achieved by the sudden
determination--"an inspiration
rather than a resolution," says
Napier--of the British commander,
General Graham (Thomas, Lord
Lynedoch, 1750-1843), to counter- [MS.]
march his troops, and force the
eminence known as the Cerro de
Puerco, or hill of Barosa, which

Footnote u: Ý

*Fallen is each dear bought
friend on Foreign Coast
Or leagued to add you to the
world you lost...*

[MS.]
[return](#)

had fallen into the hands of the French under Ruffin. Graham was at this time second in command to the Spanish Captain-general, La Peña, and at his orders, but under the impression that the hill would be guarded by the Spanish troops, was making his way to a neighbouring height. Meantime La Peña had withdrawn the corps of battle to a distance, and left the hill covered with baggage and imperfectly protected. Graham recaptured Barosa, and repulsed the French with heavy loss, in an hour and a half. Napier affirms that La Peña "looked idly on, neither sending his cavalry nor his horse artillery to the assistance of his ally;" and testifies "that no stroke in aid of the British was struck by a Spanish sabre that day."

"Famine" may have raised the devil in the English troops, but it prevented them from following up the victory. A further charge against the Spaniards was that, after Barosa had been won, the English were left for hours without food, and, as they had marched through the night before they came into action, they could only look on while the French made good their retreat.

Two companies of the 20th Portuguese formed part of the British contingent, and took part in the engagement. The year before, at Busaco (September 27, 1810), the Portuguese had displayed signal bravery; but at Gebora (February 19, 1811) "Madden's Portuguese, regardless of his example and reproaches, shamefully turned their backs" (Napier's *History of the Peninsular War* (1890), iii. 26, 98, 102-107).

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Footnote 20: Ý

"Blest paper credit! last and best supply,
That lends Corruption lighter wings to fly."

(Pope.)

Footnote v: Ý

---the glittering file
The martial sounds that
animate the while...

[MS.]

[return](#)

[In February, 1811, a select committee of the House of Commons "on commercial credit" recommended an advance of £6,000,000 to manufacturers who were suffering from over-speculation.

"Did they not know," asked Lord Grenville, in the House of Lords, March 21, "that they were adding to the mass of paper at this moment in existence a sum of

£6,000,000, as if there was not paper enough already in the country, in order to protect their commerce and manufactures from destruction?"

Nevertheless, the measure passed. The year before (February 19, 1810), a committee which had sat under the presidency of Francis Horner, to inquire into the cause of the high price of gold bullion (gold was worth £4. 10s. an ounce), returned (June 10) a report urging the resumption of cash payment at the end of two years.

It has been suggested to the editor that the asterisks ('——') in line 251 (which are not filled up in Lord Stanhope's MS. of *The Curse of Minerva*) stand for "Horner," and that Byron, writing at Athens in March, 1811, was under the impression that Perceval would adopt sound views on the currency question, and was not aware that he was strongly anti-bullionist. On that supposition the two premiers are Portland and Perceval, Horner is the Mentor, and Perceval (line 257) the "patrician clod." To what extent Byron was *au courant* with home politics when he wrote the lines, it is impossible to say, and without such knowledge some

doubt must rest on any
interpretation of the passage. But
of its genesis there is no doubt.
Lady Ann Hamilton, in her
estimate of Lord Henry Petty, in
Epics of the Ton (p. 139), has
something to say on budget
"figures"--

"Those imps which make the
senses reel, and zounds!
Mistake a cypher for a
thousand pounds;"

and her note-writer comments
thus: "It somewhat hurts the
feelings to see a minister stand up
in his place, and after a very pretty
exordium to the budget, take up a
bundle of papers from the table,
gaze at the incomprehensible
calculations before him, stammer
out a few confused numbers, and
then, with a rueful face, look over
his shoulder to V--ns--rt for
assistance. How often have I
grieved to see unhappy A--d--g--n
in this lamentable predicament!"
Again, on Thellusson being raised
to the peerage as Lord
Rendlesham, she asks--

"Say, shall we bend to titles
thus bestowed,
And like the Egyptians, hail
the calf a god?
With toads, asps, onions,

ornament the shrine,
And reptiles own and pot-
herbs things divine?"

It is evident that Byron, uninspired by Pallas, turned to the *Epics of the Ton* for "copy," but whether he left a blank on purpose because "Vansittart" (to whom Perceval did turn) would not scan, or, misled by old newspapers, would have written "Horner," must remain a mystery.

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Footnote 21: See the portrait of Spencer Perceval in the National Portrait Gallery.

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[cross-reference: return to Footnote 18 of this poem](#)

Footnote 22: The Deal and Dover traffickers in specie.

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The Waltz

Introduction

Byron spent the autumn of 1812 "by the waters of Cheltenham," and, besides writing to order his *Song of Drury Lane* (the address spoken at the opening of the theatre, Oct. 10, 1812), he put in hand a *Satire on Waltzing*. It was published anonymously in the following spring; but, possibly, because it was somewhat coolly received, he told Murray (April 21, 1813) "to contradict the report that he was the author of a certain malicious publication on waltzing." In his memoranda "chiefly with reference to my Byron," Moore notes "Byron's hatred of waltzing," and records a passage of arms between "the lame boy" and Mary Chaworth, which arose from her "dancing with some person who was unknown to her." Then, and always, he must have experienced the bitter sense of exclusion from active amusements; but it is a hasty assumption that Byron only denounced waltzing because he was unable to waltz himself. To modern sentiment, on the moral side, waltzing is unassailable; but the first impressions of spectators, to whom it was a novelty, were distinctly unfavourable.

In a letter from Germany (May 17, 1799) Coleridge describes a dance round the maypole at Rübeland.

"The dances were reels and the waltzes, but chiefly the latter; this dance is in the higher circles sufficiently voluptuous, but here the motions of it were *far* more faithful interpreters of the passions."

A year later, H.C. Robinson, writing from Frankfort in 1800 (*Diary and Letters*, i. 76), says, "The dancing is unlike anything you ever saw. You must have heard of it under the name of waltzing, that is rolling and turning, though the rolling is not horizontal but perpendicular. Yet Werther, after describing his first waltz with Charlotte, says, and I say so too, 'I felt that if I were married my wife should waltz (or roll) with no one but myself.'" Ten years later, Gillray publishes a caricature of the waltz, as a French dance, which he styles, "Le bon Genre." It is not a pretty picture. By degrees, however, and with some reluctance, society yielded to the fascinations of the stranger.

"My cousin Hartington," writes Lady Caroline Lamb, in 1812 (*Memoirs of Viscount Melbourne*, by W.T. McCullagh Torrens, i. 105), "wanted to have waltzes and quadrilles; and at Devonshire House it could not be allowed, so we had them in the great drawing-room at Whitehall. All the *bon ton* assembled there continually. There was nothing so fashionable."

"No event," says Thomas Raikes (*Personal Reminiscences*, p. 284), ever produced so great a sensation in English society as the introduction of the German waltz.... Old and young returned to school, and the mornings were now absorbed at home in practising the figures of a French quadrille or whirling a chair round the room to learn the step and measure of the German waltz. The anti-waltzing party took the alarm, cried it down; mothers forbade it, and every ballroom became a scene of feud and contention. The foreigners were not idle in forming their *élèves*; Baron Tripp, Neumann, St. Aldegonde, etc., persevered in spite of all prejudices which were marshalled against them. It was not, however, till Byron's "malicious publication" had been issued and forgotten that the new dance received full recognition. "When," Raikes concludes, "the Emperor Alexander was seen waltzing round the room at Almack's with his tight uniform and numerous decorations," or [Gronow, *Recollections*, 1860, pp. 32, 33] "Lord Palmerston might have been seen describing an infinite number of circles with Madame de Lieven," insular prejudices gave way, and waltzing became general.

Note to this edition

The title-page of the first edition (4to.) of *The Waltz* bears the imprint:

London:
Printed by S. Gosnell,
Little Queen Street, Holborn.
For Sherwood, Neely and Jones,
Paternoster Row. 1813.
(Price Three Shillings.)

Successive Revises had run as follows:--

- i. London: Printed for John Murray, Albemarle Street, Piccadilly.
By S. Gosnell, Little Queen Street. 1813.
- ii. Cambridge: Printed by G. Maitland. For John Murray, etc.
- iii. Cambridge: Printed by G. Maitland. For Sherwood, Neely and
Jones, Paternoster Row. 1813.

For the Bibliography of *The Waltz*, see **vol. vi.** of the present issue.

To the Publisher.

Sir,

I am a country Gentleman of a midland county. I might have been a Parliament-man for a certain borough; having had the offer of as many votes as General T. at the general election in 1812¹. But I was all for domestic happiness; as, fifteen years ago, on a visit to London, I married a middle-aged Maid of Honour. We lived happily at Hornem Hall till last Season, when my wife and I were invited by the Countess of Waltzaway (a distant relation of my Spouse) to pass the winter in town. Thinking no harm, and our Girls being come to a marriageable (or, as they call it, *marketable*) age, and having besides a Chancery suit inveterately entailed upon the family estate, we came up in our old chariot,--of which, by the bye, my wife grew so ashamed in less than a week, that I was obliged to buy a second-hand barouche, of which I might mount the box, Mrs. H. says, if I could drive, but never see the inside--that place being reserved for the Honourable Augustus Tiptoe, her partner-general and Opera-knight. Hearing great praises of Mrs. H.'s dancing (she was famous for birthnight minuets in the latter end of the last century), I unbooted, and went to a ball at the Countess's, expecting to see a country dance, or, at most, Cotillons, reels, and all the old paces to the newest tunes, But, judge of my surprise, on arriving, to see poor dear Mrs. Hornem with her arms half round the loins of a huge hussar-looking gentleman I never set eyes on before; and his, to say truth, rather more than half round her waist, turning round, and round, to a d----d see-saw up-and-down sort of tune, that reminded me of the "Black Joke," only more "*affettuoso*"² till it made me quite giddy with wondering they were not so. By and by they stopped a bit, and I thought they would sit or fall down:--but no; with Mrs. H.'s hand on his shoulder, "*Quam familiariter*"³ (as Terence said, when I was at school,) they walked about a minute, and then at it again, like two cock-chafers spitted on the same bodkin. I asked what all this meant, when, with a loud laugh, a child no older than our Wilhelmina (a name I never heard but in the *Vicar of Wakefield*, though her mother would call her after the Princess of Swappenbach,) said,

"L--d! Mr. Hornem, can't you see they're valtzing?" or waltzing (I forget which); and then up she got, and her mother and sister, and away they went, and round-abouted it till supper-time. Now that I know what it is, I like it of all things, and so does Mrs. H. (though I have broken my shins, and four times overturned Mrs. Hornem's maid, in practising the preliminary steps in a morning). Indeed, so much do I like it, that having a turn for rhyme, tastily displayed in some election ballads, and songs in honour of all the victories (but till lately I have had little practice in that way), I sat down, and with the aid of William Fitzgerald, Esq., and a few hints from Dr. Busby, (whose recitations I attend, and am monstrous fond of Master Busby's manner of delivering his father's late successful "Drury Lane Address,")⁴ I composed the following hymn, wherewithal to make my sentiments known to the Public; whom, nevertheless, I heartily despise, as well as the critics.

I am, Sir, yours, etc., etc.

Horace Hornem.

Footnote 1: Ý State of the poll (last day) 5.

[General Tarleton (1754-1833) contested Liverpool in October, 1812. For three days the poll stood at five, and on the last day, eleven. Canning and Gascoigne were the successful candidates.]

[return to footnote mark](#)

Footnote 2: Ý More expressive.--[MS.]

[return](#)

Footnote 3: Ý My Latin is all forgotten, if a man can be said to have forgotten what he never remembered; but I bought my title-page motto of a Catholic priest for a three-shilling bank token, after much

haggling for the even sixpence. I grudged the money to a papist, being all for the memory of Perceval and "No popery," and quite regretting the downfall of the pope, because we can't burn him any more.--
[Revise No. 2.]

[return](#)

[cross-reference: return to Footnote 17 of *The Waltz*](#)

Footnote 4: *Ý See Rejected Addresses.*

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The Waltz

an Apostrophic Hymn.

by Horace Hornem, Esq.

"Qualis in Eurotæ ripis, aut per juga Cynthi,
Exercet **Diana** choros."

Virgil, *Æn.* i. 502.

"Such on Eurotas's banks, or Cynthus's height,
Diana seems: and so she charms the sight,
When in the dance the graceful goddess leads
The quire of nymphs, and overtops their heads."

Dryden's *Virgil*.

Muse of the many-twinkling feet¹! whose charms
Are now extended up from legs to arms;
Terpsichore!--too long misdeemed a maid--
Reproachful term--bestowed but to upbraid--
Henceforth in all the bronze of brightness shine^a,
The least a Vestal of the Virgin Nine.

Far be from thee and thine the name of Prude:
Mocked yet triumphant; sneered at, unsubdued;
Thy legs must move to conquer as they fly,
If but thy coats are reasonably high!
Thy breast--if bare enough--requires no shield;
Dance forth--*sans armour* thou shalt take the field
And own--impregnable to *most* assaults,
Thy not too lawfully begotten "Waltz."

10

Hail, nimble Nymph! to whom the young hussar²,
The whiskered votary of Waltz and War,
His night devotes, despite of spur and boots;
A sight unmatched since Orpheus and his brutes:
Hail, spirit-stirring Waltz!--beneath whose banners
A modern hero fought for modish manners;
On Hounslow's heath to rival Wellesley's³ fame,
Cocked, fired, and missed his man--but gained his aim;
Hail, moving muse! to whom the fair one's breast
Gives all it can, and bids us take the rest.

20

Oh! for the flow of Busby⁴, or of Fitz,
The latter's loyalty, the former's wits,
To "energise the object I pursue,"
And give both Belial and his Dance their due^b!
Imperial Waltz! imported from the Rhine

(Famed for the growth of pedigrees and wine),
 Long be thine import from all duty free, 30
 And Hock itself be less esteemed than thee;
 In some few qualities alike--for Hock
 Improves our cellar--*thou* our living stock.
 The head to Hock belongs--thy subtler art
 Intoxicates alone the heedless heart:
 Through the full veins thy gentler poison swims,
 And wakes to Wantonness the willing limbs.
 Oh, Germany! how much to thee we owe,
 As heaven-born Pitt can testify below,
 Ere cursed Confederation made thee France's, 40
 And only left us thy d--d debts and dances⁵!
Of subsidies and Hanover bereft,
 We bless thee still--George the Third is left!
 Of kings the best--and last, not least in worth,
 For graciously begetting George the Fourth.
 To Germany, and Highnesses serene,
 Who owe us millions--don't we owe the Queen?
 To Germany, what owe we not besides?
 So oft bestowing Brunswickers and brides;
 Who paid for vulgar, with her royal blood,
 Drawn from the stem of each Teutonic stud: 50
 Who sent us--so be pardoned all her faults--
 A dozen dukes, some kings, a Queen--and Waltz.
 But peace to her--her Emperor and Diet,
 Though now transferred to Buonapartè's "fiat!"
 Back to my theme--O muse of Motion! say,
 How first to Albion found thy Waltz her way?
 Borne on the breath of Hyperborean gales,
 From Hamburg's port (while Hamburg yet had *mails*),
 Ere yet unlucky Fame--compelled to creep
 To snowy Gottenburg--was chilled to sleep; 60
Or, starting from her slumbers, deigned arise,
 Heligoland! to stock thy mart with lies^c;
 While unburnt Moscow⁶ yet had news to send,
Nor owed her fiery Exit to a friend,

She came--Waltz came--and with her certain sets
 Of true despatches, and as true Gazettes;
 Then flamed of Austerlitz the blest despatch⁷,
Which *Moniteur* nor *Morning Post* can match
 And--almost crushed beneath the glorious news--
 Ten plays, and forty tales of Kotzebue's⁸; 70
One envoy's letters, six composer's airs,
And loads from Frankfort and from Leipsic fairs:
 Meiners' four volumes upon Womankind⁹,
Like Lapland witches to ensure a wind;
Brunck's heaviest tome for ballast,¹⁰ and, to back it,
Of Heynè,¹¹ such as should not sink the packet^d.
 Fraught with this cargo--and her fairest freight,
 Delightful Waltz, on tiptoe for a Mate,
 The welcome vessel reached the genial strand,
 And round her flocked the daughters of the land. 80
 Not decent David, when, before the ark,
 His grand *Pas-seul* excited some remark;
 Not love-lorn Quixote, when his Sancho thought
 The knight's *Fandango* friskier than it ought;
 Not soft Herodias, when, with winning tread,
 Her nimble feet danced off another's head;
 Not Cleopatra on her Galley's Deck,
 Displayed so much of *leg* or more of *neck*,
 Than Thou, ambrosial Waltz, when first the Moon
 Beheld thee twirling to a Saxon tune! 90

To You, ye husbands of ten years! whose brows
 Ache with the annual tributes of a spouse;
 To you of nine years less, who only bear
 The budding sprouts of those that you *shall* wear,
 With added ornaments around them rolled
 Of native brass, or law-awarded gold;
 To You, ye Matrons, ever on the watch
 To mar a son's, or make a daughter's match;
 To You, ye children of--whom chance accords--

Always the Ladies, and *sometimes* their Lords; 100
 To You, ye single gentlemen, who seek
 Torments for life, or pleasures for a week;
 As Love or Hymen your endeavours guide,
 To gain your own, or snatch another's bride;--
 To one and all the lovely Stranger came,
 And every Ball-room echoes with her name.
 Endearing Waltz!--to thy more melting tune
 Bow Irish Jig, and ancient Rigadoon.¹²
Scotch reels, avaunt! and Country-dance forego
 Your future claims to each fantastic toe! 110
 Waltz--Waltz alone--both legs and arms demands,
 Liberal of feet, and lavish of her hands;
 Hands which may freely range in public sight
 Where ne'er before--but--pray "put out the light."
 Methinks the glare of yonder chandelier
 Shines much too far--or I am much too near;
 And true, though strange--Waltz whispers this remark,
 "My slippery steps are safest in the dark!"
 But here the Muse with due decorum halts,
 And lends her longest petticoat to "Waltz." 120
 Observant Travellers of every time!
 Ye Quartos published upon every clime!
 O say, shall dull *Romaika's* heavy round,
Fandango's wriggle, or *Bolero's* bound;
 Can Egypt's *Almas*¹³--tantalising group--
Columbia's caperers to the warlike Whoop--
 Can aught from cold Kamschatka to Cape Horn
 With Waltz compare, or after Waltz be born?
 Ah, no! from Morier's pages down to Galt's,¹⁴
Each tourist pens a paragraph for "Waltz." 130
 Shades of those Belles whose reign began of yore,
 With George the Third's--and ended long before!--
 Though in your daughters' daughters yet you thrive^e,
Burst from your lead, and be yourselves alive!
Back to the Ball-room speed your spectred host,

Fool's Paradise is dull to that you lost^f.
No treacherous powder bids Conjecture quake;
 No stiff-starched stays make meddling fingers ache^g;
 (Transferred to those ambiguous things that ape
 Goats in their visage,¹⁵ women in their shape;) 140
No damsel faints when rather closely pressed,
 But more caressing seems when most caressed;
 Superfluous Hartshorn, and reviving Salts,
 Both banished by the sovereign cordial "Waltz."
 Seductive Waltz!--though on thy native shore
 Even Werter's self proclaimed thee half a whore;
 Werter--to decent vice though much inclined,
 Yet warm, not wanton; dazzled, but not blind--
 Though gentle Genlis,¹⁶ in her strife with Staël,
Would even proscribe thee from a Paris ball; 150
 The fashion hails--from Countesses to Queens,
 And maids and valets waltz behind the scenes;
 Wide and more wide thy witching circle spreads,
 And turns--if nothing else--at least our *heads*;
 With thee even clumsy cits attempt to bounce,
 And cockney's practise what they can't pronounce.
 Gods! how the glorious theme my strain exalts,
 And Rhyme finds partner Rhyme in praise of "Waltz!"
 Blest was the time Waltz chose for her *début*!
 The Court, the Regent, like herself were new;¹⁷ 160
New face for friends, for foes some new rewards;
 New ornaments for black-and royal Guards^h;
New laws to hang the rogues that roared for bread;
 New coins (most new)¹⁸ to follow those that fled;
New victories--nor can we prize them less,
 Though Jenky¹⁹ wonders at his own success;
New wars, because the old succeed so well,
 That most survivors envy those who fell;
 New mistresses--no, old--and yet 'tis true,
 Though they be *old*, the *thing* is something new;
 Each new, quite new--(except some ancient tricks),²⁰ 170

New white-sticks--gold-sticks--broom-sticks--*all new sticks!*
 With vests or ribands--decked alike in hue,
 New troopers strut, new turncoats blush in blue:
 So saith the Muse: my----,²¹ what say you?
Such was the time when Waltz might best maintain
 Her new preferments in this novel reign;
 Such was the time, nor ever yet was such;
 Hoops are *more*, and petticoats *not much*;
 Morals and Minuets, Virtue and her stays,
 And tell-tale powder--all have had their days. 180
 The Ball begins--the honours of the house
 First duly done by daughter or by spouse,
 Some Potentate--or royal or serene--
 With Kent's gay grace, or sapient Gloster's mien^j,
Leads forth the ready dame, whose rising flush
 Might once have been mistaken for a blush.
 From where the garb just leaves the bosom free,
 That spot where hearts²² were once supposed to be;
Round all the confines of the yielded waist,
 The strangest hand may wander undisplaced: 190
 The lady's in return may grasp as much
 As princely paunches offer to her touch.
 Pleased round the chalky floor how well they trip
 One hand reposing on the royal hip!²³
The other to the shoulder no less royal
 Ascending with affection truly loyal!
 Thus front to front the partners move or stand,
 The foot may rest, but none withdraw the hand;
 And all in turn may follow in their rank,
The Earl of--Asterisk--and Lady--Blank; 200
 Sir--Such-a-one--with those of fashion's host,^{24 k}
For whose blest surnames--vide "Morning Post."
 (Or if for that impartial print too late,
 Search Doctors' Commons six months from my date)--
 Thus all and each, in movement swift or slow,
 The genial contact gently undergo;

Till some might marvel, with the modest Turk,
 If "nothing follows all this palming work?"²⁵
 True, honest Mirza!--you may trust my rhyme--
 Something does follow at a fitter time; 210
 The breast thus publicly resigned to man,
 In private may resist him--if it can.
O ye who loved our Grandmothers of yore,
 Fitzpatrick,²⁶ Sheridan, and many more!
 And thou, my Prince! whose sovereign taste and will^m
It is to love the lovely beldames still!
 Thou Ghost of Queensberry!²⁷ whose judging Sprite
Satan may spare to peep a single night,
 Pronounce--if ever in your days of bliss
 Asmodeus struck so bright a stroke as this; 220
 To teach the young ideas how to rise,
 Flush in the cheek, and languish in the eyes;
 Rush to the heart, and lighten through the frame,
 With half-told wish, and ill-dissembled flame,
 For prurient Nature still will storm the breast--
 Who, tempted thus, can answer for the rest?
 But ye--who never felt a single thought
 For what our Morals are to be, or ought;
 Who wisely wish the charms you view to reap,
 Say--would you make those beauties quite so cheap? 230
 Hot from the hands promiscuously applied,
 Round the slight waist, or down the glowing side,
 Where were the rapture then to clasp the form
 From this lewd grasp and lawless contact warmⁿ?
At once Love's most endearing thought resign,
 To press the hand so pressed by none but thine;
 To gaze upon that eye which never met
 Another's ardent look without regret;
 Approach the lip which all, without restraint,
 Come near enough--if not to touch--to taint;
 If such thou lovest--love her then no more, 240
 Or give--like her--caresses to a score;

Her Mind with these is gone, and with it go
 The little left behind it to bestow.
 Voluptuous Waltz! and dare I thus blaspheme?
 Thy bard forgot thy praises were his theme.
 Terpsichore forgive!--at every Ball
 My wife *now* waltzes--and my daughters *shall*;
 My son--(or stop--'tis needless to inquire--
 These little accidents should ne'er transpire;
 Some ages hence our genealogic tree^P
Will wear as green a bough for him as me)--
 Waltzing shall rear, to make our name amends
 Grandsons for me--in heirs to all his friends.

250

Footnote 1: Ý "Glance their many- **Footnote a:** Ý
 twinkling feet."--**Gray.**

[return to footnote mark](#)

*Henceforth with due
 unblushing brightness shine...*

[MS.]

[return](#)

Footnote 2: Ý Lines 15-28 do not **Footnote b:** Ý
 appear in the MS., but ten lines
 (omitting lines 21-24) were
 inserted in Proof No. 1.

[return](#)

*And weave a couplet worthy
 them and you...*

[Proof]

[return](#)

Footnote 3: Ý To rival Lord
 Wellesley's, or his nephew's, as the
 reader pleases:--the one gained a
 pretty woman, whom he deserved,
 by fighting for; and the other has

Footnote c: Ý

*To make Heligoland the mart
 for lies...*

been fighting in the Peninsula [MS. M.]
many a long day, "by Shrewsbury [return](#)
clock," without gaining anything
in *that* country but the title of "the
Great Lord," and "the Lord;"
which savours of profanation,
having been hitherto applied only
to that Being to whom "*Te Deums*"
for carnage are the rankest
blasphemy.--It is to be presumed
the general will one day return to
his Sabine farm: there

"To tame the genius of the
stubborn plain,
Almost as quickly as he
conquer'd Spain!"

The Lord Peterborough conquered
continents in a summer; we do
more--we contrive both to conquer
and lose them in a shorter season.
If the "great Lord's" *Cincinnatian*
progress in agriculture be no
speedier than the proportional
average of time in Pope's couplet,
it will, according to the farmer's
proverb, be "ploughing with
dogs."

By the bye--one of this illustrious
person's new titles is forgotten--it
is, however, worth remembering--
"Salvador del mundo!" credite,
poster! If this be the appellation
annexed by the inhabitants of the
Peninsula to the name of a *man*

who has not yet saved them--
query--are they worth saving, even
in this world? for, according to the
mildest modifications of any
Christian creed, those three words
make the odds much against them
in the next--"Saviour of the
world," quotha!--it were to be
wished that he, or any one else,
could save a corner of it--his
country. Yet this stupid misnomer,
although it shows the near
connection between superstition
and impiety, so far has its use, that
it proves there can be little to
dread from those Catholics
(inquisitorial Catholics too) who
can confer such an appellation on
a *Protestant*. I suppose next year
he will be entitled the "Virgin
Mary;" if so, Lord George Gordon
himself would have nothing to
object to such liberal bastards of
our Lady of Babylon.

[William Pole-Wellesley (1785?
-1857), afterwards fourth Lord
Mornington, a nephew of the great
Duke of Wellington, married, in
March, 1812, Catharine, daughter
and heiress of Sir Tylney Long,
Bart. On his marriage he added his
wife's double surname to his own,
and, thereby, gave the wits their
chance. In *Rejected Addresses*
Fitzgerald is made to exclaim--

"Bless every man possess'd
of aught to give,
Long may Long-Tilney-
Wellesley-Long-Pole live."

The principals in the duel to which Byron alludes were Wellesley-Pole and Lord Kilworth. The occasion of the quarrel was a misconception of some expression of Pole's at an assembly at Lady Hawarden's (August 6, 1811). A meeting took place on Wimbledon Common (August 9), at which the seconds intervened, and everything was "amicably adjusted." Some days later a letter appeared in the *Morning Post* (August 14, 1811), signed "Kilworth," to the effect that an apology had been offered and accepted. This led to a second meeting on Hounslow Heath (August 15), when shots were exchanged. Again the seconds intervened, and, after more explanations, matters were finally arranged. A *jeu d'esprit* which appeared in the *Morning Chronicle* (August 16, 1811) connects the "mortal fracas" with Pole's prowess in waltzing at a fête at Wanstead House, near Hackney, where, when the heiress had been wooed and won, his guests used to dine at midnight after the opera.

"Mid the tumult of waltzing
and wild Irish reels,
A prime dancer, I'm sure to
get at her--
And by Love's graceful
movements to trip up her
heels,
Is the Long and the short of
the matter."

[return](#)

Footnote 4: Ý Thomas Busby,
Mus. Doc. (1755-1838), musical
composer, and author of *A New
and Complete Musical Dictionary*,
1801, etc. He was also a versifier.
As early as 1785 he published *The
Age of Genius, A Satire*; and, after
he had ceased to compose music
for the stage, brought out a
translation of Lucretius, which had
long been in MS. His "rejected
address" on the reopening of
Drury Lane Theatre, would have
been recited by his son (October
15), but the gallery refused to hear
it out. On the next night (October
16) "Master" Busby was more
successful. Byron's parody of
Busby's address, which began with
the line, "When energising objects
men pursue," is headed,
"Parenthetical Address. By Dr.
Plagiary."

[return](#)

Footnote 5: Ý The Confederation
of the Rhine (1803-1813), by

Footnote d: Ý

*As much of Heyne as should
not sink the packet...*

[MS. M.]

[return](#)

Footnote e: Ý

which the courts of Würtemberg and Bavaria, together with some lesser principalities, detached themselves from the Germanic Body, and accepted the immediate protection of France.

[return](#)

Footnote 6: The patriotic arson of our amiable allies cannot be sufficiently commended--nor subscribed for. Amongst other details omitted in the various^A despatches of our eloquent ambassador, he did not state (being too much occupied with the exploits of Colonel C----, in swimming rivers frozen, and galloping over roads impassable,) that one entire province perished by famine in the most melancholy manner, as follows:--In General Rostopchin's consummate conflagration, the consumption of tallow and train oil was so great, that the market was inadequate to the demand: and thus one hundred and thirty-three thousand persons were starved to death, by being reduced to wholesome diet! the lamp-lighters of London have since subscribed a pint (of oil) a piece, and the tallow-chandlers have unanimously voted a quantity of best moulds (four to the pound), to the relief of the surviving Scythians;--the scarcity will soon, by such exertions, and a proper

*Who in your daughters'
daughters yet survive
Like Banquo's spirit be
yourselves alive....*

[MS. M.]

[return](#)

Footnote f:

*Elysium's ill exchanged for
that you lost...*

[MS. M.]

[return](#)

attention to the *quality* rather than the quantity of provision, be totally alleviated. It is said, in return, that the untouched Ukraine has subscribed sixty thousand beeves for a day's meal to our suffering manufacturers.

[Hamburg fell to Napoleon's forces in 1810, and thence-forward the mails from the north of Europe were despatched from Anholt, or Gothenberg, or Heligoland. In 1811 an attempt to enforce the conscription resulted in the emigration of numbers of young men of suitable age for military service. The unfortunate city was deprived of mails and males at the same time.

Heligoland, which was taken by the British in 1807, and turned into a depot for the importation of smuggled goods to French territory, afforded a meeting-place for British and continental traders. Mails from Heligoland detailed rumours of what was taking place at the centres of war; but the newspapers occasionally threw doubts on the information obtained from this source. Lord Cathcart's despatch, dated November 23, appeared in the *Gazette* December 16, 1812. The paragraph which appealed to

Byron's sense of humour is as follows:

"The expedition of Colonel Chernichef (*sic*) [the Czar's aide-de-camp] was a continued and extraordinary exertion, he having marched seven hundred wersts (*sic*) in five days, and swam several rivers."

Sub-Footnote A: Veracious despatches.--[*MS. M.*]

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[return to poem](#)

Footnote 7: Austerlitz was fought on Dec. 2, 1805. On Dec. 20 the *Morning Chronicle* published a communication from a correspondent, giving the substance of Napoleon's "Proclamation to the Army," issued on the evening after the battle, which had reached Bourrienne, the French minister at Hamburg. "An army," ran the proclamation, "of 100,000 men, which was commanded by the Emperors of Russia and Austria, has been in less than four hours either cut off or dispersed." It was an official note of this "blest despatch," forwarded by courier to Bath, which brought "the heavy news" to Pitt, and, it is believed,

Footnote g: Ý

*No stiff-starched stays make
meddling lovers ache...*

[*MS. M.*]

[return](#)

hastened his death.

[return](#)

Footnote 8: Ý August Frederick Ferdinand von Kotzebue (1761-1819), whom Coleridge appraised as "the German Beaumont and Fletcher without their poetic powers," and Carlyle as "a bundle of dyed rags," wrote over a hundred plays, publishing twenty within a few years.

Footnote h: Ý

New caps and Jackets for the royal Guards...

[MS. M.]

[return](#)

An adaptation of *Misanthropy and Repentance* as *The Stranger*, Sheridan's *Pizarro*, and Lewis' *Castle Spectre* are well-known instances of his powerful influence on English dramatists.

"The Present," writes Sara Coleridge, in a note to one of her father's letters, "will ever have her special votaries in the world of letters, who collect into their focus, by a kind of burning-glass, the feelings of the day. Amongst such Kotzebue holds a high rank. Those 'dyed rags' of his once formed gorgeous banners, and flaunted in the eyes of refined companies from London to Madrid, from Paris to Moscow."

--Coleridge's *Biographia Literaria* (1847), ii. 227.

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Footnote 9: Ý A translation of Christopher Meiner's *History of the Female Sex*, in four volumes, was published in London in 1808. Lapland wizards, not witches, were said to raise storms by knotting pieces of string, which they exposed to the wind.

[return](#)

Footnote 10: Ý Richard Franz Philippe Brunck (1729-1803). His editions of the *Anthologia Græca*, and of the Greek dramatists are among his best known works. Compare Sheridan's doggerel--

"Huge leaves of that great commentator, old Brunck,
Perhaps is the paper that
lined my poor *Trunk*."

[return](#)

Footnote 11: Ý Christian Gottlob Heyne (1729-1812) published editions of *Virgil* (1767-1775), *Pindar* (1773), and *Opuscula Academica*, in six vols. (1785-1812).

[return](#)

Footnote 12: Ý A lively dance for one couple, characterized by a peculiar jumping step. It probably

Footnote j: Ý

*With K--t's gay grace, or
silly-Billy's mien...*

[MS. M.]

*With K--t's gay grace, or G--
r's booby mien...*

[MS. erased.]

[return](#)

Footnote k: Ý

*Sir--Such a one--with Mrs.--
Miss So-so...*

[Revise]

[return](#)

Footnote m: Ý

*And thou my Prince whose
undisputed will...*

[MS. M.]

[return](#)

Footnote n: Ý

*From this abominable
contact warm...*

originated in Provence.

[return](#)

Footnote 13: Ý Dancing girls--
who do for hire what Waltz doth
gratis.

[The Romaika is a modern Greek
dance, characterized by
serpentine figures and
handkerchief-throwing among the
dancers. The Fandango (Spaniards
use the word "seguidilla") was of
Moorish origin. The Bolero was
brought from Provence, circ.
1780.

"The Bolero intoxicates, the
Fandango inflames"

(*Hist. of Dancing*, by G. Vuillier-
Heinemann, 1898).]

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Footnote 14: Ý For Morier, see
note to line 211. Galt has a
paragraph descriptive of the
waltzing Dervishes (*Voyages and
Travels* (1812), p.190).

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Footnote 15: Ý It cannot be
complained now, as in the Lady
Baussière's time, of the "Sieur de
la Croix," that there be "no
whiskers;" but how far these are
indications of valour in the field,
or elsewhere, may still be
questionable. Much may be, and
hath been^A; avouched on both

[MS. M.]

[return](#)

Footnote p: Ý

*Some generations hence our
Pedigree Will never look the
worse for him or me....*

[MS. Erased.]

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sides. In the olden time
philosophers had whiskers, and
soldiers none--Scipio himself was
shaven--Hannibal thought his one
eye handsome enough without a
beard; but Adrian, the emperor,
wore a beard (having warts on his
chin, which neither the Empress
Sabina nor even the courtiers
could abide)--Turenne had
whiskers, Marlborough none--
Buonaparte is unwhiskered, the
Regent whiskered; "*argal*"
greatness of mind and whiskers
may or may not go together; but
certainly the different occurrences,
since the growth of the last
mentioned, go further in behalf of
whiskers than the anathema of
Anselm did *against* long hair in
the reign of Henry I.--Formerly,
red was a favourite colour. See
Lodowick Barrey's comedy of
Ram Alley, 1661; Act I. Scene I.

Taffeta. Now for a wager--
What coloured beard comes
next by the window?

Adriana. A black man's, I
think.

Taffeta. I think not so: I think
a *red*, for that is most in
fashion."

There is "nothing new under the sun:" but *red*, then a *favourite*, has now subsided into a favourite's colour.

[This is, doubtless, an allusion to Lord Yarmouth, whose fiery whiskers gained him the nickname of "Red Herrings."]

Sub-Footnote A: nbsp; The paragraph "Much may be" down to "reign of Henry I." was added in Revise 1, and the remainder of the note in Revise 2.

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Footnote 16: Ý Madame Genlis (Stephanie Félicité Ducrest, Marquise de Sillery), commenting on the waltz, writes,

"As a foreigner, I shall not take the liberty to censure this kind of dance; but this I can say, that it appears intolerable to German writers of superior merits who are not accused of severity of manners,"

and by way of example instances M. Jacobi, who affirms that "Werther (*Sorrows of Werther*, Letter ix.), the lover of Charlotte, swears that, were he to perish for it, never should a girl for whom he

entertained any affection, and on whom he had honourable views, dance the waltz with any other man besides himself."--*Selections from the Works of Madame de Genlis* (1806), p. 65.

Compare, too, "Faulkland" on country-dances in *The Rivals*, act ii. sc. I,

"Country-dances! jigs and reels!... A minuet I could have forgiven.... Zounds! had she made one in a cotillon--I believe I could have forgiven even that--but to be monkey-led for a night! to run the gauntlet through a string of amorous palming puppies... Oh, Jack, there never can be but one man in the world whom a truly modest and delicate woman ought to pair with in a country-dance; and even then, the rest of the couples should be her great-uncles and aunts!"

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Footnote 17: Ý An anachronism--Waltz and the battle of Austerlitz are before said to have opened the ball together; the bard means (if he means anything), Waltz was not so much in vogue till the Regent attained the acme of his

popularity. Waltz, the comet, whiskers, and the new government, illuminated heaven and earth, in all their glory, much about the same time: of these the comet only has disappeared; the other three continue to astonish us still.--*Printers Devil*.

[As the *Printer's Devil* intimates, the various novelties of the age of "Waltz" are somewhat loosely enumerated. The Comet, which signalized 1811, the year of the restricted Regency, had disappeared before the Prince and his satellites burst into full blaze in 1812. It was (see *Historical Record of the Life Guards*, 1835, p.177) in 1812 that the Prince Regent commanded the following alterations to be made in the equipments of the regiment of Life Guards:

"Cocked hats with feathers to be discontinued, and brass helmets with black horsehair crests substituted. Long coats, trimmed with gold lace across the front. Shirts and cuffs to be replaced by short coatees," etc., etc.

In the same branch of the service, whiskers were already in vogue. The "new laws" were those

embodied in the "Frame-work Bill," which Byron denounced in his speech in the House of Lords, Feb. 27, 1812. Formerly the breaking of frames had been treated "as a minor felony, punishable by transportation for fourteen years," and the object of the bill was to make such offences capital. The bill passed into law on March 5, and as a result we read (*Annual Register*, 1812, pp.38,39) that on May 24 a special commission for the rioters of Cheshire was opened by Judge Dallas at Chester.

"His lordship passed the awful sentence of death upon sixteen, and in a most impressioned address, held out not the smallest hope of mercy."

Of these five *only* were hanged.

Owing to the scarcity of silver coinage, the Bank of England was empowered to issue bank-tokens for various sums (Mr. Hornem bought his motto for *The Waltz* with a three-shilling bank-token; see [note](#) to Preface) which came into circulation on July 9, 1811. The "new ninepences" which were said to be forthcoming never passed into circulation at all. A

single "pattern" coin (on the obverse, *Bank Token, Ninepence, 1812*) is preserved in the British Museum (see privately printed *Catalogue*, by W. Boyne (1866), p.11). The "new victories" were the fall of Ciudad Rodrigo (Jan. 17), the capture of Badajoz (April 7), and the Battle of Salamanca (July 12, 1812). By way of "new wars," the President of the United States declared war with Great Britain on June 18, and Great Britain with the United States, Oct. 13, 1812. As to "new mistresses," for a reference to "*Our Sultan's*" "she-promotions" of "those only plump and sage, Who've reached the regulation age," see *Intercepted Letters, or the Twopenny Post-bag*, by Thomas Brown the Younger, 1813, and for "gold sticks," etc., see "Promotions" in the *Annual Register* for March, 1812, in which a long list of Household appointments is duly recorded.]

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Footnote 18: Ý Amongst others a new ninepence--a creditable coin now forthcoming, worth a pound, in paper, at the fairest calculation.

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Footnote 19: Ý Robert Banks Jenkinson, second Earl of Liverpool, was Secretary at War and for the Colonies from 1809 to

1812, in Spencer Perceval's administration, and, on the assassination of the premier, undertook the government. Both as Secretary at War and as Prime Minister his chief efforts were devoted to the support of Wellington in the Peninsula.

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Footnote 20: Ý "Oh that *right* should thus overcome *might*!" Who does not remember the "delicate investigation" in the *Merry Wives of Windsor*?--

Ford: Pray you, come near; if I suspect without cause, why then make sport at me; then let me be your jest; I deserve it. How now? whither bear you this?

Mrs. Ford. What have you to do whither they bear it?--You were best meddle with buck-washing."

[Act iii. sc. 3.]

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Footnote 21: ÝThe gentle, or ferocious, reader may fill up the blank as he pleases--there are several dissyllabic names at *his* service (being already in the Regent's): it would not be fair to back any peculiar initial against the alphabet, as every month will

add to the list now entered for the sweep-stakes;--a distinguished consonant is said to be the favourite, much against the wishes of the *knowing ones*.--[Revise]

[In the Revise the line, which is not in the MS., ran,"So saith the Muse; my M---- what say you?" The name intended to be supplied is "Moirra."

On Perceval's death (May 11 1812), Lord Liverpool became Prime Minister, but was unable to carry on the government. Accordingly the Prince Regent desired the Marquis Wellesley and Canning to approach Lords Grey and Grenville with regard to the formation of a coalition ministry. They were unsuccessful, and as a next step Lord Moira (Francis Rawdon, first Marquis of Hastings, 1754-1826) was empowered to make overtures in the same quarter. The Whig Lords stipulated that the regulation of the Household should rest with ministers, and to this Moira would not consent, possibly because the Prince's favourite, Lord Yarmouth, was Vice-Chamberlain. Negotiations were again broken off, and on June 9 Liverpool began his long term of office as Prime Minister.

"I sate," writes Byron, "in the debate or rather discussion in the House of Lords on that question (the second negotiation) immediately behind Moira, who, while Grey was speaking, turned round to me repeatedly, and asked me whether I agreed with him. It was an awkward question to me, who had not heard both sides. Moira kept repeating to me, 'It is *not* so; it is so and so,'" etc.

(Letter to W. Banks (undated), *Life*, p. 162). Hence the question, "My Moira, what say you?"]

[return](#)

Footnote 22: Ý

"We have changed all that," says the Mock Doctor--'tis all gone--Asmodeus knows where. After all, it is of no great importance how women's hearts are disposed of; they have nature's privilege to distribute them as absurdly as possible. But there are also some men with hearts so thoroughly bad, as to remind us of those phenomena often mentioned in natural history; viz. a mass of solid stone--only to be opened by force--and when

divided, you discover a *toad*
in the centre, lively, and with
the reputation of being
venomous."

[In the MS. the last sentence
stood: "In this country there is *one*
man with a heart so thoroughly
bad that it reminds us of those
unaccountable petrifications often
mentioned in natural history," etc.
The couplet--

"Such things we know are
neither rich nor rare,
But wonder how the Devil
they got there,"

which was affixed to the note, was
subsequently erased.]

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Footnote 23: Ý Compare
Sheridan's lines on waltzing,
which Moore heard him "repeat in
a drawing-room"--

"With tranquil step, and timid
downcast glance,
Behold the well-pair'd couple
now advance.
In such sweet posture our
first parents moved,
While, hand in hand, through
Eden's bower they roved.
Ere yet the devil, with
promise fine and false,
Turned their poor heads, and

taught them how to waltz.
One hand grasps hers, the
other holds her hip.

...

For so the law's laid down by
Baron Trip."

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Footnote 24: Ý Lines 204-207 are not in the MS., but were added in a revise.

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Footnote 25: Ý In Turkey a pertinent--here an impertinent and superfluous question--literally put, as in the text, by a Persian to Morier, on seeing a Waltz in Pera.

[See *A Journey through Persia*, etc. By James Morier, London (1812), p. 365.]

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Footnote 26: Ý Richard Fitzpatrick (1747-1813), second son of John, first Earl of Ossory, served in the first American War at the battles of Brandywine and Germanstown. He sat as M.P. for Tavistock for thirty-three years. The chosen friend and companion of Fox, he was a prominent member of the opposition during the close of the eighteenth century. In the ministry of "All the Talents" he was Secretary at War. He dabbled in literature, was one of the authors of the *Rolliad*, and in

1775 published *Dorinda: A Town Eclogue*. He was noted for his social gifts, and in recognition, it is said, of his "fine manners and polite address," inherited a handsome annuity from the Duke of Queensberry. Byron associates him with Sheridan as *un homme galant* and leader of *ton* of the past generation.

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Footnote 27: ¶ William Douglas, third Earl of March and fourth Duke of Queensberry (1724-1810), otherwise "old Q.," was conspicuous as a "blood" and evil liver from youth to extreme old age. He was a patron of the turf, a connoisseur of Italian Opera, and *surtout* an inveterate libertine. As a Whig, he held office in the Household during North's Coalition Ministry, but throughout George the Third's first illness in 1788, displayed such indecent partisanship with the Prince of Wales, that, when the king recovered, he lost his post. His dukedom died with him, and his immense fortune was divided between the heirs to his other titles and his friends. Lord Yarmouth, whose wife, Maria Fagniani, he believed to be his natural daughter, was one of the principal legatees.

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end of text

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